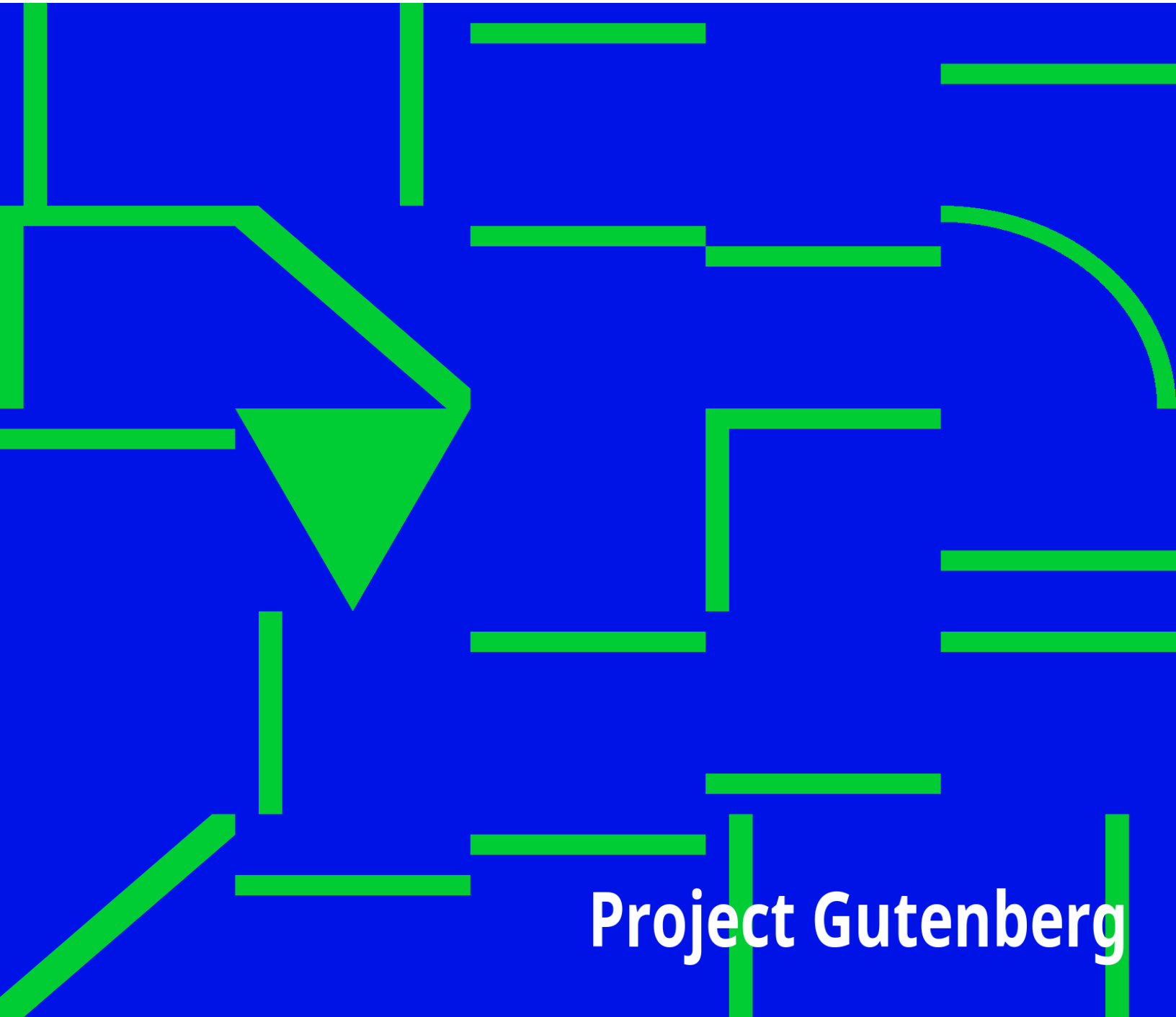


The Comedies of Terence

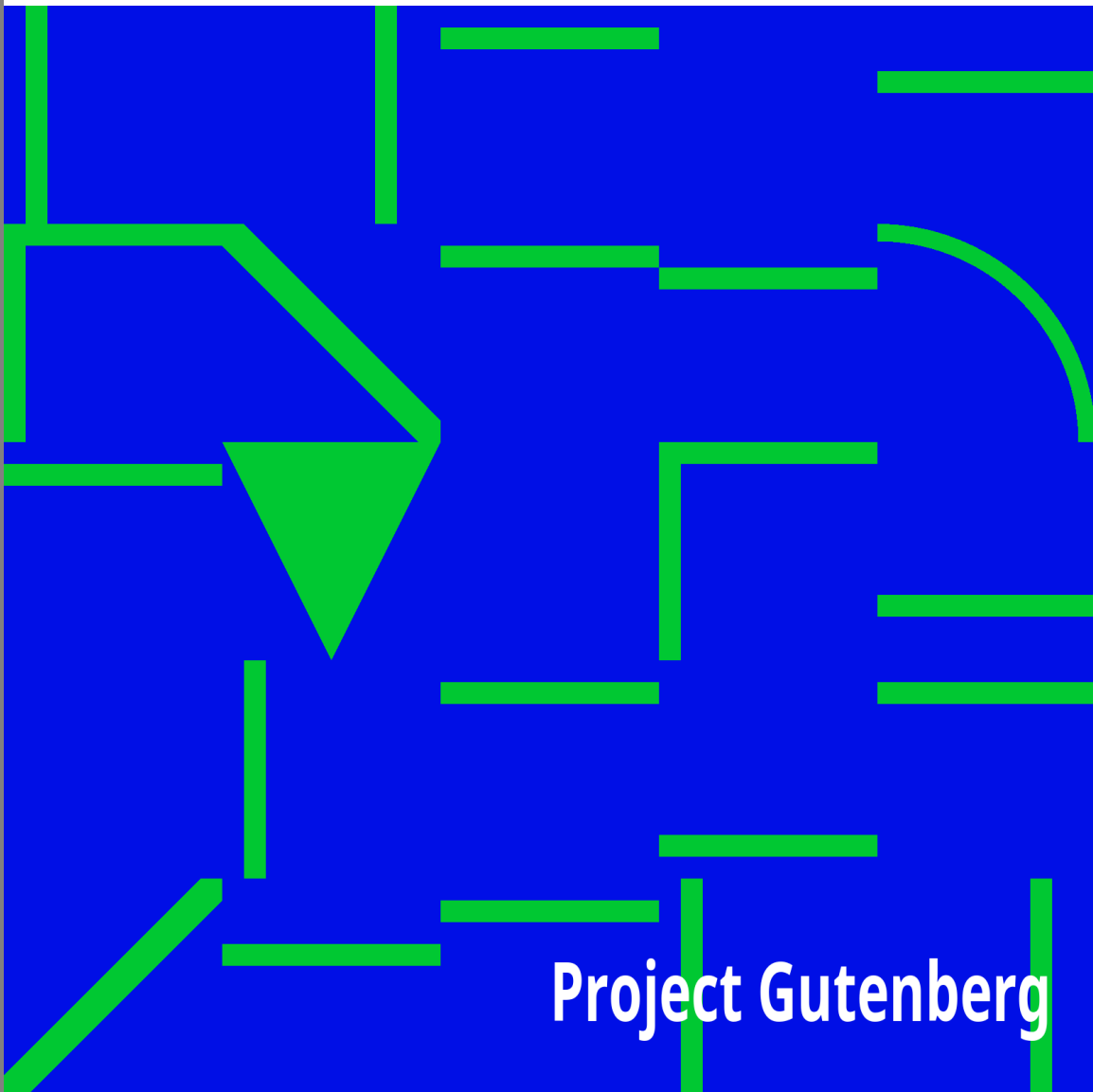
Terence



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The Comedies of Terence

Terence



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OF TERENCE ***

This translation of Terence was published by Harper & Brothers as the second part of an omnibus volume also containing the 1853 Riley translation (prose, with notes and commentary). The Riley portion has been released as [a separate e-text](#).

This e-text includes readings from the 1768 second edition of Colman, shown along the right side of the screen. In general, only differences in wording are

included; variations in spelling and punctuation were disregarded, and stage directions are omitted unless significant. It is not known whether the Harper's text was based on the first edition of Colman or some later edition. Where the Harper text was clearly in error, the 1768 reading was substituted in the main text. Errors are marked with mouse-hover popups:

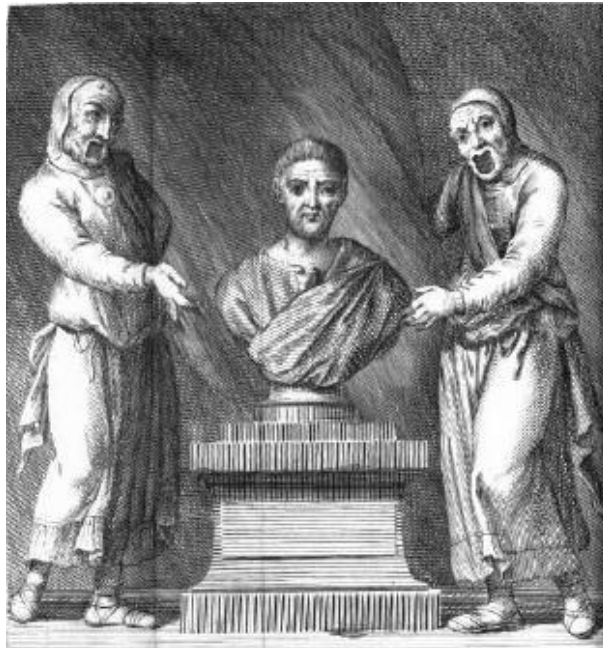
—Shared errors.

—Errors in the Harper text, corrected from the 1768 edition. In some plays, quotation marks were also supplied from the 1768 edition.

—Errors in the 1768 edition.

Page numbers in the left margin are from the 1896 Harper text, which is generally identical to the original 1859 printing and may have been set from the same plates. Page numbers in the right margin are from the 1768 Colman edition.

All illustrations are from the 1768 Colman edition.



THE
COMEDIES
OF

TERENCE.

LITERALLY TRANSLATED INTO ENGLISH PROSE,
WITH NOTES.

BY HENRY THOMAS RILEY, B.A.,

LATE SCHOLAR OF CLARE HALL, CAMBRIDGE.

TO WHICH IS ADDED
THE BLANK VERSE TRANSLATION OF
GEORGE COLMAN.

NEW YORK:

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1896.

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THE
COMEDIES
OF
TERENCE.

TRANSLATED INTO
FAMILIAR BLANK VERSE,
BY GEORGE COLMAN.

Primores populi arripuit populumque tributim:
Scilicet uni æquus virtuti atque ejus amicis.
Quin ubi se a vulgo et scena in secreta remorant

Virtus Scipiadae et mitis sapientia Læli,
Nugari cum illo et discincti ludere, donec
Decoqueretur olus, soliti.

HORACE.



THE ANDRIAN.

PERSONS REPRESENTED.

PROLOGUE.	BYRRHIA.
SIMO.	DROMO.
PAMPHILUS.	SERVANTS, ETC.
CHREMES.	
CHARINUS.	GLYCERIUM.
CRITO.	MYSIS.
SOSIA.	LESBIA.
DAVUS.	ARCHYLLIS.

SCENE, ATHENS.

PROLOGUE.

THE Bard, when first he gave his mind to write,
Thought it his only business, that his Plays
Should please the people: but it now falls out,
He finds, much otherwise, and wastes, perforce,
His time in writing Prologues; not to tell
The argument, but to refute the slanders
Broach'd by the malice of an older Bard.

And mark what vices he is charg'd withal!
Menander wrote the Andrian and Perinthian:
Know one, and you know both; in argument
Less diff'rent than in sentiment and style.
What suited with the Andrian he confesses
From the Perinthian he transferr'd, and us'd

For his: and this it is these sland'ers blame,
Proving by deep and learned disputation,
That Fables should not be contaminated. That Fables should not be confounded thus.
Troth! all the knowledge is they nothing know:
Who, blaming; him, blame Nævius, Plautus, Ennius,
Whose great example is his precedent;
Whose negligence he'd wish to emulate
Rather than *their* dark diligence. Henceforth,
Let them, I give them warning, be at peace,
And cease to rail, lest they be made to know
Their own misdeeds. Be favorable! sit
With equal mind, and hear our play; that hence
Ye may conclude, what hope to entertain,
The comedies he may hereafter write
Shall merit approbation or contempt.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.

SIMO, SOSIA, *and* SERVANTS *with Provisions.*

SIMO. Carry those things in: go! (*Ex.* SERVANTS.

Sosia, come here;

A word with you!

SOSIA. I understand: that these

Be ta'en due care of.

SIMO. Quite another thing.

SOSIA. What can my art do more for you?

SIMO. This business
Needs not that art; but those good qualities,
Which I have ever known abide in you,
Fidelity and secrecy.

SOSIA. I wait
Your pleasure.

SIMO. Since I bought you, from a boy
How just and mild a servitude you've pass'd
With me, you're conscious: from a purchas'd slave
I made you free, because you serv'd me freely:
The greatest recompense I could bestow.

SOSIA. I do remember.

SIMO. Nor do I repent.

SOSIA. If I have ever done, or now do aught
That's pleasing to you, Simo, I am glad,
And thankful that you hold my service good
And yet this troubles me: for this detail,
Forcing your kindness on my memory,
Seems to reproach me of ingratitude.
Oh tell me then at once, what would you? Sir!

SIMO. I will; and this I must advise you first;
The nuptial you suppose preparing now,
Is all unreal.

SOSIA. Why pretend it then?

SIMO. You shall hear all from first to last: and thus
The conduct of my son, my own intent,
And what part you're to act, you'll know at once.
For my son, Sosia, now to manhood grown,
Had freer scope of living: for before
How might you know, or how indeed divine
His disposition, good or ill, while youth,
Fear, and a master, all constrain'd him?

SOSIA. True.

SIMO. Though most, as is the bent of youth, apply
Their mind to some one object, horses, hounds,
Or to the study of philosophy;
Yet none of these, beyond the rest, did he
Pursue; and yet, in moderation, all.
I was o'erjoy'd.

SOSIA. And not without good cause.
For this I hold to be the Golden Rule
Of Life, too much of one thing's good for nothing.

SIMO. So did he shape his life to bear
himself
With ease and frank good-humor unto all;
Mix'd in what company soe'er, to them
He wholly did resign himself; and join'd
In their pursuits, opposing nobody,
Nor e'er assuming to himself: and thus
With ease, and free from envy, may you
gain
Praise, and conciliate friends.

He wholly did resign himself; complied
With all their humours, checking nobody,

SOSIA. He rul'd his life
By prudent maxims: for, as times go now,
Compliance raises friends, and truth breeds hate.

SIMO. Meanwhile, 'tis now about three years ago,
A certain woman from the isle of Andros,
Came o'er to settle in this neighborhood,
By poverty and cruel kindred driv'n:
Handsome and young.

SOSIA. Ah! I begin to fear
Some mischief from this Andrian.

SIMO. At first
Modest and thriftily, though poor, she liv'd,
With her own hands a homely livelihood
Scarce earning from the distaff and the loom.
But when a lover came, with promis'd gold,

Another, and another, as the mind
Falls easily from labor to delight,
She took their offers, and set up the trade.
They, who were then her chief gallants, by chance
Drew thither, as oft happen with young men
My son to join their company. “So, so!”
Said I within myself, “he’s smit! he has it!”
And in the morning as I saw their servants
Run to and fro, I’d often call, “here, boy!
Prithee now, who had Chrysis yesterday?”
The name of this same Andrian.

SOSIA. I take you.

SIMO. Phædrus they said, Clinia, or Niceratus,
For all these three then follow’d her.—“Well, well,
But what of Pamphilus?”—“Of Pamphilus!
He supp’d, and paid his reck’ning.”—I was glad.
Another day I made the like inquiry,
But still found nothing touching Pamphilus.
Thus I believ’d his virtue prov’d, and hence
Thought him a miracle of continence:
For he who struggles with such spirits, yet
Holds in that commerce an unshaken mind,
May well be trusted with the governance
Of his own conduct. Nor was I alone
Delighted with his life, but all the world
With one accord said all good things, and prais’d
My happy fortunes, who possess’d a son
So good, so lib’rally disposed.—In short
Chremes, seduc’d by this fine character,
Came of his own accord, to offer me
His only daughter with a handsome portion
In marriage with my son. I lik’d the match;
Betroth’d my son; and this was pitch’d upon,
By joint agreement, for the wedding-day.

SOSIA. And what prevents it’s being so?

SIMO. I'll tell you.
In a few days, the treaty still on foot,
This neighbor Chrysis dies.

SOSIA. In happy hour:
Happy for you! I was afraid of Chrysis.

SIMO. My son, on this event, was often there
With those who were the late gallants of Chrysis;
Assisted to prepare the funeral,
Ever condol'd, and sometimes wept with them.
This pleas'd me then; for in myself I thought,
"Since merely for a small acquaintance-sake
He takes this woman's death so nearly, what
If he himself had lov'd? What would he feel
For me, his father?" All these things, I thought;
Were but the tokens and the offices
Of a humane and tender disposition.
In short, on his account, e'en I myself
Attend the funeral, suspecting yet
No harm.

SOSIA. And what——

SIMO. You shall hear all. The Corpse
Borne forth, we follow: when among the women
Attending there, I chanc'd to cast my eyes,
Upon one girl, in form——

SOSIA. Not bad, perhaps——

SIMO. And look; so modest, and so beauteous, Sosia!
That nothing could exceed it. As she seem'd
To grieve beyond the rest; and as her air
Appear'd more liberal and ingenuous,
I went and ask'd her women who she was.
Sister, they said, to Chrysis: when at once
It struck my mind; "So! so! the secret's out;
Hence were those tears, and hence all that compassion!"

SOSIA. Alas! I fear how this affair will end!

SIMO. Meanwhile the funeral proceeds: we follow;
Come to the sepulchre: the body's plac'd
Upon the pile, lamented: whereupon
This sister I was speaking of, all wild,
Ran to the flames with peril of her life.
Then! there! the frightened Pamphilus betrays
His well-dissembled and long-hidden love:
Runs up, and takes her round the waist, and cries,
"Oh my Glycerium! what is it you do?
Why, why endeavor to destroy yourself?"
Then she, in such a manner, that you thence
Might easily perceive their long, long, love,
Threw herself back into his arms, and wept,
Oh how familiarly!

SOSIA. How say you!

SIMO. I
Return in anger thence, and hurt at heart,
Yet had no cause sufficient for reproof.
"What have I done? he'd say; or how deserv'd
Reproach? or how offended, Father?—Her
Who meant to cast herself into the flames,
I stopped." A fair excuse!

SOSIA. You're in the right;
For him, who sav'd a life, if you reprove,
What will you do to him that offers wrong?

SIMO. Chremes next day came open-mouth'd to me:
Oh monstrous! he had found that Pamphilus
Was married to this stranger woman. I
Deny the fact most steadily, and he
As steadily insists. In short we part
On such bad terms, as let me understand
He would refuse his daughter.

SOSIA. Did not you
Then take your son to task?

SIMO. Not even this
Appear'd sufficient for reproof.

SOSIA. How so?

SIMO. "Father, (he might have said) You have, you know,
Prescrib'd a term to all these things yourself.
The time is near at hand, when I must live
According to the humor of another.
Meanwhile, permit me now to please my own!"

SOSIA. What cause remains to chide him then?

SIMO. If he
Refuses, on account of this amour,
To take a wife, such obstinate denial
Must be considered as his first offense.
Wherefore I now, from this mock-nuptial,
Endeavor to draw real cause to chide:
And that same rascal Davus, if he's plotting,
That he may let his counsel run to waste,
Now, when his knaveries can do no harm:
Who, I believe, with all his might and main
Will strive to cross my purposes; and that
More to plague me, than to oblige my son.

SOSIA. Why so?

SIMO. Why so! Bad mind, bad heart: But if
I catch him at his tricks!—But what need words?
—If, as I wish it may, it should appear
That Pamphilus objects not to the match,
Chremes remains to be prevail'd upon,
And will, I hope, consent. 'Tis now your place
To counterfeit these nuptials cunningly;
To frighten Davus; and observe my son,
What he's about, what plots they hatch together.

SOSIA. Enough; I'll take due care. Let's now go in!

SIMO. Go first: I'll follow you.

(*Exit* SOSIA.

Beyond all doubt
My son's averse to take a wife: I saw
How frighten'd Davus was, but even now,
When he was told a nuptial was preparing.
But here he comes.

SCENE II.

Enter DAVUS.

DAVUS. (*to himself*). I thought 'twere wonderful
If this affair went off so easily;
And dreaded where my master's great good-humor
Would end at last: who, after he perceiv'd
The Lady was refus'd, ne'er said a word
To any of us, nor e'er took it ill.

SIMO. (*behind*). But now he will; to your cost too, I warrant you!

DAVUS. This was his scheme; to lead us by
the nose
In a false dream of joy; then all agape
With hope, even then that we were most
secure,

To have o'erwhelm'd us, nor have giv'n us To have o'erwhelm'd us, nor allow'd us time
time

To cast about which way to break the
match.

Cunning old Gentleman!

SIMO. What says the rogue?

DAVUS. My master and I did not see him!

SIMO. Davus!

DAVUS. Well! what now? (*Pretending not to see him.*)

SIMO. Here! this way!

DAVUS. What can he want? (*To himself.*)

SIMO. (*overhearing*). What say you?

DAVUS. Upon what? Sir.

SIMO. Upon what!

The world reports that my son keeps a mistress.

DAVUS. Oh, to be sure, the world cares much for that.

SIMO. D'ye mind what I say? Sirrah!

DAVUS. Nothing more, Sir.

SIMO. But for me now to dive into these matters
May seem perhaps like too severe a father:
For all his youthful pranks concern not me.
While 'twas in season, he had my free leave
To take his swing of pleasure. But to-day
Brings on another stage of life, and asks
For other manners: wherefore I desire,
Or, if you please, I do beseech you, Davus,
To set him right again.

DAVUS. What means all this?

SIMO. All, who are fond of mistresses, dislike
The thoughts of matrimony.

DAVUS. So they say.

SIMO. And then, if such a person entertains
An evil counselor in those affairs,
He tampers with the mind, and makes bad worse.

DAVUS. Troth, I don't comprehend one word of this.

SIMO. No?

DAVUS. No. I'm Davus, and not Oedipus.

SIMO. Then for the rest I have to say to you,
You choose I should speak plainly.

DAVUS. By all means.

SIMO. If I discover then, that in this match
You get to your dog's tricks to break it off,
Or try to show how shrewd a rogue you are,
I'll have you beat to mummy, and then thrown
In prison, Sirrah! upon this condition,
That when I take you out again, I swear
To grind there in your stead. D'ye take me now?
Or don't you understand this neither?

DAVUS. Clearly.
You have spoke out at last: the very thing!
Quite plain and home; and nothing round about.

SIMO. I could excuse your tricks in any thing,
Rather than this.

DAVUS. Good words! I beg of you.

SIMO. You laugh at me: well, well!—I give you warning
That you do nothing rashly, nor pretend
You was not advertis'd of this—take heed!

(Exit.

SCENE III.

DAVUS.

Troth Davus, 'tis high time to look about
you;

No room for sloth, as far as I can sound
The sentiments of our old gentleman
About this marriage, which if not fought
off,

And cunningly, spoils me, or my poor
master.

I know not what to do; nor can resolve
To help the son, or to obey the father.

If I desert poor Pamphilus, alas!
I tremble for his life; if I assist him,

I dread his father's threats: a shrewd old
Cuff,
Not easily deceiv'd. For first of all,
He knows of this amour; and watches me
With jealous eyes, lest I devise some trick
To break the match. If he discovers it,
Woe to poor Davus! nay, if he's inclin'd
To punish me, he'll seize on some pretense
To throw me into prison, right or wrong.
Another mischief is, this Andrian,
Mistress or wife, 's with child by
Pamphilus.
And do but mark their confidence! 'tis sure

Another mischief too, to make bad worse,
This Andrian, wife or mistress, is with child
By Pamphilus. And do but mark the height
Of their assurance! for 'tis certainly

The dotage of mad people, not of lovers.
Whate'er she shall bring forth, they have
resolv'd
To educate: and have among themselves
Devis'd the strangest story! that Glycerium
Is an Athenian citizen. "There was
Once on a time a certain merchant,
shipwreck'd
Upon the isle of Andros; there he died:
And Chrysis' father took this orphan-
wreck,
Then but an infant, under his protection."
Ridiculous! 'tis all romance to me:
And yet the story pleases them. And see!
Mysis comes forth. But I must to the
Forum
To look for Pamphilus, for fear his father
Should find him first, and take him
unawares.

SCENE IV.

Enter MYSIS. (Speaking to a servant within.)

I hear, Archyllis; I hear what you say:
You beg me to bring Lesbia. By my troth
That Lesbia is a drunken wretch, hot-headed,
Nor worthy to be trusted with a woman
In her first labor. Well, well! she shall come.
—Observe how earnest the old gossip is, (*Coming forward*)
Because this Lesbia is her pot-companion.
—Oh grant my mistress, Heav'n, a safe delivery,
And let the midwife trespass any where
Rather than here!—But what is it I see?
Pamphilus all disorder'd: How I fear
The cause! I'll wait a while, that I may know
If this commotion means us any ill.

SCENE V.

PAMPHILUS, MYSIS *behind*.

PAM. Is this well done? or like a man?—Is this
The action of a father?

MYSIS. What's the matter?

PAM. Oh all ye pow'rs of heav'n and earth, what's wrong
If this is not so?—If he was determin'd
That I to-day should marry, should I not
Have had some previous notice?—ought not he
To have inform'd me of it long ago?

MYSIS. Alas! what's this I hear?

PAM. And Chremes too,
Who had refus'd to trust me with his daughter,
Changes his mind, because I change not mine.
Can he then be so obstinately bent
To tear me from Glycerium? To lose her
Is losing life.—Was ever man so cross'd,

So curs'd as I?—Oh pow'rs of heav'n and earth!
Can I by no means fly from this alliance
With Chremes' family?—so oft contemn'd
And held in scorn!—all done, concluded all!——
Rejected, then recall'd:—and why?—unless,
For so I must suspect, they breed some monster,
Whom as they can obtrude on no one else,
They bring to me.

MYSIS. Alas, alas! this speech
Has struck me almost dead with fear.

PAM. And then
My father!—what to say of him?—Oh shame!
A thing of so much consequence to treat
So negligently!—For but even now
Passing me in the forum, "Pamphilus!
To-day's your wedding-day, said he: prepare;
Go, get you home!"—This sounded in my ears
As if he said, "go, hang yourself!"—I stood
Confounded. Think you I could speak one word?
Or offer an excuse, how weak soe'er?
No, I was dumb:—and had I been aware,
Should any ask what I'd have done, I would,
Rather than this, do any thing.—But now
What to resolve upon?—So many cares
Entangle me at once, and rend my mind,
Pulling it diff'rent ways. My love, compassion,
This urgent match, my rev'rence for my father,
Who yet has ever been so gentle to me,
And held so slack a rein upon my pleasures.
—And I oppose him?—Racking thought!—Ah me!
I know not what to do.

MYSIS. Alas, I fear
Where this uncertainty will end. 'Twere best
He should confer with her; or I at least
Speak touching her to him. For while the mind
Hangs in suspense, a trifle turns the scale.

PAM. Who's there? what, Mysis! Save you!

MYSIS. Save you! Sir. (*Coming forward.*)

PAM. How does she?

MYSIS. How! oppress'd with wretchedness.

To-day supremely wretched, as to-day

Was formerly appointed for your wedding.

And then she fears lest you desert her.

PAM. I!

Desert her? Can I think on't? or deceive

A wretched maid! who trusted to my care

Her life and honor. Her whom I have held

Near to my heart, and cherish'd as my wife?

Or leave her modest and well nurtur'd mind

Through want to be corrupted? Never, never.

MYSIS. No doubt, did it depend on you alone;

But if constrain'd——

PAM. D'ye think me then so vile?

Or so ungrateful, so inhuman, savage,

Neither long intercourse, nor love, nor

shame,

Can make me keep my faith?

Can move my soul, or make me keep my faith

MYSIS. I only know

That she deserves you should remember

her.

MYSIS. I only know, my mistress well deserve:
You should remember her.

PAM. Remember her?

Oh Mysis, Mysis! even at this hour,

PAM. I should remember her? Oh, Mysis,

Mysis!

The words of Chrysis touching my

Glycerium

Are written in my heart. On her death-bed

She call'd me. I approach'd her. You

retir'd.

We were alone; and Chrysis thus began:

“My Pamphilus, you see the youth and
beauty
Of this unhappy maid: and well you know,
These are but feeble guardians to preserve
Her fortune or her fame. By this right hand
I do beseech you, by your better angel,
By your tried faith, by her forlorn
condition,
I do conjure you, put her not away,
Nor leave her to distress. If I have ever,
As my own brother, lov’d you; or if she
Has ever held you dear ’bove all the world,
And ever shown obedience to your will

I do bequeath you to her as a husband,
Friend, Guardian, Father: all our little
wealth
To you I leave, and trust it to your
care.”——

She join’d our hands, and died.—I did
receive her,
And once receiv’d will keep her.

MYSIS. So we trust.

PAM. What make you from her?

MYSIS. Going for a midwife.

PAM. Haste then! and hark, be sure take special heed,
You mention not a word about the marriage,
Lest this too give her pain.

MYSIS. I understand.

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.

CHARINUS, BYRRHIA.

CHAR. How, Byrrhia? Is she to be married, say you,
To Pamphilus to-day?

BYR. 'Tis even so.

CHAR. How do you know?

BYR. I had it even now
From Davus at the Forum.

CHAR. Woe is me!
Then I'm a wretch indeed: till now my mind
Floated 'twixt hope and fear: now, hope remov'd,
Stunn'd, and o'erwhelm'd, it sinks beneath its cares.

BYR. Nay, prithee master, since the thing you wish
Can not be had, e'en wish for that which may!

CHAR. I wish for nothing but Philumena.

BYR. Ah, how much wiser were it, that you strove
To quench this passion, than, with words like these
To fan the fire, and blow it to a flame?

CHAR. How readily do men at ease prescribe
To those who're sick at heart! distress'd like me,
You would not talk thus.

BYR. Well, well, as you please.

CHAR. Ha! I see Pamphilus. I can resolve
On any thing, e'er give up all for lost.

BYR. What now?

CHAR. I will entreat him, beg, beseech him,
Tell him our course of love, and thus, perhaps,
At least prevail upon him to defer
His marriage some few days: meanwhile, I hope,
Something may happen.

BYR. Aye, that something's nothing.

CHAR. Byrrhia, what think you? Shall I speak to him?

BYR. Why not? for though you don't obtain your suit,
He will at least imagine you're prepar'd
To cuckold him, in case he marries her.

CHAR. Away, you hang-dog, with your base suspicions!

SCENE II.

Enter PAMPHILUS.

PAM. Charinus, save you!

CHAR. Save you, Pamphilus!
Imploring comfort, safety, help, and
counsel,
You see me now before you.

PAM. I do lack
Myself both help and counsel—But what
mean you?

PAM. Help, and counsel!
I can afford you neither.—But what mean you

CHAR. Is this your wedding-day?

PAM. Aye, so they say.

CHAR. Ah, Pamphilus, if so, this day
You see the last of me.

PAM. How so?

CHAR. Ah me!
I dare not speak it: prithee tell him, Byrrhia.

BYR. Aye, that I will.

PAM. What is't?

BYR. He is in love
With your bride, Sir.

PAM. I' faith so am not I.
Tell me, Charinus, has aught further passed
'Twixt you and her?

CHAR. Ah, no, no.

PAM. Would there had!

CHAR. Now by our friendship, by my love I beg
You would not marry her.——

PAM. I will endeavor.

CHAR. If that's impossible, or if this match
Be grateful to your heart——

PAM. My heart!

CHAR. At least
Defer it some few days; while I depart,
That I may not behold it.

PAM. Hear, Charinus;
It is, I think, scarce honesty in him
To look for thanks, who means no favor. I
Abhor this marriage, more than you desire it.

CHAR. You have reviv'd me.

PAM. Now if you, or he,
Your Byrrhia here, can do or think of aught;
Act, plot, devise, invent, strive all you can
To make her yours; and I'll do all I can
That she may not be mine.

CHAR. Enough.

PAM. I see
Davus, and in good time: for he'll advise

What's best to do.

CHAR. But you, you sorry rogue, (*To BYRRHIA*)
Can give me no advice, nor tell me aught,
But what it is impertinent to know.
Hence, Sirrah, get you gone!

BYR. With all my heart.

(*Exit.*)

SCENE III.

Enter DAVUS hastily.

DAVUS. Good Heav'ns, what news I bring! what joyful news!
But where shall I find Pamphilus, to drive
His fears away, and make him full of joy?

CHAR. There's something pleases him.

PAM. No matter what.
He has not heard of our ill fortune yet.

DAVUS. And he, I warrant, if he has been told
Of his intended wedding——

CHAR. Do you hear?

DAVUS. Poor soul, is running all about the town
In quest of me. But whither shall I go?
Or which way run?

CHAR. Why don't you speak to him?

DAVUS. I'll go.

PAM. Ho! Davus! Stop, come here!

DAVUS. Who calls?
O, Pamphilus! the very man.—Heyday!
Charinus too!—Both gentlemen, well met!
I've news for both.

PAM. I'm ruin'd, Davus.

DAVUS. Hear me!

PAM. Undone!

DAVUS. I know your fears.

CHAR. My life's at stake.

DAVUS. Yours I know also.

PAM. Matrimony mine.

DAVUS. I know it.

PAM. But to-day.

DAVUS. You stun me; plague!

I tell you I know ev'ry thing: you fear (*To CHARINUS.*)

You should *not* marry her.—You fear you *should*. (*To PAM.*)

CHAR. The very thing.

PAM. The same.

DAVUS. And yet that *same*

Is nothing. Mark!

PAM. Nay, rid me of my fear.

DAVUS. I will then. Chremes
Won't give his daughter to you.

DAVUS. I will then. Chremes don't intend his
daughter
Shall marry you to-day.

PAM. How d'ye know?

PAM. No! How d'ye know?

DAVUS. I'm sure of it. Your Father but just now
Takes me aside, and tells me 'twas his will
That you should wed to-day; with much beside,
Which now I have not leisure to repeat.

I, on the instant, hastening to find you,
Run to the Forum to inform you of it:
There, failing, climb an eminence, look round:
No Pamphilus: I light by chance on Byrrhia;
Inquire; he hadn't seen you. Vex'd at heart,
What's to be done? thought I. Returning thence

A doubt arose within me. Ha! bad cheer,
The old man melancholy, and a wedding
Clapp'd up so suddenly! This don't agree.

PAM. Well, what then?

DAVUS. I betook me instantly
To Chremes' house; but thither when I came,
Before the door all hush. This tickled me.

PAM. You're in the right. Proceed.

DAVUS. I watch'd a while:
Meantime no soul went in, no soul came out;
No matron; in the house no ornament;
No note of preparation. I approach'd,
Look'd in——

PAM. I understand: a potent sign!

DAVUS. Does this seem like a nuptial?

PAM. I think not,
Davus.

DAVUS. *Think not*, d'ye say? you don't conceive:
The thing is evident. I met beside,
As I departed thence, with Chremes' boy,
Bearing some pot-herbs, and a pennyworth
Of little fishes for the old man's dinner.

CHAR. I am deliver'd, Davus, by your means,
From all my apprehensions of to-day.

DAVUS. And yet you are undone.

CHAR. How so? Since Chremes
Will not consent to give Philumena
To Pamphilus.

DAVUS. Ridiculous! As if,
Because the daughter is denied to him,
She must of course wed you. Look to it well;
Court the old Gentleman through friends, apply,

Or else——

CHAR. You're right: I will about it straight,
Although that hope has often fail'd. Farewell.

(Exit.

SCENE IV.

PAMPHILUS. DAVUS.

PAM. What means my father then? Why counterfeit?

DAVUS. That I'll explain. If he were angry now,
Merely that Chremes has refus'd his daughter,
He'd think himself in fault; and justly too,
Before the bias of your mind is known.
But granting you refuse her for a wife,
Then all the blame devolves on you, and then
Comes all the storm.

PAM. What course then shall I take?
Shall I submit——

DAVUS. He is your Father, Sir,
Whom to oppose were difficult; and then
Glycerium's a lone woman; and he'll find
Some course, no matter what, to drive her hence.

PAM. To drive her hence?

DAVUS. Directly.

PAM. Tell me then,
Oh tell me, Davus, what were best to do?

DAVUS. Say that you'll marry!

PAM. How!

DAVUS. And where's the harm?

PAM. Say that I'll marry!

DAVUS. Why not?

PAM. Never, never.

DAVUS. Do not refuse!

PAM. Persuade not!

DAVUS. Do but mark
The consequence.

PAM. Divorcement from Glycerium.
And marriage with the other.

DAVUS. No such thing.
Your father, I suppose, accosts you thus.
I'd have you wed to-day;—I will, quoth you:
What reason has he to reproach you then?
Thus shall you baffle all his settled schemes,
And put him to confusion; all the while
Secure yourself: for 'tis beyond a doubt
That Chremes will refuse his daughter to you;
So obstinately too, you need not pause,
Or change these measures, lest he change his mind;
Say to your father then, that you will wed,
That, with the will, he may want cause to chide.
But if, deluded by fond hopes, you cry,
“No one will wed their daughter to a rake,
A libertine.”—Alas, you're much deceiv'd.
For know, your father will redeem some wretch
From rags and beggary to be your wife,
Rather than see your ruin with Glycerium.
But if he thinks you bear an easy mind,
He too will grow indiff'rent, and seek out
Another match at leisure; the mean while
Affairs may take a lucky turn.

PAM. D'ye think so?

DAVUS. Beyond all doubt.

PAM. See, what you lead me to.

DAVUS. Nay, peace!

PAM. I'll say so then. But have a care
He knows not of the child, which I've agreed
To educate.

DAVUS. O confidence!

PAM. She drew
This promise from me, as a firm assurance
That I would not forsake her.

DAVUS. We'll take care.
But here's your father: let him not perceive
You're melancholy.

SCENE V.

Enter SIMO at a distance.

SIMO. I return to see
What they're about, or what they meditate.

DAVUS. Now is he sure that you'll refuse to wed.
From some dark corner brooding o'er black thoughts
He comes, and fancies he has fram'd a speech
To disconcert you. See, you keep your ground.

PAM. If I can, Davus.

DAVUS. Trust me, Pamphilus,
Your father will not change a single word
In anger with you, do but say you'll wed.

SCENE VI.

Enter BYRRHIA behind.

BYR. To-day my master bade me leave all else
For Pamphilus, and watch how he proceeds,
About his marriage; wherefore I have now

Followed the old man hither: yonder too
Stands Pamphilus himself, and with him Davus.
To business then!

SIMO. I see them both together.

DAVUS. Now mind. (*Apart to PAM.*)

SIMO. Here, Pamphilus!

DAVUS. Now turn about,
As taken unawares. (*Apart.*)

PAM. Who calls? my father! (*Apart.*)

PAM. Who calls? my father!

DAVUS. Well said! (*Apart.*)

SIMO. It is my pleasure, that to-day,
As I have told you once before, you marry.

DAVUS. Now on our part, I fear what he'll reply. (*Aside.*)

PAM. In that, and all the rest of your commands,
I shall be ready to obey you, Sir!

BYR. How's that! (*Overhearing.*)

DAVUS. Struck dumb. (*Aside.*)

BYR. What said he? (*Listening.*)

SIMO. You perform
Your duty, when you cheerfully comply
With my desires.

DAVUS. There! said I not the truth? (*Apart to PAM.*)

BYR. My master then, so far as I can find,
May whistle for a wife.

SIMO. Now then go in
That when you're wanted you be found.

PAM. I go.

(*Exit.*)

BYR. Is there no faith in the affairs of men?
'Tis an old saying and a true one too;

“Of all mankind each loves himself the best.”
I’ve seen the lady; know her beautiful;
And therefore sooner pardon Pamphilus,
If he had rather win her to his arms,
Than yield her to th’ embraces of my master.
I will go bear these tidings, and receive
Much evil treatment for my evil news.

(Exit.

SCENE VII.

Manent SIMO and DAVUS.

DAVUS. Now he supposes I’ve some trick in hand,
And loiter here to practice it on him!

SIMO. Well, what now, Davus?

DAVUS. Nothing.

SIMO. Nothing, say you?

DAVUS. Nothing at all.

SIMO. And yet I look’d for something.

DAVUS. So, I perceive, you did:—This nettles him. *(Aside.)*

SIMO. Can you speak truth?

DAVUS. Most easily.

SIMO. Say then,
Is not this wedding irksome to my son,
From his adventure with the Andrian?

DAVUS. No faith; or if at all, ’twill only be
Two or three days’ anxiety, you know;
Then ’twill be over: for he sees the thing
In its true light.

SIMO. I praise him for’t.

DAVUS. While you
Restrain'd him not; and while his youth
allow'd

'Tis true he lov'd; and even then by stealth, 'Tis true he lov'd; but even then by stealth,
As wise men ought, and careful of his
fame.

Now his age calls for matrimony, now
To matrimony he inclines his mind.

SIMO. Yet, in my eyes, he seem'd a little sad.

DAVUS. Not upon that account. He has he thinks
Another reason to complain of you.

SIMO. For what?

DAVUS. A trifle.

SIMO. Well, what is't?

DAVUS. Nay, nothing.

SIMO. Tell me, what is't?

DAVUS. You are then, he complains,
Somewhat too sparing of expense.

SIMO. I?

DAVUS. You.

A feast of scarce ten Drachms? Does this, says he,
Look like a wedding-supper for his son?
What friends can I invite? especially
At such a time as this?—and, truly, Sir,
You have been very frugal; much too sparing.
I can't commend you for it.

SIMO. Hold your peace.

DAVUS. I've ruffled him. (*Aside.*)

SIMO. I'll look to that. Away!

(*Exit DAVUS.*)

What now? What means the varlet? Precious rogue,

For if there's any knavery on foot,
He, I am sure, is the contriver on't.

(*Exit.*

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.

SIMO, DAVUS, *coming out of SIMO's house.*—MYSIS, LESBIA, *going toward the house of GLYCERIUM.*

MYSIS. Aye, marry, 'tis as you say, Lesbia:
Women scarce ever find a constant man.

SIMO. The Andrian's maid-servant! Is't not?

DAVUS. Aye.

MYSIS. But Pamphilus——

SIMO. What says she? (*Overhearing.*)

MYSIS. Has been true.

SIMO. How's that? (*Overhearing.*)

DAVUS. Would he were deaf, or she were dumb! (*Aside.*)

MYSIS. For the child, boy, or girl, he has resolv'd
To educate.

SIMO. O Jupiter! what's this
I hear? If this be true, I'm lost indeed.

LESBIA. A good young Gentleman!

MYSIS. Oh, very good.
But in, in, lest you make her wait.

LESBIA. I follow.

(*Exeunt* MYNIS and LESBIA.

SCENE II.

Manent SIMO, DAVUS.

DAVUS. Unfortunate! What remedy! (*Aside.*)

SIMO. How's this? (*To himself.*)
And can he be so mad? What! educate
A harlot's child!—Ah, now I know their drift:
Fool that I was, scarce smelt it out at last.

DAVUS (*listening*). What's this he says he has smelt out?

SIMO. Imprimis, (*To himself.*)
'Tis this rogue's trick upon me. All a sham:
A counterfeit deliv'ry, and mock labor,
Devis'd to frighten Chremes from the match.

GLY. (*within*). Juno Lucina, save me! Help, I pray thee.

SIMO. Heyday! Already! Oh ridiculous!
Soon as she heard that I was at the door
She hastens to cry out: your incidents
Are ill-tim'd, Davus.

DAVUS. Mine, Sir?

SIMO. Are your players
Unmindful of their cues, and want a prompter?

DAVUS. I do not comprehend you.

SIMO (*apart.*) If this knave
Had, in the real nuptial of my son,
Come thus upon me unprepar'd, what sport,
What scorn he'd have exposed me to? But now

At his own peril be it. I'm secure.

SCENE III.

Re-enter LESBIA.—ARCHYLLIS appears at the door.

LESBIA to ARCHYLLIS (*within*). As yet, Archyllis, all the symptoms seem
As good as might be wish'd in her condition:
First, let her make ablution: after that,
Drink what I've order'd her, and just so much:
And presently I will be here again. (*Coming forward.*)
Now, by this good day, Master Pamphilus
Has got a chopping boy: Heav'n grant it live!
For he's a worthy Gentleman, and scorn'd
To do a wrong to this young innocent.

(*Exit.*)

SCENE IV.

Manent SIMO, DAVUS.

SIMO. This too where's he that knows you would not swear
Was your contrivance?

DAVUS. My contrivance! what, Sir?

SIMO. While in the house, forsooth, the midwife gave
No orders for the Lady in the straw:
But having issued forth into the street,
Bawls out most lustily to those within.
—Oh Davus, am I then so much your scorn?
Seem I so proper to be play'd upon,
With such a shallow, barefac'd, imposition?
You might at least, in reverence, have us'd
Some spice of art, wer't only to pretend
You fear'd my anger, should I find you out.

DAVUS. I' faith now he deceives himself, not I. (*Aside.*)

SIMO. Did not I give you warning? threaten too,
In case you play'd me false? But all in vain:
For what car'd you?—What! think you I believe
This story of a child by Pamphilus?

DAVUS. I see his error: Now I know my game. (*Aside.*)

SIMO. Why don't you answer?

DAVUS. What! you don't believe it!
As if you had not been informed of this?
(*Archly.*)

SIMO. I been inform'd?

SIMO. Inform'd?

DAVUS. What then you found it out?
(*Archly.*)

DAVUS. What then you found it out yourself?

SIMO. D'ye laugh at me?

DAVUS. You must have been inform'd:
Or whence this shrewd suspicion?

SIMO. Whence! from you:
Because I know you.

DAVUS. Meaning, this was done
By my advice?

SIMO. Beyond all doubt; I know it:

DAVUS. You do not know me, Simo.——

SIMO. I not know you?

DAVUS. For if I do but speak, immediately
You think yourself impos'd on.——

SIMO. Falsely, hey?

DAVUS. So that I dare not ope my lips before you.

SIMO. All that I know is this; that nobody
Has been deliver'd here.

DAVUS. You've found it out?
Yet by-and-by they'll bring the bantling here,
And lay it at our door. Remember, Sir,
I give you warning that will be the case;
That you may stand prepar'd, nor after say,
'Twas done by Davus's advice, his tricks!
I would fain cure your ill opinion of me.

SIMO. But how d'ye know?

DAVUS. I've heard so, and believe so.
Besides a thousand things concur to lead
To this conjecture. In the first place, she
Profess'd herself with child by Pamphilus:
That proves a falsehood. Now that she
perceives

A nuptial preparation at our house,
A maid's dispatch'd immediately to bring
A midwife to her, and withal a child;
You too they will contrive shall see the
child,
Or else the wedding must proceed.

SIMO. How's this?
Having discover'd such a plot on foot,
Why did you not directly tell my son?

DAVUS. Who then has drawn him from her but myself?
For we all know how much he doted on her:
But now he wishes for a wife. In fine,
Leave that affair to me; and you meanwhile
Pursue, as you've begun, the nuptials; which
The Gods, I hope, will prosper!

SIMO. Get you in.
Wait for me there, and see that you prepare
What's requisite.

(*Exit* DAVUS.

He has not wrought upon me

DAVUS. I've heard so, and believe so.
Besides a thousand different things concur
To lead to this conjecture. First, Glycerium
Profess'd herself with child by Pamphilus:
That proves a falsehood. Now as she perceives:
A nuptial preparation at our house,
A maid's immediately dispatch'd to bring

To yield implicit credit to his tale,
Nor do I know if all he said be true.
But, true or false, it matters not: to me
My Son's own promise is the main concern.
Now to meet Chremes, and to beg his daughter
In marriage with my son. If I succeed,
What can I rather wish, than to behold
Their marriage-rites to-day? For since my son
Has given me his word, I've not a doubt,
Should he refuse, but I may force him to it:
And to my wishes see where Chremes comes.

SCENE V.

Enter CHREMES.

SIMO. Chremes, good-day!

CHREMES. The very man I look'd for.

SIMO. And I for you.

CHREMES. Well met.—Some persons came
To tell me you inform'd them, that my daughter
Was to be married to your son to-day:
And therefore came I here, and fain would know
Whether 'tis you or they have lost their wits.

SIMO. A moment's hearing; you shall be inform'd,
What I request, and what you wish to know.

CHREMES. I hear: what would you? speak.

SIMO. Now by the Gods;
Now by our friendship, Chremes, which begun
In infancy, has still increas'd with age;
Now by your only daughter, and my son,
Whose preservation wholly rests on you;
Let me entreat this boon: and let the match
Which should have been, still be.

CHREMES. Why, why entreat?
Knowing you ought not to beseech this of me.
Think you that I am other than I was,
When first I gave my promise? If the match
Be good for both, e'en call them forth to wed.
But if their union promises more harm
Than good to both, you also, I beseech you,
Consult our common interest, as if
You were her father, Pamphilus my son.

SIMO. E'en in that spirit, I desire it, Chremes,
Entreat it may be done; nor would entreat,
But that occasion urges.

CHREMES. What occasion?

SIMO. A diff'rence 'twixt Glycerium and my son.

CHREMES. I hear. (*Ironically.*)

SIMO. A breach so wide as gives me hopes
To sep'rate them forever.

CHREMES. Idle tales!

SIMO. Indeed 'tis thus.

CHREMES. Aye marry, thus it is.
Quarrels of lovers but renew their love.

SIMO. Prevent we then, I pray, this mischief now;
While time permits, while yet his passion's sore
From contumelies; ere these women's wiles,
Their wicked arts, and tears made up of fraud
Shake his weak mind, and melt it to compassion.
Give him a wife: by intercourse with her,
Knit by the bonds of wedlock, soon I hope,
He'll rise above the guilt that sinks him now.

CHREMES. So you believe: for me, I can not think
That he'll be constant, or that I can bear it.

SIMO. How can you know, unless you make the trial?

CHREMES. Aye, but to make that trial on a daughter
Is hard indeed.

SIMO. The mischief, should he fail,
Is only this: divorce, which Heav'n forbid!
But mark what benefits if he amend!
First, to your friend you will restore a son;
Gain to yourself a son-in-law, and match
Your daughter to an honest husband.

CHREMES. Well!
Since you're so thoroughly convinc'd 'tis right,
I can deny you naught that lies in me.

SIMO. I see I ever lov'd you justly, Chremes.

CHREMES. But then——

SIMO. But what?

CHREMES. Whence is't you know
That there's a difference between them?

CHREMES. From whence are you appriz'd

SIMO. Davus,
Davus, in all their secrets, told me so;
Advis'd me too, to hasten on the match
As fast as possible. Would he, d'ye think,
Do that, unless he were full well assur'd
My son desir'd it too?—Hear, what he says.
Ho there! call Davus forth.—But here he comes.

SCENE VI.

Enter DAVUS.

DAVUS. I was about to seek you.

SIMO. What's the matter?

DAVUS. Why is not the bride sent for? it grows late.

SIMO. D'ye hear him?—Davus, I for some time past
Was fearful of you; lest, like other slaves,

As slaves go now, you should put tricks upon me,
And baffle me, to favor my son's love.

DAVUS. I, Sir?

SIMO. I thought so: and in fear of that
Conceal'd a secret which I'll now disclose.

DAVUS. What secret, Sir?

SIMO. I'll tell you: for I now
Almost begin to think you may be trusted.

DAVUS. You've found what sort of man I am at last.

SIMO. No marriage was intended.

DAVUS. How! none!

SIMO. None.
All counterfeit, to sound my son and you.

DAVUS. How say you?

SIMO. Even so.

DAVUS. Alack, alack!
I never could have thought it. Ah, what art! (*Archly.*)

SIMO. Hear me. No sooner had I sent you in.
But opportunely I encountered Chremes.

DAVUS. How! are we ruin'd then? (*Aside.*)

SIMO. I told him all.
That you had just told me,——

DAVUS. Confusion! how? (*Aside.*)

SIMO. Begged him to grant his daughter, and at length
With much ado prevail'd.

DAVUS. Undone! (*Aside.*)

SIMO. How's that? (*Overhearing.*)

DAVUS. Well done! I said.

SIMO. My good friend Chremes then

Is now no obstacle.

CHREMES. I'll home a while,
Order due preparations, and return.

(Exit.

SIMO. Prithee, now, Davus, seeing you alone
Have brought about this match——

DAVUS. Yes, I alone.

SIMO. Endeavor farther to amend my son.

DAVUS. Most diligently.

SIMO. It were easy now,
While his mind's irritated.

DAVUS. Be at peace.

SIMO. Do then: where is he?

DAVUS. Probably at home.

SIMO. I'll in, and tell him, what I've now told you.

(Exit.

SCENE VII.

DAVUS *alone.*

Lost and undone! To prison with me straight!
No prayer, no plea: for I have ruin'd all!
Deceiv'd the old man, hamper'd Pamphilus
With marriage; marriage, brought about to-day
By my sole means; beyond the hopes of one;
Against the other's will.——Oh, cunning fool!
Had I been quiet, all had yet been well.
But see, he's coming. Would my neck were broken! *(Retires.)*

SCENE VIII.

Enter PAMPHILUS; DAVUS behind.

PAM. Where is this villain that has ruined me?

DAVUS. I'm a lost man.

PAM. And yet I must confess,
That I deserv'd this, being such a dolt,
A very idiot, to commit my fortunes
To a vile slave. I suffer for my folly,
But will at least take vengeance on him.

But will at least take vengeance upon him.

DAVUS. If I can but escape this mischief
now,
I'll answer for hereafter.

DAVUS. Let me but once escape the present
danger,
I'll answer for hereafter.

PAM. To my father
What shall I say?—And can I then refuse,
Who have but now consented? with what face?
I know not what to do.

DAVUS. I'faith, nor I;
And yet it takes up all my thoughts. I'll tell him
I've hit on something to delay the match.

PAM. Oh! (*Seeing DAVUS.*)

DAVUS. I am seen.

PAM. So, good Sir! What say you?
See, how I'm hamper'd with your fine advice.

DAVUS (*coming forward*). But I'll deliver you.

PAM. Deliver me?

DAVUS. Certainly, Sir.

PAM. What, as you did just now?

DAVUS. Better, I hope.

PAM. And can you then believe
That I would trust you, rascal? You amend
My broken fortunes, or redeem them lost?

You, who to-day, from the most happy state,
Have thrown me upon marriage.—Did not I
Foretell it would be thus?

DAVUS. You did indeed.

PAM. And what do you deserve for this?

DAVUS. The gallows.
—Yet suffer me to take a little breath,
I'll devise something presently.

PAM. Alas,
I have not leisure for your punishment.
The time demands attention to myself,
Nor will be wasted in revenge on you.

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.

CHARINUS *alone.*

Is this to be believ'd, or to be told?
Can then such inbred malice live in man,
To joy in ill, and from another's woes
To draw his own delight?—Ah, is't then so?
—Yes, such there are, the meanest of mankind,
Who, from a sneaking bashfulness, at first
Dare not refuse; but when the time comes on
To make their promise good, then force perforce
Open themselves and fear: yet must deny.
Then too, oh shameless impudence, they cry,

“Who then are you? and what are you to me?
Why should I render up my love to you?
Faith, neighbor, charity begins at home.”
—Speak of their broken faith, they blush not, they,
Now throwing off that shame they ought to wear,
Which they before assum’d without a cause.
—What shall I do? go to him? on my wrongs
Expostulate, and throw reproaches on him?
What will that profit, say you?—very much.
I shall at least imbitter his delight,
And gratify my anger.

SCENE II.

To him PAMPHILUS and DAVUS.

PAM. Oh, Charinus,
By my imprudence, unless Heav’n forefend,
I’ve ruin’d both myself and you.

CHAR. Imprudence!
Paltry evasion! you have broke your faith.

PAM. What now?

CHAR. And do you think that words like these
Can baffle me again?

PAM. What means all this?

CHAR. Soon as I told you of my passion for her,
Then she had charms for you.—Ah, senseless fool,
To judge your disposition by my own!

PAM. You are mistaken.

CHAR. Was your joy no joy,
Without abusing a fond lover’s mind,
Fool’d on with idle hopes?—Well, take her.

PAM. Take her?

Alas, you know not what a wretch I am:
How many cares this slave has brought upon me,
My rascal here.

CHAR. No wonder if he takes
Example from his master.

PAM. Ah, you know not
Me, or my love, or else you would not talk thus.

CHAR. Oh yes, I know it all. You had but now
A dreadful altercation with your father:
And therefore he's enrag'd, nor could prevail
On you, forsooth, to wed. (*Ironically.*)

PAM. To show you then,
How little you conceive of my distress,
These nuptials were mere semblance, mock'ry all,
Nor was a wife intended me.

CHAR. I know it:
You are constrain'd, poor man, by inclination.

PAM. Nay, but have patience! you don't know——

CHAR. I know
That you're to marry her.

PAM. Why rack me thus?
Nay hear! he never ceas'd to importune
That I would tell my father, I would wed;
So press'd, and urg'd, that he at length prevail'd.

CHAR. Who did this?

PAM. Davus.

CHAR. Davus!

PAM. Davus all.

CHAR. Wherefore?

PAM. I know not: but I know the Gods
Meant in their anger I should listen to him.

CHAR. Is it so, Davus?

DAVUS. Even so.

CHAR. How, villain?

The Gods confound you for it!—Tell me, wretch
Had all his most inveterate foes desir'd
To throw him on this marriage, what advice
Could they have given else?

DAVUS. I am deceiv'd,
But not dishearten'd.

CHAR. True. (*Ironically.*)

DAVUS. This way has fail'd;
We'll try another way: unless you think
Because the business has gone ill at first,
We can not graft advantage on misfortune.

PAM. Oh aye, I warrant you, if you look to 't,
Out of one wedding you can work me two.

DAVUS. Pamphilus, 'tis my duty, as your slave,
To strive with might and main, by day and night
With hazard of my life, to do you service:
'Tis yours, if I am cross'd, to pardon me.
My undertakings fail indeed, but then
I spare no pains. Do better, if you can,
And send me packing.

PAM. Aye, with all my heart:
Place me but where you found me first.

DAVUS. I will.

PAM. But do it instantly.

DAVUS. Hist! hold a while:
I hear the creaking of Glycerium's door.

PAM. Nothing to you.

DAVUS. I'm thinking.

PAM. What, at last?

DAVUS. Your business shall be done, and presently.

SCENE III.

Enter MYSIS.

MYSIS *to GLYCERIUM (within)*. Be where he will, I'll find your Pamphilus,
And bring him with me. Meanwhile, you, my soul,
Forbear to vex yourself.

PAM. Mysis!

MYSIS. Who's there?
Oh Pamphilus, well met, Sir!

PAM. What's the matter?

MYSIS. My mistress, by the love you bear her, begs
Your presence instantly. She longs to see you.

PAM. Ah, I'm undone: This sore breaks out afresh.
Unhappy that we are, through your curs'd means,
To be tormented thus. (*To DAVUS.*)—She has been told
A nuptial is prepar'd and therefore sends.

CHAR. From which how safe you were, had he been quiet! (*Pointing to DAVUS.*)

DAVUS. Aye, if he raves not of himself enough,
Do, irritate him. (*To CHARINUS.*)

MYSIS. Truly that's the cause;
And therefore 'tis, poor soul, she sorrows thus.

PAM. Mysis, I swear to thee by all the Gods,
I never will desert her: though assur'd
That I for her make all mankind my foes.
I sought her, carried her: our hearts are one,
And farewell they that wish us put asunder!
Death, naught but death shall part us.

MYSIS. I revive.

PAM. Apollo's oracles are not more true.
If that my father may be wrought upon,
To think I hinder'd not the match, 'tis well:
But if that can not be, come what come may,
Why let him know, 'twas I—What think you now? (*To CHARINUS.*)

CHAR. That we are wretches both.

DAVUS. My brain 's at work.

CHAR. O brave!

PAM. I know what you'd attempt.

DAVUS. Well, well!
I will effect it for you.

PAM. Aye, but now.

DAVUS. E'en now.

CHAR. What is't?

DAVUS. For him, Sir, not for you.
Be not mistaken.

CHAR. I am satisfied.

PAM. Say, what do you propose?

DAVUS. This day, I fear,
Is scarce sufficient for the execution,
So think not I have leisure to relate.
Hence then! you hinder me: hence, hence I say.

PAM. I'll to Glycerium.

(Exit.

DAVUS. Well, and what mean you?
Whither will you, Sir?

CHAR. Shall I speak the truth?

DAVUS. Oh to be sure: now for a tedious tale!

CHAR. What will become of me?

DAVUS. How! not content!
Is it not then sufficient, if I give you
The respite of a day, a little day,
By putting off his wedding?

CHAR. Aye, but Davus,——

DAVUS. But what?

CHAR. That I may wed——

DAVUS. Ridiculous!

CHAR. If you succeed, come to me.

DAVUS. Wherefore come?
I can't assist you.

CHAR. Should it so fall out——

DAVUS. Well, well, I'll come.

CHAR. If aught, I am at home.

(*Exit.*

SCENE IV.

Manent DAVUS, MYSIS.

DAVUS. Mysis, wait here till I come forth.

MYSIS. For what?

DAVUS. It must be so.

MYSIS. Make haste then.

DAVUS. In a moment.

(*Exit to GLYCERIUM'S.*

SCENE V.

MYSIS *alone.*

Can we securely then count nothing ours?
Oh all ye Gods! I thought this Pamphilus
The greatest good my mistress could obtain,
Friend, lover, husband, ev'ry way a blessing:
And yet what woe, poor wretch, endures she not
On his account? Alas, more ill than good.
But here comes Davus.

SCENE VI.

Re-enter DAVUS with the child.

MYSIS. Prithce, man, what now?
Where are you carrying the child?

DAVUS. Oh, Mysis,
Now have I need of all your ready wit,
And all your cunning.

MYSIS. What are you about?

DAVUS. Quick, take the boy, and lay him at our door.

MYSIS. What, on the bare ground?

DAVUS. From the altar then
Take herbs and strew them underneath.

MYSIS. And why
Can't you do that yourself?

DAVUS. Because, that if
My master chance to put me to my oath
That 'twas not I who laid it there, I may
With a safe conscience swear. (*Gives her
the child.*)

DAVUS. Because, supposing
There should be need to swear to my old mast
I did not lay the bantling there myself
I may with a safe conscience.

MYSIS. I conceive.

MYSIS. I understand.
But pray how came this sudden qualm
upon you?

DAVUS. Nay, but be quick, that you may comprehend

What I propose.— (MYSIS *lays the child at SIMO's door.*)
Oh Jupiter! (*Looking out.*)

MYSIS. What now?

DAVUS. Here comes the father of the bride!—I change
My first-intended purpose.

MYSIS. What you mean
I can't imagine.

DAVUS. This way from the right,
I'll counterfeit to come:—And be't your care
To throw in aptly now and then a word,
To help out the discourse as need requires.

MYSIS. Still what you're at, I can not comprehend.
But if I can assist, as you know best,
Not to obstruct your purposes, I'll stay. (DAVUS *retires.*)

SCENE VII.

Enter CHREMES going toward SIMO's.

CHREMES. Having provided all things necessary.
I now return to bid them call the bride.
What's here? (*seeing the child*) by Hercules, a child! Ha, woman,
Was't you that laid it here?

MYSIS. Where is he gone? (*Looking after DAVUS.*)

CHREMES. What, won't you answer me?

MYSIS. (*Looking about.*) Not here: Ah me!
The fellow's gone, and left me in the lurch.

(DAVUS *coming forward and pretending not to see them.*)

DAVUS. Good Heavens, what confusion at the Forum!
The people all disputing with each other!
The market-price is so confounded high. (*Loud.*)
What to say else I know not. (*Aside.*)

MYSIS (to DAVUS). What d'ye mean,

(CHREMES retires and listens to their conversation.)

By leaving me alone?

DAVUS. What farce is this?

Ha, Mysis, whence this child? Who brought it here?

MYSIS. Have you your wits, to ask me such a question?

DAVUS. Whom should I ask, when no one else is here?

CHREMES (*behind*). I wonder whence it comes. (*To himself.*)

DAVUS. Wilt answer me! (*Loud.*)

MYSIS. Ah! (*Confused.*)

DAVUS. This way to the right! (*Apart to MYSIS.*)

MYSIS. You're raving mad.

Was 't not yourself!

DAVUS. I charge you not a word,
But what I ask you. (*Apart to MYSIS.*)

MYSIS. Do you threaten me?

DAVUS. Whence comes this child? (*Loud.*)

MYSIS. From our house.

DAVUS. Ha! ha! ha!
No wonder that a harlot has assurance.

CHREMES. This is the Andrian's servant-maid, I take it.

DAVUS. Do we then seem to you such proper folks
To play these tricks upon? (*Loud to MYSIS.*)

CHREMES. I came in time. (*To himself.*)

DAVUS. Make haste, and take your bantling from our door. (*Loud.*)
Hold! do not stir from where you are, be sure. (*Softly.*)

MYSIS. A plague upon you: you so terrify me!

DAVUS. Wench, did I speak to you or no? (*Loud.*)

MYSIS. What would you?

DAVUS. What would I? Say, whose child have you laid here?
Tell me. (*Loud.*)

MYSIS. You don't know?

DAVUS. Plague of what I know:
Tell what I ask. (*Softly.*)

MYSIS. Yours.

DAVUS. Ours? Whose? (*Loud.*)

MYSIS. Pamphilus's.

DAVUS. How say you? Pamphilus's?
(*Loud.*)

MYSIS. Why is 't not?

MYSIS. To be sure.

CHREMES. I had good cause to be against
this match. (*To himself.*)

DAVUS. O monstrous impudence!
(*Bawling.*)

MYSIS. Why all this noise?

DAVUS. Did not I see this child convey'd by stealth
Into your house last night?

MYSIS. Oh rogue!

DAVUS. 'Tis true.
I saw old Canthara stuff'd out?

MYSIS. Thank Heav'n,
Some free-women were present at her labor?

DAVUS. Troth, she don't know the gentleman, for whom
She plays this game. She thinks, should Chremes see
The child laid here, he would not grant his daughter.
Faith, he would grant her the more willingly.

CHREMES. Not he indeed. (*To himself.*)

DAVUS. But now, one word for all,
Take up the child; or I shall trundle him
Into the middle of the street, and roll
You, madam, in the mire.

MYSIS. The fellow's drunk.

DAVUS. One piece of knavery begets another:
Now, I am told, 'tis whisper'd all about,
That she's a citizen of Athens— (*Loud.*)

CHREMES. How!

DAVUS. And that by law he will be forc'd to wed her.

MYSIS. Why prithee is she not a citizen?

CHREMES. What a fine scrape was I within a hair
Of being drawn into! (*To himself.*)

DAVUS. What voice is that? (*Turning about.*)
Oh Chremes! you are come in time. Attend!

CHREMES. I have heard all already.

DAVUS. You've heard all?

CHREMES. Yes all, I say, from first to last.

DAVUS. Indeed?
Good lack, what knaveries! this lying jade
Should be dragg'd hence to torture.—This is he! (*To MYSIS.*)
Think not 'twas Davus you impos'd upon.

MYSIS. Ah me!—Good Sir, I spoke the truth indeed.

CHREMES. I know the whole.—Is Simo in the house?

DAVUS. Yes, Sir.

(*Exit* CHREMES.

SCENE VIII.

Manent DAVUS, MYSIS. DAVUS *runs up to her.*

MYSIS. Don't offer to touch me, you villain!
If I don't tell my mistress every word——

DAVUS. Why you don't know, you fool, what good we've done.

MYSIS. How should I?

DAVUS. This is father to the bride:
Nor could it otherwise have been contriv'd
That he should know what we would have him.

MYSIS. Well,
You should have given me notice.

DAVUS. Is there then
No diff'rence, think you, whether all you say
Falls natural from the heart, or comes
From dull premeditation?

SCENE IX.

Enter CRITO.

CRITO. In this street
They say that Chrysis liv'd: who rather chose
To heap up riches here by wanton ways,
Than to live poor and honestly at home:
She dead, her fortune comes by law to me.
But I see persons to inquire of. (*Goes up.*) Save you!

MYSIS. Good now, who's that I see? is it not Crito,
Chrysis's kinsman? Aye, the very same.

CRITO. O Mysis, save you!

MYSIS. Save you, Crito!

CRITO. Chrysis
Is then—ha?

MYSIS. Aye, she has left us, poor souls!

CRITO. And ye; how go ye on here?—pretty well?

MYSIS. We?—as we *can*, as the old saying goes,
When as we *would* we can not.

CRITO. And Glycerium,
Has she found out her parents?

MYSIS. Would she had!

CRITO. Not yet! an ill wind blew me hither then.
For truly, had I been appris'd of that,
I'd ne'er have set foot here: for this Glycerium
Was always call'd and thought to be her sister.
What Chrysis left, she takes possession of:
And now for me, a stranger, to commence
A lawsuit here, how good and wise it were,
Other examples teach me. She, I warrant,
Has got her some gallant too, some defender:
For she was growing up a jolly girl
When first she journeyed hither. They will cry
That I'm a pettifogger, fortune-hunter,
A beggar.—And besides it were not well
To leave her in distress.

MYSIS. Good soul! troth Crito,
You have the good old-fashion'd honesty.

CRITO. Well, since I am arriv'd here, bring me to her,
That I may see her.

MYSIS. Aye, with all my heart.

DAVUS. I will in with them: for I would not choose
That our old gentleman should see me now.

(*Exeunt.*

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.

CHREMES, SIMO.

CHREMES. Enough already, Simo, and enough
I've shown my friendship for you; hazarded
Enough of peril: urge me then no more!
Wishing to please you, I had near destroy'd
My daughter's peace and happiness forever.

SIMO. Ah, Chremes, I must now entreat the more,
More urge you to confirm the promis'd boon.

CHREMES. Mark, how unjust you are through willfulness!
So you obtain what you demand, you set
No bounds to my compliance, nor consider
What you request; for if you did consider,
You'd cease to load me with these injuries.

SIMO. What injuries?

CHREMES. Is that a question now?
Have you not driven me to plight my child
To one possess'd with other love, averse
To marriage; to expose her to divorce,
And crazy nuptials; by her woe and bane
To work a cure for your distemper'd son?
You had prevail'd: I travel'd in the match,
While circumstances would admit; but now
The case is chang'd, content you:—It is said
That she's a citizen; a child is born:
Prithee excuse us!

SIMO. Now, for Heav'n's sake.

Believe not them, whose interest it is
To make him vile and abject as themselves.
These stories are all feign'd, concerted all,
To break the match: when the occasion's past
That urges them to this, they will desist.

CHREMES. Oh, you mistake: e'en now I saw the maid
Wrangling with Davus.

SIMO. Artifice! mere trick.

CHREMES. Aye, but in earnest; and when neither knew
That I was there.

SIMO. It may be so: and Davus
Told me beforehand they'd attempt all this;
Though I, I know not how, forgot to tell you.

SCENE II.

Enter DAVUS from GLYCERIUM'S.

DAVUS (*to himself*). He may be easy now, I warrant him——

CHREMES. See yonder's Davus.

SIMO. Ha! whence comes the rogue?

DAVUS. By my assistance, and this stranger's safe. (*To himself.*)

SIMO. What mischief's this? (*Listening.*)

DAVUS. A more commodious man,
Arriving just in season, at a time
So critical, I never knew. (*To himself.*)

SIMO. A knave!
Who's that he praises? (*Listening.*)

DAVUS. All is now secure. (*To himself.*)

SIMO. Why don't I speak to him?

DAVUS. My master here! (*Turning about.*)

What shall I do? (*To himself.*)

SIMO. Good Sir, your humble Servant! (*Sneering.*)

DAVUS. Oh, Simo! and our Chremes!—All is now
Prepar'd within.

SIMO. You've taken special care. (*Ironically.*)

DAVUS. E'en call them when you please.

SIMO. Oh, mighty fine!

That to be sure is all that's wanting now.

—But tell me, Sir! what business had you there? (*Pointing to GLYCERIUM'S.*)

DAVUS. I? (*Confused.*)

SIMO. You?

DAVUS. I—? (*Stammering.*)

SIMO. You, Sir.

DAVUS. I went in but now. (*Disordered.*)

SIMO. As if I ask'd, how long it was ago.

DAVUS. With Pamphilus.

SIMO. Is Pamphilus within?

—Oh torture.—Did not you assure me, Sirrah,
They were at variance?

DAVUS. So they are.

SIMO. Why then

Is Pamphilus within?

CHREMES. Oh, why d'ye think?

He's gone to quarrel with her. (*Sneering.*)

DAVUS. Nay, but Chremes,

There's more in this, and you shall hear strange news.

There's an old countryman, I know not who,

Is just arriv'd here; confident and shrewd;

His look bespeaks him of some consequence.

A grave severity is in his face,

And credit in his words.

SIMO. What story now?

DAVUS. Nay, nothing, Sir, but what I heard him say.

SIMO. And what says he, then?

DAVUS. That he's well assur'd
Glycerium's an Athenian citizen.

SIMO. Ho, Dromo! Dromo!

DAVUS. What now?

SIMO. Dromo!

DAVUS. Hear me.

SIMO. Speak but a word more—Dromo!

DAVUS. Pray, Sir, hear!

SCENE III.

Enter DROMO.

DROMO. Your pleasure, Sir?

SIMO. Here, drag him headlong in,
And truss the rascal up immediately.

DROMO. Whom?

SIMO. Davus.

DAVUS. Why!

SIMO. Because I'll have it so.
Take him, I say.

DAVUS. For what offense?

SIMO. Off with him!

DAVUS. If it appear that I've said aught but truth,
Put me to death.

SIMO. I will not hear. I'll trounce you.

DAVUS. But though it should prove true, Sir!

SIMO. True or false.

See that you keep him bound: and do you hear?

Bind the slave hand and foot. Away!

(*Exeunt DROMO and DAVUS.*

SCENE IV.

Manent SIMO, CHREMES.

—By Heav'n,

As I do live, I'll make you know this day

What peril lies in trifling with a master,

And make him know what 'tis to plague a father.

CHREMES. Ah, be not in such rage.

SIMO. Oh Chremes, Chremes,

Filial unkindness!—Don't you pity me!

To feel all this for such a thankless son!——

Here, Pamphilus, come forth! ho, Pamphilus!

Have you no shame? (*Calling at GLYCERIUM'S door.*)

SCENE V.

Enter PAMPHILUS.

PAM. Who calls?—Undone! my father!

SIMO. What say you? Most——

CHREMES. Ah, rather speak at once

Your purpose, Simo, and forbear reproach.

SIMO. As if 'twere possible to utter aught

Severer than he merits!—Tell me then; (*To PAM.*)

Glycerium is a citizen?

PAM. They say so.

SIMO. They say so!—Oh amazing impudence!——
Does he consider what he says? does he
Repent the deed? or does his color take
The hue of shame?—To be so weak of soul,
Against the custom of our citizens,
Against the law, against his father's will,
To wed himself to shame and this vile woman.

PAM. Wretch that I am!

SIMO. Ah, Pamphilus! d'ye feel
Your wretchedness at last? Then, then, when first
You wrought upon your mind at any rate
To gratify your passion: from that hour
Well might you feel your state of wretchedness.
—But why give in to this? Why torture thus,
Why vex my spirit? Why afflict my age
For his distemp'rature? Why rue his sins?
—No; let him have her, joy in her, live with her.

PAM. My father!——

SIMO. How, my father!—can I think
You want this father? You that for yourself
A home, a wife, and children have acquir'd
Against your father's will? And witnesses
Suborn'd, to prove that she's a citizen?
—You've gain'd your point.

PAM. My father, but one word!

SIMO. What would you say?

CHREMES. Nay, hear him, Simo.

SIMO. Hear him?

What must I hear then, Chremes!

CHREMES. Let him speak.

SIMO. Well, let him speak: I hear him.

PAM. I confess,
I love Glycerium: if it be a fault,
That too I do confess. To you, my father,
I yield myself: dispose me as you please!
Command me! Say that I shall take a wife;
Leave her; I will endure it, as I may——
This only I beseech you, think not I
Suborn'd this old man hither.—Suffer me
To clear myself, and bring him here before you.

SIMO. Bring him here!

PAM. Let me, father!

CHREMES. 'Tis but just:
Permit him!

PAM. Grant me this!

SIMO. Well, be it so.

(*Exit* PAMPHILUS.

I could bear all this bravely, Chremes; more,
Much more, to know that he deceiv'd me not.

CHREMES. For a great fault a little punishment
Suffices to a father.

SCENE VI.

Re-enter PAMPHILUS *with* CRITO.

CRITO. Say no more!
Any of these inducements would prevail:
Or your entreaty, or that it is truth,
Or that I wish it for Glycerium's sake.

CHREMES. Whom do I see? Crito, the Andrian?
Nay certainly 'tis Crito.

CRITO. Save you, Chremes!

CHREMES. What has brought you to Athens?

CRITO. Accident.

But is this Simo?

CHREMES. Aye.

SIMO. Asks he for me?

So, Sir, you say that this Glycerium

Is an Athenian citizen?

CRITO. Do you

Deny it?

SIMO. What then are you come prepar'd?

CRITO. Prepar'd! for what?

SIMO. And dare you ask for what?

Shall you go on thus with impunity?

Lay snares for inexperience'd, lib'ral youth,

With fraud, temptation, and fair promises

Soothing their minds?——

CRITO. Have you your wits?

SIMO. —And then

With marriage solder up their harlot loves?

PAM. Alas, I fear the stranger will not bear this. (*Aside.*)

CHREMES. Knew you this person, Simo, you'd not think thus:

He's a good man.

SIMO. A good man he?—To come,

Although at Athens never seen till now,

So opportunely on the wedding-day!——

Is such a fellow to be trusted, Chremes?

PAM. But that I fear my father, I could make

That matter clear to him. (*Aside.*)

SIMO. A Sharper!

CRITO. How?

CHREMES. It is his humor, Crito: do not heed him.

CRITO. Let him look to 't. If he persists in saying
Whate'er he pleases, I shall make him hear
Something that may displease him.—Do I stir
In these affairs, or make them my concern?
Bear your misfortunes patiently! For me,
If I speak true or false, shall now be known.
—“A man of Athens once upon a time
Was shipwreck'd on the coast of Andros: with him
This very woman, then an infant. He
In this distress applied, it so fell out,
For help to Chrysis' father—”

SIMO. All romance.

CHREMES. Let him alone.

CRITO. And will he interrupt me?

CHREMES. Go on.

CRITO. “Now Chrysis' father, who receiv'd him,
Was my relation. There I've often heard
The man himself declare, he was of Athens.
There too he died.”

CHREMES. His name?

CRITO. His name so quickly!— Phania.

CRITO. His name so quickly!—
Phania.

CHREMES. Amazement!

CHREMES. Amazement!

CRITO. By my troth, I think 'twas Phania;
But this I'm sure, he said he was of
Rhamnus.

CRITO. Troth, I think 'twas Phania;
But this I'm sure, he said he was of Rhamnus.

CHREMES. Oh Jupiter!

CRITO. These circumstances, Chremes,
Were known to many others, then in Andros.

CHREMES. Heav'n grant it may be as I wish!—Inform me,
Whose daughter, said he, was the child? his own?

CRITO. No, not his own.

CHREMES. Whose then?

CRITO. His brother's daughter.

CHREMES. Mine, mine undoubtedly!

CRITO. What say you?

SIMO. How!

PAM. Hark, Pamphilus!

SIMO. But why believe you this?

CHREMES. That Phania was my brother.

SIMO. True. I knew him.

CHREMES. He, to avoid the war, departed hence:
And fearing 'twere unsafe to leave the child,
Embark'd with her in quest of me for Asia:
Since when I've heard no news of him till now.

PAM. I'm scarce myself, my mind is so enrapt
With fear, hope, joy, and wonder of so great,
So sudden happiness.

SIMO. Indeed, my Chremes,
I heartily rejoice she's found your daughter.

PAM. I do believe you, father.

CHREMES. But one doubt
There still remains, which gives me pain.

PAM. Away
With all your doubts! you puzzle a plain cause. (*Aside.*)

CRITO. What is that doubt?

CHREMES. The name does not agree.

CRITO. She had another, when a child.

CHREMES. What, Crito?
Can you remember?

CRITO. I am hunting for it.

PAM. Shall then his memory oppose my bliss,
When I can minister the cure myself?

No, I will not permit it—Hark you, Chremes,
The name is Pasibula.

CRITO. True.

CHREMES. The same.

PAM. I've heard it from herself a thousand times.

SIMO. Chremes, I trust you will believe, we all
Rejoice at this.

CHREMES. 'Fore Heaven I believe so.

PAM. And now, my father——

SIMO. Peace, son! the event
Has reconcil'd me.

PAM. O thou best of fathers!
Does Chremes too confirm Glycerium mine?

CHREMES. And with good cause if Simo hinder not.

PAM. Sir! (*To SIMO.*)

SIMO. Be it so.

CHREMES. My daughter's portion is
Ten talents, Pamphilus.

PAM. I am content.

CHREMES. I'll to her instantly: and prithee, Crito,
Along with me! for sure she knows me not.

(*Exeunt CHREMES and CRITO.*)

SIMO. Why do you not give orders instantly
To bring her to our house?

PAM. Th' advice is good.
I'll give that charge to Davus.

SIMO. It can't be.

PAM. Why?

SIMO. He has other business of his own,
Of nearer import to himself.

PAM. What business?

SIMO. He's bound.

PAM. Bound! how, Sir!

SIMO. How, Sir?—neck and heels.

PAM. Ah, let him be enlarg'd.

SIMO. It shall be done.

PAM. But instantly.

SIMO. I'll in, and order it.

(Exit.

PAM. Oh what a happy, happy day is this!

SCENE VII.

Enter CHARINUS behind.

CHAR. I come to see what Pamphilus is doing:
And there he is!

PAM. And is this true?—yes, yes,
I know 'tis true, because I wish it so.
Therefore I think the life of Gods eternal,
For that their joys are permanent: and now,
My soul hath her content so absolute,
That I too am immortal, if no ill
Step in betwixt me and this happiness.
Oh, for a bosom-friend now to pour out
My ecstasies before him!

CHAR. What's this rapture? *(Listening.)*

PAM. Oh, yonder's Davus: nobody more welcome:
For he, I know, will join in transport with me.

SCENE VIII.

Enter DAVUS.

DAVUS (*entering*). Where's Pamphilus?

PAM. Oh Davus!

DAVUS. Who's there?

PAM. I.

DAVUS. Oh Pamphilus!

PAM. You know not my good fortune.

DAVUS. Do you know my ill fortune?

PAM. To a tittle.

DAVUS. 'Tis after the old fashion, that my ills
Should reach your ears, before your joys reach mine.

PAM. Glycerium has discover'd her relations.

DAVUS. O excellent!

CHAR. How's that? (*Listening.*)

PAM. Her father is
Our most near friend.

DAVUS. Who?

PAM. Chremes.

DAVUS. Charming news!

PAM. And I'm to marry her immediately.

CHAR. Is this man talking in his sleep, and dreams
On what he wishes waking? (*Listening.*)

PAM. And moreover,

For the child, Davus——

DAVUS. Ah, Sir, say no more.
You're th' only favorite of the Gods.

CHAR. I'm made,
If this be true. I'll speak to them. (*Comes forward.*)

PAM. Who's there?
Charinus! oh, well met.

CHAR. I give you joy.

PAM. You've heard then——

CHAR. Ev'ry word: and prithee now,
In your good fortune, think upon your friend.
Chremes is now your own; and will perform
Whatever you shall ask.

PAM. I shall remember.
'Twere tedious to expect his coming forth:
Along with me then to Glycerium!
Davus, do you go home, and hasten them
To fetch her hence. Away, away!

DAVUS. I go.

(*Exeunt PAMPHILUS and CHARINUS.*)

(*DAVUS addressing the audience.*)

Wait not till they come forth: within
She'll be betroth'd; within, if aught remains
Undone, 'twill be concluded—Clap your hands!



THE EUNUCH.

PERSONS REPRESENTED.

PROLOGUE.	DORUS.
LACHES.	SANGA.
PHÆDRIA.	SIMALIO, ETC.
CHÆREA.	
ANTIPHO.	THAIS.
CHREMES.	PYTHIAS.
THRASO.	DORIAS.
GNATHO.	SOPHRONA.
PARMENO.	PAMPHILA.

SCENE, ATHENS.

PROLOGUE.

To please the candid, give offense to none,
This, says the Poet, ever was his care:
Yet if there's one who thinks he's hardly censur'd,
Let him remember he was the aggressor:
He, who translating many, but not well,
On good Greek fables fram'd poor Latin plays;
He, who but lately to the public gave
The Phantom of Menander; *He*, who made,
In the Thesaurus, the Defendant plead
And vouch the question'd treasure to be his,
Before the Plaintiff his own title shows,
Or whence it came into his father's tomb.

Henceforward, let him not deceive himself,
Or cry, "I'm safe, he can say naught of me."
I charge him that he err not, and forbear
To urge me farther; for I've more, much more,
Which now shall be o'erlook'd, but shall be known,
If he pursue his slanders, as before.

Soon as this play, the Eunuch of Menander,
Which we are now preparing to perform,
Was purchas'd by the Ædiles, he obtain'd
Leave to examine it: and afterward
When 'twas rehears'd before the Magistrates,
"A Thief," he cried, "no Poet gives this piece.
Yet has he not deceived us: for we know,
The Colax is an ancient comedy
Of Nævius, and of Plautus; and from thence
The Parasite and Soldier both are stolen."

If that's the Poet's crime, it is a crime
Of ignorance, and not a studied theft.
Judge for yourselves! the fact is even thus.
The Colax is a fable of Menander's;
Wherein is drawn the character of Colax
The parasite, and the vain-glorious soldier;
Which characters, he scruples not to own,
He to his Eunuch from the Greek transferr'd:
But that he knew those pieces were before
Made Latin, that he steadfastly denies.

Yet if to other Poets 'tis not lawful
To draw the characters our fathers drew,
How can it then be lawful to exhibit
Slaves running to and fro; to represent
Good matrons, wanton harlots; or to show
An eating parasite, vain-glorious soldier,
Supposititious children, bubbled dotards,
Or love, or hate, or jealousy?—In short,
Nothing's said now but has been said before.
Weigh then these things with candor, and forgive

The Moderns, if what Ancients did, they do.

Attend, and list in silence to our play,
That ye may know what 'tis the Eunuch means.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.

Enter PHÆDRIA and PARMENO.

PHÆD. And what then shall I do? not go? not now?
When she herself invites me? or were't best
Fashion my mind no longer to endure
These harlots' impudence?—Shut out! recall'd!
Shall I return? No, not if she implore me.

PAR. Oh brave! oh excellent! if you maintain it!
But if you try, and can't go through with spirit,
And finding you can't bear it, uninvited,
Your peace unmade, all of your own accord,
You come and swear you love, and can't endure it,
Good-night! all's over! ruin'd and undone
She'll jilt you, when she sees you in her pow'r.

PHÆD. You then, in time consider and advise!

PAR. Master! the thing which hath not in itself
Or measure or advice, advice can't rule.
In love are all these ills: suspicions, quarrels,
Wrongs, reconcilements, war, and peace again:
Things thus uncertain, if by reason's rules
You'd certain make, it were as wise a task

To try with reason to run mad. And now
What you in anger meditate—I her?
That him?—that me? that would not—pardon me!
I would die rather: No! she shall perceive
How much I am a man.—Big words like these,
She in good faith with one false tiny drop,
Which, after grievous rubbing, from her eyes
Can scarce perforce be squeez'd, shall overcome.
Nay, she shall swear, 'twas you in fault, not she;
You too shall own th' offense, and pray for pardon.

PHÆD. Oh monstrous! monstrous! now indeed I see
How false she is, and what a wretch I am!
Spite of myself I love; and knowing, feeling,
With open eyes run on to my destruction;
And what to do I know not.

PAR. What to do?
What should you do, Sir, but redeem yourself
As cheaply as you can?—at easy rates
If possible—if not—at any rate——
And never vex yourself.

PHÆD. Is that your counsel?

PAR. Aye, if you're wise; and do not add to love
More troubles than it has, and those it has
Bear bravely! But she comes, our ruin comes;
For she, like storms of hail on fields of corn,
Beats down our hopes, and carries all before her.

SCENE II.

Enter THAIS.

THAIS. Ah me! I fear lest Phædria take offense
And think I meant it other than I did,
That he was not admitted yesterday. (*To herself, not seeing them.*)

PHÆD. I tremble, Parmeno, and freeze with horror.

PAR. Be of good cheer! approach yon fire—she'll warm you.

THAIS. Who's there? my Phædria? Why did you stand here?
Why not directly enter?

PAR. Not one word
Of having shut him out!

THAIS. Why don't you speak?

PHÆD. Because, forsooth, these doors will always fly
Open to me, or that because I stand
The first in your good graces. (*Ironically.*)

THAIS. Nay, no more!

PHÆD. No more?—O Thais, Thais, would to Heaven
Our loves were parallel, that things like these
Might torture you, as this has tortur'd me:
Or that your actions were indifferent to me!

THAIS. Grieve not, I beg, my love, my Phædria!
Not that I lov'd another more, I did this.
But I by circumstance was forc'd to do it.

PAR. So then, it seems, for very love, poor soul,
You shut the door in 's teeth.

THAIS. Ah Parmeno!
Is't thus you deal with me? Go to!—But hear
Why I did call you hither?

PHÆD. Be it so.

THAIS. But tell me first, can yon slave hold his peace?

PAM. I? oh most faithfully: But hark ye,
madam!

On this condition do I bind my faith:
The truths I hear, I will conceal; whate'er
Is false, or vain, or feign'd, I'll publish it.

The truths I hear, I will conceal; but falsehood
Fiction, or gross pretence, shall out at once.

I'm full of chinks, and run through here
and there:

So if you claim my secrecy, speak truth.

THAIS. My mother was a Samian, liv'd at Rhodes.

PAR. This sleeps in silence. (*Archly.*)

THAIS. There a certain merchant
Made her a present of a little girl,
Stol'n hence from Attica.

PHÆD. A citizen?

THAIS. I think so, but we can not tell for certain.
Her father's and her mother's name she told
Herself; her country and the other marks
Of her original, she neither knew,
Nor, from her age, was 't possible she should.
The merchant added further, that the pirates,
Of whom he bought her, let him understand,
She had been stol'n from Sunium. My mother
Gave her an education, brought her up
In all respects as she had been her own;
And she in gen'ral was suppos'd my sister.
I journeyed hither with the gentleman
To whom alone I was connected then,
The same who left me all I have.

PAR. Both these
Are false, and shall go forth at large.

PAR. These articles
Are both rank falsehoods, and shall out.

THAIS. Why so?

PAR. Because nor you with one could be content,
Nor he alone enrich'd you; for my master
Made good and large addition.

THAIS. I allow it,
But let me hasten to the point I wish:
Meantime the captain, who was then but young
In his attachment to me, went to Caria.
I, in his absence, was address'd by you;
Since when, full well you know, how very dear

I've held you, and have trusted you with all
My nearest counsels.

PHÆD. And yet Parmeno
Will not be silent even here.

PAR. Oh, Sir,
Is that a doubt?

THAIS. Nay, prithee now, attend!
My mother's lately dead at Rhodes: her brother,
Too much intent on wealth, no sooner saw
This virgin, handsome, well-accomplish'd, skill'd
In music, than, spurr'd on by hopes of gain,
In public market he expos'd and sold her.
It so fell out, my soldier-spark was there,
And bought her, all unknowing these events,
To give to me: but soon as he return'd,
And found how much I was attach'd to you,
He feign'd excuses to keep back the girl;
Pretending, were he thoroughly convinc'd
That I would still prefer him to yourself,
Nor fear'd that when I had receiv'd the girl,
I would abandon him, he'd give her to me;
But that he doubted. For my part, I think
He is grown fond of her himself.

PHÆD. Is there
Aught more between them?

THAIS. No; for I've inquir'd,
And now, my Phædria, there are sundry causes
Wherefore I wish to win the virgin from him.
First, for she's call'd my sister; and moreover,
That I to her relations may restore her.
I'm a lone woman, have nor friend, nor kin:
Wherefore, my Phædria, I would raise up friends
By some good turn:—And you, I prithee now,
Help me to do it. Let him some few days
Be my gallant in chief. What! no reply?

PHÆD. Abandon'd woman! Can I aught reply
To deeds like these?

PAR. Oh excellent! well said!
He feels at length; Now, master, you're a man.

PHÆD. I saw your story's drift.—“A little girl
Stol'n hence—My mother brought her up—was call'd
My sister—I would fain obtain her from him,
That I to her relations might restore her——”
All this preamble comes at last to this.
I am excluded, he's admitted. Why?
But that you love him more than me, and fear
Lest this young captive win your hero from you.

THAIS. Do I fear that?

PHÆD. Why, prithee now, what else?
Does he bring gifts alone? didst e'er perceive
My bounty shut against you? Did I not,
Because you told me you'd be glad to have
An Ethiopian servant-maid, all else
Omitted, seek one out? You said besides,
You wish'd to have an Eunuch, 'cause forsooth,
They were for dames of quality; I found one:
For both I yesterday paid twenty *minæ*,
Yet you condemn me—I forgot not these,
And for these I'm despis'd.

THAIS. Why this, my Phædria?
Though I would fain obtain the girl, and though
I think by these means it might well be done;
Yet, rather than make you my enemy,
I'll do as you command.

PHÆD. Oh, had you said
Those words sincerely. “Rather than make you
My enemy!”—Oh, could I think those words
Came from your heart, what is 't I'd not endure!

PAR. Gone! conquer'd with one word! alas, how soon!

THAIS. Not speak sincerely? from my very soul?
What did you ever ask, although in sport,
But you obtain'd it of me? yet I can't
Prevail on you to grant but two short days.

PHÆD. Well—for two days—so those two be not twenty.

THAIS. No in good faith but two, or——

PHÆD. Or? no more.

THAIS. It shall not be: but you will grant me those.

PHÆD. Your will must be a law.

THAIS. Thanks, my sweet Phædria!

PHÆD. I'll to the country: there consume myself
For these two days: it must be so: we must
Give way to Thais. See you, Parmeno,
The slaves brought hither.

PAR. Sir, I will.

PHÆD. My Thais,
For these two days farewell!

THAIS. Farewell, my Phædria!
Would you aught else with me?

PHÆD. Aught else, my Thais?
Be with yon soldier present, as if absent:
All night and day love me: still long for me:
Dream, ponder still of me; wish, hope for me:
Delight in me; be all in all with me;
Give your whole heart, for mine's all yours, to me.

(Exeunt.)

SCENE III.

Manet THAIS.

Ah me! I fear that he believes me not,

And judges of my heart from those of others.
I in my conscience know, that nothing false
I have deliver'd, nor to my true heart
Is any dearer than this Phædria:
And whatsoe'er in this affair I've done,
For the girl's sake I've done: for I'm in hopes
I know her brother, a right noble youth.
To-day I wait him, by his own appointment;
Wherefore I'll in, and tarry for his coming.

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.

PHÆDRIA, PARMENO.

PHÆDRIA. Carry the slaves according to my order.

PAR. I will.

PHÆD. But diligently.

PAR. Sir, I will.

PHÆD. But soon.

PAR. I will, Sir!

PHÆD. Say, is it sufficient?

PAR. Ah! what a question's that? as if it were
So difficult! I wish, Sir Phædria,
You could gain aught so easy, as lose these.

PHÆD. I lose, what's dearer yet, my comfort with them.

Repine not at my gifts.

PAR. Not I: moreover
I will convey them straight. But have you any
Other commands?

PHÆD. Oh yes: set off our presents
With words as handsome as you can: and drive,
As much as possible, that rival from her!

PAR. Ah, Sir, I should, of course, remember that.

PHÆD. I'll to the country, and stay there.

PAR. O, aye! (*Ironically.*)

PHÆD. But hark you!

PAR. Sir, your pleasure?

PHÆD. Do you think
I can with constancy hold out, and not
Return before my time?

PAR. Hold out? Not you.

Either you'll straight return, or soon at
night

Your dreams will drive you out o' doors.

Either you'll straight return, or want of sleep
Will drive you forth at midnight.

PHÆD. I will toil;

PHÆD. I'll toil;

That, weary, I may sleep against my will.

PAR. Weary you may be; but you'll never sleep.

PHÆD. Ah, Parmeno, you wrong me. I'll cast out
This treacherous softness from my soul, nor thus
Indulge my passions. Yes, I could remain,
If need, without her even three whole days.

PAR. Hui! three whole livelong days! consider, Sir.

PHÆD. I am resolved.

(PARMENO alone.)

Heav'ns, what a strange disease is this! that love

Should so change men, that one can hardly swear
They are the same!—No mortal liv'd
Less weak, more grave, more temperate than he.
—But who comes yonder?—Gnatho, as I live;
The Captain's parasite! and brings along
The Virgin for a present: oh rare wench!
How beautiful! I shall come off, I doubt,
But scurvily with my decrepit Eunuch.
This Girl surpasses ev'n Thais herself.

SCENE II.

Enter GNATHO leading PAMPHILA; PARMENO behind.

GNAT. Good Heav'ns! how much one man
excels another!

What diff'rence 'twixt a wise man and a
fool!

What just now happen'd proves it: coming
hither

I met with an old countryman, a man
Of my own place and order, like myself,
No scurvy fellow, who, like me, had spent
In mirth and jollity his whole estate.

He was in a most wretched trim; his looks
Lean, sick, and dirty; and his clothes all
rags.

Seeing him in a wretched trim; his looks

"How now!" cried I, "what means this
figure, friend?"

Alas! says he, my patrimony's gone.

—Ah, how am I reduc'd! my old acquaintance
And friends all shun me."—Hearing this, how cheap
I held him in comparison with me!

"Why, how now? wretch, said I, most idle wretch!
Have you spent all, nor left ev'n hope behind?
What! have you lost your sense with your estate?
Me!—look on me—come from the same condition!

How sleek! how neat! how clad! in what good case!
I've ev'ry thing, though nothing; naught possess,
Yet naught I ever want."—"Ah, Sir, but I
Have an unhappy temper, and can't bear
To be the butt of others, or to take
A beating now and then."—"How then! d'ye think
Those are the means of thriving? No, my friend!
Such formerly indeed might drive a trade:
But mine's a new profession; I the first
That ever struck into this road. There are
A kind of men, who wish to be the head
Of ev'ry thing; but are not. These I follow;
Not for their sport and laughter, but for gain
To laugh with them, and wonder at their parts:
Whate'er they say, I praise it; if again
They contradict, I praise that too: does any
Deny? I too deny: affirm? I too
Affirm: and in a word, I've brought myself
To say, unsay, swear, and forswear, at pleasure:
And that is now the best of all professions."

PAR. A special fellow this! who drives fools mad.

GNAT. Deep in this conversation, we at
length

Come to the market, where the sev'ral
tradesmen,

Butchers, cooks, grocers, poult'ers,
fishmongers,

(Who once did profit and still profit by
me,)

(Who, while my means were ample, profited,
And, tho' now wasted, profit by me still,)

All run with joy to me, salute, invite,
And bid me welcome. He, poor half-
starv'd wretch,

Soon as he saw me thus caress'd, and
found

I got my bread so easily, desired
He might have leave to learn that art of me.

I bade him follow me, if possible:
And, as the Schools of the Philosophers
Have ta'en from the Philosophers their
names,

So, in like manner, let all Parasites
Be call'd from me Gnathonics!

PAR. Mark, what ease,
And being kept at other's cost, produces!

GNAT. But hold, I must convey this girl to Thais,
And bid her forth to sup.—Ha, Parmeno!
Our rival's slave, standing at Thais' door!
—How melancholy he appears! All's safe:
These poor rogues find but a cold welcome here.
I'll play upon this knave. (*Aside.*)

PAR. These fellows think
This present will make Thais all their own. (*Aside.*)

GNAT. To Parmeno, his lov'd and honor'd friend,
Gnatho sends greeting. (*Ironically.*)—What are you upon?

PAR. My legs.

GNAT. I see it.—Is there nothing here
Displeasing to you?

PAR. You.

GNAT. I do believe it.
But prithee, is there nothing else?

PAR. Wherefore?

GNAT. Because you're melancholy.

PAR. Not at all.

GNAT. Well, do not be so!—Pray, now, what d'ye think
Of this young handmaid?

PAR. Troth, she's not amiss.

GNAT. I plague the rascal. (*Half aside.*)

PAR. How the knave's deceiv'd! (*Half aside.*)

GNAT. Will not this gift be very acceptable
To Thais, think you?

PAR. You'd insinuate
That we're shut out.—There is, alas, a change
In all things.

GNAT. For these six months, Parmeno,
For six whole months at least, I'll make you easy;
You sha'n't run up and down, and watch till daylight;
Come, don't I make you happy?

PAR. Very happy.

GNAT. 'Tis my way with my friends.

PAR. You're very good.

GNAT. But I detain you: you, perhaps, was going
Somewhere else.

PAR. Nowhere.

GNAT. May I beg you then
To use your int'rest here, and introduce me
To Thais?

PAR. Hence! away! these doors
Fly open now, because you carry her.

GNAT. Would you have any one call'd forth?

(*Exit.*

PAR. Well, well!
Pass but two days; and you, so welcome now,
That the doors open with your little finger,
Shall kick against them then, I warrant you,
Till your heels ache again.

(*Re-enter GNATHO.*)

GNAT. Ha! Parmeno!
Are you here still? What! are you left a spy,

Lest any go-between should run by stealth
To Thais from the Captain?

(Exit.

PAR. Very smart!
No wonder such a wit delights the Captain!
But hold! I see my master's younger son
Coming this way. I wonder much he should
Desert Piræus, where he's now on guard.
'Tis not for nothing. All in haste he comes,
And seems to look about.

SCENE III.

Enter CHÆREA; PARMENO behind.

CHÆR. Undone! undone!
The Girl is lost; I know not where she is,
Nor where I am: ah, whither shall I trace?
Where seek? of whom inquire? or which way turn?
I'm all uncertain; but have one hope still:
Where'er she is, she can not long lie hid.
Oh charming face! all others from my memory
Hence I blot out. Away with common beauties!

PAR. So, here's the other! and he mutters too
I know not what of love. Oh what a poor
Unfortunate old man their father is!
As for this stripling, if he once begin,
His brother's is but jest and children's play
To his mad fury.

CHÆR. Twice ten thousand curses
Seize the old wretch, who kept me back to-day;
And me for staying! with a fellow too
I did not care a farthing for!—But see!
Yonder stands Parmeno.—Good-day!

PAR. How now?

Wherefore so sad? and why this hurry, Chærea?
Whence come you?

CHÆR. I? I can not tell, i'faith,
Whence I am come, or whither I am going,
I've so entirely lost myself.

PAR. And why?

CHÆR. I am in love.

PAR. Oh brave!

CHÆR. Now, Parmeno,
Now you may show what kind of man you are.
You know you've often told me; "Chærea,
Find something out to set your heart upon,
And mark how I will serve you!" yes, you know
You've often said so, when I scrap'd together
All the provisions for you at my father's.

PAR. Away, you trifler!

CHÆR. Nay, in faith, it's true:
Now make your promise good! and in a cause
Worthy the utmost reachings of your soul:
A girl! my Parmeno, not like our misses;
Whose mothers try to keep their shoulders down,
And bind their bosoms, that their shapes may seem
Genteel and slim. Is a girl rather plump?
They call her nurse, and stint her in her food:
Thus art, in spits of nature, makes them all
Mere bulrushes: and therefore they're belov'd.

PAR. And what's this girl of yours?

CHÆR. A miracle.

PAR. Oh, to be sure!

CHÆR. True, natural red and white;
Her body firm, and full of precious stuff!

PAR. Her age?

CHÆR. About sixteen.

PAR. The very prime!

CHÆR. This girl, by force, by stealth, or by entreaty,
Procure me! how I care not, so I have her.

PAR. Well, whom does she belong to?

CHÆR. I don't know.

PAR. Whence comes she?

CHÆR. I can't tell.

PAR. Where does she live?

CHÆR. I can't tell neither.

PAR. Where was it you saw her?

CHÆR. Here in the street.

PAR. And how was it you lost her?

CHÆR. Why it was that, which I so fumed about,
As I came hither! nor was ever man
So jilted by good fortune as myself.

PAR. What mischief now?

CHÆR. Confounded luck.

PAR. How so?

CHÆR. How so! d'ye know one Archidemides,
My father's kinsman, and about his age?

PAR. Full well.

CHÆR. As I was in pursuit of her
He met me.

PAR. Rather inconveniently.

CHÆR. Oh most unhappily! for other ills
May be told, Parmeno!—I could swear too,
For six, nay seven months, I had not seen
him,

CHÆR. Oh most unhappily! for lighter ills
May pass for inconvenient, Parmeno.
Nay, I could swear, with a safe conscience too

Till now, when least I wish'd and most
would shun it.

Is not this monstrous? Eh!

PAR. Oh! very monstrous.

CHÆR. Soon as from far he saw me, instantly,
Bent, trembling, drop-jaw'd, gasping, out of breath,
He hobbled up to me.—“Holo! ho! Chærea!”——
I stopp'd.—“D'ye know what I want with you?”—“What?”
—“I have a cause to-morrow.”—“Well! what then?”——
—“Fail not to tell your father, he remember
To go up with me, as an advocate.”——
His prating took some time. “Aught else?” said I.
“Nothing,” said he:—Away flew I, and saw
The girl that instant turn into this street.

PAR. Sure he must mean the virgin, just
now brought
To Thais for a present.

CHÆR. Soon as I
Came hither, she was out of sight.

PAR. Had she
Any attendants?

CHÆR. Yes; a parasite,
With a maid-servant.

PAR. 'Tis the very same;
Away! have done! all's over.

CHÆR. What d'ye mean?

PAR. The girl I mean.

CHÆR. D'ye know then who she is?
Tell me!—or have you seen her?

PAR. Yes, I've seen her;
I know her; and can tell you where she is.

CHÆR. How! my dear Parmeno, d'ye know her?

CHÆR. When I reach'd
This place, the girl was vanish'd.

PAR. Had your lady
Any attendants?

PAR. Yes.

CHÆR. And where she is, d'ye know?

PAR. Yes,—there she is; (*Pointing.*)
Carried to Madam Thais for a present.

CHÆR. What monarch could bestow a gift so precious?

PAR. The mighty Captain Thraso, Phædria's rival.

CHÆR. Alas, poor brother!

PAR. Aye, and if you knew
The gift he sends to be compar'd with this,
You'd cry alas, indeed!

CHÆR. What is his gift?

PAR. An Eunuch.

CHÆR. What! that old and ugly slave
That he bought yesterday?

PAR. The very same.

CHÆR. Why, surely, he'll be trundled out o'
doors

He and his gift together—I ne'er knew
Till now that Thais was our neighbor.

PAR. She
Has not been long so.

CHÆR. Ev'ry way unlucky:
Ne'er to have seen her neither:—Prithee,
tell me,
Is she so handsome, as she's said to be?

PAR. Yes, faith.

CHÆR. But nothing to compare to mine.

PAR. Oh, quite another thing.

CHÆR. But Parmeno!
Contrive that I may have her.

He and his gift together—But till now
I never knew this Thais was our neighbour.

PAR. She came but lately.

CHÆR. Ev'ry way unlucky:

PAR. Well, I will.

Depend on my assistance:—have you any
Further commands? (*As if going.*)

CHÆR. Where are you going?

PAR. Home;
To bring according to your brother's order,
The slaves to Thais.

CHÆR. Oh, that happy Eunuch!
To be convey'd into that house!

PAR. Why so?

CHÆR. Why so? why, he shall have that
 charming girl
His fellow-servant, see her, speak with her,
Be with her in the same house all day long,
And sometimes eat, and sometimes sleep
 by her.

His fellow-servant, see her all day long,
Converse with her, dwell under the same roof,
And sometimes eat, and sometimes sleep by h

PAR. And what if you should be so happy?

CHÆR. How?
Tell me, dear Parmeno!

PAR. Assume his dress.

CHÆR. His dress! what then?

PAR. I'll carry you for him.

CHÆR. I hear you.

PAR. I will say that you are he.

CHÆR. I understand you.

PAR. So shall you enjoy
Those blessings which but now you envied him:
Eat with her, be with her, touch, toy with her,
And sleep by her: since none of Thais' maids
Know you, or dream of what you are. Besides,
Your figure, and your age are such, that you

May well pass for an Eunuch.

CHÆR. Oh, well said!

I ne'er heard better counsel. Come, let's in?

Dress me, and carry me! Away, make haste!

PAR. What are you at? I did but jest.

CHÆR. You trifle.

PAR. I'm ruin'd: fool, what have I done? Nay, whither

D'ye push me thus? You'll throw me down. Nay, stay!

CHÆR. Away.

PAR. Nay, prithee!

CHÆR. I'm resolv'd.

PAR. Consider;

You carry this too far.

CHÆR. No, not at all.

Give way!

PAR. And Parmeno must pay for all.

Ah, we do wrong!

CHÆR. Is it then wrong for me

To be convey'd into a house of harlots,

And turn those very arts on them, with which

They hamper us, and turn our youth to scorn?

Can it be wrong for me too, in my turn,

To deceive them, by whom we're all deceiv'd?

No, rather let it be! 'tis just to play

This trick upon them: which, if gray-beards know,

They'll blame indeed, but all will think well done.

PAR. Well, if you must, you must; but do not then,

After all's over, throw the blame on me.

CHÆR. No, no!

PAR. But do you order me?

CHÆR. I do:

CHÆR. I do:

Order, command, force.

PAR. Oh, I'll not dispute
Your pow'r. So, follow me.

CHÆR. Heav'n speed the plow.

Order, command, compel you; nor will e'er
Deny, or disavow my putting-on.

PAR. Come on then: follow me!

CHÆR. Heav'n grant success!

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.

Enter THRASO and GNATHO.

THRASO. And Thais then returns me many
thanks?

GNAT. Ten thousand.

THRA. Say, is she delighted with it?

GNAT. Not so much with the gift itself, as
that

By you 'twas given: but therein she
triumphs.

(*Enter PARMENO behind.*)

PAR. I'm come to look about me, and
observe

A proper opportunity to bring
My presents. But behold the Captain!

THRA. 'Tis
Something, I know not how, peculiar to
me,

GNAT. Not for the present's sake so much, as t
From you it was presented: But therein
She truly triumphs.

PAR. I'm upon the watch,
To mark a proper opportunity
To bring my presents. But behold the Captain:

THRA. It is, indeed, something, I know not hov
Peculiar to me, do whate'er I please,
It will appear agreeable.

GNAT. In truth
I always have observ'd it.

THRA. Ev'n the King
Held himself much obliged, whate'er I did:
Not so to others.

That all I do 's agreeable.

GNAT. In truth
I have observ'd it.

THRA. E'en the King always
Held himself much obliged, whate'er I did:
Not so to others.

GNAT. Men of wit, like you,
The glory, got by others' care and toil,
Often transfer unto themselves.

THRA. You've hit it.

GNAT. The king then held you——

THRA. Certainly.

GNAT. Most dear.

THRA. Most near. He trusted his whole army to me,
His counsels.——

GNAT. Wonderful!

THRA. And then whene'er
Satiety of company, or hate
Of business seiz'd him—when he would repose——
As if——you understand me.

GNAT. Perfectly.
When he would—in a manner—clear his stomach
Of all uneasiness.

THRA. The very thing.
On such occasions he chose none but me.

GNAT. Hui! there's a king indeed! a king of
taste!

THRA. One of a thousand.

GNAT. Of a million sure!
—If he could live with you. (*Aside.*)

THRA. No general man, I promise you.

GNAT. Oh no!
He must have been particular indeed,
If he convers'd with You.

THRA. The courtiers all
Began to envy me, and rail'd in secret:
I car'd not; whence their spleen increas'd
the more.

One in particular, who had the charge
Of th' Indian elephants; who grew at last
So very troublesome, "I prithee, Strato,
Are you so savage, and so fierce, (says I,)
Because you're governor of the wild
beasts?"

GNAT. Oh, finely said! and shrewdly! excellent!
Too hard upon him!—what said he to't?

THRA. Nothing.

GNAT. And how the devil should he?

PAR. Gracious Heav'n!
The stupid coxcomb!—and that rascal too! (*Aside.*)

THRA. Aye! but the story of the Rhodian, Gnatho!
How smart I was upon him at a feast——
Did I ne'er tell you?

GNAT. Never: but pray do!
—I've heard it o'er and o'er a thousand times. (*Aside.*)

THRA. We were by chance together at a feast——
This Rhodian, that I told you of and I.——
I, as it happen'd, had a wench: the spark
Began to toy with her, and laugh at me.
"Why how now, Impudence! (said I,) are you
A *hare* yourself, and yet would hunt for *game*?"

GNAT. Ha! ha! ha!

THRA. What's the matter?

GNAT. Ha! ha! ha!
Witty! smart! excellent! incomparable!
Is it your own? I swear I thought 'twas old.

THRA. Why, did you ever hear it?

GNAT. Very often;
And reckon'd admirable.

THRA. 'Tis my own.

GNAT. And yet 'twas pity to be so severe
On a young fellow, and a gentleman.

PAR. Ah! devil take you! (*Aside.*)

GNAT. What became of him?

THRA. It did for him. The company were all
Ready to die with laughing:—in a word,
They dreaded me.

GNAT. No wonder.

THRA. Harkye, Gnatho!
Thais, you know, suspects I love this girl.
Shall I acquit myself?

GNAT. On no account.
Rather increase her jealousy.

THRA. And why?

GNAT. Why?—do you ask?—as if you didn't know!——
Whene'er she mentions Phædria, or whene'er
She praises him, to vex you——

THRA. I perceive.

GNAT. To hinder that, you've only this resource.
When she names Phædria, name you Pamphila.
If she should say, "come! let's have Phædria
To dinner with us!"—"aye, and Pamphila
To sing to us!"—if she praise Phædria's person,
Praise you the girl's! so give her tit for tat,
And gall her in her turn.

THRA. Suppose she lov'd me,
This might avail me, Gnatho!

GNAT. While she loves
The presents which you give, expecting more,
So long she loves you; and so long you may
Have pow'r to vex her. She will always fear
To make you angry, lest some other reap
The harvest, which she now enjoys alone.

THRA. You're right: and yet I never thought of it.

GNAT. Ridiculous! because you did not turn
Your thoughts that way; or with how much more ease
Would you have hit on this device yourself!

SCENE II.

Enter THAIS and PYTHIAS.

THAIS. I thought I heard the Captain's voice: and see!
Good-day, my Thraso!

THRA. Oh my Thais, welcome!
How does my sweeting?—are you fond of me
For sending you that music-girl?

PAR. Oh brave!
He sets out nobly!

THAIS. For your worth I love you.

GNAT. Come, let's to supper? why do you delay?

PAR. Mark t'other! he's a chip of the old block.

THAIS. I'm ready when you please.

PAR. I'll up to her,
And seem as if but now come forth.—Ha! Thais,
Where are you gadding?

THAIS. Well met, Parmeno!
I was just going——

PAR. Whither?

THAIS. Don't you see
The Captain?

PAR. Yes, I see him—to my sorrow.
The presents from my master wait your pleasure.

THRA. Why do we stop thus? wherefore go not hence? (*Angrily.*)

PAR. Beseech you, Captain, let us, with your leave,
Produce our presents, treat, and parley with her!

THRA. Fine gifts, I warrant you, compar'd
with mine!

PAR. They'll answer for themselves—Holo,
there! order
The slaves, I told you, to come forth.—
Here, this way!

PAR. They'll answer for themselves—Ho, ther
within!
Order the slaves, I told you, to come forth.

(*Enter a BLACK GIRL.*)

Do you stand forward!—This girl, ma'am,
comes quite
From Ethiopia.

This way! do you stand forward!—This girl,
ma'am,
Comes quite from Æthiopia.

THRA. Worth three Minæ.

THRA. Worth about three Minæ.

GNAT. Scarce.

PAR. Ho! where are you, Dorus?—Oh, come hither!

(*Enter CHÆREA in the Eunuch's habit.*)

An Eunuch, Madam! of a lib'ral air,
And in his prime!

THAIS. Now as I live, he's handsome!

PAR. What say you, Gnatho? Is he despicable?
Or, Captain, what say you?—Dumb?—Praise sufficient;
Try him in letters, exercises, music:
In all the arts, a gentleman should know,
I'll warrant him accomplish'd.

THRA. Troth, that Eunuch
Is well enough.

PAR. And he, who sends these presents,
Requires you not to live for him alone,
And for his sake to shut out all mankind:
Nor does he tell his battles, show his wounds,
Or shackle your free will, as some folks do.

(*Looking at THRASO.*)

But when 'twill not be troublesome, or when
You've leisure, in due season, he's content
If then he is admitted.

THRA. This poor fellow
Seems to belong to a poor wretched master.

GNAT. Beyond all doubt; for who that could obtain
Another, would endure a slave like this?

PAR. Peace, wretch, that art below the meanest slave!
You that could bring your mind so very low,
As to cry aye and no at yon fool's bidding,
I'm sure, might get your bread out o'the fire.

THRA. Why don't we go? (*Impatiently.*)

THAIS. Let me but carry in
These first, and give some orders in the
house,
And I'll attend you.

THAIS. Let me but introduce

(*Exit with CHÆREA, and the Ethiopian.*)

THRA. I'll depart from hence.
Gnatho, wait you for her!

PAR. It ill beseems
The dignity of a renown'd commander,
T' escort his mistress in the street.

THRA. Away,
Slave! you're beneath my notice—like your master.

(*Exit PARMENO.*)

GNAT. Ha! ha! ha! ha!

THRA. What moves your laughter?

THRA. What moves your laughter, Gnatho?

GNAT. That

GNAT. Your speech but now: and then the
Rhodian came

You said just now: and then the Rhodian
came

Across my mind.—But Thais comes.

THRA. Go run,
And see that ev'ry thing's prepar'd at home!

GNAT. It shall be done.

(Exit.

THAIS (*entering with* PYTHIAS). Take care now, Pythias,
Great care, if Chremes come, to press him stay;
Or, if that's inconvenient, to return:
If that's impossible, then bring him to me!

PYTH. I'll do so.

THAIS. Hold! what else had I to say?
Take care, be sure, of yonder virgin! see,
You keep at home.

THRA. Let's go.

THAIS. Girls, follow me!

(Exit, attended by Servants and THRASO.

SCENE III.

CHREMES *alone.*

In truth the more and more I think, the
more
I am convinc'd that Thais means me ill:
So plain I see her arts to draw me in.
Ev'n when she first invited me, (and when

Had any ask'd, *What business have you
there?*

The question would have stagger'd me,)
she fram'd

Sev'ral excuses to detain me there.

Said she had made a sacrifice, and had
Affairs of consequence to settle with me.

—Oho! thought I immediately, I smell
A trick upon me!—down she sat, behav'd
Familiarly, and tried to beat about
For conversation. Being at a loss,
She ask'd, how long my parents had been
dead?

—I told her, long time since:—on which
she ask'd,

Whether I had a country-house at Sunium?

—And how far from the sea?—I half
believe

She likes my villa, and would wheedle me
To give it her.—Her final questions were,
If I ne'er lost a little sister thence?

—Who was miss'd with her?—what she
had when lost?

If any one could know her? Why should
Thais

Demand all this, unless,—a saucy
baggage!——

She means to play the counterfeit, and
feign

Herself that sister?—but if she's alive,
She is about sixteen, not more; Thais
Is elder than myself.—She sent beside
To beg I'd come again.—Or, let her say
What she would have; or, not be
troublesome!

I'll not return a third time.—Ho! who's
there?

—If there was any body capable
Of recollecting her?—Why all these questions
Unless perhaps she means,—a saucy baggage!
To play the counterfeit, and feign herself
That sister, who was lost so long ago?
But she, if living, is about sixteen;
Not more: and Thais older than myself.
She sent beside to press me earnestly
To visit her again.—Or, let her say
What she would have; or, trouble me no more!
I'll not return a third time.—Ho! who's there?
Here am I! Chremes!

Here am I! Chremes!

SCENE IV.

Enter PYTHIAS.

PYTH. Oh, sweet, charming, Sir!

CHRE. A coaxing hussy!

PYTH. Thais begs and prays
You'd come again to-morrow.

CHRE. I am going
Into the country.

PYTH. Nay, now prithee come?

CHRE. I can't, I tell you.

PYTH. Walk in, then, and stay
Till she returns herself.

CHRE. Not I.

PYTH. And why,
Dear Chremes?

CHRE. Go, and hang yourself!

CHRE. Off, you saucy slut!

PYTH. Well, Sir,
Since you're so positive, shall I entreat you
To go to her?

CHRE. I will.

PYTH. Here, Dorias! (*A maid-servant enters.*)
Conduct this gentleman to Captain Thraso's.

(*PYTHIAS re-enters.—CHREMES goes out another way with DORIAS.*)

SCENE V.

ANTIPHO *alone.*

But yesterday a knot of us young fellows
Assembled at Piræus, and agreed
To club together for a feast to-day.

Chærea had charge of all; the rings were
given,

And time and place appointed.—The
time's past;

No entertainment's at the place; and
Chærea

Is nowhere to be found.—I can't tell what
To think on't.—Yet the rest of my
companions

Have all commission'd me to seek him out.
I'll see if he's at home;—but who comes
here

From Thais?—Is it he, or no?—'Tis he.

—What manner of man's here?—what
habit's that?

—What mischief has the rogue been at?
I'm all

Astonishment, and can not guess.—But I'll
Withdraw a while, and try to find it out.
(Retires.)

Is no where to be met with.—For my part,
I'm quite to seek in this; and what to say,
Or guess, I know not.—Yet the company
Have all commission'd me to find him out.
I'll see if he's at home;—but who comes here
From Thais?—Is it he, or no?—'Tis he.——
—What manner of man's here?—what habit's
that?
—What mischief is the meaning of all this?
I'm all astonishment, and can not guess.
But I'll withdraw a while, and try to learn.

SCENE VI.

Enter CHÆREA, in the Eunuch's habit.

CHÆR. (looking about). Is any body here?

—No, nobody.

Does any follow me?—No, nobody.

May I then let my ecstasy break forth!

O Jupiter! 'tis now the very time,

When I could suffer to be put to death,

Lest not another transport like to this,
Remain in life to come.—But is there not
Some curious impertinent to come
Across me now, and murder me with
questions?

—To ask, why I'm so flutter'd? why so
joyful?

Whither I'm going? whence I came? and
where

I got this habit? what I'm looking after?
Whether I'm in my senses? or stark mad?

ANTI. I'll go myself, and do that kindness
to him.

Chærea, (*advancing*,) what's all this
flutter? what's this dress?

What is't transports you? what d'ye want?
art mad?

Why do ye start at me? and why not speak?

CHÆR. O happy, happy day!—Save you,
dear friend!

There's not a man on earth I'd rather see
This moment than yourself.

ANTI. Come, tell me all!

CHÆR. Tell you! I will beseech you give me
hearing.

D'ye know my brother's mistress here?

ANTI. Yes: Thais,
Or I'm deceiv'd.

CHÆR. The same.

ANTI. I do remember.

CHÆR. To-day a girl was sent a present to
her.

Why need I speak or praise her beauty now

Whither I'm going? whence I came? from
whence

ANTI. I do:
Thais, I think.

CHÆR. The same.

ANTI. I recollect.

To you, that know me, and my taste so
well?

She set me all on fire.

ANTI. Is she so handsome?

CHÆR. Most exquisite: Oh, had you but
once seen her,

You would pronounce her, I am confident,
The first of womankind.—But to be brief,
I fell in love with her.—By great good luck
There was at home an Eunuch, which my
brother

The first of womankind.—But in a word,

Had bought for Thais, but not yet sent
thither.

—I had a gentle hint from Parmeno,
Which I seiz'd greedily.

ANTI. And what was that?

CHÆR. Peace, and I'll tell you.—To change dresses with him,
And order Parmeno to carry me
Instead of him.

ANTI. How? for an Eunuch, you?

CHÆR. E'en so.

ANTI. What good could you derive from that?

CHÆR. What good!—why, see, and hear, and be with her
I languish'd for, my Antipho!—was that
An idle reason, or a trivial good?
—To Thais I'm deliver'd; she receives me,
And carries me with joy into her house;
Commits the charming girl——

ANTI. To whom?——to you?

CHÆR. To me.

ANTI. In special hands, I must confess.

CHÆR.—Enjoins me to permit no man come near her;

Nor to depart, myself, one instant from her;
But in an inner chamber to remain
Alone with her alone. I nod, and look
Bashfully on the ground.

ANTI. Poor simple soul!

CHÆR. I am bid forth, says she; and carries off
All her maid-servants with her, save some few
Raw novices, who straight prepar'd the bath.
I bade them haste; and while it was preparing,
In a retiring-room the Virgin sat;
Viewing a picture, where the tale was drawn
Of Jove's descending in a golden show'r
To Danaë's bosom.—I beheld it too,
And because he of old the like game play'd,
I felt my mind exult the more within me,
That Jove should change himself into a man,
And steal in secret through a stranger-roof,
With a mere woman to intrigue.—Great Jove,
Who shakes the highest heav'ns with his thunder!
And I, poor mortal man, not do the same!——
I did it, and with all my heart I did it.
—While thoughts, like these, possess'd my soul, they call'd
The girl to bathe. She goes, bathes, then returns:
Which done, the servants put her into bed.
I stand to wait their orders. Up comes one,
“Here, harkye, Dorus! take this fan and mark
You cool her gently thus, while we go bathe.
When we have bath'd, you, if you please, bathe too,”
I, with a sober air, receive the fan.

ANTI. Then would I fain have seen your simple face!
I should have been delighted to behold
How like an ass you look'd, and held the fan.

CHÆR. Scarce had she spoke, when all rush'd out o' doors;
Away they go to bathe; grow full of noise,
As servants use, when masters are abroad.

Meanwhile sleep seiz'd the virgin: I, by stealth,
Peep'd through the fan-sticks thus; then looking round,
And seeing all was safe, made fast the door.

ANTI. What then?

CHÆR. What then, fool!

ANTI. I confess.

CHÆR. D'ye think,
Bless'd with an opportunity like this,
So short, so wish'd for, yet so unexpected,
I'd let it slip? No. Then I'd been, indeed,
The thing I counterfeited.

ANTI. Very true.

But what's become of our club-supper?

CHÆR. Ready.

ANTI. An honest fellow! where? at your own house?

CHÆR. At Freeman Discus's.

ANTI. A great way off.

CHÆR. Then we must make more haste.

ANTI. But change your dress.

CHÆR. Where can I change it? I'm
distress'd. From home
I must play truant, lest I meet my brother.
My father too, perhaps, is come to town.

ANTI. Come then to my house! that's the
nearest place
Where you may shift.

ANTI. Come to my house then! that's the nearest
place

CHÆR. With all my heart! let's go!
And at the same time, I'll consult with you
How to enjoy this dear girl.

ANTI. Be it so.

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.

Enter DORIAS, with a Casket.

DORIAS. Now, as I hope for mercy, I'm
afraid,
From what I've seen, lest yonder
swaggerer
Make some disturbance, or do violence
To Thais. For as soon as Chremes came,
(The youth that's brother to the virgin,) she
Beseech'd of Thraso he might be admitted.
This piqu'd him; yet he durst not well
refuse.
She, fearing Chremes should not be
detain'd,
Till she had time and opportunity
To tell him all she wish'd about his sister,
Urg'd Thraso more and more to ask him in.
The Captain coldly asks him; down he sat;
And Thais enter'd into chat with him.
The Captain, fancying a rival brought
Before his face, resolv'd to vex her too:
"Here, boy," said he, "let Pamphila be
call'd
To entertain us!"—"Pamphila!" cries
Thais;
"She at a banquet?—No it must not
be."——

(Chremes, the youth that's brother to the virgin
She beg'd of Thraso, he might be admitted.)

Thraso insisting on't, a broil ensued:
On which my mistress slyly slipping off
Her jewels, gave them me to bear away;
Which is, I know, a certain sign, she will,
As soon as possible, sneak off herself.
Exit.)

SCENE II.

Enter PHÆDRIA.

PHÆD. Going into the country, I began
(As happens when the mind is ill at ease)
To ponder with myself upon the road,
Tossing from thought to thought, and viewing all
In the worst light. While thus I ruminate,
I pass unconsciously my country-house,
And had got far beyond, ere I perceiv'd it.
I turn'd about, but with a heavy heart;
And soon as to the very spot I came
Where the roads part, I stop. Then paus'd a while:
"Alas! thought I, and must I here remain
Two days? alone: without her?—Well! what then?
That's nothing.—What, is't nothing?—If I've not
The privilege to touch her, shall I not
Behold her neither?—If *one* may not be,
At least the *other* shall.—And certainly
Love, in its last degree, is something still."
—Then I, on purpose, pass'd the house.—But see!
Pythias breaks forth affrighted.—What means this?

SCENE III.

Enter PYTHIAS and DORIAS; PHÆDRIA at a distance.

PYTH. Where shall I find, unhappy that I am,
Where seek this rascal-slave?—this slave, that durst

To do a deed like this?—Undone! undone!

PHÆD. What this may be, I dread.

PYTH. And then the villain,
After he had abused the virgin, tore
The poor girl's clothes, and dragg'd her by the hair.

PHÆD. How's this!

PYTH. Who, were he now within my reach,
How could I fly upon the vagabond,
And tear the villain's eyes out with my nails?

PHÆD. What tumult's this, arisen in my absence?
I'll go and ask her.— (*Going up.*) What's the matter, Pythias?
Why thus disturb'd? and whom is it you seek?

PYTH. Whom do I seek? Away, Sir Phædria!
You and your gifts together!

PHÆD. What's the matter?

PYTH. The matter, Sir! the Eunuch, that you sent us,
Has made fine work here! the young virgin, whom
The Captain gave my mistress, he has ravish'd.

PHÆD. Ravish'd? How say you?

PYTH. Ruin'd, and undone!

PHÆD. You're drunk.

PYTH. Would those who wish me ill were so!

DORI. Ah Pythias! what strange prodigy is this?

PHÆD. You're mad: how could an Eunuch——

PYTH. I don't know
Or who, or what he was.—What he has done,
The thing itself declares.—The virgin weeps,
Nor, when you ask what ails her, dare she tell.
But he, good man, is nowhere to be found:
And I fear too, that when he stole away,
He carried something off.

PHÆD. I can't conceive
Whither the rascal can have flown, unless
He to our house, perhaps, slunk back again.

PYTH. See now, I pray you, if he has.

PHÆD. I will.

(Exit.

DORI. Good lack! so strange a thing I never heard.

PYTH. I've heard, that they lov'd women mightily
But could do nothing; yet I never thought on't:
For if I had, I'd have confin'd him close
In some by-place, nor trusted the girl to him.

SCENE IV.

Re-enter PHÆDRIA, with DORUS the Eunuch, in CHÆREA'S clothes.

PHÆD. Out, rascal, out!—What are you resty, Sirrah?
Out, thou vile bargain!

DOR. Dear Sir! (*Crying.*)

PHÆD. See the wretch!
What a wry mouth he makes!—Come, what's the meaning
Of your returning? and your change of dress?
What answer, Sirrah!—If I had delay'd
A minute longer, Pythias, I had miss'd him,
He was equipp'd so bravely for his flight.

PYTH. What, have you got the rogue?

PHÆD. I warrant you.

PYTH. Well done! well done!

DORI. Aye, marry, very well.

PYTH. Where is he?

PHÆD. Don't you see him?

PYTH. See him? whom?

PHÆD. This fellow, to be sure.

PYTH. This man! who is he?

PHÆD. He that was carried to your house to-day.

PYTH. None of our people ever laid their eyes
Upon this fellow, Phædria!

PHÆD. Never saw him?

PYTH. Why, did you think this fellow had been brought
To us?

PHÆD. Yes, surely; for I had no other.

PYTH. Oh dear! this fellow's not to be compar'd
To t'other.—He was elegant, and handsome.

PHÆD. Aye, so he might appear a while ago,
Because he had gay clothes on: now he seems
Ugly, because he's stripped.

PYTH. Nay, prithee, peace!
As if the diff'rence was so very small!——
The youth conducted to our house to-day,
'Twould do you good to cast your eyes on, Phædria:
This is a drowsy, wither'd, weasel-fac'd,
Old fellow.

PHÆD. How?——you drive me to that pass,
That I scarce know what I have done myself.
—Did not I buy you, rascal? (*To DORUS.*)

DOR. Yes, Sir.

PYTH. Order him
To answer me.

PHÆD. Well, question him.

PYTH. (*to DORUS.*) Was you
Brought here to-day? (*Shakes his head.*) See there! Not he. It was
Another, a young lad, about sixteen,

Whom Parmeno brought with him.

PHÆD. (*to DORUS*). Speak to me!

First tell me, whence had you that coat? What, dumb?

I'll make you speak, you villain? (*Beating him.*)

DOR. Chærea came—— (*Crying.*)

PHÆD. My brother?

DOR. Yes, Sir!

PHÆD. When?

DOR. To-day.

PHÆD. How long since?

DOR. Just now.

PHÆD. With whom?

DOR. With Parmeno.

PHÆD. Did you

Know him before?

DOR. No, Sir; nor e'er heard of him.

PHÆD. How did you know then that he was
my brother?

PHÆD. How did you know he was my brother
then?

DOR. Parmeno told me so; and Chærea
Gave me these clothes——

PHÆD. Confusion! (*Aside.*)

DOR. Put on mine;
And then they both went out o' doors together.

PYTH. Now, Sir, do you believe that I am sober?
Now do you think, I've told no lie? And now
Are you convinc'd the girl has been abus'd!

PHÆD. Away, fool! d'ye believe what this wretch says?

PYTH. What signifies belief?—It speaks itself.

PHÆD. (*apart to DORUS*). Come this way—hark ye!——further still.——
Enough.

Tell me once more.——Did Chærea strip you?

DOR. Yes.

PHÆD. And put your clothes on?

DOR. Yes, Sir!

PHÆD. And was brought
In your stead hither?

DOR. Yes.

PHÆD. Great Jupiter! (*Pretending to be in a passion with him.*)
What a most wicked scoundrel's this?

PYTH. Alas!

Don't you believe, then, we've been vilely us'd?

PHÆD. No wonder if you credit what he says.
I don't know what to do. (*Aside.*)—Here, harkye, Sirrah!
Deny it all again. (*Apart to DORUS.*)—What! can't I beat
The truth out of you, rascal?—have you seen
My brother Chærea? (*Aloud, and beating him.*)

DOR. No, Sir! (*Crying.*)

PHÆD. So! I see
He won't confess without a beating.—This way! (*Apart.*) Now
He owns it; now denies it.—Ask my pardon! (*Apart.*)

DOR. Beseech you, Sir, forgive me!

PHÆD. Get you gone. (*Kicking him.*)
Oh me! oh dear!

(*Exit, howling.*)

PHÆD. (*aside*). I had no other way
To come off handsomely.—We're all undone.
—D'ye think to play your tricks on me, you rascal?

(*Aloud, and Exit after DORUS.*)

SCENE V.

Manent PYTHIAS *and* DORIAS.

PYTH. As sure as I'm alive, this is a trick
Of Parmeno's.

DORI. No doubt on't.

PYTH. I'll devise
Some means to-day to fit him for't.—But now
What would you have me do?

DORI. About the girl!

PYTH. Aye; shall I tell; or keep the matter secret?

DORI. Troth, if you're wise you know not what you know,
Nor of the Eunuch, nor the ravishment:
So shall you clear yourself of all this trouble,
And do a kindness to our mistress too.
Say nothing, but that Dorus is gone off.

PYTH. I'll do so.

DORI. Prithee is not Chremes yonder?
Thais will soon be here.

PYTH. How so?

DORI. Because
When I came thence, a quarrel was abroad
Among them.

PYTH. Carry in the jewels, Dorias.
Meanwhile I'll learn of Chremes what has happen'd.

(*Exit* DORIAS.

SCENE VI.

Enter CHREMES tipsy.

CHREM. So! so!—I'm in for't—and the wine I've drank
Has made me reel again.—Yet while I sat,
How sober I suppos'd myself!—But I
No sooner rose, than neither foot, nor head,
Knew their own business!

PYTH. Chremes!

CHREM. Who's that?—Ha!
Pythias!—How much more handsome you seem now,
Than you appear'd a little while ago!

PYTH. I'm sure you seem a good deal merrier.

CHREM. I'faith it's an old saying, and a true one,
“Ceres and Bacchus are warm friends of Venus.”
—But, pray, has Thais been here long before me?

PYTH. Has she yet left the Captain's?

CHREM. Long time since:
An age ago. They've had a bloody quarrel.

PYTH. Did not she bid you follow her?

CHREM. Not she:
Only she made a sign to me at parting.

PYTH. Well, wasn't that enough?

CHREM. No, faith! I did not
At all conceive her meaning, till the
Captain
Gave me the hint, and kick'd me out o'
doors!
—But here she is! I wonder how it was,
I overtook her!

CHREM. No, faith! I never
At all conceiv'd her meaning, till the Captain

SCENE VII.

Enter THAIS.

THAIS. I am apt to think,
The Captain will soon follow me, to take
The virgin from me: Well then, let him come!
But if he does but lay a finger on her,
We'll tear his eyes out.—His impertinence.
And big words, while mere words, I can endure;
But if he comes to action, woe be to him!

CHREM. Thais, I have been here some time.

THAIS. My Chremes!
The very man I wanted!—Do you know
That you have been th' occasion of this quarrel?
And that this whole affair relates to you?

CHREM. To me! how so?

THAIS. Because, while I endeavor,
And study to restore your sister to you,
This and much more I've suffer'd.

CHREM. Where's my sister?

THAIS. Within, at my house.

CHREM. Ha! (*With concern.*)

THAIS. Be not alarm'd:
She has been well brought up, and in a manner
Worthy herself and you.

CHREM. Indeed?

THAIS. 'Tis true:
And now most freely I restore her to you,
Demanding nothing of you in return.

CHREM. I feel your goodness, Thais, and shall ever
Remain much bounden to you.

THAIS. Aye, but now
Take heed, my Chremes, lest ere you receive
The maid from me, you lose her! for 'tis she,
Whom now the Captain comes to take by storm.

—Pythias, go, fetch the casket with the proofs!

CHREM. D'ye see him, Thais? (*Looking out.*)

PYTH. Where's the casket plac'd?

PYTH. Where does the casket stand?

THAIS. Plac'd in the cabinet.—D'ye loiter, hussy?

THAIS. Upon the cabinet.—D'ye loiter, hussy?

(*Exit* PYTHIAS.)

CHREM. What force the Captain brings with him against you!
Good Heav'n!

THAIS. Are you afraid, young gentleman?

CHREM. Away!—who? I? afraid?—There is no man
Alive less so.

CHREM. Away!—who? I? afraid?—No mortal less.

THAIS. Nay, you had need be stout at present, Chremes.

THAIS. You'd need be stout at present.

CHREM. What kind of man d'ye take me for?

THAIS. Consider,
He, whom you've now to cope with, is a stranger
Less powerful than you, less known, and less
Befriended here than you!

CHREM. I know all that:
But why, like fools, admit what we may shun?
Better prevent a wrong, than afterward
Revenge it, when receiv'd——Do you step in,
And bolt the door, while I run to the Forum,
And call some officers to our assistance. (*Going.*)

THAIS. Stay! (*Holding him.*)

CHREM. 'Twill be better.

THAIS. Hold!

CHREM. Nay, let me go!

I'll soon be back.

THAIS. We do not want them, Chremes.
Say, only, that this maiden is your sister,
And that you lost her when a child, and now
Know her again for yours.

(*Enter* PYTHIAS.)

THAIS (*to* PYTH.) Produce the proofs!

PYTH. Here they are.

THAIS. Take them, Chremes!—If the Captain
Attempts to do you any violence,
Lead him before a magistrate. D'ye mark me?

CHREM. I do.

THAIS. Be sure now speak with a good
courage!

CHREM. I will.

THAIS. Come, gather up your cloak.—
Undone!

I've got a champion, who wants help
himself.

My champion wants a champion for himself.

(*Exeunt.*

SCENE VIII.

Enter THRASO, GNATHO, SANGA, *etc.*

THRASO. Shall I put up with an affront so gross,
So monstrous, Gnatho?—No, I'd rather die.
Simalio, Donax, Syrus, follow me!
First, I will storm their castle.

GNAT. Excellent!

THRA. Next carry off the Virgin.

GNAT. Admirable!

THRA. Then punish Thais herself.

GNAT. Incomparable!

THRA. Here, in the centre, Donax, with your club!
Do you, Simalio, charge on the left wing!
You, Syrus, on the right!—Bring up the rest!
Where's the Centurion Sanga, and his band
Of rascal runaways?

SAN. Here, Sir!

THRA. How now?
Think'st thou to combat with a dish-clout, slave!
That thus thou bring'st it here?

SAN. Ah, Sir! I knew
The valor of the gen'ral and his troops;
And seeing this affair must end in blood,
I brought a clout, to wipe the wounds withal.

THRA. Where are the rest?

SAN. Rest! Plague, whom d'ye mean?
There's nobody, but Sannio, left at home.

THRA. Lead you the van (*to GNATHO*); and I'll bring up the rear:
Thence give the word to all.

GNAT. What wisdom is!
Now he has drawn up these in rank and file,
His post behind secures him a retreat.

THRA. Just so his line of battle Pyrrhus form'd.

(*CHREMES and THAIS appear above at a window.*)

CHREM. D'ye see, my Thais, what he is about?
To bar and bolt the doors was good advice.

THAIS. Tut, man! you fool, that seems so mighty brave,
Is a mere coward. Do not be afraid!

THRA. What were best? (*To GNATHO.*)

GNAT. Troth, I wish you had a sling:
That you from far in ambush might attack them!
They'd soon fly then, I warrant you.

THRA. But see!
Thais appears.

GNAT. Let's charge them then! Come on!

THRA. Halt!—'Tis the part of a wise general
To try all methods, ere he come to arms.
How do you know, but Thais may obey
My orders without force?

GNAT. Oh, gracious Heavens!
Of what advantage is it to be wise!
I ne'er approach but I go wiser from you.

THRA. Thais, first answer this! Did you, or
no,
When I presented you the Virgin, promise,
To give yourself some days to me alone?

THAIS. What then?

THRA. Is that a question, when you durst
To bring a rival to my face?

THAIS. And what
Business have you with him?

THRA. ——And then stole off
In company with him?

THAIS. It was my pleasure.

THRA. Therefore, restore my Pamphila;
unless
You choose to see her carried off by force.

CHREM. She restore Pamphila to you? Or
you

THRA. Is that a question, when you brought
Your lover to affront me to my face?—

THAIS. What business have you with him?

THRA. ——And stole off
In company with him?

THAIS. It was my pleasure.

THRA. Therefore, restore me Pamphila; unless
You choose to see her carried off by force.

Attempt to touch her, rascal?

GNAT. Ah, beware!

Peace, peace, young gentleman!

THRA. (to CHREM.) What is't you mean?

Shall I not touch my own?

CHREM. Your own, you scoundrel?

GNAT. Take heed! you know not whom you rail at thus.

CHREM. Won't you be gone?—here, hark ye, Sir! d'ye know

How matters stand with you?—if you attempt

To raise a riot in this place to-day,

I'll answer for it, that you shall remember

This place, to-day, and me, your whole life-long.

GNAT. I pity you: to make so great a man

Your enemy!

CHREM. Hence! or I'll break your head.

GNAT. How's that, you hang-dog? Are you for that sport?

THRA. Who are you, fellow?—what d'ye mean?—and what

Have you to do with Pamphila?

CHREM. I'll tell you,

First, I declare, that she's a free-born woman!

THRA. How?

CHREM. And a citizen of Athens.

THRA. Hui!

CHREM. My sister.

THRA. Impudence!

CHREM. So, Captain, now

I give you warning, offer her no force!

—Thais, I'll now to Sophrona, the Nurse,

And bring her here with me to see the proofs.

THRA. And you prohibit me to touch my own?

CHREM. Yes, I prohibit you.

GNAT. D'ye hear? he owns
The robbery himself. Isn't that sufficient?

THRA. And, Thais, you maintain the same?

THAIS. Ask those
Who care to answer. (*Shuts down the window.*)

(*Manent THRASO and GNATHO, etc.*)

THRA. What shall we do now?

GNAT. Why—e'en go back again!—This harlot here
Will soon be with you to request forgiveness.

THRA. D'ye think so?

GNAT. Aye, most certainly. I know
The ways of women.—When you will, they won't;
And when you won't, they're dying for you.

THRA. True.

GNAT. Shall I disband the army?

THRA. When you will.

GNAT. Sanga, as well becomes a brave militia,
Take to your houses and firesides again.

SAN. My mind was like a sop i' th' pan, long since.

GNAT. Good fellow!

SAN. To the right about there! march!

(*Exit, with GNATHO and THRASO at the head of the troops.*)

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.

THAIS *and* PYTHIAS.

THAIS. Still, still, you, baggage, will you shuffle with me?
—“I know—I don’t know—he’s gone off—I’ve heard——
I was not present”—Be it what it may,
Can’t you inform me openly?—The Virgin,
Her clothes all torn, in sullen silence weeps.
The Eunuch’s fled.—What means all this? and what
Has happen’d?—Won’t you answer me?

PYTH. Alas!
What can I answer you?—He was, they say,
No Eunuch.

THAIS. What then?

PYTH. Chærea.

THAIS. Chærea!
What Chærea?

PYTH. Phædria’s younger brother.

THAIS. How!
What’s that, hag?

PYTH. I’ve discover’d it: I’m sure on’t.

THAIS. Why, what had he to do with us? or why
Was he brought hither?

PYTH. That I can not tell;
Unless, as I suppose, for love of Pamphila.

THAIS. Alas! I am undone; undone, indeed,
If that, which you have told me now, be true.
Is’t that the girl bemoans thus?

PYTH. I believe so.

THAIS. How, careless wretch! was that the charge I gave you

At my departure?

PYTH. What could I do? She
Was trusted, as you bade, to him alone.

THAIS. Oh, jade, you set the wolf to keep the sheep
—I'm quite asham'd to 've been so poorly bubbled.

PYTH. Who comes here?—Hist! peace, madam, I beseech you!
We're safe: we have the very man.

(*Seeing CHÆREA at a distance.*)

THAIS. Where is he?

PYTH. Here, on the left; d'ye see him, ma'am?

THAIS. I see him.

PYTH. Let him be seiz'd immediately!

THAIS. And what
Can we do to him, fool?

PYTH. Do to him, say you?
—See, what a saucy face the rogue has got!
Ha'nt he?—and then how settled an assurance?

SCENE II.

Enter CHÆREA.

CHÆR. At Antipho's, as if for spite, there
were
His father and his mother both at home,
So that I could by no means enter, but
They must have seen me. Meanwhile, as I
stood
Before the door, came by an old
acquaintance,
At sight of whom I flew, with all my speed,
Into a narrow, unfrequented alley;
And thence into another, and another,

Frighten'd and flurried as I scampered on,
Lest any one should know me.—But is that
Thais? 'Tis she herself. I'm all aground.
What shall I do?—Pshaw! what have I to
care?

What can she do to me?

THAIS. Let's up to him.
Oh, Dorus! good Sir, welcome!—And so,
Sirrah,
You ran away.

CHÆR. Yes, madam!

THAIS. And you think
It was a clever trick?

CHÆR. No, madam!

THAIS. Can you
Believe that you shall go unpunish'd for it?

CHÆR. Forgive me this one fault! If I
commit
Another, kill me!

THAIS. Do you dread my cruelty?

CHÆR. No, ma'am!

THAIS. What then?

CHÆR. I was afraid, lest She
Accuse me to you. (*Pointing to PYTHIAS.*)

THAIS. Upon what account?

CHÆR. A little matter.

PYTH. Rogue! a little matter?
Is it so little, think you, to abuse
A virgin, and a citizen!

CHÆR. I thought
She was my fellow-servant.

Lest any one should know me in this habit.
But is that Thais? She. I'm all aground.

THAIS. And you think
It was a clever trick, I warrant you?

CHÆR. No, madam!

THAIS. Can you believe that you shall go
unpunish'd?

THAIS. Of what crime?

PYTH. Fellow-servant!
I can scarce hold from flying at his hair.
Monstrous! he's come to make his sport of
us.

THAIS. Away! you rave.

PYTH. Why so? if I had done 't,
I should have still been in the monster's
debt;
Particularly, as he owns himself
Your servant.

PYTH. Not I. If I had done 't,

THAIS. Well—no more of this.—Oh,
Chærea,
You've done a deed unworthy of yourself:
For granting I, perhaps, might well deserve
This injury, it was not honorable
In you to do it.—As I live, I know not
What counsel to pursue about this girl;
You've so destroy'd my measures, that I
can't
Restore her, without blushing to her
friends,
Nor so deliver her, as I propos'd,
To make them thank me for my kindness,
Chærea!

CHÆR. Henceforth, I hope, eternal peace
shall be
Betwixt us, Thais! Oft from things like
these,
And bad beginnings, warmest friendships
rise.
What if some God hath order'd this?

THAIS. Indeed,
I'll so interpret it, and wish it so.

CHÆR. I prithee do!—and be assured of
this,
That naught I did in scorn, but all in love.

THAIS. I do believe it; and, on that account,
More readily forgive you: for oh! Chærea,
I am not form'd of an ungentle nature,
Nor am I now to learn the pow'r of love.

CHÆR. Now, Thais, by my life, I love thee
too.

PYTH. Then, by my troth, you must take
care of him.

CHÆR. I durst not——

PYTH. I don't mind a word you say.

THAIS. Have done!

CHÆR. But now, in this one circumstance,
Let me beseech you to assist me! I
Commit myself entirely to your care:
Invoke you, as my patroness; implore you.
Perdition seize me, but I'll marry her!

Let me beseech you to assist me, Thais!
I trust myself entirely to your care:

THAIS. But if your father——

CHÆR. What of him? I know
He'll soon consent, provided it appears
That she's a citizen.

THAIS. If you will wait
A little while, her brother will be here:
He's gone to fetch the nurse that brought
her up;
And you shall witness the discovery.

CHÆR. I will remain then.

THAIS. But, in the mean time,
Had you not rather wait within, than here
Before the door?

CHÆR. Much rather.

PYTH. What the plague
Are you about?

THAIS. What now?

PYTH. What now, indeed?
Will you let him within your doors again?

THAIS. Why not?

PYTH. Remember that I prophesy,
He'll make some fresh disturbance.

THAIS. Prithee, peace!

PYTH. It seems, you have not had sufficient
proof
Of his assurance.

CHÆR. I'll do no harm, Pythias!

PYTH. I'll not believe it, Chærea, till I see
it.

PYTH. I'll not believe it, till I see it, Chærea.

CHÆR. But you shall keep me, Pythias!

PYTH. No, not I.
For, by my troth, I would trust nothing
with you,
Neither to keep, nor be kept by you.—
Hence!
Away!

THAIS. Oh brave! the brother's here!
(*Looking out.*)

CHÆR. Confusion!
Let's in, dear Thais! I'd not have him see
me
Here in this dress.

THAIS. Why so? Are you asham'd?

CHÆR. I am indeed.

PYTH. Indeed! asham'd! oh dear!
Think of the girl!

THAIS. Go in! I'll follow you.
Pythias, do you stay here to bring in
Chremes.

(*Exeunt* THAIS *and* CHÆREA.

SCENE III.

PYTHIAS, CHREMES, SOPHRONA.

PYTH. What can I think of? what can I devise?
Some trick now to be even with that rogue
Who palm'd this young spark on us.

CHREM. (*leading the nurse*). Nay, but stir
Your stumps a little faster, nurse!

SOPH. I come.

CHREM. Aye, marry; but you don't come on a jot.

PYTH. Well! have you shown the tokens to the nurse?

CHREM. I have.

PYTH. And pray what says she? Did she know them?

CHREM. At first sight.

PYTH. Oh brave news! I'm glad to hear it;
For I've a kindness for the girl. Go in;
My mistress is impatient for your coming.

(*Exeunt* CHREMES *and* SOPHRONA.

See, yonder's my good master Parmeno,
Marching this way: How unconcern'd, forsooth,
He stalks along!—But I've devis'd, I hope,
The means to vex him sorely.—First I'll in,
To know the truth of this discovery,
And then return to terrify this rascal.

(Exit.

SCENE IV.

Enter PARMENO.

PAR. I'm come to see what Chærea has been doing:
Who, if he has but manag'd matters well,
Good Heav'ns, how much, and what sincere applause
Shall Parmeno acquire!—For not to mention,
In an intrigue so difficult as this,
Of so much probable expense at least,
Since with a griping harlot he'd have bargain'd,
That I've procur'd for him the girl he lov'd,
Without cost, charge, or trouble; t'other point,
That, that I hold my master-piece, there think
I've gain'd the prize, in showing a young spark
The dispositions and the ways of harlots:
Which having early learn'd, he'll ever shun.

(*Enter* PYTHIAS *behind*.)

When they're abroad, forsooth, there's none so clean,
Nothing so trim, so elegant, as they;
Nor, when they sup with a gallant, so nice!
To see these very creatures' gluttony,
Filth, poverty, and meanness, when at home;
So eager after food, that they devour
From yesterday's stale broth the coarse black bread:—
All this to know is safety to young men.

SCENE V.

PYTHIAS, PARMENO.

PYTH. (*behind*). 'Faith, Sirrah, I'll be handsomely revenged
For all you've done and said. You shall not boast
Your tricks on us without due punishment.

(*Aloud, coming forward.*)

Oh Heav'ns! oh dreadful deed! oh hapless youth!
Oh wicked Parmeno, that brought him here!

PAR. What now?

PYTH. It mov'd me so. I could not bear
To see it: therefore I flew out o' doors.
What an example will they make of him!

PAR. Oh Jupiter! What tumult can this be?
Am I undone, or no?—I'll e'en inquire.
Pythias! (*going up.*) What now? what is't you rave about?
Who's to be made this terrible example?

PYTH. Who? most audacious monster! while you meant
To play your tricks on us, you have destroyed
The youth whom you brought hither for the Eunuch.

PAR. How so? and what has happen'd? Prithee tell me!

PYTH. Tell you? D'ye know the virgin, that was sent
To-day to Thais, is a citizen?
Her brother too a man of the first rank?

PAR. I did not know it.

PYTH. Aye, but so it seems.
The poor young spark abus'd the girl; a thing
No sooner known, than he, the furious brother——

PAR. Did what?

PYTH. First bound him hand and foot——

PAR. How! bound him!

PYTH. And now, though Thais begged him not to do it——

PAR. How! what!

PYTH. Moreover threatens, he will serve
him
After the manner of adulterers;
A thing I ne'er saw done, and ne'er desire.

PAR. How durst he offer at an act so
monstrous?

PYTH. And why so monstrous?

PAR. Is it not most monstrous?
Who ever saw a young man seiz'd and
bound
For rapes and lewdness in a house of
harlots?

PYTH. I don't know.

PAR. Aye; but you must all know this.
I tell you, and foretell you, that young
spark
Is my old master's son.

PYTH. Indeed, is he?

PAR. And let not Thais suffer any one
To do him violence!—But why don't I
Rush in myself?

PYTH. Ah! take care, Parmeno,
What you're about; lest you do him no
good,
And hurt yourself: for they imagine you,
Whatever has been done, the cause of all.

PAR. What shall I do then, wretch? what
undertake?
—Oh! yonder's my old master, just
return'd
To town. Shall I tell him, or no?—I' faith
I'll tell him, though I am well convinc'd it
will
Bring me into a scrape; a heavy one: And
yet
It must be done to help poor Chærea.

PYTH. Right.

Who ever saw a young man seiz'd by force,
And punish'd for adultery in a brothel?

PAR. And let not Thais suffer any one
To do him any violence!—But why
Don't I rush in myself?

PYTH. Ah! have a care
What you're about; lest you do him no good,
And hurt yourself: for they imagine you,
Whatever has been done, the cause of all.

PAR. What shall I do then? what resolve?
Confusion!
—Oh! yonder's my old master, just return'd
To town. Shall I tell *him* of it, or no?
I'll tell him, tho' I am well convinc'd, the blan
Will light on me, and heavily: And yet
It must be done to help poor Chærea.

I'll in again; and you, in the mean while,
Tell the old gentleman the whole affair.

(Exit.

SCENE VI.

Enter LACHES.

LACHES. I've this convenience from my
 neighb'ring villa;
I'm never tir'd of country or of town.
For as disgust comes on, I change my
 place.

—But is not that our Parmeno? 'Tis he
For certain.—Whom d'ye wait for,
 Parmeno,
Before that door?

—But is not that our Parmeno? 'Tis he.
Parmeno, who is it you're waiting for

PAR. Who's that? Oh, Sir! you're welcome:
I'm glad to see you safe return'd to town.

LACHES. Whom do you wait for?

PAR. I'm undone: my tongue
Cleaves to my mouth through fear.

LACHES. Ha! what's the matter?
Why do you tremble so? Is all right?
 Speak!

PAR. First, Sir, I'd have you think, for so it
 is,
Whatever has befall'n has not befall'n
Through any fault of mine.

PAR. First be persuaded, Sir,—for that's the ca
Whatever has befall'n has not befall'n
Through any fault of mine.

LACHES. What is't?

LACHES. What is't?

PAR. That's true.

PAR. That's true.
Your pardon, Sir, I should have told that first.
—Phædria lately bought a certain Eunuch
By way of present to this gentlewoman.

Your pardon, Sir, I should have told that
first.

—Phædria, Sir, bought a certain Eunuch,
as

A present to send her.

LACHES. Her!—Her! whom?

PAR. Thais.

LACHES. Bought? I'm undone! at what
price?

PAR. Twenty Minæ.

LACHES. I'm ruin'd.

PAR. And then Chærea's fall'n in love
With a young music-girl.

LACHES. How! what! in love!
Knows he already what a harlot is?
Has he stol'n into town? More plagues on
plagues.

LACHES. What gentlewoman, sirrah?

PAR. Madam Thais.

Is he in town? misfortune on misfortune!

PAR. Nay, Sir! don't look on me! it was not
done
By my advice.

LACHES. Leave prating of yourself.
As for you, rascal, if I live—But first
Whatever has befallen, tell me, quick!

PAR. Chærea was carried thither for the
Eunuch.

LACHES. He for the Eunuch!

PAR. Yes: since when, within
They've seiz'd and bound him for a
ravisher.

LACHES. Confusion!

PAR. See the impudence of harlots!

LACHES. Is there aught else of evil or
misfortune
You have not told me yet?

PAR. You know the whole.

LACHES. Then why do I delay to rush in on
them?

(*Exit.*

PAR. There is no doubt but I shall smart for
this.

But since I was oblig'd to 't, I rejoice
That I shall make these strumpets suffer
too:

For our old gentleman has long desir'd
Some cause to punish them; and now he
has it.

SCENE VII.

Enter PYTHIAS; *PARMENO at a distance.*

PYTH. Well! I was ne'er more pleas'd in all my life
Than when I saw th' old man come blund'ring in.
I had the jest alone; for I alone
Knew what he was afraid of.

PAR. Hey! what now?

PYTH. I'm now come forth t' encounter Parmeno.
Where is he?

PAR. She seeks me.

PYTH. Oh, there he is.
I'll go up to him.

PAR. Well, fool, what's the matter? (PYTHIAS *laughs.*)
What would you? what d'ye laugh at? Hey! what still?

PYTH. Oh, I shall die: I'm horribly fatigu'd

With laughing at you. (*Laughing heartily.*)

PAR. Why so? pray!

PAR. For what cause?

PYTH. Why so? (*Laughing.*)

PYTH. What cause?

I ne'er saw, ne'er shall see, a greater fool.

Oh, it's impossible to tell what sport

You've made within.—I swear, I always
thought

That you had been a shrewd, sharp,
cunning fellow.

What! to believe directly what I told you!

Or was you prick'd in conscience for the
sin

Or was not you contented with the crime
You urg'd the youth to perpetrate, unless
You afterwards betray'd him to his father?

The young man had committed through
your means,

That you must after tell his father of him?

How d'ye suppose he felt when old gray-
beard

Surpris'd him in that habit?—What! you
find

That you're undone. (*Laughing heartily.*)

PAR. What's this, impertinence?

Was it a lie you told me? D'ye laugh still?

Is't such a jest to make fools of us, hag?

PYTH. Delightful! (*Laughing.*)

PAR. If you don't pay dearly for it!——

PYTH. Perhaps so. (*Laughing.*)

PAR. I'll return it.

PYTH. Oh, no doubt on't. (*Laughing.*)

But what you threaten, Parmeno, is distant:

You'll be truss'd up to-day; who first draw in

A raw young man to sin, and then betray him.

They'll both conspire to make you an example. (*Laughing.*)

PAR. I'm done for.

PYTH. Take this, slave, as a reward
For the fine gift you sent us; so, farewell!

(*Exit* PYTHIAS.

PAR. I've been a fool indeed; and like a rat,
Betray'd myself to-day by my own squeaking.

SCENE VIII.

Enter THRASO, GNATHO; PARMENO *behind*.

GNAT. What now? in what hope, or with
what design
Advance we hither? what adventure,
Thraso?

GNAT. What now? with what hope, or design,
advance we?
What's your intention, Thraso?

THRASO. My intention?
To Thais to surrender at discretion.

THRASO. What do I mean?—To Thais to
surrender
On her own terms?

GNAT. How say you?

GNAT. Indeed?

THRASO. Indeed! why not,
As well as Hercules to Omphale?

THRASO. Even so. Why should not I,
As well as Hercules to Omphale?

GNAT. A fit example.—Would I might
behold

GNAT. A fit example.—Oh, that I could see her
Combing your empty noddle with her slipper!
But her door opens.

Your head broke with her slipper. (*Aside.*) But her doors
Creak, and fly open.

THRASO. 'Sdeath! what mischief now?
I ne'er so much as saw this face before.
Why bursts he forth with such alacrity?

THRASO. Death! what mischief now?

SCENE IX.

Enter CHÆREA *at another part of the stage*.

CHÆR. Lives there, my countrymen, a happier man
To-day than I?—Not one.—For on my head

The gods have plainly emptied all their store,
On whom they've pour'd a flood of bliss at once.

PAR. What's he so pleas'd at?

CHÆR. (*seeing him.*) Oh my Parmeno
Inventor, undertaker, perfecter
Of all my pleasures, know'st thou my good fortunes?
Know'st thou my Pamphila's a citizen?

PAR. I've heard so.

CHÆR. Know'st thou she's betroth'd my wife?

PAR. Oh brave, by Heav'n!

PAR. Good news, by heaven!

GNAT. Hear you what he says? (*To THRASO.*)

CHÆR. Then I rejoice, my brother Phædria's love
Is quietly secur'd to him forever:
We're now one family: and Thais has
Found favor with my father, and resign'd
Herself to us for patronage and care.

PAR. She's then entirely Phædria's!

CHÆR. Aye, entirely.

PAR. Another cause of joy: the Captain routed!

CHÆR. See, Parmeno, my brother (wheresoe'er
He be) know this, as soon as possible!

PAR. I'll see if he's at home.

(*Exit.*)

THRASO. Hast any doubt,
Gnatho, but I'm entirely ruin'd?

GNAT. None at all.

CHÆR. What shall I mention first? whom praise the most!
Him that advis'd this action? or myself
That durst to undertake it?—or extol
Fortune, the governess of all, who deign'd,

Events so many, of such moment too,
So happily to close within one day?
Or shall I praise my father's frank good-humor,
And gay festivity?—Oh, Jupiter,
Make but these blessings sure!

Make but these blessings permanent!

SCENE X.

Enter PHÆDRIA.

PHÆD. O heavenly powers!
What wondrous things has Parmeno just
told me!
But where's my brother?
CHÆR. Here he is.
PHÆD. I'm happy.

PHÆD. Good heavens!
What wondrous things has Parmeno just told r
But where's my brother?

CHÆR. Here.

PHÆD. I'm quite transported.

CHÆR. I dare believe you are; and trust me,
brother,
Naught can be worthier of your love than
Thais:
Our family are all much bounden to her.
PHÆD. So! you'd need sing her praise to
me!

THRASO. Confusion!
As my hope dies, my love increases.
Gnatho
Your help! my expectation's all in you.

As my hope dies, my passion gathers strength.
Gnatho, your help! my only hope's in you.

GNAT. What would you have me do?
THRASO. Accomplish this;
By pray'r, by purchase, that I still may have
Some little share in Thais.
GNAT. A hard task!

THRASO. Do but incline to do't, you can, I know.
Effect it, and demand whatever gift,
Whate'er reward you please, it shall be yours.

GNAT. Indeed?

THRASO. Indeed!

GNAT. If I accomplish this,
I claim, that you agree to throw your doors,
Present or absent, always open to me;
A welcome, uninvited guest forever.

THRASO. I pawn my honor as the pledge.

GNAT. I'll try.

PHÆD. What voice is that? Oh, Thraso!

THRASO. Gentlemen,
Good-day!

PHÆD. Perhaps you're not acquainted yet
With what has happen'd here?

THRASO. I am.

PHÆD. Why then
Do I behold you in these territories?

THRASO. Depending on——

PHÆD. Depend on naught but this!
Captain, I give you warning, if, henceforth,
I ever find you in this street, although
You tell me, "*I was looking for another,*
I was but passing through," expect no quarter.

GNAT. Oh fie! that is not handsome.

PHÆD. I have said it.

GNAT. You can not be so rude.

PHÆD. It shall be so.

GNAT. First grant me a short hearing: if you like

What I propose, agree to't.

PHÆD. Let us hear!

GNAT. Do you retire a moment, Thraso!

(THRASO *retires.*) First,

I must beseech you both, most firmly
think,

That I, whate'er I do in this affair,
For my own sake I do it: but if that
Likewise advantage you, not to agree
In you were folly.

PHÆD. What is't you propose?

GNAT. I think you should admit the
Captain, as
Your rival.

PHÆD. How? admit him?

GNAT. Nay consider!

Phædria, you live at a high rate with her,
Revel, and feast, and stick at no expense.
Yet what you give's but little, and you
know

'Tis needful Thais should receive much
more

Now to supply your love without your cost,
A fitter person, one more form'd, can't be
Than Thraso is: first, he has wherewithal
To give, and gives most largely: a fool too,
A dolt, a block, that snores out night and
day;

Nor can you fear she'll e'er grow fond of
him;

And you may drive him hence whene'er
you please.

PHÆD. What shall we do? (*To CHÆREA.*)

PHÆD. What are your proposals?

GNAT. I think, 'twere not imprudent to admit
The Captain, as your rival.

PHÆD. How!
Admit him, say you?

GNAT. Nay reflect a little.
Phædria, you live at a high rate with Thais,

GNAT. Moreover this; the which
I hold no trifle, no man entertains
More nobly or more freely.

PHÆD. I begin
To think we've need of such a fool.

CHÆR. And I.

GNAT. Well judg'd! and let me beg one
favor more;

Admit me of your family!—I have
Roll'd this stone long enough.

Admit me into your fraternity!
I've roll'd this stone too long.

PHÆD. We do admit you.

CHÆR. With all our hearts.

GNAT. And you, Sirs, in return,
Shall pledge me in the Captain; eat him;
drink him:
And laugh at him.

CHÆR. A bargain!

PHÆD. 'Tis his due.

GNAT. Thraso, whene'er you please,
approach!

GNAT. Thraso, whene'er you please, come
forward!

THRASO. Pray now,
How stands the case?

THRASO. Well!
How stands the case?

GNAT. Alas! they knew you not!
But when I drew your character, and
prais'd
Your worth, according to your deeds and
virtues,
I gain'd my point.

THRASO. 'Tis well: I'm much oblig'd;
I ne'er was any where, in all my life,
But all folks lov'd me dearly.

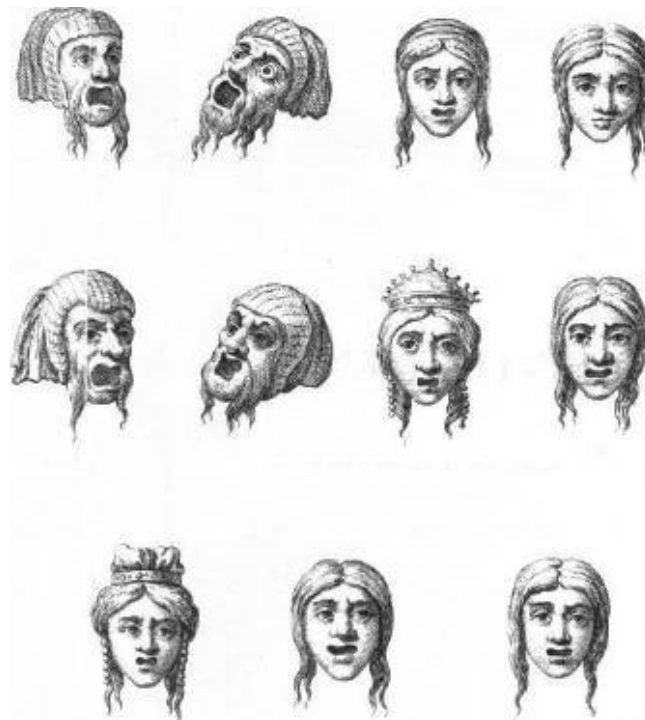
But all folks lov'd me most exceedingly.

GNAT. Did not I
Say he had all the Attic elegance?

GNAT. There, did I not assure you, gentlemen,
That he had all the Attick Elegance?

PHÆD. He is the very character you drew.

GNAT. Retire then.—Ye, (*to the audience,*) farewell, and clap your hands!



THE SELF-TORMENTOR.

PERSONS REPRESENTED.

PROLOGUE.	SOSTRATA.
MENEDEMUS.	ANTIPHILA.
CHREMES.	BACCHIS.
CLINIA.	NURSE.
CLITIPHO.	PHRYGIA, <i>and other servants of</i> BACCHIS.
SYRUS.	
DROMO.	

SCENE, *a Village near* ATHENS.

PROLOGUE.

LEST any of you wonder, why the Bard
To an old actor hath assign'd the part
Sustain'd of old by young performers; that
I'll first explain: then say what brings
To-day, a whole play, wholly from the Greek,
We mean to represent:—The Self-Tormentor:
Wrought from a single to a double plot.

Now therefore that our comedy is new,
And what it is, I've shown: who wrote it too,
And whose in Greek it is, were I not sure
Most of you knew already, would I tell.
But, wherefore I have ta'en this part upon me,
In brief I will deliver: for the Bard
Has sent me here as pleader, not as Prologue;

You he declares his judges, me his counsel:
And yet as counsel nothing can I speak
More than the Author teaches me to say,
Who wrote th' oration which I now recite.

As to reports, which envious men have spread,
That he has ransack'd many Grecian plays,
While he composes some few Latin ones,
That he denies not, he has done; nor does
Repent he did it; means to do it still;
Safe in the warrant and authority
Of greater bards, who did long since the same.
Then for the charge, that his arch-enemy
Maliciously reproaches him withal,
That he but lately hath applied himself
To music, with the genius of his friends,
Rather than natural talents, fraught; how true,
Your judgment, your opinion, must decide.
I would entreat you, therefore, not to lean
To tales of slander, rather than of candor.
Be favorable; nurse with growing hopes
The bards, who give you pleasing novelties;
Pleasing I say, not such as *His* I mean,
Who lately introduc'd a breathless slave,
Making the crowd give way—But wherefore trace
A dunce's faults? which shall be shown at large,
When more he writes, unless he cease to rail.

Attend impartially! and let me once
Without annoyance act an easy part;
Lest your old servant be o'er-labor'd still
With toilsome characters, the running slave,
The eating parasite, enrag'd old man,
The bold-fac'd sharper, covetous procurer;
Parts, that ask pow'rs of voice, and iron sides.
Deign then, for my sake, to accept this plea,
And grant me some remission from my labor.
For they, who now produce new comedies,
Spare not my age! If there is aught laborious,

They run to me; but if of little weight,
Away to others. In our piece to-day
The style is pure: now try my talents then
In either character. If I for gain,
Never o'er-rated my abilities;
If I have held it still my chief reward
To be subservient to your pleasure; fix
In me a fair example, that our youth
May seek to please you, rather than themselves.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.

CHREMES, MENEDEMUS.

CHREM. Though our acquaintance is as yet but young,
Since you have bought this farm that neighbors mine,
And little other commerce is betwixt us;
Yet or your virtue, or good neighborhood,
(Which is in my opinion kin to friendship,)
Urge me to tell you, fairly, openly,
That you appear to me to labor more
Than your age warrants, or affairs require.
Now, in the name of heav'n and earth,
 what is't
You want? what seek you? Threescore
 years of age,
Or older, as I guess; with an estate,
Better than which, more profitable, none

For in the name of heav'n and earth, what would
 you?
What do you drive at? Threescore years of age

In these parts hold; master of many slaves;
As if you had not one at your command,
You labor in their offices yourself.

I ne'er go out so soon at morn, return
So late at eve, but in your grounds I see
you

Dig, plow, or fetch and carry: in a word,
You ne'er remit your toil, nor spare
yourself.

This, I am certain, is not done for pleasure.
—You'll say, perhaps, it vexes you to see
Your work go on so slowly;—do but give
The time you spend in laboring yourself
To set your slaves to work, 'twill profit
more.

MENE. Have you such leisure from your own affairs
To think of those, that don't concern you, Chremes?

CHREM. I am a man, and feel for all mankind.
Think, I advise, or ask for information:
If right, that I may do the same; if wrong,
To turn you from it.

MENE. I have need to do thus.
Do you as you think fit.

CHREM. Need any man
Torment himself?

MENE. I need.

CHREM. If there's a cause,
I'd not oppose it. But what evil's this?
What is th' offense so grievous to your
nature,
That asks such cruel vengeance on
yourself?

MENE. Alas! alas! (*In tears.*)

CHREM. Nay, weep not; but inform me.

I ne'er go out so soon, return so late,
Morning or evening, but I see you still
At labour on your acres, digging, plowing,
Or carrying some burden: in a word,

CHREM. If you're unhappy,
I'm sorry for it. But what evil's this?

Be not reserv'd; fear nothing: prithee, trust me:
By consolation, counsel, or assistance,
I possibly may serve you.

MENE. Would you know it?

CHREM. Aye, for the very reason I have mention'd.

MENE. I will inform you.

CHREM. But meanwhile lay down
Those rakes: don't tire yourself.

MENE. It must not be.

CHREM. What mean you?

MENE. Give me leave: that I may take
No respite from my toil.

CHREM. I'll not allow it. (*Taking away the rakes.*)

MENE. Ah, you do wrong.

CHREM. What, and so heavy too! (*Weighing them in his hand.*)

MENE. Such my desert.

CHREM. Now speak. (*Laying down the rakes.*)

MENE. One only son
I have.—*Have*, did I say?—*Had* I mean, Chremes.
Have I or no, is now uncertain.

CHREM. Wherefore?

MENE. That you shall know. An old Corinthian woman
Now sojourns here, a stranger in these parts,
And very poor. It happen'd, of her daughter
My son became distractedly enamor'd;——
E'en to the brink of marriage; and all this
Unknown to me: which I no sooner learn'd
Than I began to deal severely with him,
Not as a young and love-sick mind requir'd,
But in the rough and usual way of fathers.
Daily I chid him; crying, "How now, Sir!

Think you that you shall hold these courses long,
And I your father living?—Keep a mistress,
As if she were your wife!—You are deceiv'd,
If you think that, and do not know me, Clinia.
While you act worthily, you're mine; if not,
I shall act toward you worthy of myself.
All this arises from mere idleness.
I, at your age, ne'er thought of love; but went
To seek my fortune in the wars in Asia,
And there acquir'd in arms both wealth and glory.”
—In short, things came to such a pass, the youth,
O'ercome with hearing still the self-same thing,
And wearied out with my reproaches; thinking,
Age and experience had enabled me
To judge his interest better than himself,
Went off to serve the king in Asia, Chremes.

CHREM. How say you?

MENE. Stole away three months ago,
Without my knowledge.

CHREM. Both have been to blame:
And yet this enterprise bespeaks a mind,
Modest and manly.

MENE. Having heard of this
From some of his familiars, home I came
Mournful, half-mad, and almost wild with grief.
I sit me down; my servants run to me;
Some draw my sandals off; while others haste
To spread the couches, and prepare the supper:
Each in his way, I mark, does all he can
To mitigate my sorrow. Noting this,
“How,” said I to myself, “so many then
Anxious for me alone? to pleasure me?
So many slaves to dress me? All this cost
For me alone?—Meanwhile, my only son,
For whom all these were fit, as well as me,

Nay rather more, since he is of an age
More proper for their use; him, him, poor boy,
Has my unkindness driven forth to sorrow.
Oh I were worthy of the heaviest curse,
Could I brook that!—No; long as he shall lead
A life of penury abroad, an exile
Through my unjust severity, so long
Will I revenge his wrongs upon myself,
Laboring, scraping, sparing, slaving for him.”
—In short, I did so; in the house I left
Nor clothes, nor movables: I scrap’d up all.
My slaves, both male and female, except those
Who more than earn’d their bread in country-work,
I sold: Then set my house to sale: In all
I got together about fifteen talents;
Purchas’d this farm; and here fatigue myself;
Thinking I do my son less injury,
While I’m in misery too; nor is it just
For me, I think, to taste of pleasure here,
Till he return in safety to partake on’t.

CHREM. You I believe a tender parent, him
A duteous son, if govern’d prudently.
But you was unacquainted with his nature,
And he with yours: sad life, where things are so!
You ne’er betray’d your tenderness to him;
Nor durst he place that confidence in you,
Which well becomes the bosom of a father.
Had that been done, this had not happen’d to you.

MENE. True, I confess; but I was most in fault.

CHREM. All, Menedemus, will, I hope, be well,
And trust, your son will soon return in safety.

MENE. Grant it, good Gods!

CHREM. They will. Now, therefore, since
The Dionysia are held here to-day,
If ’tis convenient, come, and feast with me.

MENE. Impossible.

CHREM. Why so?—Nay, prithee now,
Indulge yourself a while: your absent son,
I'm sure, would have it so.

MENE. It is not meet,
That I, who drove him forth to misery,
Should fly it now myself.

CHREM. You are resolv'd?

MENE. Most constantly.

CHREM. Farewell then!

MENE. Fare you well!

(Exit.

SCENE II.

CHREMES *alone.*

He draws tears from me.—How I pity him!
—But 'tis high time, as the day goes, to
warn
My neighbor Phania to come forth to
supper.
I'll go, and see if he's at home.

(*Goes to PHANIA'S door, and returns.*)

There was,
It seems, no need of warning: for, they tell
me,
He has been gone to my house some time
since;
I keep my guests in waiting; so I'll in.
But my doors creak. (CLITIPHO *appears.*)
Who's this? I'll step aside. (*Retires.*)

There was,
It seems, no need of warning: for, they tell me
He went to his appointment some time since.
'Tis I myself that keep my guests in waiting.
I'll in immediately.—But what's the meaning
That my door opens?—Who's this?—I'll retir

SCENE III.

Enter CLITIPHO, speaking to CLINIA within.

As yet, my Clinia, you've no cause to fear:
They are not long: and she, I'm confident,
Will be here shortly with the messenger.
Prithée, away then with these idle cares,
Which thus torment you!

CHREM. (*behind.*) Whom does my son speak to?

CLIT. My father as I wish'd—Good Sir, well met.

CHREM. What now?

CLIT. D'ye know our neighbor Menedemus?

CHREM. Aye, very well.

CLIT. D'ye know he has a son?

CHREM. I've heard he is in Asia.

CLIT. No such thing.
He's at our house, Sir.

CHREM. How!

CLIT. But just arriv'd:
Ev'n at his landing I fell in with him,
And brought him here to supper: for, from boys,
We have been friends and intimates.

CHREM. Good news:
Now do I wish the more that Menedemus,
Whom I invited, were my guest to-day,
That I, and under my own roof, had been
The first to have surpris'd him with this
joy!

That I, and under my own roof, might be

And I may yet. (*Going.*)

CLIT. Take heed! it were not good.

CHREM. How so?

CLIT. Because the youth is yet in doubt:
Newly arriv'd; in fear of ev'ry thing;
He dreads his father's anger, and suspects
The disposition of his mistress tow'rds him;
Her, whom he dotes upon; on whose account,
This diff'rence and departure came about.

CHREM. I know it.

CLIT. He has just dispatch'd his boy
Into the city to her, and our Syrus
I sent along with him.

CHREM. What says the son?

CLIT. Says? that he's miserable.

CHREM. Miserable!
Who needs be less so? for what earthly good
Can man possess which he may not enjoy?
Parents, a prosp'rous country, friends, birth, riches.
Yet these all take their value from the mind
Of the possessor: he that knows their use,
To him they're blessings; he that knows it not,
To him misuse converts them into curses.

CLIT. Nay, but he ever was a cross old man:
And now there's nothing that I dread so much,
As lest he be transported in his rage
To some gross outrages against his son.

CHREM. He!—He!—But I'll contain myself. 'Tis good
For Menedemus that his son should fear. (*Aside.*)

CLIT. What say you, Sir, within yourself! (*Overhearing.*)

CHREM. I say,
Be't as it might, the son should have remain'd.
Grant that the father bore too strict a hand
Upon his loose desires; he should have borne it.
Whom would he bear withal, if not a parent?

Was't fitting that the father should conform
To the son's humor, or the son to his?
And for the rigor that he murmurs at,
'Tis nothing: the severities of fathers,
Unless perchance a hard one here and there,
Are much the same: they reprimand their sons
For riotous excesses, wenching, drinking;
And starve their pleasures by a scant allowance.
Yet this all tends to good: but when the mind
Is once enslav'd to vicious appetites,
It needs must follow vicious measures too.
Remember then this maxim, Clitipho,
A wise one 'tis to draw from others' faults
A profitable lesson for yourself.

CLIT. I do believe it.

CHREM. Well, I'll in, and see
What is provided for our supper: you,
As the day wears, see that you're not far hence.

(Exit.

SCENE IV.

CLITIPHO *alone.*

What partial judges of all sons are fathers!
Who ask gray wisdom from our greener years,
And think our minds should bear no touch of youth;
Governing by their passions, now kill'd in them,
And not by those that formerly rebell'd.
If ever I've a son, I promise him
He shall find me an easy father; fit
To know, and apt to pardon his offenses!
Not such as mine, who, speaking of another,
Shows how he'd act in such a case himself:
Yet when he takes a cup or two too much,

Oh, what mad pranks he tells me of his own:
But warns me now “to draw from others’ faults
A profitable lesson for myself.”
Cunning old gentleman! he little knows,
He pours his proverbs in a deaf man’s ear.
The words of Bacchis, *Give me, Bring me*, now
Have greater weight with me: to whose commands,
Alas! I’ve nothing to reply withal;
Nor is there man more wretched than myself.
For Clinia here (though he, I must confess,
Has cares enough) has got a mistress, modest,
Well-bred, and stranger to all harlot arts:
Mine is a self-will’d, wanton, haughty madam,
Gay, and extravagant; and let her ask
Whate’er she will, she must not be denied;
Since poverty I durst not make my plea.
This is a plague I have but newly found,
Nor is my father yet appris’d of it.

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.

Enter CLINIA.

CLIN. Had my affairs in love been prosperous,
They had, I know, been here long since: but, ah,
I fear she’s fall’n from virtue in my absence:
So many things concur to prove it so,
My mind misgives me; opportunity,

The place, her age, an infamous old mother,
Under whose governance she lives, to whom
'Naught but gain's precious.

(*To him* CLITIPHO.)

CLIT. Clinia!

CLIN. Woe is me! (*To himself.*)

CLIT. Take heed, lest some one issue from your father's,
And chance to see you here.

CLIN. I will: but yet
My mind forebodes I know not what of ill.

CLIT. What, still foreboding, ere you know the truth?

CLIN. Had there been no untoward circumstance,
They had return'd already

CLIT. Patience, Clinia!
They'll be here presently.

CLIN. Presently! but when?

CLIT. Consider, 'tis a long way off: and then
You know the ways of women; to set off,
And trick their persons out, requires an age.

CLIN. Oh Clitipho, I fear——

CLIT. Take courage; see,
Dromo and Syrus!

SCENE II.

Enter SYRUS and DROMO, conversing at a distance.

SYRUS. Say you?

DROMO. Even so.

SYRUS. But while we chat, the girls are left behind.

CLIT. (*listening*.) Girls, Clinia! do you hear?

CLIN. I hear, I see,
And now, at last, I'm happy, Clitipho.

DROMO (*to SYRUS*). Left behind! troth, no wonder: so encumber'd;
A troop of waiting-women at her heels!

CLIN. (*listening*). Confusion! Whence should she have waiting-women?

CLIT. How can I tell?

SYRUS (*to DROMO*). We ought not to have dropp'd them.
They bring a world of baggage!

CLIN. (*listening*). Death!

SYRUS. Gold, clothes!
It grows late too, and they may miss their
way.

We've been to blame: Dromo, run back,
and meet them.

Away! quick! don't loiter.

Away! quick, quick! don't loiter.

(*Exit DROMO.*

CLIN. What a wretch!
All my fair hopes quite blasted!

CLIT. What's the matter?
What is it troubles you?

CLIN. What troubles me?
D'ye hear? She waiting-women, gold, and clothes!
She, whom I left with one poor servant-girl!
Whence come they, think you?

CLIT. Oh, I take you now.

SYRUS (*to himself*). Gods, what a crowd! our house will hardly hold them.
What eating, and what drinking will there be!
How miserable our old gentleman!
But here are those I wish'd to see!

(*Seeing CLIT. and CLIN.*)

CLIN. Oh Jove!

Where then are truth, and faith, and honor fled?
While I a fugitive, for love of you,
Quit my dear country, you, Antiphila,
For sordid gain desert me in distress!
You, for whose sake I courted infamy,
And cast off my obedience to my father.
He, I remember now with grief and shame,
Oft warn'd me of these women's ways; oft tried
In vain by sage advice to wean me from her.
But now I bid farewell to her forever;
Though, when 'twere good and wholesome, I was froward.
No wretch more curs'd than I!

SYRUS. He has misconstrued
All our discourse, I find—You fancy, Clinia,
Your mistress other than she is. Her life,
As far as we from circumstance could learn,
Her disposition tow'rd you, are the same.

CLIN. How! tell me all: for there is naught on earth
I'd rather know than that my fears are false.

SYRUS. First then, that you may be appris'd of all,
Th' old woman, thought her mother, was not so:
That beldam also is deceas'd; for this
I overheard her, as we came along,
Telling the other.

CLIT. Other! who? what other?

SYRUS. Let me but finish what I have begun,
And I shall come to that.

CLIT. Dispatch then.

SYRUS. First,
Having arriv'd, Dromo knocks at the door:
Which an old woman had no sooner open'd,
But in goes Dromo, and I after him.
Th' old woman bolts the door, and spins again,

And now, or never, Clinia, might be known,
Coming thus unexpectedly upon her,
Antiphila's employments in your absence:
For such, as then we saw, we might presume
Her daily practice, which of all things else,
Betrays the mind and disposition most.
Busily plying of the web we found her,
Decently clad in mourning,—I suppose,
For the deceas'd old woman.—She had on
No gold or trinkets, but was plain and neat,
And dress'd like those who dress but for themselves.
No female varnish to set off her beauty:
Her hair dishevel'd, long, and flowing loose
About her shoulders.—Peace! (*To CLINIA.*)

CLIN. Nay, prithee, Syrus,
Do not transport me thus without a cause.

SYRUS. Th' old woman spun the woof; one servant-girl,
A tatter'd dirty dowdy, weaving by her.

CLIT. Clinia, if this be true, as sure it is,
Who is more fortunate than you? D'ye mark
The ragged dirty girl that he describ'd?
A sign the mistress leads a blameless life,
When she maintains no flaunting go-between:
For 'tis a rule with those gallants, who wish
To win the mistress, first to bribe the maid.

CLIN. Go on, I beg you, Syrus; and take heed
You fill me not with idle joy.—What said she
When you nam'd me?

SYRUS. As soon as we inform'd her
You was return'd, and begg'd her to come to you,
She left her work immediately, and burst
Into a flood of tears, which one might see
Were shed for love of you.

CLIN. By all the Gods,

I know not where I am for very joy.
Oh, how I trembled!

CLIT. Without cause, I knew.
But come; now, Syrus, tell us, who's that other?

SYRUS. Your mistress, Bacchis.

CLIT. How! what! Bacchis? Tell me,
Where d'ye bring her, rogue?

CLIT. How! what! Bacchis?
Where d'ye propose to carry her, rogue?

SYRUS. Where?

SYRUS. Where do I bring her?
To our house certainly.

CLIT. My father's?

SYRUS. Aye.

CLIT. Oh monstrous impudence!

SYRUS. Consider, Sir;
More danger, the more honor.

CLIT. Look ye, Sirrah,
You mean to purchase praise at my expense,
Where the least slip of yours would ruin me.
What is't you drive at?

SYRUS. But——

CLIT. But what?

SYRUS. I'll tell you,
Give me but leave!

CLIN. Permit him.

CLIT. Well, I do.

SYRUS. This business—now—is just as if— (*Drawling.*)

CLIT. Confusion!
What a long roundabout beginning!

CLIN. True.
To the point, Syrus!

SYRUS. I've no patience with you.
You use me ill, Sir, and I can't endure it.

CLIN. Hear him: peace, Clitipho! (*To CLITIPHO.*)

SYRUS. You'd be in love;
Possess your mistress; and have wherewithal
To make her presents: but to gain all this
You'd risk no danger. By my troth, you're wise,
If it be wise to wish for what can't be.
Take good and bad together; both, or none;
Choose which you will; no mistress, or no danger.
And yet, the scheme I've laid is fair and safe;
Your mistress may be with you at your father's
Without detection; by the self-same means
I shall procure the sum you've promis'd her,
Which you have rung so often in my ears,
You've almost deafen'd them.—What would you more?

CLIT. If it may be so——

SYRUS. If! the proof shall show.

CLIT. Well, well then, what's this scheme?

SYRUS. We will pretend
That Bacchis is his mistress.

CLIT. Mighty fine!
What shall become then of his own? Shall she
Pass for his too, because one's not enough
To answer for?

SYRUS. No. She shall to your mother.

CLIT. How so?

SYRUS. 'Twere tedious, Clitipho, to tell:
Let it suffice, I've reason for it.

CLIT. Nonsense!
I see no ground to make me hazard this.

SYRUS. Well; if you dread this, I've another way,

Which you shall both own has no danger in't.

CLIT. Aye, prithee, find that out.

SYRUS. With all my heart.

I'll run and meet the woman on the road,
And order them to go straight home again.

CLIT. How! what!

SYRUS. I mean to ease you of your fear,
That you may sleep in peace on either side. (*Going.*)

CLIT. What shall I do?

CLIN. E'en profit of his scheme.

CLIT. But, Syrus, tell me then——

SYRUS. Away, away!
This day too late you'll wish for her in vain. (*Going.*)

CLIN. This is your time: enjoy it, while you may:
Who knows if you may have the like again?

CLIT. Syrus, I say.

SYRUS. Call as you please, I'll on.

CLIT. Clinia, you're right.—Ho, Syrus! Syrus, ho!
Syrus, I say.

SYRUS. So, he grows hot at last. (*To himself.*)
What would you, Sir? (*Turning about.*)

CLIT. Come back, come back!

SYRUS. I'm here. (*Returns.*)
You're pleasure, Sir!—What, will not this content you?

CLIT. Yes, Syrus; me, my passion, and my fame
I render up to you: dispose of all;
But see you're not to blame.

SYRUS. Ridiculous!
Spare your advice, good Clitipho! you know
Success is my concern still more than yours:

For if perchance we fail in our attempt,
You shall have words; but I, alas! dry blows.
Be sure then of my diligence; and beg
Your friend to join, and countenance our scheme.

CLIN. Depend on me: I see it must be so.

CLIT. Thanks, my best Clinia!

CLIN. But take heed she trip not.

SYRUS. Oh, she's well instructed.

SYRUS. Oh, she is well instructed.

CLIT. Still I wonder
How you prevail'd so easily upon her:
Her, who's so scornful.

SYRUS. I came just in time,
Time, that in most affairs is all in all:
For there I found a certain wretched captain,
Begging her favors. She, an artful baggage,
Denied him, to inflame his mind the more,
And make her court to you.—But hark ye, Sir,
Be cautious of your conduct! no imprudence!
You know how shrewd and keen your father is;
And I know your intemperance too well.
No double-meanings, glances, leers, sighs, hems,
Coughing, or titt'ring, I beseech you, Sir!

CLIT. I'll play my part——

SYRUS. Look to't!

CLIT. To your content.

SYRUS. But see, the women! they're soon after us. (*Looking out.*)

CLIT. Where are they?— (SYRUS *stops him.*) Why d'ye hold me?

SYRUS. She is not
Your mistress now.

CLIT. True: not before my father.
But now, meanwhile——

SYRUS. Nor now, meanwhile,
CLIT. Allow me!
SYRUS. No.
CLIT. But a moment!
SYRUS. No.
CLIT. A single kiss!
SYRUS. Away, if you are wise!
CLIT. Well, well, I'm gone.
—What's he to do?
SYRUS. Stay here.
CLIT. O happy——
SYRUS. March! (*Pushes off CLITIPHO.*)

SCENE III

Enter BACCHIS, and ANTIPHILA at a distance.

BACCH. Well, I commend you, my Antiphila:
Happy, that you have made it still your care,
That virtue should seem fair as beauty in you!
Nor Gracious Heav'n so help me, do I wonder
If ev'ry man should wish you for his own;
For your discourse bespeaks a worthy mind.
And when I ponder with myself, and weigh
Your course of life, and all the rest of those
Who live not on the common, 'tis not strange,
Your morals should be different from ours.
Virtue's your int'rest; those, with whom we deal,
Forbid it to be ours: For our gallants,
Charm'd by our beauty, court us but for that;
Which fading, they transfer their love to others.
If then meanwhile we look not to ourselves,
We live forlorn, deserted, and distress'd.

You, when you've once agreed to pass your life
Bound to one man, whose temper suits with yours,
He too attaches his whole heart to you:
Thus mutual friendship draws you each to each;
Nothing can part you, nothing shake your love.

ANTI. I know not others'; for myself I know,
From his content I ever drew my own.

CLIN. (*overhearing*). Excellent maid! my best Antiphila!
Thou too, thy love alone is now the cause
That brings me to my native land again.
For when away, all evils else were light
Compar'd to wanting thee.

SYRUS. I do believe it.

CLIN. O Syrus, 'tis too much: I can not bear it.
Wretch that I am!—and must I be debarr'd
To give a loose to love, a love like this?

SYRUS. And yet if I may judge your father's mind,
He has more troubles yet in store for you.

BACCH. Who is that youth that eyes us? (*Seeing CLINIA.*)

ANTI. Ha! (*seeing him.*)—Support me!

BACCH. Bless me, what now?

ANTI. I faint.

BACCH. Alas, poor soul!
What is't surprises you, Antiphila?

ANTI. Is't Clinia that I see, or no?

BACCH. Whom do you see?

CLIN. Welcome my soul! (*Running up to her.*)

ANTI. My wish'd-for Clinia, welcome!

CLIN. How fares my love?

ANTI. O'erjoyed at your return.

(*Apart.*)

CLIN. And do I hold thee, my Antiphila,
Thou only wish and comfort of my soul!

SYRUS. In, in, for you have made our good man wait.

(Exeunt.)

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.

CHREM. 'Tis now just daybreak.—Why delay I then
To call my neighbor forth, and be the first
To tell him of his son's return?—The youth,
I understand, would fain not have it so.
But shall I, when I see this poor old man
Afflict himself so grievously, by silence
Rob him of such an unexpected joy,
When the discov'ry can not hurt the son?
No, I'll not do't; but far as in my pow'r
Assist the father. As my son, I see,
Ministers to th' occasions of his friend,
Associated in counsels, rank, and age,
So we old men should serve each other too.

SCENE II.

Enter MENEDEMUS.

MENE. *(to himself)*. Sure I'm by nature form'd for misery
Beyond the rest of humankind, or else

'Tis a false saying, though a common one,
“That time assuages grief.” For ev’ry day
My sorrow for the absence of my son
Grows on my mind: the longer he’s away,
The more impatiently I wish to see him,
The more pine after him.

CHREM. But he’s come forth. (*Seeing MENEDEMUS.*)
Yonder he stands. I’ll go and speak with him.
Good-morrow, neighbor! I have news for you;
Such news as you’ll be overjoy’d to hear.

MENE. Of my son, Chremes?

CHREM. He’s alive and well.

MENE. Where?

CHREM. At my house.

MENE. My son?

CHREM. Your son.

MENE. Come home?

CHREM. Come home.

MENE. My dear boy come? my Clinia?

CHREM. He.

MENE. Away then! prithee, bring me to him.

CHREM. Hold!

He cares not you should know of his return,
And dreads your sight because of his late trespass.
He fears, besides, your old severity
Is now augmented.

MENE. Did not you inform him
The bent of my affections?

CHREM. Not I.

MENE. Wherefore, Chremes?

CHREM. Because 'twould injure both yourself and him
To seem of such a poor and broken spirit.

MENE. I can not help it. Too long, much too long,
I've been a cruel father.

CHREM. Ah, my friend,
You run into extremes; too niggardly,
Or, too profuse; imprudent either way.
First, rather than permit him entertain
A mistress, who was then content with little,
And glad of any thing, you drove him hence:
Whereon the girl was forc'd against her will,
To grow a common gamester for her bread:
And now she can't be kept without much cost,
You'd squander thousands. For to let you know
How admirably madam's train'd to mischief,
How finely form'd to ruin her admirers,
She came to my house yesternight with more
Than half a score of women at her tail,
Laden with clothes and jewels.—If she had
A Prince to her gallant, he could not bear
Such wild extravagance: much less can you.

MENE. Is she within too?

CHREM. She within! Aye, truly.
I've found it to my cost: for I have given
To her and her companions but one supper;
And to give such another would undo me.
For, not to dwell on other circumstances,
Merely to taste, and smack, and spirt about.
What quantities of wine has she consum'd!
This is too rough, she cries; *some softer, pray!*
I have pierc'd every vessel, ev'ry cask;
Kept ev'ry servant running to and fro:
All this ado, and all in one short night!
What, Menedemus, must become of you,
Whom they will prey upon continually?

Now, afore Heaven, thinking upon this,
I pitied you.

MENE. Why let him have his will;
Waste, consume, squander; I'll endure it
all,
So I but have him with me.

So I but keep him with me.

CHREM. If resolv'd
To take that course, I hold it of great
moment
That he perceive not you allow of this.

MENE. What shall I do then?

CHREM. Any thing much rather
Than what you mean to do: at second-hand
Supply him; or permit his slave to trick
you;
Though I perceive they're on that scent
already,
And privately contriving how to do't.
There's Syrus, and that little slave of yours
In an eternal whisper: the young men
Consulting too together: and it were
Better to lose a talent by these means,
Than on your plan a mina: for at present
Money is not the question, but the means
To gratify the youth the safest way.
For if he once perceives your turn of mind,
And that you'd rather hazard life, and
wealth,
Than part from him; ah, Menedemus, what
A window to debauchery you'll open!
Nay, life itself will grow a burden to you;
For too much liberty corrupts us all.
Whatever comes into his head, he'll have;
Nor think if his demand be right or wrong.

That you had rather throw away your life,
And waste your whole estate, than part with him
Ah, what a window to debauchery
You'll open, Menedemus! Such a one,
As will embitter even life itself;

You, on your part, to see your wealth and
son

Both wreck'd, will not be able to endure.

You'll not comply with his demands;

whereon

He falls to his old fence immediately,

And knowing where your weak part lies,

will threaten

To leave you instantly.

MENE. 'Tis very like.

CHREM. Now on my life I have not clos'd my eyes,

Nor had a single wink of sleep this night,

For thinking how I might restore your son.

MENE. Give me your hand: and let me beg you, Chremes,

Continue to assist me!

CHREM. Willingly.

MENE. D'ye know what I would have you do at present?

CHREM. What?

MENE. Since you have found out they meditate

Some practice on me, prithee, urge them on

To execute it quickly: for I long

To grant his wishes, long to see him straight.

CHREM. Let me alone. I must lay hold of Syrus,

And give him some encouragement.—But see!

Some one, I know not who, comes forth: In, in,

Lest they perceive that we consult together!

I have a little business too in hand.

Simus and Crito, our two neighbors here,

Have a dispute about their boundaries;

And they've referr'd it to my arbitration,

I'll go and tell them, 'tis not in my power

To wait on them, as I propos'd to-day.

I will be with you presently.

MENE. Pray do.

(*Exit* CHREMES.

Gods! that the nature of mankind is such,
To see and judge of the affairs of others
Much better than their own! Is't therefore so,
Because that, in our own concerns, we feel
Too much the influence of joy or sorrow? The influence of joy or grief too nearly?
How much more wisely does my neighbor here,
Consult for me, than I do for myself!

CHREM. (*returning.*) I've disengag'd myself! that I might be
At leisure to attend on your affairs.

(*Exit* MENEDEMUS.

SCENE III.

Enter SYRUS at another part of the stage.

SYRUS (*to himself.*) This way, or that way,
or some way or other!
For money must be had, and th' old man
trick'd.

SYRUS One way, or other, money must be had,
And the old gentleman impos'd upon.

CHREM. (*overbearing.*) Was I deceiv'd in
thinking they were at it?
That slave of Clinia's, it should seem, is
dull,
And so our Syrus has the part assign'd
him.

SYRUS. Who's there (*seeing* CHREMES).
Undone if he has overheard me.
(*Aside.*)

CHREM. Syrus.

SYRUS. Sir!

CHREM. What now?

SYRUS. Nothing.—But I wonder
To see you up so early in the morning,
Who drank so freely yesterday.

CHREM. Not much.

SYRUS. Not much? You have, Sir, as the
 proverb goes,
The old age of an eagle.

CHREM. Ah!

SYRUS. A pleasant,
Good sort of girl, this wench of Clinia's.

CHREM. Aye, so she seems.

SYRUS. And handsome.

CHREM. Well enough.

SYRUS. Not like the maids of old, but
 passable,
As girls go now: nor am I much amaz'd
That Clinia dotes upon her. But he has,
Alas, poor lad! a miserable, close,
Dry, covetous, curmudgeon to his father:
Our neighbor here; d'ye know him?—Yet,
 as if
He did not roll in riches, his poor son
Was forc'd to run away for very want.
D'ye know this story?

CHREM. Do I know it? Aye.
A scoundrel! should be horse-whipp'd.

SYRUS. Who?

CHREM. That slave
Of Clinia's——

SYRUS. Troth, I trembled for you, Syrus!
 (Aside.)

CHREM. Who suffer'd this.

SYRUS. Why what should he have done?

CHREM. What?—have devis'd expedients,
contriv'd schemes,

To raise the cash for the young gentleman
To make his mistress presents; and have
done

A kindness to th' old hunks against his will.

SYRUS. You jest.

CHREM. Not I: it was his duty, Syrus.

SYRUS. How's this? why prithee then, d'ye
praise those slaves,
Who trick their masters?

CHREM. Yes upon occasion.

SYRUS. Mighty fine, truly!

CHREM. Why, it oft prevents
A great deal of uneasiness: for instance,
This Clinia, Menedemus' only son,
Would never have elop'd.

SYRUS. I can not tell
Whether he says all this in jest or earnest;
But it gives fresh encouragement to me.
(*Aside.*)

CHREM. And now what is't the blockhead
waits for, Syrus?
Is't till his master runs away again,
When he perceives himself no longer able
To bear with the expenses of his mistress?
Has he no plot upon th' old gentleman?

SYRUS. He's a poor creature.

CHREM. But it is your part,
For Clinia's sake, to lend a helping hand.

CHREM. What?—have devis'd some scheme,
some ways and means

My neighbour Menedemus, well deceiv'd,
Would ne'er have seen his son abandon him.

SYRUS. I don't know whether he's in jest or
earnest,
But it gives me encouragement to trick him.

SYRUS. Why, that indeed I easily can do,
If you command me; for I know which
way.

CHREM. I take you at your word.

SYRUS. I'll make it good.

CHREM. Do so.

SYRUS. But hark ye, Sir! remember this,
If ever it hereafter comes to pass,
—As who can answer for th' affairs of
men!

That your own son——

CHREM. I hope 'twill never be.

SYRUS. I hope so too; nor do I mention this
From any knowledge or suspicion of him:
But that in case—his time of life, you
know;

And should there be occasion, trust me,
Chremes,
But I could handle you most handsomely.

CHREM. Well, well, we'll think of it, when
that time comes.

Now to your present task!

(*Exit* CHREMES.

SCENE IV.

SYRUS *alone*.

I never heard
My master argue more commodiously;
Nor ever had a mind to mischief, when
It might be done with more impunity.
But who's this coming from our house?

Nor ever was inclin'd to mischief, when

SCENE V.

Enter CLITIPHO, and CHREMES following.

CHREM. How now?
What manners are these, Clitipho? does this
Become you?

CLIT. What's the matter?

CHREM. Did not I
This very instant see you put your hand
Into yon wench's bosom?

SYRUS. So! all's over:
I am undone. (*Aside.*)

CLIT. Me, Sir?

CHREM. These very eyes
Beheld you: don't deny it.—'Tis base in you
To be so flippant with your hands. For what
Affront's more gross than to receive a friend
Under your roof, and tamper with his mistress?
And, last night in your cups too, how indecent
And rudely you behav'd!

SYRUS. 'Tis very true.

CHREM. So very troublesome, so help me Heav'n,
I fear'd the consequence. I know the ways
Of lovers: they oft take offense at things
You dream not of.

CLIT. But my companion, Sir,
Is confident I would not wrong him.

CHREM. Granted.
Yet you should cease to hang forever on them.
Withdraw, and leave them sometimes to themselves.
Love has a thousand sallies; you restrain them.

I can conjecture from myself. There's none,
How near soever, Clitipho, to whom
I dare lay open all my weaknesses.
With one my pride forbids it, with another
The very action shames me: and believe me,
It is the same with him; and 'tis our place
To mark on what occasions to indulge him.

SYRUS. What says he now? (*Aside.*)

CLIT. Confusion!

SYRUS. Clitipho,
These are the very precepts that I gave you:
And how discreet and temperate you've been!

CLIT. Prithee, peace!

SYRUS. Aye, I warrant you.

CHREM. Oh, Syrus,
I'm quite asham'd of him.

SYRUS. I do not doubt it.
Nor without reason; for it troubles me.

CLIT. Still, rascal!

SYRUS. Nay, I do but speak the truth.

CLIT. May I not then go near them?

CHREM. Prithee, then,
Is there *one* way alone of going near them?

SYRUS. Confusion! he'll betray himself before
I get the money. (*Aside.*)—Chremes, will you once
Hear a fool's counsel?

CHREM. What do you advise?

SYRUS. Order your son about his business.

CLIT. Whither?

SYRUS. Whither! where'er you please. Give place to them.

Go take a walk.

CLIT. Walk! where?

SYRUS. A pretty question!

This, that, or any way.

CHREM. He says right. Go!

CLIT. Now, plague upon you, Syrus! (*Going.*)

SYRUS (*to CLITIPHO, going*). Henceforth, learn
To keep those hands of yours at rest.

(*Exit CLITIPHO.*)

SCENE VI.

CHREMES, SYRUS.

D'ye mind?

What think you, Chremes, will become of him,
Unless you do your utmost to preserve,
Correct, and counsel him?

CHREM. I'll take due care.

SYRUS. But now's your time, Sir, to look after him.

CHREM. It shall be done.

SYRUS. It must be, if you're wise:
For ev'ry day he minds me less and less.

CHREM. But, Syrus, say, what progress have you made
In that affair I just now mention'd to you?
Have you struck out a scheme that pleases you?
Or are you still to seek?

SYRUS. The plot, you mean,
On Menedemus. I've just hit on one.

CHREM. Good fellow! prithee now, what is't?

SYRUS. I'll tell you.

But as one thing brings in another——

CHREM. Well?

SYRUS. This Bacchis is a sad jade.

CHREM. So it seems.

SYRUS. Aye, Sir, if you knew all; nay, even now
She's hatching mischief.—Dwelling hereabouts,
There was of late an old Corinthian woman,
To whom this Bacchis lent a thousand pieces.

CHREM. What then?

SYRUS. The woman's dead; and left behind
A daughter, very young, whom she bequeath'd,
By way of pledge, to Bacchis for the money.

CHREM. I understand.

SYRUS. This girl came here with Bacchis,
And now is with your wife.

CHREM. What then?

SYRUS. She begs
Of Clinia to advance the cash; for which
She'll give the girl as an equivalent.
She wants the thousand pieces.

CHREM. Does she so?

SYRUS. No doubt on't.

CHREM. So I thought.—And what do you
Intend to do?

SYRUS. Who? I, Sir? I'll away
To Menedemus presently; and tell him
This maiden is a rich and noble captive,
Stolen from Caria; and to ransom her
Will greatly profit him.

CHREM. 'Twill never do.

SYRUS. How so?

CHREM. I answer now for Menedemus.
I will not purchase her. What say you now?

SYRUS. Give a more favorable answer!

CHREM. No,
There's no occasion.

SYRUS. No occasion?

CHREM. No.

SYRUS. I can not comprehend you.

CHREM. I'll explain.
—But hold! what now? whence comes it that our door
Opens so hastily?

SCENE VII.

Enter at a distance SOSTRATA *with a ring, and the* NURSE.

SOSTRA. Or I'm deceiv'd,
Or this is certainly the very ring;
The ring with which my daughter was expos'd.

CHREM. (*to SYRUS, behind*). What can those words mean, Syrus?

SOSTRA. Tell me, Nurse!
Does it appear to you to be the same?

NURSE. Aye, marry: and the very moment that
You show'd it me, I said it was the same.

SOSTRA. But have you thoroughly examin'd, Nurse?

NURSE. Aye, thoroughly.

SOSTRA. In then, and let me know
If she has yet done bathing; and meanwhile
I'll wait my husband here.

(*Exit* NURSE.

SYRUS. She wants you, Sir! inquire
What she would have. She's grave, I know
not why.

'Tis not for nothing; and I fear the cause.

CHREM. The cause? pshaw! nothing. She'll
take mighty pains
To be deliver'd of some mighty trifle.

SOSTRA. (*seeing them*). Oh husband!

CHREM. Oh wife!

SOSTRA. I was looking for you,

CHREM. Your pleasure?

SOSTRA. First, I must entreat you then,
Believe, I would not dare do any thing
Against your order.

CHREM. What! must I believe
A thing past all belief?—I do believe it.

SYRUS. This exculpation bodes some fault, I'm sure. (*Aside.*)

SOSTRA. Do you remember, I was pregnant once,
When you assur'd me with much earnestness,
That if I were deliver'd of a girl,
You would not have the child brought up?

CHREM. I know
What you have done. You have brought up the child.

SYRUS. Madam, if so, my master gains a loss.

SOSTRA. No, I have not: but there was at that time
An old Corinthian woman dwelling here,
To whom I gave the child to be expos'd.

CHREM. O Jupiter! was ever such a fool!

SOSTRA. Ah, what have I committed?

CHREM. What committed!

SYRUS. She wants you, Sir!
Enquire, what she would have. She's very grave

SOSTRA. If I've offended, Chremes, 'tis a crime
Of ignorance, and nothing of my purpose.

CHREM. Own it or not, I know it well enough,
That ignorantly, and imprudently,
You do and say all things; how many faults
In this one action are you guilty of!
For first, had you complied with my commands,
The girl had been dispatch'd; and not her death
Pretended, and hopes given of her life.
But that I do not dwell upon: You'll cry,
"—Pity,—a mother's fondness."—I allow it.
But then how rarely you provided for her!
What could you mean? consider!—for 'tis plain,
You have betray'd your child to that old beldam,
Either for prostitution, or for sale.
So she but liv'd, it was enough, you thought:
No matter how, or what vile life she led.
—What can one do, or how proceed, with those,
Who know of neither reason, right, nor justice?
Better or worse, for or against, they see
Nothing but what they list.

SOSTRA. My dearest Chremes,
I own I have offended: I'm convinc'd.
But since you're more experienc'd than myself,
I pray you be the more indulgent too,
And let my weakness shelter in your justice.

CHREM. Well, well, I pardon you: but, Sostrata,
Forgiving you thus easily, I do
But teach you to offend again. But come,
Say, wherefore you began this?

SOSTRA. As we women
Are generally weak and superstitious,
When first to this Corinthian old woman
I gave the little infant, from my finger
I drew a ring, and charg'd her to expose

That with my daughter: that if chance she died,
She might have part of our possessions with her.

CHREM. 'Twas right: you thus preserv'd yourself and her.

SOSTRA. This is that ring.

CHREM. Where had it you?

SOSTRA. The girl
That Bacchis brought with her——

SYRUS. Ha! (*Aside.*)

CHREM. What says she?

SOSTRA. Desir'd I'd keep it while she went to bathe.
I took no notice on't, at first; but I
No sooner look'd on't than I knew't again,
And straight ran out to you.

CHREM. And what d'ye think,
Or know concerning her?

SOSTRA. I can not tell,
Till you inquire it of herself, and find,
If possible, from whence she had the ring.

SYRUS. Undone! I see more hope than I desire.
She's ours, if this be so. (*Aside.*)

CHREM. Is she alive
To whom you gave the child?

SOSTRA. I do not know.

CHREM. What did she tell you formerly?

SOSTRA. That she
Had done what I commanded her.

CHREM. Her name;
That we may make inquiry.

SOSTRA. Philtere.

SYRUS. The very same! she's found, and I am lost.

(*Aside.*)

CHREM. In with me, Sostrata!

SOSTRA. Beyond my hopes.
How much I fear'd you should continue still
So rigidly inclin'd, as formerly,
When you refus'd to educate her, Chremes!

CHREM. Men can not always be as they desire,
But must be govern'd by their fortunes still.
The times are alter'd with me, and I wish
To have a daughter now; then, nothing less.

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.

SYRUS, *alone.*

My mind misgives me, my defeat is nigh,
This unexpected incident has driven
My forces into such a narrow pass,
I can not even handsomely retreat
Without some feint, to hinder our old man
From seeing that this wench is Clitipho's.
As for the money, and the trick I dream'd of,
Those hopes are flown, and I shall hold it triumph,
So I but 'scape a scouring—Cursed fortune,
To have so delicate a morsel snatch'd
Out of my very jaws!—What shall I do?
What new device? for I must change my plan.

—Nothing so difficult, but may be won
By industry.—Suppose, I try it thus. (*Thinking.*)
—’Twill never do.—Or thus?—No better still.
But thus I think.—No, no.—Yes, excellent!
Courage! I have it.—Good!—Good!—best of all!——
—’Faith, I begin to hope to lay fast hold
Of that same slipp’ry money after all.

SCENE II.

Enter CLINIA at another part of the stage.

CLIN. Henceforward, fate, do with me what thou wilt!
Such is my joy, so full and absolute,
I can not know vexation. From this hour
To you, my father, I resign myself,
Content to be more frugal than you wish!

SYRUS (*overhearing*). ’Tis just as I suppos’d. The girl’s acknowledged;
His raptures speak it so.— (*Going up.*) I’m overjoyed
That things have happen’d to your wish.

CLIN. O Syrus!
Have you then heard it too?

SYRUS. I heard it? Aye:
I, who was present at the very time!

SYRUS. Undoubtedly.

CLIN. Was ever any thing so lucky?

SYRUS. Nothing.

CLIN. Now, Heav’n so help me, I rejoice at this
On her account much rather than my own,
Her, whom I know worthy the highest honors.

SYRUS. No doubt on’t.—But now, Clinia, hold a while!
Give me a moment’s hearing in my turn.
For your friend’s business must be thought of now,
And well secur’d, lest our old gentleman
Suspect about the wench.

CLIN. O Jupiter! (*In raptures.*)

SYRUS. Peace! (*Impatiently.*)

CLIN. My Antiphila shall be my wife.

SYRUS. And will you interrupt me?

CLIN. Oh, my Syrus,
What can I do! I'm overjoy'd. Bear with me.

SYRUS. Troth so I do.

CLIN. We're happy, as the Gods.

SYRUS. I lose my labor on you.

CLIN. Speak; I hear.

SYRUS. Aye, but you don't attend.

CLIN. I'm all attention.

SYRUS. I say then, Clinia, that your friend's affairs
Must be attended to, and well secur'd:
For if you now depart abruptly from us,
And leave the wench upon our hands, my master
Will instantly discover she belongs
To Clitipho. But if you take her off,
It will remain, as still it is, a secret.

CLIN. But, Syrus, this is flatly opposite
To what I most devoutly wish, my marriage,
For with what face shall I accost my father?
D'ye understand me?

SYRUS. Aye.

CLIN. What can I say?
What reason can I give him?

SYRUS. Tell no lie.
Speak the plain truth.

CLIN. How?

SYRUS. Every syllable.

Tell him your passion for Antiphila;
Tell him you wish to marry her, and tell him,
Bacchis belongs to Clitipho.

CLIN. 'Tis well,
In reason, and may easily be done:
And then besides you'd have me win my father,
To keep it hid from your old gentleman.

SYRUS. No; rather to prevail on him, to go
And tell him the whole truth immediately.

CLIN. How? are you mad? or drunk? You'll be the ruin
Of Clitipho: for how can he be safe?
Eh, Sirrah!

SYRUS. That's my master-piece: this plot
Is my chief glory, and I'm proud to think
I have such force, such power of cunning in me,
As to be able to deceive them both,
By speaking the plain truth: that when your father
Tells Chremes, Bacchis is his own son's mistress,
He sha'n't believe it.

CLIN. But that way again
You blast my hopes of marriage: for while Chremes
Supposes her my mistress, he'll not grant
His daughter to me. You, perhaps, don't care,
So you provide for him, what comes of me.

SYRUS. Why, plague! d'ye think I'd have you counterfeit
Forever? but a day, to give me time
To bubble Chremes of the money.—Peace!
Not an hour more.

CLIN. Is that sufficient for you?
But then, suppose his father find it out!

SYRUS. Suppose, as some folks say, the sky should fall!

CLIN. Still I'm afraid.

SYRUS. Afraid indeed, as if

It was not in your pow'r, whene'er you pleas'd,
To clear yourself, and tell the whole affair.

CLIN. Well, well, let Bacchis be brought over then!

SYRUS. Well said; and here she comes.

SCENE III.

Enter BACCHIS, PHRYGIA, etc., at another part of the stage.

BACCH. Upon my life,
This Syrus with his golden promises
Has fool'd me hither charmingly! Ten minæ
He gave me full assurance of: but if
He now deceives me, come whene'er he will,
Canting and fawning to allure me hither,
It shall be all in vain; I will not stir.
Or when I have agreed, and fix'd a time,
Of which he shall have giv'n his master notice,
And Clitipho is all agog with hope,
I'll fairly jilt them both, and not come near them;
And master Syrus' back shall smart for it.

CLIN. She promises you very fair.

SYRUS. D'ye think
She jests? She'll do it, if I don't take heed.

BACCH. They sleep: i' faith, I'll rouse them.

Hark ye, Phrygia,
Didst note the villa of Charinus, which
That fellow just now show'd us? (*Aloud.*)

PHRY. I did, Madam.

BACCH. The next house on the right hand.
(*Aloud.*)

PHRY. I remember.

Did you observe the villa of Charinus,
Which yonder fellow shew'd us?

PHRY. I did, Madam.

BACCH. The next upon the right.

PHRY. I recollect.

BACCH. Run thither quickly: for the Captain
spends
The Dionysia there. (*Aloud.*)

SYRUS (*behind*). What means she now?

BACCH. Tell him I'm here; and sore against
my will,
Detain'd by force; but that I'll find some
means

Detain'd by force; but I'll devise some means

To slip away and come to him. (*Aloud.*)

SYRUS. Confusion!— (*Comes forward.*)
Stay, Bacchis, Bacchis! where d'ye send
that girl?

Bid her stop!

BACCH. Go! (*To PHRYGIA.*)

SYRUS. The money's ready.

SYRUS. The money's ready for you.

BACCH. Then
I stay. (*PHRYGIA returns.*)

BACCH. Oh! then I stay.

SYRUS. You shall be paid directly.

SYRUS. This instant you shall have it,
Bacchis.

BACCH. When you please; I don't press
you.

SYRUS. But d'ye know
What you're to do?

BACCH. Why, what?

SYRUS. You must go over,
You and your equipage, to Menedemus.

BACCH. What are you at now, sauce-box?

SYRUS. Coining money
For your use, Bacchis.

BACCH. Do you think to play
Your jests on me?

SYRUS. No; this is downright earnest.

BACCH. Are you the person I'm to deal
with?

SYRUS. No.

But there I'll pay the money.

But 'twill secure your money.

BACCH. Let us go then!

SYRUS. Follow her there.—Ho, Dromo!

SCENE IV.

Enter DROMO.

DROMO. Who calls?

SYRUS. Syrus.

DROMO. Your pleasure! What's the matter now?

SYRUS. Conduct

All Bacchis' maids to your house instantly.

DROMO. Why so?

SYRUS. No questions: let them carry over
All they brought hither. Our old gentleman
Will think himself reliev'd from much expense
By their departure. Troth, he little knows
With how much loss this small gain threatens him.
If you're wise, Dromo, know not what you know.

DROMO. I'm dumb.

(*Exit DROMO, with BACCHIS' servants and baggage, into the house of*
MENEDEMUS.

SCENE V.

After which, enter CHREMES.

CHREM. (*to himself*). 'Fore Heav'n, I pity Menedemus.
His case is lamentable: to maintain
That jade and all her harlot family!
Although I know for some few days to come
He will not feel it; so exceedingly
He long'd to have his son: but when he sees
Such monstrous household riot and expense
Continue daily, without end or measure,
He'll wish his son away from him again.
But yonder's Syrus in good time. (*Seeing SYRUS.*)

SYRUS. I'll to him. (*Aside.*)

CHREM. Syrus!

SYRUS. Who's there? (*Turning about.*)

CHREM. What now?

SYRUS. The very man!
I have been wishing for you this long time.

CHREM. You seem to've been at work with
the old man.

CHREM. You seem to've been at work with
Menedemus.

SYRUS. What! at our plot? No sooner said
than done.

CHREM. Indeed!

SYRUS. Indeed.

CHREM. I can't forbear to stroke
Your head for it. Good lad! come nearer,
Syrus!
I'll do thee some good turn for this. I will,
I promise you. (*Patting his head.*)

SYRUS. Ah, if you did but know
How luckily it came into my head!

CHREM. Pshaw, are you vain of your good
luck?

SYRUS. Not I.
I speak the plain truth.

CHREM. Let me know it then.

SYRUS. Clinia has told his father that the
wench

Is mistress to your Clitipho; and that
He brought her with him hither, to prevent
Your smoking it.

He brought her over with him to their house,
To hinder your detecting it.

CHREM. Incomparable!

CHREM. Good! good!

SYRUS. Really?

SYRUS. D'ye think so?

CHREM. O, admirable!

CHREM. Charming!

SYRUS. Aye, if you knew all.
But only hear the rest of our advice.
He'll tell his father he has seen your
daughter,
Whose beauty has so charm'd him at first
sight,
He longs to marry her.

But only hear the rest of our device.

CHREM. Antiphila?

SYRUS. The same: and he'll request him to demand her
Of you in marriage.

CHREM. To what purpose, Syrus?
I don't conceive the drift on't.

SYRUS. No! you're slow.

CHREM. Perhaps so.

SYRUS. Menedemus instantly
Will furnish him with money for the wedding,
To buy——d'ye take me?

CHREM. Clothes and jewels.

SYRUS. Aye.

CHREM. But I will neither marry, nor betroth

My daughter to him.

SYRUS. No? Why?

CHREM. Why!—is that
A question? to a wretch!——

SYRUS. Well, as you please.
I never meant that he should marry her,
But only to pretend——

CHREM. I hate pretense.
Plot as you please, but do not render me
An engine in your rogueries. Shall I
Contract my daughter, where I never can
Consent to marry her?

SYRUS. I fancied so.

CHREM. Not I.

SYRUS. It might be done most dextrously:
And, in obedience to your strict commands,
I undertook this business.

CHREM. I believe it.

SYRUS. However, Sir, I meant it well.

CHREM. Nay, nay,
Do't by all means, and spare no trouble in't;
But bring your scheme to bear some other way.

SYRUS. It shall be done: I'll think upon
some other.
—But then the money which I mention'd
to you,
Owing to Bacchis by Antiphila,
Must be repaid her: and you will not now
Attempt to shift the matter off; or say,
“—What is't to me? was I the borrower?
Did I command it? Could she pledge my
daughter

Against my will?”—These pleas you cannot u

Against my will?"——You can say none of
this;

For 'tis a common saying, and a true,
That strictest law is oft the highest wrong.

CHREM. I mean not to evade it.

SYRUS. No, I'll warrant.

Nay you, though others did, could never
think on't;

For all the world imagines you've acquir'd
A fair and handsome fortune.

CHREM. I will carry
The money to her instantly myself.

SYRUS. No; rather send it by your son.

CHREM. Why so!

SYRUS. Because he acts the part of her gallant.

CHREM. What then?

SYRUS. Why then 'twill seem more probable,
If he presents it: I too shall effect
My scheme more easily.—And here he is.—
In, Sir, and fetch the money out.

CHREM. I will.

(*Exit* CHREMES.

SCENE VI.

Enter CLITIPHO.

CLIT. (*to himself*). Nothing so easy in itself, but when
Perform'd against one's will, grows difficult.
This little walk how easy! yet how faint
And weary it has made me!—and I fear
Lest I be still excluded, and forbid
To come near Bacchis. (*Seeing* SYRUS.)—Now all powers above.

Confound you, Syrus, for the trick you play'd me!
That brain of yours is evermore contriving
Some villainy to torture me withal.

SYRUS. Away, you malapert! Your
frowardness
Had well-nigh ruin'd me.

CLIT. I would it had,
As you deserv'd!

SYRUS. As I deserv'd!—How's that?—
Before you touch'd the cash, that I was just
About to give you.

CLIT. Why, what can I say?
You went away; came back, beyond my
hopes,
And brought my mistress with you; then
again
Forbade my touching her.

SYRUS. Well, well, I can't
Be peevish with you now—But do you know
Where Bacchis is?

CLIT. At our house.

SYRUS. No.

CLIT. Where then?

SYRUS. At Clinia's.

CLIT. Then I'm ruin'd.

SYRUS. Courage, man!
You shall go to her instantly, and carry
The money that you promis'd her.

CLIT. Fine talk!
Where should I get it?

SYRUS. From your father.

SYRUS. Away, you malapert! Your frowardness
Had well-nigh been my ruin.

CLIT. Would it had!
For you deserv'd it richly.

SYRUS. How! deserv'd it?
I'faith I'm glad I heard you say so much
Before you touch'd the cash, that I was just
About to give you.

CLIT. Pshaw!

You play upon me.

SYRUS. The event shall show.

CLIT. Then I am bless'd indeed. Thanks, thanks, dear Syrus!

SYRUS. Hist! here's your father.—Have a care! don't seem
Surpris'd at any thing: give way in all:
Do as he bids, and say but little. Mum!

SCENE VII.

Enter CHREMES.

CHREM. Where's Clitipho?

SYRUS (*to CLITIPHO*). Here, say.

CLIT. Here, Sir!

CHREM. Have you
Inform'd him of the business? (*To SYRUS.*)

SYRUS. In good part.

CHREM. Here, take the money then, and carry it. (*To CLITIPHO.*)

SYRUS. Plague, how you stand, log!—take it.

CLIT. Give it me. (*Awkwardly.*)

SYRUS. Now in with me immediately!—You, Sir, (*To CHREMES.*)
Be pleas'd meanwhile to wait our coming here;
There's nothing to detain us very long.

(*Exit CLITIPHO and SYRUS.*)

SCENE VIII.

CHREMES alone.

My daughter now has had ten minæ of me,

Which I account laid out upon her board:
Ten more her clothes will come to: and moreover
Two talents for her portion.—How unjust
And absolute is custom! I must now
Leave every thing, and find a stranger out,
On whom I may bestow the sum of wealth
Which I have so much labor'd to acquire.

SCENE IX.

Enter MENEDEMUS.

MENE. (*to himself*). Oh son, how happy hast thou made thy father,
Convinc'd of thy repentance!

CHREM. (*overhearing*). How mistaken!

MENE. Chremes! I wish'd for you.—'Tis in your power,
And I beseech you do it, to preserve
My son, myself, and family.

CHREM. I'll do't.
Wherein can I oblige you?

MENE. You to-day
Have found a daughter.

CHREM. True. What then?

MENE. My Clinia
Begs your consent to marry her.

CHREM. Good Heaven!
What kind of man are you?

MENE. What mean you, Chremes?

CHREM. Has it then slipp'd your memory so soon,
The conversation that we had together,
Touching the rogueries they should devise,
To trick you of your money?

MENE. I remember.

CHREM. This is the trick.

MENE. How, Chremes? I'm deceiv'd.
'Tis as you say. From what a pleasing hope
Have I then fall'n!

CHREM. And she, I warrant you,
Now at your house, is my son's mistress? Eh!

MENE. So they say.

CHREM. What! and you believ'd it?

MENE. All.

CHREM. —And they say too he wants to marry her;
That soon as I've consented, you may give him
Money to furnish her with jewels, clothes,
And other necessities.

MENE. Aye, 'tis so:
The money's for his mistress.

CHREM. To be sure.

MENE. Alas, my transports are all groundless then.
—Yet I would rather bear with any thing,
Than lose my son again.—What answer, Chremes,
Shall I return with, that he mayn't perceive
I've found him out, and take offense?

CHREM. Offense!
You're too indulgent to him, Menedemus!

MENE. Allow me. I've begun, and must go
through.
Do but continue to assist me.

CHREM. Say,
That we have met, and treated of the
match.

MENE. Well; and what else?

CHREM. That I give full consent;

MENE. Allow me. I've begun, and must go
through.
Do but continue to assist me, Chremes.

CHREM. Say we have met, and treated of the
match.

That I approve my son-in-law;—In short,
You may assure him also, if you please,
That I've betroth'd my daughter to him.

MENE. Good!
The thing I wanted.

CHREM. So shall he the sooner
Demand the money; you, as you desire,
The sooner give.

MENE. 'Tis my desire indeed.

CHREM. 'Troth, friend, as far as I can judge
of this,
You'll soon be weary of your son again.
But as the case now stands, give
cautiously,
A little at a time, if you are wise.

MENE. I will.

CHREM. Go in, and see what he demands.
If you should want me, I'm at home.

MENE. 'Tis well.
For I shall let you know, do what I will.

(*Exeunt severally.*

The very thing I wanted.

CHREM. So your son
The sooner shall demand the money of you;
And so shall you, according to your wish
The sooner give.

MENE. It is my wish indeed.

CHREM. 'Fore heaven, friend, as far as I can
judge,
You'll soon be weary of your son again.
But be it as it may, give cautiously,
A little at a time, if you are wise.

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.

MENEDEMUS *alone.*

That I'm not otherwise, no conjurer,
I know full well: but my assistant here,
And counselor, and grand controller Chremes,
Outgoes me far: dolt, blockhead, ninny, ass;
Or these, or any other common terms
By which men speak of fools, befit me well:
But him they suit not: his stupidity
Is so transcendent, it exceeds them all.

SCENE II.

Enter CHREMES.

CHREM. (*to SOSTRATA, within*). Nay prithee, good wife, cease to stun the Gods
With thanking them that you have found your daughter;
Unless you fancy they are like yourself,
And think they can not understand a thing
Unless said o'er and o'er a hundred times.
—But meanwhile (*coming forward*) wherefore do my son and Syrus
Loiter so long?

MENE. Who are those loiterers, Chremes?

CHREM. Ha, Menedemus, are you there?—Inform me,
Have you told Clinia what I said?

MENE. The whole.

CHREM. And what said he?

MENE. Grew quite transported at it,
Like those who wish for marriage.

CHREM. Ha! ha! ha!

MENE. What do you laugh at?

CHREM. I was thinking of
The cunning rogueries of that slave, Syrus. (*Laughing.*)

MENE. Oh, was that it?

CHREM. Why, he can form and mould

The very visages of men, a rogue! (*Laughing.*)

MENE. Meaning my son's well-acted
transport?

CHREM. Aye. (*Laughing.*)

MENE. The very same thing I was thinking
of.

MENE. The very thing that I was thinking of.

CHREM. A subtle villain! (*Laughing.*)

MENE. Nay, if you knew more,
You'd be still more convinc'd on't.

CHREM. Say you so?

MENE. Aye; do but hear.

CHREM. (*laughing*). Hold! hold! inform me
first

How much you're out of pocket. For as
soon

As you inform'd your son of my consent,
Dromo, I warrant, gave you a broad hint
That the bride wanted jewels, clothes,
attendants;

That you might pay the money.

MENE. No.

CHREM. How? No?

MENE. No, I say.

CHREM. What! nor Clinia?

MENE. Not a word;
But only press'd the marriage for to-day.

CHREM. Amazing!—But our Syrus? Did not he
Throw in a word or two?

MENE. Not he.

CHREM. How so?

MENE. Faith I can't tell: but I'm amaz'd that you,
Who see so clearly into all the rest,
Should stick at this.—But that arch villain Syrus
Has form'd and moulded your son too so rarely.
That nobody can have the least suspicion
That this is Clinia's mistress.

CHREM. How?

MENE. I pass
Their kisses and embraces. All that's nothing.

CHREM. What is there more that he can counterfeit?

MENE. Ah! (*Smiling.*)

CHREM. What d'ye mean?

MENE. Nay, do but hear. I have
A private snug apartment, a back room,
Whither a bed was brought and made.

CHREM. What then?

MENE. No sooner done, than in went Clitipho.

CHREM. Alone?

MENE. Alone.

CHREM. I tremble.

MENE. Bacchis follow'd.

CHREM. Alone?

MENE. Alone.

CHREM. Undone!

MENE. No sooner in,
But they made fast the door.

CHREM. Ha! And was Clinia
Witness to this?

MENE. He was.—Both he and I.

CHREM. Bacchis is my son's mistress, Menedemus.
I'm ruin'd.

MENE. Why d'ye think so?

CHREM. Mine is scarce
A ten-days' family.

MENE. What are you dismay'd
Because he sticks so closely to his friend?

CHREM. Friend! His she-friend.

MENE. If so——

CHREM. Is that a doubt?
Is any man so courteous, and so patient,
As tamely to stand by and see his mistress——

MENE. Ha, ha, ha! Why not?—That I, you know,
Might be more easily impos'd upon. (*Ironically.*)

CHREM. D'ye laugh at me? I'm angry with myself:
And well I may. How many circumstances
Conspir'd to make it gross and palpable,
Had I not been a stone!—What things I saw!
Fool, fool! But by my life I'll be reveng'd:
For now——

MENE. And can't you then contain yourself?
Have you no self-respect? And am not I
A full example for you?

CHREM. Menedemus,
My anger throws me quite beside myself.

MENE. That you should talk thus! is it not a shame
To be so lib'ral of advice to others,
So wise abroad, and poor in sense at home?

CHREM. What shall I do?

MENE. That which but even now
You counsel'd me to do: Give him to know

That you're indeed a father: let him dare
Trust his whole soul to you, seek, ask of you;
Lest he to others have recourse, and leave you.

CHREM. And let him go; go where he will; much rather
Than here by his extravagance reduce
His father to distress and beggary.
For if I should continue to supply
The course of his expenses, Menedemus,
Your desp'rate rakes would be my lot indeed.

MENE. Ah, to what evils you'll expose yourself,
Unless you're cautious! You will seem severe,
And yet forgive him afterward, and then
With an ill grace too.

CHREM. Ah, you do not know
How much this grieves me.

MENE. Well, well, take your way.
But tell me, do you grant me my request
That this your new-found daughter wed my son?
Or is there aught more welcome to you?

CHREM. Nothing.
The son-in-law and the alliance please me.

MENE. What portion shall I tell my son you've settled!
Why are you silent?

CHREM. Portion!

MENE. Aye, what portion?

CHREM. Ah!

MENE. Fear not, Chremes, though it be but small:
The portion nothing moves us.

CHREM. I propos'd,
According to my fortune, that two talents
Were full sufficient: But you now must say,
If you'd save me, my fortune, and my son,

That I have settled all I have upon her.

MENE. What mean you?

CHREM. Counterfeit amazement too,
And question Clitipho my reason for it.

MENE. Nay, but I really do not know your reason.

CHREM. My reason for it?—That his wanton mind,
Now flush'd with lux'ry and lasciviousness,
I may o'erwhelm: and bring him down so low,
He may not know which way to turn himself.

MENE. What are you at?

CHREM. Allow me! let me have
My own way in this business.

MENE. I allow you.
Is it your pleasure?

CHREM. It is.

MENE. Be it so.

CHREM. Come then, let Clinia haste to call the bride.
And for this son of mine, he shall be school'd,
As children ought.—But Syrus!

MENE. What of him?

CHREM. What! I'll so handle him, so curry him,
That while he lives he shall remember me.

(*Exit* MENEDEMUS.

What, make a jest of me? a laughing-stock?
Now, afore Heav'n, he would not dare to treat
A poor lone widow as he treated me.

SCENE III.

Re-enter MENEDEMUS, *with* CLITIPHO *and* SYRUS.

CLIT. And can it, Menedemus, can it be,
My father has so suddenly cast off
All natural affection? for what act?
What crime, alas! so heinous have I done?
It is a common failing.

MENE. This I know,
Should be more heavy and severe to you
On whom it falls: and yet am I no less
Affected by it, though I know not why,
And have no other reason for my grief,
But that I wish you well.

CLIT. Did not you say
My father waited here?

MENE. Aye; there he is.

(*Exit* MENEDEMUS.

CHREM. Why d'ye accuse your father, Clitipho?
Whate'er I've done, was providently done
Tow'rd you and your imprudence. When I saw
Your negligence of soul, and that you held
The pleasures of to-day your only care,
Regardless of the morrow; I found means
That you should neither want, nor waste my substance.
When you, whom fair succession first made heir,
Stood self-degraded by unworthiness,
I went to those the next in blood to you,
Committing and consigning all to them.
There shall your weakness, Clitipho, be sure
Ever to find a refuge; food, and raiment,
And roof to fly to.

CLIT. Ah me!

CHREM. Better thus,
Than, you being heir, for Bacchis to have all.

SYRUS. Distraction! what disturbances have I,
Wretch that I am, all unawares created!

CLIT. Would I were dead!

CHREM. Learn first what 'tis to live.
When you know that, if life displeases you,
Then talk of dying.

SYRUS. Master, may I speak?

CHREM. Speak.

SYRUS. But with safety?

CHREM. Speak.

SYRUS. How wrong is this,
Or rather what extravagance and madness,
To punish him for my offense!

CHREM. Away!
Do not you meddle. No one blames you, Syrus!
Nor need you to provide a sanctuary,
Or intercessor.

SYRUS. What is it you do?

CHREM. I am not angry, nor with you, nor him:
Nor should you take offense at what I do.

(*Exit* CHREMES.

SCENE IV.

Manent CLITIPHO, SYRUS.

SYRUS. He's gone. Ah, would I'd ask'd him——

CLIT. Ask'd what, Syrus?

SYRUS. Where I should eat, since he has cast us off.
You, I perceive, are quarter'd on your sister.

CLIT. Is't come to this, that I should be in fear
Of starving, Syrus?

SYRUS. So we do but live,

There's hope——

CLIT. Of what?

SYRUS. That we shall have rare stomachs.

CLIT. D'ye jest at such a time as this;
And lend me no assistance by your counsel?

SYRUS. Nay, I was studying for you even now.
And was so all the while your father spoke.
And far as I can understand this——

CLIT. What?

SYRUS. Stay, you shall have it presently. (*Thinking.*)

CLIT. Well, what?

SYRUS. Thus then: I don't believe that you're their son.

CLIT. How Syrus! are you mad?

SYRUS. I'll speak my thoughts.
Be you the judge. While they had you alone,
While yet there was no other nearer joy,
You they indulg'd, and gave with open hand:
But now a daughter's found, their real child,
A cause is found to drive you forth.

CLIT. 'Tis like.

SYRUS. Think you this fault so angers him?

CLIT. I think not.

SYRUS. Consider too; 'tis ever found that mothers
Plead for their sons, and in the father's wrath
Defend them. 'Tis not so at present.

CLIT. True.

What shall I do then, Syrus?

SYRUS. Ask of them
The truth of this suspicion. Speak your thoughts.
If 'tis not so, you'll speedily incline them

Both to compassion; or, if so, be told
Whose son you are.

CLIT. Your counsel's good. I'll do't.

SCENE V.

SYRUS *alone*.

A lucky thought of mine! for Clitipho:
The less he hopes, so much more easily
Will he reduce his father to good terms.
Besides, who knows but he may take a wife?
No thanks to Syrus neither.—But who's here?
Chremes!—I'm off: for seeing what has pass'd,
I wonder that he did not order me
To be truss'd up immediately. I'll hence
To Menedemus, and prevail on him
To intercede for me: as matters stand,
I dare not trust to our old gentleman.

(*Exit* SYRUS.

SCENE VI.

Enter CHREMES, SOSTRATA.

SOSTRA. Nay indeed, husband, if you don't take care,
You'll bring some kind of mischief on your son:
I can't imagine how a thought so idle
Could come into your head.

CHREM. Still, woman, still
D'ye contradict me? Did I ever wish
For any thing in all my life, but you
In that same thing oppos'd me, Sostrata?
Yet now if I should ask wherein I'm wrong,
Or wherefore I act thus, you do not know.

Why then d'ye contradict me, simpleton?

SOSTRA. Not know?

CHREM. Well, well, you know: I grant it, rather
Than hear your idle story o'er again.

SOSTRA. Ah, 'tis unjust in you to ask my silence
In such a thing as this.

CHREM. I do not ask it.
Speak if you will: I'll do it ne'ertheless.

SOSTRA. Will you?

CHREM. I will.

SOSTRA. You don't perceive what harm
May come of this. He thinks himself a foundling.

CHREM. A foundling, say you?

SOSTRA. Yes indeed, he does.

CHREM. Confess it to be true.

SOSTRA. Ah, Heav'n forbid!
Let our most bitter enemies do that!
Shall I disown my son, my own dear child!

CHREM. What! do you fear you can not at
your pleasure
Produce convincing proofs that he's your
own?

SOSTRA. Is it because my daughter's found
you say this?

CHREM. No: but because, a stronger reason
far,

His manners so resemble yours, you may
Easily prove him thence to be your son.
He is quite like you: not a vice, whereof
He is inheritor, but dwells in you:
And such a son no mother but yourself

His manners are so very like your own,
They are convincing proofs that he's your son

Could have engender'd.—But he comes.—
How grave!
Look in his face, and you may guess his
plight.

SCENE VII.

Enter CLITIPHO.

CLIT. Oh mother, if there ever was a time
When you took pleasure in me, or delight
To call me son, beseech you, think of that;
Pity my present misery, and tell me
Who are my real parents!

SOSTRA. My dear son,
Take not, I beg, that notion to your mind,
That you're an alien to our blood.

CLIT. I am.

SOSTRA. Ah me! and can you then demand me that?
So may you prosper after both, as you're
Of both the child! and if you love your mother,
Take heed henceforward that I never hear
Such words from you.

CHREM. And if you fear your father,
See that I never find such vices in you.

CLIT. What vices?

CHREM. What? I'll tell you. Trifler, idler,
Cheat, drunkard, whoremaster, and prodigal.
—Think this, and think that you are ours.

SOSTRA. These words
Suit not a father.

CHREM. No, no, Clitipho,
Though from my brain you had been born, as Pallas

Sprang, it is said, from Jupiter, I would not
Bear the disgrace of your enormities.

SOSTRA. The Gods forbid——

CHREM. I know not for the Gods:
I will do all that lies in me. You seek
For parents, which you have: but what is wanting,
Obedience to your father, and the means
To keep what he by labor hath acquir'd,
For that you seek not.—Did you not by tricks
Ev'n to my presence introduce——I blush
To speak immodestly before your mother:
But you by no means blush'd to do't.

CLIT. Alas!
How hateful am I to myself! how much
Am I asham'd! so lost, I can not tell
How to attempt to pacify my father.

SCENE VIII.

Enter MENEDEMUS.

MENE. Now in good faith our Chremes plagues his son
Too long and too severely. I come forth
To reconcile him, and make peace between them.
And there they are!

CHREM. Ha, Menedemus! wherefore
Is not my daughter summon'd? and the portion,
I settled on her; ratified by you?

SOSTRA. Dear husband, I beseech you not to do it!

CLIT. My father, I entreat you pardon me!

MENE. Forgive him, Chremes! let his pray'rs prevail!

CHREM. What! shall I then with open eyes bestow
My whole estate on Bacchis? I'll not do't.

MENE. We will prevent that. It shall not be so.

CLIT. If you regard my life, forgive me, father!

SOSTRA. Do, my dear Chremes!

MENE. Do, I prithee now!

Be not obdurate, Chremes!

CHREM. Why is this?

I see I can't proceed as I've begun.

MENE. 'Tis as it should be now.

CHREM. On this condition,

That he agrees to do what I think fit.

CLIT. I will do ev'ry thing. Command me, father!

CHREM. Take a wife.

CLIT. Father!

CHREM. Nay, Sir, no denial!

MENE. I take that charge upon me. He shall do't.

CHREM. But I don't hear a word of it from him.

CLIT. Confusion!

SOSTRA. Do you doubt then, Clitipho?

CHREM. Nay, which he pleases.

MENE. He'll obey in all;

Whate'er you'd have him.

SOSTRA. This at first is grievous,

While you don't know it; when you know it, easy.

CLIT. I'm all obedience, father!

SOSTRA. Oh my son,

I'll give you a sweet wife, that you'll adore,

Phanocrata's, our neighbor's daughter.

CLIT. Her!

That red-hair'd, blear-eyed, wide-mouth'd, hook-nos'd wench?

I can not, father.

CHREM. Oh, how nice he is!
Would any one imagine it?

SOSTRA. I'll get you
Another then.

CLIT. Well, well; since I must marry,
I know one pretty near my mind.

SOSTRA. Good boy!

CLIT. The daughter of Archonides, our neighbor.

SOSTRA. Well chosen!

CLIT. One thing, father, still remains.

CHREM. What?

CLIT. That you'd grant poor Syrus a full pardon
For all that he hath done on my account.

CHREM. Be it so.— (*To the Audience.*) Farewell Sirs, and clap your hands!



THE BROTHERS.

PERSONS REPRESENTED.

PROLOGUE.

DEMEA.

MICIO.

ÆSCHINUS.

CTESIPHO.

HEGIO.

SANNIO.

GETA.

SYRUS.

GETA.

DROMO.

PARMENO, *other Servants, etc.*

SOSTRATA.

CANTHARA.

MUSIC-GIRL, *and other Mutes.*

SCENE, ATHENS.

PROLOGUE.

THE Bard perceiving his piece cavil'd at
By partial critics, and his adversaries
Misrepresenting what we're now to play,
Pleads his own cause: and you shall be the judges,
Whether he merits praise or condemnation.

The *Synapthnescontes* is a piece
By Diphilus, a comedy which Plautus,
Having translated, call'd COMMORIENTES.
In the beginning of the Grecian play
There is a youth, who rends a girl perforce
From a procurer: and this incident,
Untouch'd by Plautus, render'd word for word,

Has our bard interwoven with his *Brothers*;
The new piece which we represent to-day.
Say then if this be theft, or honest use
Of what remain'd unoccupied.—For that
Which malice tells, that certain noble persons
Assist the Bard, and write in concert with him;
That which they deem a heavy slander, He
Esteems his greatest praise: that he can please
Those who please you, who all the people please;
Those who in war, in peace, in counsel, ever
Have render'd you the dearest services,
And ever borne their faculties so meekly.

Expect not now the story of the play:
Part the old men, who first appear, will open;
Part will in act be shown.—Be favorable;
And let your candor to the poet now
Increase his future earnestness to write!

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.

Enter MICIO.

Ho, Storax!—Æschinus did not return
Last night from supper; no, nor any one
Of all the slaves who went to see for him.
—'Tis commonly—and oh how truly!—
said,
If you are absent, or delay, 'twere best

Ho, Storax!—No reply?—Then Aeschinus
Never return'd, it seems, last night from supper
Nor any of the slaves, who went to meet him.
—'Tis commonly—and oh how truly!—said,
If you are absent, or delay, 'twere best
That should befall you, which your wife declares
Or which in anger she supposes of you
Than that which kindest parents fear.—Your wife
If you delay, suspects that you're engag'd

That should befall you, which your wife
denounces,
Or which in anger she calls down upon
you,
Than that which kindest parents fear.—
Your wife,
If you delay, or thinks that you're in love,
Or lov'd, or drink, or entertain yourself,
Taking your pleasure, while she pines at home.
—And what a world of fears possess me now!
How anxious that my son is not return'd;
Lest he take cold, or fall, or break a limb!
—Gods, that a man should suffer any one
To wind himself so close about his heart,
As to grow dearer to him than himself!

In some intrigue, debauch, or entertainment;
Consulting your own happiness abroad,
While she, poor soul! is left to pine at home.
But what a world of fears possess me now!
How many ills I figure to myself,
As causes that my son is not return'd!
Lest he have taken cold, or had a fall,
Or broke a limb!—Good heavens! that a man
Shou'd doat so much, or suffer any one
To wind himself so close about his heart,
As to grow dearer to him than himself!

And yet he is not my son, but my brother's,
Whose bent of mind is wholly different.
I, from youth upward even to this day,
Have led a quiet and serene town-life;
And, as some reckon fortunate, ne'er married.
He, in all points the opposite of this,
Has pass'd his days entirely in the country
With thrift and labor; married; had two sons;
The elder boy is by adoption mine;
I've brought him up; kept; lov'd him as my own;
Made him my joy, and all my soul holds dear,
Striving to make myself as dear to him.
I give, o'erlook, nor think it requisite
That all his deeds should be controll'd by me,
Giving him scope to act as of himself;
So that the pranks of youth, which other children
Hide from their fathers, I have us'd my son
Not to conceal from me. For whosoe'er
Hath won upon himself to play the false one,
And practice impositions on a father,
Will do the same with less remorse to others;

And 'tis, in my opinion, better far
To bind your children to you by the ties
Of gentleness and modesty, than fear.
And yet my brother don't accord in this,
Nor do these notions nor this conduct please him.
Oft he comes open-mouth'd—"Why how now, Micio?
Why do you ruin this young lad of ours?
Why does he wench? why drink? and why do you
Allow him money to afford all this?
You let him dress too fine. 'Tis idle in you."
—'Tis hard in him, unjust and out of reason.
And he, I think, deceives himself indeed,
Who fancies that authority more firm
Founded on force, than what is built on friendship;
For thus I reason, thus persuade myself:
He who performs his duty driven to't
By fear of punishment, while he believes
His actions are observ'd, so long he's wary;
But if he hopes for secrecy, returns
To his own ways again: But he whom kindness,
Him also inclination makes your own:
He burns to make a due return, and acts,
Present or absent, evermore the same.
'Tis this then is the duty of a father,
To make a son embrace a life of virtue,
Rather from choice than terror or constraint.
Here lies the mighty difference between
A father and a master. He who knows not
How to do this, let him confess he knows not
How to rule children.—But is this the man
Whom I was speaking of? Yes, yes, 'tis he.
He seems uneasy too, I know not why,
And I suppose, as usual, comes to wrangle.

SCENE II.

Enter DEMEA.

MICIO. Demea, I'm glad to see you well.

DEMEA. Oho!

Well met: the very man I came to seek.

MICIO. But you appear uneasy: What's the matter?

DEMEA. Is it a question, when there's
Æschinus

To trouble us, what makes me so uneasy?

MICIO. I said it would be so.—What has he done?

DEMEA. What has he done? a wretch, whom
neither ties

Of shame, nor fear, nor any law can bind!

For not to speak of all his former pranks,

What has he been about but even now!

MICIO. What has he done?

DEMEA. Burst open doors, and forc'd
His way into another's house, and beat
The master and his family half dead;
And carried off a wench whom he was
fond of.

The whole town cries out shame upon him,
Micio.

I have been told of it a hundred times
Since my arrival. 'Tis the common talk.

And if we needs must draw comparisons,
Does not he see his brother thrifty, sober,
Attentive to his business in the country?
Not given to these practices; and when
I say all this to him, to you I say it.

DEMEA. Uneasy? well I may.—The matter, say
you?

What can the matter be but Æschinus?

MICIO. I said it wou'd be so.—What has he do

DEMEA. What has he done! a wretch whom
neither fear,

Nor modesty, nor any law can bind!

For not to speak of all his former pranks,

What has he been about but even now!

MICIO. What has he done?

DEMEA. Burst open doors, and made
His way by force into another's house;
Half-kill'd the master and his family,
And carried off a wench whom he was fond of
All Athens cries out shame upon him for it.
I have been told of it a hundred times
Since my arrival. 'Tis the town-talk, Micio.
And if we needs must draw comparisons,

You are his ruin, Micio.

MICIO. How unjust
Is he who wants experience! who believes
Nothing is right but what he does himself!

DEMEA. Why d'ye say that?

MICIO. Because you, Demea,
Judge wrongly of these matters. 'Tis no
crime

Misjudge these matters. 'Tis no heinous crime

For a young man to wench or drink.—'Tis
not,

Believe me!—nor to force doors open.—
This,

If neither you nor I have done, it was
That poverty allow'd us not. And now
You claim a merit to yourself, from that
Which want constrain'd you to. It is not
fair.

For had there been but wherewithal to do't,
We likewise should have done thus.

Wherefore you,
Were you a man, would let your younger
son,

Now, while it suits his age, pursue his
pleasures;

Rather than, when it less becomes his
years,

When, after wishing long, he shall at last
Be rid of you, he should run riot then.

DEMEA. Oh Jupiter! the man will drive me
mad.

Is it no crime, d'ye say, for a young man
To take these courses?

MICIO. Nay, nay; do but hear me,
Nor stun me with the self-same thing
forever!

Your elder son you gave me for adoption:
He's mine, then, Demea; and if he offends,
'Tis an offense to me, and I must bear
The burden. Does he treat? or drink? or
dress?

'Tis at my cost.—Or wench? I will supply
him,

While 'tis convenient to me; when 'tis not,
His mistresses perhaps will shut him out.
—Has he broke open doors? we'll make
them good.

Or torn a coat? it shall be mended. I,
Thank Heaven, have enough to do all this,
And 'tis as yet not irksome.—In a word,
Or cease, or choose some arbiter between
us:

Have done, or chuse some arbiter between us:

I'll prove that you are more in fault than I.

DEMEA. Ah, learn to be a father; learn from
those

Who know what 'tis to be indeed a parent!

MICIO. By nature you're his father, I by
counsel.

DEMEA. You! do you counsel any thing?

MICIO. Nay, nay;
If you persist, I'm gone.

DEMEA. Is't thus you treat me?

MICIO. Must I still hear the same thing o'er
and o'er?

MICIO. Must I be plagued with the same thing
often?

DEMEA. It touches me.

MICIO. And me it touches too.

But, Demea, let us each look to our own;
Let me take care of one, and mind you
t'other.

For to concern yourself with both, appears

As if you'd redemand the boy you gave.

DEMEA. Ah, Micio!

MICIO. So it seems to me.

DEMEA. Well, well;

Let him, if 'tis your pleasure, waste,
destroy.

And squander; it is no concern of mine.

If henceforth I e'er say one word——

MICIO. Again?

Angry again, good Demea?

DEMEA. You may trust me.

Do I demand him back again I gave you?

—It hurts me. I am not a stranger to him.

—But if I once oppose—Well, well, I've
done.

You wish I should take care of one. I do

Take special care of him; and he, thank

Heav'n,

Is as I wish he *should* be: which your ward,

I warrant, shall find out one time or other.

I will not say aught worse of him at
present.

(*Exit.*

SCENE III.

MICIO *alone.*

Though what he says be not entirely true,

There's something in it, and it touches me.

But I dissembled my concern with him,

Because the nature of the man is such,

To pacify, I must oppose and thwart him;

And even thus I scarce can teach him
patience.

But were I to inflame, or aid his anger,
I were as great a madman as himself.
Yet Æschinus, 'tis true, has been to blame.
What wench is there he has not lov'd? to
whom

What wench is there but he is her gallant?
Or tempts her with some gift?—But lately too

He has not made some present—And but
lately
(Tir'd, I suppose, and sick of wantonness)
He told me he propos'd to take a wife.
I hop'd the heyday of the blood was over,
And was rejoic'd: but his intemperance
Breaks out afresh.—Well, be it what it
may,
I'll find him out; and know it instantly,
If he is to be met with at the Forum.

(Exit.

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.

*Enter ÆSCHINUS, SANNIO, PARMENO, the Music-Girl, and a crowd of
People.*

SAN. Help, help, dear countrymen, for Heaven's sake!
Assist a miserable, harmless man!
Help the distress'd!

ÆSCH. (*to the Girl*). Fear nothing: stand just there!
Why d'ye look back? you're in no danger. Never,
While I am by, shall he lay hands upon you.

SAN. Aye, but I will, in spite of all the world.

ÆSCH. Rogue as he is, he'll scarce do any thing
To make me cudgel him again to-day.

SAN. One word, Sir Æschinus! that you may not
Pretend to ignorance of my profession;
I'm a procurer.

ÆSCH. True.

SAN. And in my way
Of as good faith as any man alive.
Hereafter, to absolve yourself, you'll cry,
That you repent of having wrong'd me thus.
I sha'n't care *that* for your excuse. (*Snapping his fingers.*) Be sure
I'll prosecute my right; nor shall fine words
Atone for evil deeds. I know your way,
—"I'm sorry that I did it: and I'll swear
You are unworthy of this injury"—
Though all the while I'm us'd most scurvily.

ÆSCH. (*to PAR.*) Do you go forward, Parmeno, and throw
The door wide open.

SAN. That sha'n't signify.

ÆSCH. (*to PARMENO*). Now in with her!

SAN. (*stepping between*). I'll not allow it.

ÆSCH. (*to PARMENO*). Here!
Come hither, Parmeno!—you're too far off.—
Stand close to that pimp's side—There—there—just there!
And now be sure you always keep your eyes
Steadfastly fix'd on mine; and when I wink,
To drive your fist directly in his face.

SAN. Aye, if he dare.

ÆSCH. (*to* PARMENO). Now mind!— (*To* SANNIO). Let go the girl (*SANNIO still struggling with the Girl, ÆSCHINUS winks, and PARMENO strikes SANNIO*).

SAN. Oh monstrous!

ÆSCH. He shall double it, unless
You mend your manners.

(*PARMENO strikes SANNIO again.*)

SAN. Help, help: murder, murder!

ÆSCH. (*to* PARMENO). I did not wink: but you had better err
That way than t'other.—Now go in with her.

(*PARMENO leads the Girl into MICIO's house.*)

SAN. How's this?—Do you reign king here, Æschinus?

ÆSCH. Did I reign king, you should be recompens'd
According to your virtues, I assure you.

SAN. What business have you with me?

ÆSCH. None.

SAN. D'ye know
Who I am, Æschinus?

ÆSCH. Nor want to know.

SAN. Have I touch'd aught of yours, Sir?

ÆSCH. If you had,
You should have suffer'd for't.

SAN. What greater right
Have you to take away my slave, for whom
I paid my money? answer me!

ÆSCH. 'Twere best
You'd leave off bellowing before our door:
If you continue to be troublesome,
I'll have you dragg'd into the house, and there
Lash'd without mercy.

SAN. How, a freeman lash'd!

ÆSCH. Ev'n so.

SAN. O monstrous tyranny! Is this,
Is this the liberty they boast of here,
Common to all?

ÆSCH. If you have brawl'd enough,
Please to indulge me with one word, you pimp.

SAN. Who has brawl'd most, yourself or I?

ÆSCH. Well, well!
No more of that, but to the point!

SAN. What point?
What would you have?

ÆSCH. Will you allow me then
To speak of what concerns you?

SAN. Willingly:
Speak, but in justice.

ÆSCH. Very fine! a pimp,
And talks of justice!

SAN. Well, I am a pimp;
The common bane of youth, a perjurer,
A public nuisance, I confess it: yet
I never did you wrong.

ÆSCH. No, that's to come.

SAN. Prithree return to whence you first set out, Sir!

ÆSCH. You, plague upon you for it! bought the girl
For twenty minæ; which sum we will give you.

SAN. What if I do not choose to sell the girl?
Will you oblige me?

ÆSCH. No.

SAN. I fear'd you would.

ÆSCH. She's a free-woman, and should *not* be sold,

And, as such, by due course of law I claim her.
Now then consider which you like the best,
To take the money, or maintain your action.
Think on this, Pimp, till I come back again.

(Exit.

SCENE II.

SANNIO *alone.*

Oh Jupiter! I do not wonder now
That men run mad with injuries. He drags me
Out of my own house; cudgels me most soundly;
And carries off my slave against my will:
And after this ill-treatment, he demands
The Music-Girl to be made over to him
At the same price I bought her.—He has pour'd
His blows upon me, thick as hail; for which,
Since he deserves so nobly at my hands,
He should no doubt be gratified.—Nay, nay,
Let me but touch the cash, I'm still content.
But this I guess will be the case: as soon
As I shall have agreed to take his price,
He'll produce witnesses immediately,
To prove that I have sold her—And the money
Will be mere moonshine.—“By-and-by.”—“To-morrow.”
—Yet I could bear that too, although much wrong,
Might I but get the money after all:
For thus it is, friend Sannio; when a man
Has taken up this trade, he must receive,
And pocket the affronts of young gallants.
—But nobody will pay me, and I draw
Conclusions to no purpose.

SCENE III.

Enter SYRUS.

SYRUS (*to ÆSCH. within*). Say no more!
Let me alone to talk with him! I warrant
I'll make him take the money; aye, and own
That he's well treated too. (*Coming forward.*) Why how now, Sannio?
What's the dispute I overheard just now
'Twixt you and my young master?

SAN. Never was
Any dispute conducted more unfairly,
Than that between us two to-day! Poor I
With being drubb'd, and he with drubbing me,
'Till we were both quite weary.

SYRUS. All your fault.

SAN. What could I do?

SYRUS. Give a young man his way.

SAN. What could I give him more, who gave my face?

SYRUS. Nay, but d'ye know my meaning, Sannio?
To seem upon occasion to slight money,
Proves in the end, sometimes, the greatest gain.
Why prithee, blockhead, could you be afraid,
Had you abated somewhat of your right,
And humor'd the young gentleman, he would not
Have paid you back again with interest?

SAN. I never purchase hope with ready money.

SYRUS. Away! you'll never thrive. You do not know
How to ensnare men, Sannio.

SAN. Well, perhaps,
Your way were best: yet I was ne'er so crafty
But I had rather, when 'twas in my power,
Receive prompt payment.

SYRUS. Pshaw! I know your spirit:
As if you valued twenty minæ now,

So you might do a kindness to my master!
—Besides, they say you're setting out for Cyprus. (*Carelessly.*)

SAN. Ha! (*Alarmed.*)

SYRUS. —And have bought up a large stock of goods
To carry over thither.—Hir'd a vessel.
That 'tis, I know, which keeps you in suspense:
When you return, I hope, you'll settle this.

SAN. I shall not budge a foot.—Undone by
Heav'n!
Urg'd by these hopes they've undertaken
this. (*Aside.*)

SYRUS. He fears. I've thrown a small rub in
his way. (*Aside.*)

SYRUS. He fears. I hinted Cyprus. There's the

SAN. (*to himself.*) Confusion! they have
nick'd me to a hair!
I've bought up sev'ral slaves, and other
wares,
For exportation; and to miss my time
At Cyprus-fair would be a heavy loss.
Then if I leave this business broken thus,
All's over with me; and at my return
'Twill come to nothing, grown quite cold
and stale.
“—What! come at last?—Why did you
stay so long?
Where have you been?”—that it were
better lose it,
Than wait for it so long, or sue for't then.

SYRUS (*coming up to him.*) Well, have you calculated what's your due?

SAN. Monstrous oppression! Is this honorable,
Or just in Æschinus, to take away
My property by force?

SYRUS. So, so! he comes. (*Aside.*)
—I have but one word more to say to you.

See how you like it.—Rather, Sannio,
Than run the risk to get or lose the whole,
E'en halve the matter: and he shall contrive
To scrape together by some means ten minæ.

SAN. Alas, alas! am I in danger then
Of losing ev'n my very principal?
Shame on him! he has loosen'd all my teeth:
My head is swell'd all over like a mushroom:
And will he cheat me too?—I'm going nowhere.

SYRUS. Just as you please.—Have you aught else to say
Before I go?

SAN. Yes, one word, prithee Syrus!
However things have happen'd, rather than
I should be driven to commence a suit,
Let him return me my bare due at least;
The sum she cost me, Syrus.—I'm convinc'd
You've had no tokens of my friendship yet;
But you shall find I will not be ungrateful.

SYRUS. I'll do my best. But I see Ctesipho.
He is rejoic'd about his mistress.

SAN. Say,
Will you remember me?

SYRUS. Hold, hold a little! (SYRUS *and* SANNIO *retire*.)

SCENE IV.

Enter CTESIPHO at another part of the stage.

CTES. Favors are welcome in the hour of need
From any hand; but doubly welcome when
Conferr'd by those from whom we most expect them.
O brother, brother, how shall I applaud thee?
Ne'er can I rise to such a height of praise
But your deservings will outtop me still:

For in this point I am supremely bless'd,
That none can boast so excellent a brother,
So rich in all good qualities, as I.

SYRUS (*coming forward*). O Ctesipho!

CTES. (*turning round*). O Syrus! where's my brother?

SYRUS. At home, where he expects you.

CTES. Ha! (*Joyfully.*)

SYRUS. What now!

CTES. What now?—By his assistance I live, Syrus.
Ah, he's a friend indeed! who disregarding
All his own interests for my advantage,
The scandal, infamy, intrigue, and blame,
All due to me, has drawn upon himself!
What could exceed it?—But who's there?—The door
Creaks on the hinges. (*Offering to go off.*)

SYRUS. Hold! 'tis Æschinus.

SCENE V.

Enter ÆSCHINUS.

ÆSCH. Where is that rascal?

SAN. (*behind.*) He inquires for me.
Has he brought out the cash with him?—Confusion!
I see none.

ÆSCH. (*to CTESIPHO*). Ha! well met: I long'd to see you
How is it, Ctesipho? All's safe. Away
With melancholy!

CTES. Melancholy! I
Be melancholy, who have such a brother?
Oh my dear Æschinus! thou best of brothers,
—Ah, I'm asham'd to praise you to your face,
Lest it appear to come from flattery,

Rather than gratitude.

ÆSCH. Away, you fool!

As if we did not know each other, Ctesipho.
It only grieves me, we so lately knew this,
When things were almost come to such a pass,
That all the world, had they desir'd to do it,
Could not assist you.

CTES. 'Twas my modesty.

ÆSCH. Pshaw! it was folly, and not modesty.
For such a trifle, almost fly your country?
Heaven forbid it!—fie, fie, Ctesipho!

CTES. I've been to blame.

ÆSCH. Well, what says Sannio?

SYRUS. He's pacified at last.

ÆSCH. I'll to the Forum,
And pay him off.—You, Ctesipho, go in
To the poor girl.

SAN. Now urge the matter, Syrus! (*Apart to*
SYRUS.)

SYRUS. Let's go; for Sannio wants to be at
Cyprus.

SAN. Not in such haste: though truly I have
no cause
To loiter here.

SAN. Not in such haste: though truly I've no
cause

SYRUS. You shall be paid: ne'er fear!

SAN. But all?

SYRUS. Yes, all: so hold your tongue, and follow!

SAN. I will.

(*Exit after ÆSCHINUS—SYRUS going.*)

CTES. Hist! hark ye, Syrus!

SYRUS (*turning back.*) Well, what now?

CTES. For Heaven's sake discharge that scurvy fellow
Immediately; for fear, if further urg'd,
This tale should reach my father's ears: and then
I am undone forever.

SYRUS. It sha'n't be.
Be of good courage! meanwhile, get you in,
And entertain yourself with her; and order
The couches to be spread, and all prepar'd.
For, these preliminaries once dispatch'd,
I shall march homeward with provisions.

CTES. Do!
And since this business has turn'd out so well,
Let's spend the day in mirth and jollity!

(*Exeunt severally.*

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.

SOSTRATA, CANTHARA.

Sos. Prithee, good nurse, how will it go with her?

CAN. How go with her? Why well, I warrant you.

Sos. Her pains begin to come upon her, nurse.

CAN. You're as much frighten'd at your time of day,
As if you ne'er was present at a labor,

Or never had been brought to bed yourself.

SOS. Alas, I've no soul here: we're all alone.
Geta is absent; nor is there a creature
To fetch a midwife, or call Æschinus.

CAN. He'll be here presently, I promise you:
For he, good man, ne'er lets a single day
Go by, but he is sure to visit us.

SOS. He is my only comfort in my sorrows.

CAN. Troth, as the case stands, madam, circumstances
Could not have happen'd better than they have:
And since your daughter suffer'd violence,
'Twas well she met with such a man as this;
A man of honor, rank, and family.

SOS. He is, indeed, a worthy gentleman:
The gods preserve him to us!

SCENE II.

Enter GETA hastily at another part of the stage.

GETA. We are now
So absolutely lost, that all the world
Joining in consultation to apply
Relief to the misfortune that has fallen
On me, my mistress, and her daughter, all
Would not avail.—Ah me! so many troubles
Environ us at once, we sink beneath them.
Rape, poverty, oppression, solitude,
And infamy! oh, what an age is this!
O wicked, oh vile race!—oh impious man!

SOS. (*to CANTHARA*). Ah, why should Geta seem thus terrified
And agitated?

GETA (*to himself*). Wretch! whom neither honor,
Nor oaths, nor pity could control or move!

Nor her approaching labor; her, on whom
He shamefully committed violation!

Sos. I don't well understand him.

CAN. Prithee then
Let us draw nearer, Sostrata!

GETA (*to himself.*) Alas,
I'm scarcely in my perfect mind, I burn
With such fierce anger.—Oh, that I had all
That villain-family before me now,
That I might vent my indignation on them,
While yet it boils within me.—There is nothing
I'd not endure to be reveng'd on them.
First I'd tread out the stinking snuff his father,
Who gave the monster being.—And then, Syrus,
Who urg'd him to it,—how I'd tear him!—First
I'd seize him round the waist, and lift him high,
Then dash his head against the ground, and strew
The pavement with his brains.—For Æschinus,
I'd tear his eyes out, and then tumble him,
Head foremost down some precipice.—The rest
I'd rush on, drag, crush, trample under foot.
But why do I delay to tell my mistress
This heavy news as soon as possible! (*Going.*)

Sos. Let's call him back.—Ho, Geta!

GETA. Whosoe'er
You are, excuse me.

Sos. I am Sostrata.

GETA. Where, where is Sostrata? (*Turns about.*) I sought you, Madam;
Impatiently I sought you: and am glad
To have encounter'd you thus readily.

Sos. What is the matter? why d'ye tremble thus?

GETA. Alas!

Sos. Take breath!—But why thus mov'd, good Geta?

GETA. We're quite——

SOS. Quite what?

GETA. Undone: We're ruin'd, Madam.

SOS. Explain, for Heaven's sake!

GETA. Ev'n now——

SOS. What now?

GETA. Æschinus——

SOS. What of Æschinus?

GETA. Has quite
Estrang'd himself from all our family.

SOS. How's that? confusion! why?

GETA. He loves another.

SOS. Wretch that I am!

GETA. Nor that clandestinely;
But snatch'd her in the face of all the world
From a procurer.

SOS. Are you sure of this?

GETA. Sure? With these very eyes I saw it, Madam.

SOS. Alas, alas! What then can we believe?
To whom give credit?—What? our Æschinus!
Our very life, our sole support and hope!
Who swore he could not live one day without her,
And promis'd he would place the new-born babe
Upon his father's lap, and in that way
Wring from him his consent to marry her!

GETA. Nay, weep not, mistress; but consider rather
What course were best to follow: to conceal
This wrong, or to disclose it to some friend?

CAN. Disclose it! Are you mad? Is this a thing
To be disclos'd, d'ye think?

GETA. I'd not advise it.

For first, that he has quite abandon'd us,
The thing itself declares. If we then make
The story known, no doubt but he'll deny it.
Your reputation, and your daughter's life
Will be endanger'd: or if he confess,
Since he affects another, 'twere not good
That he should wed your daughter.—For which reasons,
Silence is requisite.

Sos. Ah, no: not I.

GETA. What mean you?

Sos. To disclose the whole.

GETA. How, Madam!
Think what you are about.

Sos. Whatever happens,
The thing can't be in a worse state than now.
In the first place my daughter has no portion,
And that which should have been her second dowry
Is also lost; and she can ne'er be giv'n
In marriage as a virgin. For the rest,
If he denies his former commerce with her,
I have the ring he lost to vouch the fact.
In short, since I am conscious to myself.
That I am not to blame in this proceeding,
And that no sordid love of gain, nor aught
Unworthy of my daughter or myself,
Has mix'd in this affair, I'll try it, Geta.

GETA. Well, I agree, 'twere better to disclose it.

Sos. You then away, as fast as possible,
And run to Hegio our good friend and kinsman,
To let him know the whole affair: for he
Was the chief friend of my dear Simulus,
And ever show'd a great regard for us.

GETA. And well he does, for no one else cares for us.

Sos. And you, good Canthara, away with haste,
And call a midwife; that we may be sure
Of her assistance in the time of need.

(*Exeunt severally.*

SCENE III.

Enter DEMEA.

DEME. Confusion! I have heard that
Ctesipho
Was present with his brother at this riot.
This is the sum of all my miseries,
If he, even he, a sober, hopeful lad,
May be seduc'd into debaucheries.
—But where shall I inquire for him? I
warrant
They have decoy'd him into some vile
brothel.
That profligate persuaded him, I'm sure.
—But here comes Syrus; he can tell me all.
And yet this slave is of the gang; and if
He once perceives that I'm inquiring for
him,
He'll never tell me any thing; a rogue!
I'll not discover my design.

—But here comes Syrus.—I shall know from
What is become of Ctesipho.—And yet
This rascal's of the gang; and if he once
Perceives that I'm enquiring after him,
He'll never tell, a villain!—I'll take care
To cover my design.

SCENE IV.

Enter SYRUS *at another part of the stage.*

SYRUS (*to himself*). We've just
Disclos'd the whole of this affair to Micio,
Exactly as it happen'd. I ne'er saw
The good old gentleman more pleas'd.

SYRUS We've just disclos'd
The whole of this affair to Micio,

DEME. Oh Heav'n,

The folly of the man! (*Listening.*)

SYRUS (*to himself*). He prais'd his son;
Me, who concerted the whole scheme, he
thank'd.

DEM. I burst with rage. (*Listening.*)

SYRUS (*to himself*). He told the money
down
Immediately, and threw us in beside,
To make an entertainment, a half-mina:
Which I've laid out according to my liking.

DEM. So! if you'd have your business well
ta'en care of,
Commit it to this fellow!

DEM. So! if you'd have your business well
discharg'd,

SYRUS (*overhearing*). Who's there? Demea!
I did not see you, Sir. How goes it?

DEM. How?
I can't sufficiently admire your conduct.

SYRUS (*negligently*). Silly enough, to say
the truth, and idle.

(*To servants within*). Cleanse you the rest
of those fish, Dromo: let
That large eel play a little in the water.
When I return it shall be bon'd; till then
It must not be.

Here! Hark ye, Dromo! see you gut and scale
The other fish immediately: But let

DEM. Are crimes like these——

SYRUS (*to DEMEA*). Indeed
I like them not, and oft cry shame upon
them.

—(*To servants within*.) See that those salt
fish are well soak'd, Stephanio.

DEM. Gods! is this done on purpose? Does
he think
'Tis laudable to spoil his son? Alas!

I think I see the day when Æschinus
Shall fly for want, and list himself a
soldier.

SYRUS. O Demea! that is to be wise: to see,
Not that alone which lies before your feet,
But ev'n to pry into futurity.

DEM. What! is the Music-Girl at your
house?

SYRUS. Aye,
Madam's within.

DEM. What! and is Æschinus
To keep her at home with him?

SYRUS. I believe so;
Such is their madness.

DEM. Is it possible?

SYRUS. A fond and foolish father!

DEM. I'm asham'd
To own my brother; I'm griev'd for him.

SYRUS. Ah!
There is a deal of diff'rence, Demea,
—Nor is't because you're present that I say
this——

There is a mighty difference between you!
You are, from top to toe, all over wisdom:
He a mere dotard.—Would you e'er permit
Your boy to do such things?

DEM. Permit him? I?
Or should I not much rather smell him out
Six months before he did but dream of it?

SYRUS. Pshaw! do you boast your vigilance
to me?

DEM. Heav'n keep him ever as he is at
present!

SYRUS. As fathers form their children, so
they prove.

DEM. But now we're speaking of him, have
you seen
The lad to-day? (*With an affected
carelessness.*)

SYRUS. Your son d'ye mean?—I'll drive
him
Into the country. (*Aside.*)—He is hard at
work
Upon your grounds by this time. (*To
DEMEA.*)

DEM. Are you sure on't?

SYRUS. Sure? I set out with him myself.

DEM. Good! good!
I was afraid he loiter'd here. (*Aside.*)

SYRUS. And much
Enrag'd, I promise you.

DEM. On what account?

SYRUS. A quarrel with his brother at the
Forum,
About the Music-Girl.

DEM. Indeed?

SYRUS. Aye, faith:
He did not mince the matter: he spoke out;
For as the cash was telling down, in pops,
All unexpected, Master Ctesipho:
Cries out—"Oh Æschinus, are these your
courses?

DEM. But, prithee, have you seen the lad to-da

SYRUS. Your son, d'ye mean?—I'll drive him c
of town.
He's hard at work upon your grounds by this
time.

DEM. Ay? Are you sure he's gone into the
country?

These your pursuits? enormities like these?
Oh shame! oh scandal to our family!"

Do you commit these crimes? and do you
bring
Such a disgrace upon our family?"

DEM. Oh, oh, I weep for joy.

SYRUS. ——“You squander not
The money only, but your life, your
honor.”

DEM. Heav’n bless him; he is like his
ancestors. (*Weeping.*)

SYRUS. Father’s own son, I warrant him.

DEM. Oh, Syrus!
He’s full of all those precepts, he!

SYRUS. No doubt on’t:
He need not go from home for good
instruction.

DEM. I spare no pains; neglect no means; I
train him.

—In short, I bid him look into the lives
Of all, as in a mirror, and thence draw
From others an example for himself.
—“Do this.”——

SYRUS. Good!

DEM. “Fly that.”

SYRUS. Very good!

DEM. “This deed
Is commendable.”

Is highly commendable.”

SYRUS. That’s the thing!

DEM. “That’s reprehensible.”

SYRUS. Most excellent!

DEM. “And then moreover——”

SYRUS. Faith, I have not time
To give you further audience just at
 present,
I've got an admirable dish of fish;
And I must take good care they are not
 spoil'd.
For that were an offense as grievous,
 Demea,
In us, as 'twere in you to leave undone
The things you just now mentioned: and I
 try,
According to my weak abilities,
To teach my fellow-slaves the self-same
 way.
—"This is too salt.—This is burnt up too
 much.
That is not nice and cleanly.—That's well
 done.
Mind, and do so again."—I spare no pains,
And give them the best precepts that I can.
In short, I bid them look into the dishes,
As in a mirror, Demea, and thence learn
The duty of a cook.—This school of ours,
I own, is idle: but what can you do?
According to the man must be the lesson.
—Would you aught else with us?

DEM. Your reformation.

SYRUS. Do you go hence into the country?

DEM. Straight.

SYRUS. For what should you do here, where
 nobody,
However good your precepts, cares to
 mind them?

(Exit.

SCENE V.

DEMEA *alone.*

I then will hence, since he, on whose account
I hither came, is gone into the country.
He is my only care, *He's* my concern.
My brother, since he needs will have it so,
May look to Æschinus himself.—But who
Is coming yonder? Hegio, of our tribe?
If I see plainly, beyond doubt 'tis he.
Ah, we've been old acquaintance quite from boys;
And such men nowadays are wondrous scarce.
A citizen of ancient faith and virtue!
The commonwealth will ne'er reap harm from him.
How I rejoice to see but the remains
Of this old stock! Ah, life's a pleasure now.
I'll wait, that I may ask about his health,
And have a little conversation with him.

SCENE VI.

Enter HEGIO, GETA conversing at a distance.

HEGIO. Good Heaven! a most unworthy
action, Geta!

HEGIO. Can it be true?

GETA. Ev'n so.

GETA. Ev'n so.

HEGIO. A deed so base
Sprung from that family?—Oh Æschinus,
I'm sure this was not acting like your
father.

HEGIO. A deed so base
Sprung from that family?—Oh Æschinus,
This was not acting like your father.

DEM. (*behind.*) So! he has heard about this
Music-Girl,
And is affected at it, though a stranger,

DEM. (*behind.*) So!
He has just heard about this Musick-Girl,
And is affected at it, though a stranger,
While his good father truly thinks it nothing.
Oh monstrous! would that he were somewhere
nigh,
And heard all this!

While his good father truly thinks it
nothing.

Oh monstrous! would that he were
somewhere nigh,
And heard all this!

HEGIO. Unless they do what's just,
They shall not carry off the matter thus.

HEGIO. Unless they do you justice
They shall not carry off the matter thus.

GETA. Our only hope is in you, Hegio.
You're our sole friend, our guardian, and
our father,
The good old Simulus, on his death-bed
Bequeath'd us to your care. If you desert
us,
We are undone indeed.

On his death-bed, the good old Simulus

HEGIO. Ah, name it not!
I will not, and with honesty, I can not.

DEM. I'll go up to him.—Save you, Hegio!

HEGIO. The man I look'd for.—Save you,
Demea!

DEM. Your pleasure!

HEGIO. Æschinus, your elder son,
Adopted by your brother, has committed
A deed unworthy of an honest man,
And of a gentleman.

Your brother's by adoption, has committed

DEM. How so?

HEGIO. You knew
Our friend and good acquaintance, Simulus?

DEM. Aye, sure.

HEGIO. He has debauch'd his daughter.

DEM. How!

HEGIO. Hold, Demea, for the worst is still to come.

DEM. Is there aught worse?

HEGIO. Much worse: for this perhaps
Might be excus'd. The night, love, wine, and youth,
Might prompt him. 'Tis the frailty of our nature.
—Soon as his sense returning made him conscious
Of his rash outrage, of his own accord
He came to the girl's mother, weeping, praying.
Entreating, vowing constancy, and swearing
That he would take her home.—He was forgiven;
The thing conceal'd; and his vows credited.
The girl from that encounter prov'd with child:
This is the tenth month.—He, good gentleman,
Has got a music-girl, Heav'n bless the mark!
With whom he means to live, and quit the other.

DEM. And are you well assur'd of this?

HEGIO. The mother,
The girl, the fact itself, are all before you,
Joining to vouch the truth on't. And besides,
This Geta here—as servants go, no bad one,
Nor given up to idleness—maintains them;
The sole support of all the family.
Here take him, bind him, force the truth from him.

GETA. Aye, torture me, if 'tis not so, good Demea!
Nay, Æschinus, I'm sure, will not deny it.
Bring me before him.

DEM. (*aside*). I'm asham'd: and what
To do, or what to say to him, I know not.

PAMPHILA (*within*). Ah me! I'm torn in pieces!—Racking pains!
Juno Lucina, help me! save, I pray thee!

HEGIO. Ha! Is she then in labor, Geta?

GETA. Yes, Sir.

HEGIO. Hark! she now calls upon your justice, Demea!

Grant her then freely, what law else will claim.
And Heaven send, that you may rather do
What honor bids! but if you mean it not,
Be sure of this; that with my utmost force
I'll vindicate the girl, and her dead father;
He was my kinsman; we were bred together
From children; and our fortunes twin'd together
In war, and peace, and bitter poverty.
Wherefore I'll try, endeavor, strive, nay lose
My life itself, before I will forsake them.
—What is your answer?

DEM. I'll find out my brother:
What he advises, I will follow, Hegio.

HEGIO. But still remember, Demea, that the more
You live at ease; the more your pow'r, your wealth,
Your riches, and nobility; the more
It is your duty to act honorably,
If you regard the name of honest men.

DEM. Go to: we'll do you justice.

HEGIO. 'Twill become you.
Geta, conduct me in to Sostrata.

(*Exit with GETA.*

SCENE VII.

DEMEA *alone.*

This is no more than I foretold: and well
If his intemp'rance would stop *here!*—But this
Immoderate indulgence must produce
Some terrible misfortune in the end.
—I'll hence, find out my brother, tell my news,
And empty all my indignation on him.

(*Exit.*

SCENE VIII.

Re-enter HEGIO, speaking to SOSTRATA at the door.

Be of good cheer, my Sostrata; and comfort,
As much as in your pow'r, poor Pamphila!
I'll find out Micio, if he's at the Forum,
And tell him the whole story: if he'll act
With honor in it, why 'tis well; if not,
Let him but speak his mind to me, and then
I shall know how to act accordingly.

(Exit.

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.

CTESIPHO, SYRUS.

CTES. My father gone into the country, say you?

SYRUS. Long since.

CTES. Nay; speak the truth!

SYRUS. He's at his farm,
And hard at work, I warrant you.

CTES. I wish,
So that his health were not the worse for it,
He might so heartily fatigue himself,

As to be forc'd to keep his bed these three days!

SYRUS. I wish so too; and more, if possible.

CTES. With all my heart: for I would fain consume,
As I've begun, the livelong day in pleasure.
Nor do I hate that farm of ours so much
For any thing, as that it is so near.
For if 'twas at a greater distance, night
Would come upon him ere he could return.
But now, not finding me, I'm very sure
He'll hobble back again immediately;
Question me where I've been, that I've not seen him
All the day long; and what shall I reply?

SYRUS. What? can you think of nothing?

CTES. No, not I.

SYRUS. So much the worse.—Have you no client, friend,
Or guest?

CTES. I have. What then?

SYRUS. You've been engag'd
With them.

CTES. When not engag'd? It can not be.

SYRUS. It may.

CTES. Aye, marry, for the day I grant you.
But if I pass the night here, what excuse
Then, Syrus?

SYRUS. Ah! I would it were the custom
To be engag'd at night too with one's friends!
—But be at ease! I know his mind so well,
That when he raves the loudest, I can make him
As gentle as a lamb.

CTES. How so?

SYRUS. He loves

To hear you prais'd. I sing your praises to him,
And make you out a little God.

CTES. Me!

SYRUS. You.
And then the old man blubbers like a child,
For very joy.—But have a care! (*Looking out.*)

CTES. What now?

SYRUS. The wolf i' th' fable!

CTES. What, my father?

SYRUS. He.

CTES. What's the best, Syrus?

SYRUS. In! fly! I'll take care.

CTES. You have not seen me, if he asks: d'ye hear?

SYRUS. Can't you be quiet? (*Pushes out CTESIPHO.*)

SCENE II.

Enter DEMEA at another part of the stage.

DEM. Verily I am
A most unhappy man! for first of all,
I can not find my brother any where:
And then besides, in looking after him,
I chanc'd on one of my day laborers,
Who had but newly left my farm, and told me
Ctesipho was not there. What shall I do?

CTES. (*peeping out.*) Syrus? } (*Apart.*)

SYRUS. What? }

CTES. Does he seek me? }

SYRUS. Yes. }

CTES. Undone!

SYRUS. Courage!

DEM. (*to himself*). Plague on it, what ill luck is this?

I can't account for it: but I believe

That I was born for nothing but misfortunes.

I am the first who feels our woes; the first

Who knows of them; the first who tells the news:

And come what may, I bear the weight alone.

SYRUS (*behind*). Ridiculous! he says he knows all first;

And he alone is ignorant of all.

DEM. I'm now return'd to see if Micio

Be yet come home again.

CTES. (*peeping out*). Take care, good Syrus,
He don't rush in upon us unawares!

SYRUS. Peace! I'll take care.

CTES. 'Faith, I'll not trust to you,
But shut myself and her in some by-place
Together: that's the safest.

SYRUS. Well, away! (*CTESIPHO disappears.*)
I'll drive the old man hence, I warrant you.

(*Apart.*)

DEM. (*seeing SYRUS*). But see that rascal Syrus coming hither!

SYRUS (*advancing hastily, and pretending not to see DEMEA*).

By Hercules, there is no living here,

For any one, at this rate.—I'd fain know

How many masters I'm to have.—Oh monstrous!

DEM. What does he howl for? what's the meaning on't?

Hark ye, my good Sir! prithee tell me if

My brother be at home.

SYRUS. *My good Sir!* Plague!

Why do you come with your *good Sirs* to me?

I'm half-kill'd.

DEM. What's the matter?

SYRUS. What's the matter!

Ctesipho, vengeance on him, fell upon me,
And cudgel'd me and the poor Music-Girl
Almost to death.

DEM. Indeed?

SYRUS. Indeed. Nay see
How he has cut my lip. (*Pretending to show it.*)

DEM. On what account?

SYRUS. The girl, he says, was bought by my advice.

DEM. Did not you say you saw him out of town
A little while ago?

SYRUS. And so I did.
But he came back soon after, like a madman.
He had no mercy.—Was not he asham'd
To beat a poor old fellow? to beat me;
Who bore him in my arms but t'other day,
An urchin thus high? (*Showing.*)

DEM. Oh rare, Ctesipho!
Father's own son! a man, I warrant him.

SYRUS. Oh rare, d'ye cry? I' faith, if he is wise,
He'll hold his hands another time.

DEM. Oh brave!

SYRUS. Oh mighty brave, indeed!—Because he beat
A helpless girl, and me a wretched slave,
Who durst not strike again;—oh, to be sure,
Mighty brave, truly!

DEM. Oh, most exquisite!
My Ctesipho perceived, as well as I,
That you was the contriver of this business.
—But is my brother here?

SYRUS. Not he. (*Sulkily.*)

DEM. I'm thinking
Where I shall seek him.

SYRUS. I know where he is:
But I'll not tell.

DEM. How, Sirrah?

SYRUS. Even so.

DEM. I'll break your head.

SYRUS. I can not tell the name
Of him he's gone to, but I know the place.

DEM. Well, where's the place?

SYRUS. D'ye know the Portico
Just by the market, down this way? (*Pointing.*)

DEM. I do.

SYRUS. Go up that street; keep straight
along: and then
You'll see a hill; go straight down that: and
then
On this hand, there's a chapel; and just by
A narrow lane. (*Pointing.*)

SYRUS. Go straight along that street: and at the
end

DEM. Where? (*Looking.*)

SYRUS. There; by the great wild fig-tree.
D'ye know it, Sir?

DEM. I do.

SYRUS. Go through that lane.

DEM. That lane's no thoroughfare.

SYRUS. Aye, very true:
No more it is, Sir.—What a fool I am!
I was mistaken—You must go quite back
Into the portico; and after all,

This is the nearest and the safest way.
—D’ye know Cratinus’ house? the rich man?

DEM. Aye.

SYRUS. When you’ve pass’d that, turn short upon the left.
Keep straight along that street, and when you reach
Diana’s Temple, turn upon the right.
And then, on this side of the city gate,
Just by the pond, there is a baker’s shop,
And opposite a joiner’s.—There he is.

DEM. What business has he there?

SYRUS. He has bespoke
Some tables to be made with oaken legs
To stand the sun.

DEM. For you to drink upon.
Oh brave! But I lose time. I’ll after him.

(*Exit hastily.*

SCENE III.

SYRUS *alone.*

Aye, go your ways! I’ll work your old shrunk shanks
As you deserve, old Drybones!—Æschinus
Loiters intolerably. Dinner’s spoil’d.
Ctesipho thinks of nothing but his girl.
’Tis time for me to look to myself too.
Faith, then I’ll in immediately; pick out
All the tid-bits, and tossing off my cups,
In lazy leisure lengthen out the day.

(*Exit.*

SCENE IV.

Enter MICIO and HEGIO.

MICIO. I can see nothing in this matter, Hegio,
Wherein I merit so much commendation.
'Tis but my duty, to redress the wrongs
That we have caus'd: unless perhaps you took me
For one of those who, having injur'd you,
Term fair expostulation an affront;
And having first offended, are the first
To turn accusers.—I've not acted thus:
And is't for this that I am thank'd?

HEGIO. Ah, no;
I never thought you other than you are.
But let me beg you, Micio, go with me
To the young woman's mother, and repeat
Yourself to her what you have just told me:
—That the suspicion, fall'n on Æschinus,
Sprung from his brother and the Music-Girl.

MICIO. If you believe I ought, or think it needful,
Let's go!

HEGIO. 'Tis very kind in you: for thus
You'll raise her spirit drooping with the load
Of grief and misery, and have perform'd
Ev'ry good office of benevolence.
But if you like it not, I'll go myself,
And tell her the whole story.

MICIO. No, I'll go.

HEGIO. 'Tis good and tender in your nature, Micio.
For they, whose fortunes are less prosperous,
Are all I know not how, the more suspicious;
And think themselves neglected and contemn'd,
Because of their distress and poverty.
Wherefore I think 'twould satisfy them more
If you would clear up this affair yourself.

MICIO. What you have said is just, and very true.

HEGIO. Let me conduct you in!

MICIO. With all my heart.

(*Exeunt.*)

SCENE V.

ÆSCHINUS *alone.*

Oh torture to my mind! that this misfortune
Should come thus unexpectedly upon me!
I know not what to do, which way to turn.
Fear shakes my limbs, amazement fills my soul,
And in my breast despair shuts out all counsel.
Ah, by what means can I acquit myself?
Such a suspicion is now fallen on me;
And that too grounded on appearances.
Sostrata thinks that on my own account
I bought the Music-Girl. That's plain enough
From the old nurse. For meeting her by chance,
As she was sent from hence to call a midwife,
I ran, and ask'd her of my Pamphila.
—"Is she in labor? are you going now
To call a midwife?"—"Go, go, Æschinus!
Away, you have deceiv'd us long enough,
Fool'd us enough with your fine promises,"
Cried she.—"What now?" says I.—"Farewell, enjoy
The girl that you're so taken with!"—I saw
Immediately their cause of jealousy:
Yet I contain'd myself, nor would disclose
My brother's business to a tattling gossip,
By whom the knowledge on't might be betray'd.
—But what shall I do now? shall I confess
The girl to be my brother's; an affair
Which should by no means be reveal'd?—But not
To dwell on that.—Perhaps they'd not disclose it.
Nay, I much doubt if they would credit it:

So many proofs concur against myself.—
I bore her off: I paid the money down;
She was brought home to me.—All this, I own,
Is my own fault. For should I not have told
My father, be it as it might, the whole?
I should, I doubt not, have obtain'd his leave
To marry Pamphila.—What indolence,
Ev'n, till this hour! now, Æschinus, awake!
—But first I'll go and clear myself to them.
I'll to the door. (*Goes up.*) Confusion! how I tremble!
How guilty like I seem when I approach
This house! (*Knocks.*) Holloa! within! 'Tis I;
'Tis Æschinus. Come, open somebody
The door immediately!—Who's here? A stranger!
I'll step aside. (*Retires.*)

SCENE VI.

Enter MICIO.

MICIO (*to SOSTRATA, within*). Do as I have told you, Sostrata.
I'll find out Æschinus, and tell him all.
—But who knock'd at the door? (*Coming forward.*)

ÆSCH. (*behind*). By Heav'n, my father!
Confusion!

MICIO (*seeing him*). Æschinus!

ÆSCH. What does he here? (*Aside.*)

MICIO. Was't you that knock'd? What, not a word! Suppose
I banter him a little. He deserves it,
For never trusting this affair to me. (*Aside.*)
—Why don't you speak?

ÆSCH. Not I, as I remember. (*Disordered.*)

MICIO. No, I dare say, not you: for I was wond'ring
What business could have brought you here.—He blushes.

All's safe, I find. (*Aside.*)

ÆSCH. (*recovering.*) But prithee, tell me, Sir,
What brought you here?

MICIO. No business of my own.
But a friend drew me hither from the Forum,
To be his advocate.

ÆSCH. In what?

MICIO. I'll tell you.
This house is tenanted by some poor women,
Whom, I believe, you know not;—Nay, I'm sure on't,
For 'twas but lately they came over hither.

ÆSCH. Well?

MICIO. A young woman and her mother.

ÆSCH. Well?

MICIO. The father's dead.—This friend of mine, it seems,
Being her next relation, by the law
Is forc'd to marry her.

ÆSCH. Confusion! (*Aside.*)

MICIO. How?

ÆSCH. Nothing.—Well?—pray go on, Sir!——

MICIO. He's now come
To take her home, for he is of Miletus.

ÆSCH. How! take her home with him?

MICIO. Yes, take her home.

ÆSCH. What, to Miletus?

MICIO. Aye.

ÆSCH. Oh torture! (*Aside.*)— Well?
What say the women?

MICIO. Why, what should they? Nothing.

Indeed the mother has devis'd a tale
About her daughter's having had a child
By some one else, but never mentions whom:
His claim, she says, is prior; and my friend
Ought not to have her.

ÆSCH. Well? and did not this
Seem a sufficient reason?

MICIO. No.

ÆSCH. No, Sir?
And shall this next relation take her off?

MICIO. Aye, to be sure: why not?

ÆSCH. Oh barbarous, cruel!
And to speak plainly, Sir—ungenerous!

MICIO. Why so?

ÆSCH. Why so, Sir?—What d'ye think
Will come of him, the poor unhappy youth
Who was connected with her first—who still
Loves her, perhaps, as dearly as his life;—
When he shall see her torn out of his arms,
And borne away forever?—Oh shame, shame!

MICIO. Where is the shame on't?—Who betroth'd, who gave her?
When was she married? and to whom? Where is he,
And wherefore did he wed another's right?

ÆSCH. Was it for her, a girl of such an age,
To sit at home, expecting till a kinsman
Came, nobody knows whence, to marry her?
—This, Sir, it was your business to have said,
And to have dwelt on it.

MICIO. Ridiculous!
Should I have pleaded against him to whom
I came an advocate?—But after all,
What's this affair to us? or, what have we
To do with them? let's go!—Ha! why those tears?

ÆSCH. Father, beseech you, hear me!

MICIO. Æschinus,
I have heard all, and I know all, already:
For I do love you; wherefore all your actions
Touch me the more.

ÆSCH. So may you ever love me,
And so may I deserve your love, my father,
As I am sorry to have done this fault,
And am ashamed to see you!

MICIO. I believe it;
For well I know you have a liberal mind:
But I'm afraid you are too negligent,
For in what city do you think you live?
You have abus'd a virgin, whom the law
Forbade your touching.—'Twas a fault, a great one;
But yet a natural failing. Many others,
Some not bad men, have often done the same.
—But after this event, can you pretend
You took the least precaution? or consider'd
What should be done, or how?—If shame forbade
Your telling me yourself, you should have found
Some other means to let me know of it.
Lost in these doubts, ten months have slipp'd away.
You have betray'd, as far as in you lay,
Yourself, the poor young woman, and your child.
What! did you think the Gods would bring about
This business in your sleep; and that your wife,
Without your stir, would be convey'd to you
Into your bed-chamber?—I would not have you
Thus negligent in other matters.—Come,
Cheer up, son! you shall wed her.

ÆSCH. How!

MICIO. Cheer up,
I say!

ÆSCH. Nay, prithee, do not mock me, father!

MICIO. Mock you? I? wherefore?

ÆSCH. I don't know; unless
That I so much desire it may be true,
I therefore fear it more.

MICIO. —Away; go home;
And pray the Gods, that you may call your wife
Away!

ÆSCH. How's that? my wife? what! now?

MICIO. Now.

ÆSCH. Now?

MICIO. Ev'n now, as soon as possible.

ÆSCH. May all
The Gods desert me, Sir, but I do love you,
More than my eyes!...

MICIO. Than her?

ÆSCH. As well.

MICIO. That's much.

ÆSCH. But where is that Milesian?

MICIO. Gone:
Vanish'd: on board the ship.—But why d'ye loiter?

ÆSCH. Ah, Sir, you rather go, and pray the Gods;
For, being a much better man than I,
They will the sooner hear your pray'rs.

MICIO. I'll in,
To see the needful preparations made.
You, if you're wise, do as I said.

(Exit.

SCENE VII.

ÆSCHINUS *alone.*

How's this?
Is this to be a father? Or is this
To be a son?—Were he my friend or
 brother,
Could he be more complacent to my wish?
Should I not love him? bear him in my
 bosom!
Ah! his great kindness has so wrought
 upon me,
That it shall be the study of my life
To shun all follies, lest they give him pain.
—But I'll in straight, that I may not retard
My marriage by my own delay.

But wherefore do I loiter here, and thus
Retard my marriage by my own delay?

(*Exit.*

SCENE VIII.

DEMEA *alone.*

I'm tir'd
With walking.—Now great Jove confound
 you, Syrus;
You and your blind directions! I have
 crawl'd
All the town over: to the gate; the pond;
Where not? No sign of any shop was there,
Nor any person who had seen my brother.
—Now I'll in, therefore, and set up my rest
In his own house, till he comes home
 again. (*Going.*

I've walk'd, and walk'd, till I'm quite tir'd wi
 walking.
—Almighty Jove confound you, Syrus, I say;

SCENE IX.

Enter MICIO.

MICIO. I'll go and let the women know we're ready.

DEM. But here he is.—I have long sought you, Micio.

MICIO. What now?

DEM. I bring you more offenses: great ones;
Of that sweet youth——

MICIO. See there!

DEM. New; capital!

MICIO. Nay, nay, no more!

DEM. Ah, you don't know——

MICIO. I do.

DEM. O fool, you think I mean the Music-Girl.
This is a rape upon a citizen.

MICIO. I know it.

DEM. How? d'ye know it, and endure it?

MICIO. Why not endure it?

DEM. Tell me, don't you rave?
Don't you go mad?

MICIO. No: to be sure I'd rather——

DEM. There's a child born.

MICIO. Heav'n bless it!

DEM. And the girl
Has nothing.

MICIO. I have heard so.

DEM. And is he

To marry her without a fortune?

MICIO. Aye.

DEM. What's to be done then?

MICIO. What the case requires.
The girl shall be brought over here.

DEM. Oh Jove!
Can that be proper?

MICIO. What can I do else?

DEM. What can you do!—If you're not really griev'd,
It were at least your duty to appear so.

MICIO. I have contracted the young woman to him:
The thing is settled: 'tis their wedding-day:
And all their apprehensions I've remov'd.
This is still more my duty.

DEM. Are you pleas'd then
With this adventure, Micio?

MICIO. Not at all,
If I could help it: now 'tis past all cure,
I bear it patiently. The life of man
Is like a game at tables. If the cast
Which is most necessary be not thrown,
That which chance sends you must correct by art.

DEM. Oh rare *Corrector!*—By your *art* no less
Than twenty minæ have been thrown away
On yonder Music-wench; who out of hand,
Must be sent packing; if no buyer, gratis.

MICIO. Not in the least; nor do I mean to sell her.

DEM. What will you do, then?

MICIO. Keep her in my house.

DEM. Oh Heav'n and earth! a harlot and a wife
In the same house!

MICIO. Why not?

DEM. Have you your wits?

MICIO. Truly I think so.

DEM. Now, so help me Heav'n,
Seeing your folly, I believe you keep her
To sing with you.

MICIO. Why not?

DEM. And the young bride
Shall be her pupil?

MICIO. To be sure.

DEM. And you
Dance hand in hand with them?

MICIO. Aye.

DEM. Aye?

MICIO. And you
Make one among us too upon occasion.

DEM. Ah! are you not ashamed on't?

MICIO. Patience, Demea!
Lay by your wrath, and seem, as it
becomes you,
Cheerful and free of heart at your son's
wedding.

—I'll but speak with the bride and
Sostrata,
And then return to you immediately.

—I'll go and warn the bride and Sostrata,

(Exit.

SCENE X.

DEMEA *alone.*

Jove, what a life! what manners! what distraction!
A bride just coming home without a portion;
A Music-Girl already there in keeping;
A house of waste; the youth a libertine;
Th' old man a dotard!—'Tis not in the pow'r
Of Providence herself, howe'er desirous,
To save from ruin such a family.

SCENE XI.

Enter at a distance SYRUS, drunk.

SYRUS. (*to himself*). Faith, little Syrus, you've ta'en special care
Of your sweet self, and play'd your part most rarely.
—Well, go your ways:—but having had my fill
Of ev'ry thing within, I've now march'd forth
To take a turn or two abroad.

DEM. (*behind*). Look there!
A pattern of instruction!

SYRUS. (*seeing him*). But see there:
Yonder's old Demea. (*Going up to him.*) What's the matter now?
And why so melancholy?

DEM. Oh thou villain!

SYRUS. What! are you spouting sentences, old wisdom?

DEM. Were you my servant——

SYRUS. You'd be plaguy rich,
And settle your affairs most wonderfully.

DEM. I'd make you an example.

SYRUS. Why? for what?

DEM. Why, Sirrah?—In the midst of the disturbance,
And in the heat of a most heavy crime,
While all is yet confusion, you've got drunk,
As if for joy, you rascal!

SYRUS. Why the plague
Did not I keep within? (*Aside.*)

SCENE XII.

Enter DROMO, hastily.

DROMO. Here! hark ye, Syrus!
Ctesipho begs that you'd come back.

SYRUS. Away! (*Pushes him off.*)

DEM. What's this he says of Ctesipho?

SYRUS. Pshaw! nothing.

DEM. How! dog, is Ctesipho within?

SYRUS. Not he.

DEM. Why does he name him then?

SYRUS. It is another.
Of the same name—a little parasite——
D'ye know him?

DEM. But I will immediately. (*Going.*)

SYRUS. (*stopping him*). What now? where now?

DEM. Let me alone. } *Struggling.*

SYRUS. Don't go!

DEM. Hands off! what won't you? must I brain you, rascal?

(*Disengages himself from SYRUS, and Exit.*

SCENE XIII.

SYRUS *alone.*

He's gone—gone in—and faith no welcome roarer——
—Especially to Ctesipho.—But what

Can I do now; unless, till this blows over,
I sneak into some corner, and sleep off
This wine that lies upon my head?—I'll do't.

(*Exit reeling.*

SCENE XIV.

Enter MICIO from SOSTRATA.

MICIO. (*to SOSTRATA within.*)

All is prepar'd: and we are ready, Sostrata,
As I have already told you, when you please. (*Comes forward.*)
But who's this forces open our street door
With so much violence?

(*Enter DEMEA on t'other side.*)

DEM. Confusion! death!
What shall I do? or how resolve? where vent
My cries and exclamations? Heav'n! Earth! Sea!

MICIO (*behind.*) So! all's discover'd: that's the thing he raves at.
—Now for a quarrel!—I must help the boy.

DEM. (*seeing him.*) Oh, there's the grand corrupter of our children!

MICIO. Appease your wrath, and be yourself again!

DEM. Well, I've appeas'd it; I'm myself again;
I spare reproaches; let us to the point!
It was agreed between us, and it was
Your own proposal too, that you should never
Concern yourself with Ctesipho, nor I
With Æschinus. Say, was't not so?

MICIO. It was.
I don't deny it.

DEM. Why does Ctesipho
Revel with you then? Why do you receive him?
Buy him a mistress, Micio?—Is not justice

My due from you, as well as yours from me?
Since I do not concern myself with yours,
Meddle not you with mine!

MICIO. This is not fair;
Indeed it is not. Think on the old saying,
“All things are common among friends.”

DEM. How smart!
Put off with quips and sentences at last!

MICIO. Nay, hear me, if you can have patience, Demea.
—First, if you’re griev’d at their extravagance,
Let this reflection calm you! Formerly,
You bred them both according to your fortune,
Supposing it sufficient for them both:
Then too you thought that I should take a wife.
Still follow the old rule you then laid down:
Hoard, scrape, and save; do ev’ry thing you can
To leave them nobly! Be that glory yours.
My fortune, fall’n beyond their hopes upon them,
Let them use freely! As your capital
Will not be wasted, what addition comes
From mine, consider as clear gain: and thus,
Weighing all this impartially, you’ll spare
Yourself, and me, and them, a world of trouble.

DEM. Money is not the thing: their morals

MICIO. Hold!
I understand; and meant to speak of that.
There are in nature sundry marks, good
Demea,

By which you may conjecture easily,
That when two persons do the self-same
thing,

It oftentimes falls out that in the one
’Tis criminal, in t’other ’tis not so:
Not that the thing itself is different,

By which you may conjecture of men’s minds
And when two persons do the self-same thing,
May oftentimes pronounce, that in the one
’Tis dangerous, in t’other ’tis not so:

But he who does it.—In these youths I see
The marks of virtue; and, I trust, they'll
 prove
Such as we wish them. They have sense, I
 know;
Attention; in its season, liberal shame;
And fondness for each other; all sure signs
Of an ingenuous mind and noble nature:
And though they stray, you may at any
 time
Reclaim them.—But perhaps you fear
 they'll prove
Too inattentive to their interest.
Oh my dear Demea, in all matters else
Increase of years increases wisdom in us:
This only vice age brings along with it;
“We're all more worldly-minded than
 there's need:”
Which passion age, that kills all passions
 else,
Will ripen in your sons too.

DEM. Have a care
That these fine arguments and this great mildness
Don't prove the ruin of us, Micio.

MICIO. Peace!
It shall not be: away with all your fears!
This day be rul'd by me: come, smooth your brow.

DEM. Well, since at present things are so, I must,
But then I'll to the country with my son
To-morrow, at first peep of day.

MICIO. At midnight,
So you'll but smile to-day.

DEM. And that wench too
I'll drag away with me.

MICIO. Aye; there you've hit it.
For by that means you'll keep your son at home;
Do but secure her.

DEM. I'll see that: for there
I'll put her in the kitchen and the mill,
And make her full of ashes, smoke, and meal:
Nay at high noon too she shall gather stubble.
I'll burn her up, and make her black as coal.

MICIO. Right! now you're wise.—And then I'd make my son
Go to bed to her, though against his will.

DEM. D'ye laugh at me? how happy in your temper!
I feel——

MICIO. Ah! that again?

DEM. I've done.

MICIO. In then!
And let us suit our humor to the time.

(Exeunt.

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.

DEMEA *alone.*

Never did man lay down so fair a plan,
So wise a rule of life, but fortune, age,
Or long experience made some change in it;

And taught him that those things he thought he knew
He did not know, and what he held as best,
In practice he threw by. The very thing
That happens to myself. For that hard life
Which I have ever led, my race near run,
Now in the last stage, I renounce: and why?
But that by dear experience I've been told,
There's nothing so advantages a man
As mildness and complacency. Of this
My brother and myself are living proofs:
He always led an easy, cheerful life;
Good-humor'd, mild, offending nobody,
Smiling on all; a jovial bachelor,
His whole expenses centred in himself.
I, on the contrary, rough, rigid, cross,
Saving, morose, and thrifty, took a wife:
—What miseries did marriage bring!—had children;
—A new uneasiness!—and then besides,
Striving all ways to make a fortune for them,
I have worn out my prime of life and health:
And now, my course near finish'd, what return
Do I receive for all my toil? Their hate.
Meanwhile my brother, without any care,
Reaps all a father's comforts. Him they love,
Me they avoid: to him they open all
Their secret counsels; doat on him; and both
Repair to him; while I am quite forsaken.
His life they pray for, but expect my death.
Thus those, brought up by my exceeding labor,
He, at a small expense, has made his own:
The care all mine, and all the pleasure his.
—Well then, let me endeavor in my turn
To teach my tongue civility, to give
With open-handed generosity,
Since I am challeng'd to't!—and let me too
Obtain the love and reverence of my children!
And if 'tis bought by bounty and indulgence,

I will not be behind-hand.—Cash will fail:
What's that to me, who am the eldest born?

SCENE II.

Enter SYRUS.

SYRUS. Oh Sir! your brother has dispatch'd me to you
To beg you'd not go further off.

DEM. Who's there?——
What, honest Syrus! save you: how is't with you?
How goes it?

SYRUS. Very well, Sir.

DEM. (*aside.*) Excellent!
Now for the first time, I, against my nature,
Have added these three phrases, "Honest Syrus!——
How is't?—How goes it?"— (*To SYRUS.*) You have prov'd yourself
A worthy servant. I'll reward you for it.

SYRUS. I thank you, Sir.

DEM. I will, I promise you;
And you shall be convinc'd on't very soon.

SCENE III.

Enter GETA.

GETA (*to SOSTRATA within*). Madam, I'm going to look after them,
That they may call the bride immediately.
—But here is Demea. Save you!

DEM. Oh! your name?

GETA. Geta, Sir.

DEM. Geta, I this day have found you
To be a fellow of uncommon worth:

For sure that servant's faith is well approv'd
Who holds his master's interest at heart,
As I perceiv'd that you did, Geta! wherefore,
Soon as occasion offers, I'll reward you.
—I am endeavoring to be affable,
And not without success. (*Aside.*)

GETA. 'Tis kind in you
To think of your poor slave, Sir.

DEM. (*aside.*) First of all
I court the mob, and win them by degrees.

SCENE IV.

Enter ÆSCHINUS.

ÆSCH. They murder me with their delays; and while
They lavish all this pomp upon the nuptials,
They waste the livelong day in preparation.

DEM. How does my son?

ÆSCH. My father! are you here?

DEM. Aye, by affection, and by blood your father,
Who love you better than my eyes.—But why
Do you not call the bride?

ÆSCH. 'Tis what I long for:
But wait the music and the singers.

DEM. Pshaw!
Will you for once be rul'd by an old fellow?

ÆSCH. Well?

DEM. Ne'er mind singers, company, lights, music;
But tell them to throw down the garden-wall,
As soon as possible. Convey the bride
That way, and lay both houses into one.
Bring too the mother, and whole family,

Over to us.

ÆSCH. I will. O charming father!

DEM. (*aside*). *Charming!* See there! he calls me *charming* now.

—My brother's house will be a thoroughfare;

Throng'd with whole crowds of people; much expense

Will follow; very much: what's that to me?

I am call'd *charming*, and get into favor.

—Ho! order Babylo immediately

To pay him twenty minæ.—Prithee, Syrus,

Why don't you execute your orders?

SYRUS. What?

DEM. Down with the wall!— (*Exit* SYRUS.) You, Geta, go and bring
The ladies over.

GETA. Heaven bless you, Demea,
For all your friendship to our family!

(*Exit* GETA.

DEM. They're worthy of it.—What say you to this?

(*To* ÆSCHINUS.)

ÆSCH. I think it admirable.

DEM. 'Tis much better
Than for a poor soul, sick, and lying-in,
To be conducted through the street.

ÆSCH. I never
Saw any thing concerted better, Sir.

DEM. 'Tis just my way.—But here comes Micio.

SCENE V.

Enter MICIO.

MICIO (*at entering*.) My brother order it, d'ye say? where is he?
—Was this your order, Demea?

DEM. 'Twas my order:
And by this means, and every other way,
I would unite, serve, cherish, and oblige,
And join the family to ours!

ÆSCH. Pray do, Sir! (*To MICIO.*)

MICIO. I don't oppose it.

DEM. Nay, but 'tis our duty.
First, there's the mother of the bride——

MICIO. What then?

DEM. Worthy and modest.

MICIO. So they say.

DEM. In years.

MICIO. True.

DEM. And so far advanc'd, that she is long
Past child-bearing, a poor lone woman too,
With none to comfort her.

MICIO. What means all this?

DEM. This woman 'tis your place to marry, brother;
—And yours (*to ÆSCHINUS*) to bring him to't.

MICIO. I marry her?

DEM. You.

MICIO. I?

DEM. Yes, you I say.

MICIO. Ridiculous!

DEM. (*to ÆSCHINUS*). If you're a man, he'll do't.

ÆSCH. (*to MICIO*). Dear father!

MICIO. How!
Do you then join him, fool?

DEM. Nay, don't deny.

It can't be otherwise.

MICIO. You've lost your senses!

ÆSCH. Let me prevail upon you, Sir!

MICIO. You're mad.

Away!

DEM. Oblige your son.

MICIO. Have you your wits?

I a new married man at sixty-five!

And marry a decrepit poor old woman!

Is that what you advise me!

ÆSCH. Do it, Sir!

I've promis'd them.

MICIO. You've promis'd them, indeed!

Prithee, boy, promise for yourself.

DEM. Come, come!

What if he ask'd still more of you?

MICIO. As if

This was not ev'n the utmost.

DEM. Nay, comply!

ÆSCH. Be not obdurate!

DEM. Come, come, promise him.

MICIO. Won't you desist?

ÆSCH. No, not till I prevail.

MICIO. This is mere force.

DEM. Nay, nay, comply, good Micio!

MICIO. Though this appears to me absurd, wrong, foolish,

And quite repugnant to my scheme of life,

Yet, if you're so much bent on't, let it be!

ÆSCH. Obliging father, worthy my best love!

DEM. (*aside*). What now?—This answers to my wish.—What more?
—Hegio's their kinsman (*to MICIO*), our relation too,
And very poor. We should do him some service.

MICIO. Do what?

DEM. There is a little piece of ground,
Which you let out near town. Let's give it
him
To live upon.

MICIO. So little, do you call it?

DEM. Well, if 'tis large, let's give it. He has
been
Father to her; a good man; our relation.
It will be given worthily. In short,
That saying, Micio, I now make my own,
Which you so lately and so wisely quoted;
"It is the common failing of old men
To be too much intent on worldly matters."
Let us wipe off that stain. The saying's
true,
And should be practic'd.

DEM. Well, if 'tis large, let's give it. He has be
A father to the bride; a worthy man;
Our kinsman too. It will be well bestow'd.
In short, that saying I now make my own,
Which you but now so wisely quoted, Micio;
"It is the common failing of old men
To be too much intent on worldly matters."
Let us wipe off that stain. The saying's true,
And worthy notice.

MICIO. Well, well; be it so,
If he requires it. (*Pointing to ÆSCHINUS.*)

ÆSCH. I beseech it, father.

DEM. Now you're indeed my brother, soul and body.

MICIO. I'm glad to find you think me so.

DEM. I foil him
At his own weapons. (*Aside.*)

SCENE VI.

To them SYRUS.

SYRUS. I have executed

Your orders, Demea.

DEM. A good fellow!——Truly
Syrus, I think, should be made free to-day.

MICIO. Made free! He!——Wherefore?

DEM. Oh, for many reasons.

SYRUS. Oh Demea, you're a noble gentleman.
I've taken care of both your sons from boys;
Taught them, instructed them, and given them
The wholesomest advice that I was able.

DEM. The thing's apparent: and these offices,
To cater;—bring a wench in, safe and snug;
—Or in mid-day prepare an entertainment;——
All these are talents of no common man.

SYRUS. Oh most delightful gentleman!

DEM. Besides,
He has been instrumental too this day
In purchasing the Music-Girl. He manag'd
The whole affair. We should reward him for it.
It will encourage others.—In a word,
Your Æschinus would have it so.

MICIO. Do you
Desire it?

ÆSCH. Yes, Sir.

MICIO. Well, if you desire it——
Come hither, Syrus!—Be thou free! (SYRUS *kneels*; MICIO *strikes him, being
the ceremony of manumission, or giving a slave his freedom.*)

SYRUS. I thank you:
Thanks to you all; but most of all, to Demea!

DEM. I'm glad of your good fortune.

ÆSCH. So am I.

SYRUS. I do believe it; and I wish this joy

Were quite complete, and I might see my wife,
My Phrygia too, made free, as well as I.

DEM. The very best of women!

SYRUS. And the first
That suckled my young master's son, your grandson.

DEM. Indeed! the first who suckled him!—Nay then,
Beyond all doubt, she should be free.

MICIO. For what?

DEM. For that. Nay, take the sum, whate'er it be,
Of me.

SYRUS. Now all the powers above grant all
Your wishes, Demea!

MICIO. You have thriv'd to-day
Most rarely, Syrus.

DEM. And besides this, Micio,
It would be handsome to advance him something
To try his fortune with. He'll soon return it.

MICIO. Not that. (*Snapping his fingers.*)

ÆSCH. He's honest.

SYRUS. Faith I will return it.
Do but advance it.

ÆSCH. Do, Sir!

MICIO. Well, I'll think on't.

DEM. I'll see that he shall do't. (*To SYRUS.*)

SYRUS. Thou best of men!

ÆSCH. My most indulgent father!

MICIO. What means this?
Whence comes this hasty change of manners, brother?
Whence flows all this extravagance? and whence
This sudden prodigality?

DEM. I'll tell you:

To show you, that the reason why our sons
Think you so pleasant and agreeable,
Is not from your deserts, or truth, or justice,
But your compliance, bounty, and indulgence.
—Now, therefore, if I'm odious to you, son,
Because I'm not subservient to your humor
In all things, right or wrong; away with care!
Spend, squander, and do what you will!—but if,
In those affairs where youth has made you blind,
Eager, and thoughtless, you will suffer me
To counsel and correct—and in due season
Indulge you—I am at your service.

ÆSCH. Father,
In all things we submit ourselves to you.
What's fit and proper, you know best.—But what
Shall come of my poor brother?

DEM. I consent
That he shall have her: let him finish there.

ÆSCH. All now is as it should be.— (*To the audience.*) Clap your hands!



THE STEP-MOTHER.

PERSONS REPRESENTED.

PROLOGUE.

LACHES.

PHIDIPPUS.

PAMPHILUS.

PARMENO.

SOSIA.

BOY, *and other Servants.*

SOSTRATA.

MYRRHINA.

BACCHIS.

PHILOTIS.

SYRA.

NURSE, *Servants to Bacchis, etc.*

SCENE, ATHENS.

The word “stepmother” in place of “mother-in-law” is an anomalous English usage, not a mistranslation.

PROLOGUE.

THIS play is call'd the STEP-MOTHER. When first
It was presented, such a hurricane,
A tumult so uncommon interven'd,
It neither could be seen nor understood:
So taken were the people, so engag'd
By a rope-dancer!—It is now brought on
As a new piece: and he who wrote the play
Suffer'd it not to be repeated then,
That he might profit by a second sale.
Others, his plays, you have already known;
Now then, let me beseech you, know this too.

ANOTHER PROLOGUE.

I COME a pleader, in the shape of prologue:
Let me then gain my cause, and now grown old.
Experience the same favor as when young;
Who then recover'd many a lost play,
Breath'd a new life into the scenes, and sav'd
The author and his writings from oblivion.
Of those which first I studied of Cæcilius,
In some I was excluded; and in some
Hardly maintain'd my ground. But knowing well
The variable fortunes of the scene,
I was content to hazard certain toil
For an uncertain gain. I undertook
To rescue those same plays from condemnation,
And labor'd to reverse your sentence on them;
That the same Poet might afford me more,
And no ill fortune damp young Genius in him.
My cares prevail'd; the plays were heard; and thus
Did I restore an Author, nearly lost
Through the malevolence of adversaries,
To study, labor, and the Poet's art.
But had I at that time despis'd his plays,
Or labor'd to deter him from the task,
It had been easy to have kept him idle,
And to have scar'd him from attempting more:
For my sake, therefore, deign to hear with candor
The suit I mean to offer to you now.

Once more I bring the STEP-MOTHER before you,
Which yet in silence I might never play;
So did confusion crush it: which confusion
Your prudence may allay, if it will deign
To second our endeavors.—When I first
Began to play this piece, the sturdy Boxers,
(The dancers on the rope expected too,)

Th' increasing crowds, the noise and women's clamor,
Oblig'd me to retire before my time.
I, upon this occasion, had recourse
To my old way. I brought it on again.
In the first act I please: meanwhile there spreads
A rumor of the Gladiators: then
The people flock together, riot, roar,
And fight for places. I meanwhile *my* place
Could not maintain—To-day there's no disturbance;
All's silence and attention; a clear stage:
'Tis yours to give these games their proper grace.
Let not, oh let not the Dramatic Art
Fall to a few! let your authority
Assist and second mine! if I for gain
Ne'er overrated my abilities,
If I have made it still my only care
To be obedient to your will, oh grant
That he who hath committed his performance
To my defense, and who hath thrown himself
On your protection, be not giv'n to scorn,
And foul derision of his envious foes!

Admit this plea for my sake, and be silent;
That other Poets may not fear to write,
That I too may hereafter find it meet
To play new pieces bought at my expense.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.

PHILOTIS, SYRA.

PHI. Now, by my troth, a woman of the town
Scarce ever finds a faithful lover, Syra.
This very Pamphilus, how many times
He swore to Bacchis, swore so solemnly
One could not but believe him, that he never
Would, in her lifetime, marry. See! he's married.

SYRA. I warn you, therefore, and most earnestly
Conjure you, to have pity upon none.
But plunder, fleece, and beggar ev'ry man
That falls into your pow'r.

PHI. What! spare none?

SYRA. None.
For know, there is not one of all your sparks
But studies to cajole you with fine speeches,
And have his will as cheaply as he can.
Should not you, then, endeavor to fool them?

PHI. But to treat all alike is wrong.

SYRA. What! wrong?
To be reveng'd upon your enemies?
Or to snare those who spread their snares for you?
—Alas! why have not I your youth and beauty,
Or you my sentiments?

SCENE II.

Enter PARMENO.

PAR. (*to* SCRITUS *within*). If our old gentleman
Asks for me, tell him I'm this very moment
Gone to the Port to seek for Pamphilus.
D'ye understand my meaning, Scritus? If he asks,
Tell him that; if he should not ask, say nothing;
That this excuse may serve another time. (*Comes forward.*

—But is not that Philotis? Whence comes she?
Philotis, save you!

PHI. Save you, Parmeno!

SYRA. Save you, good Parmeno!

PAR. And save you, Syra!

—Tell me, Philotis, where have you been gadding?
Taking your pleasure this long time?

PHI. I've taken
No pleasure, Parmeno, indeed. I went
With a most brutal Captain hence to Corinth,
There have I led a wretched life with him
For two whole years.

PAR. Aye, aye, I warrant you
That you have often wish'd to be in Athens;
Often repented of your journey.

PHI. Oh,
'Tis quite impossible to tell how much
I long'd to be at home, how much I long'd
To leave the Captain, see you, revel with you,
After the good old fashion, free and easy.
For there I durst not speak a single word,
But what, and when the mighty Captain pleas'd.

PAR. 'Twas cruel in him thus to tie your tongue:
At least, I'll warrant, that you thought it so.

PHI. But what's this business, Parmeno? this story
That Bacchis has been telling me within?
I could not have believ'd that Pamphilus
Would in her lifetime marry.

PAR. Marry truly!

PHI. Why he is married: is not he?

PAR. He is.
But I'm afraid 'twill prove a crazy match,

And will not hold together long.

PHI. Heav'n grant it.
So it turn out to Bacchis's advantage!
But how can I believe this, Parmeno?
Tell me.

PAR. It is not fit it should be told.
Inquire no more.

PHI. For fear I should divulge it?
Now Heav'n so prosper me, as I inquire,
Not for the sake of telling it again,
But to rejoice within myself.

PAR. All these
Fair words, Philotis, sha'n't prevail on me
To trust my back to your discretion.

PAR. No, no:

PHI. Well;
Don't tell me, Parmeno.—As if you had not
Much rather tell this secret than I hear it.

PAR. She's in the right: I am a blab, 'tis true,
It is my greatest failing.—Give your word
You'll not reveal it, and I'll tell you.

PHI. Now
You're like yourself again. I give my word.
Speak.

PAR. Listen then.

PHI. I'm all ear.

PAR. Pamphilus
Doted on Bacchis still as much as ever,
When the old gentleman began to tease him
To marry, in the common cant of fathers;
—“That he was now grown old; and Pamphilus
His only child; and that he long'd for heirs,
As props of his old age.” At first my master
Withstood his instances, but as his father

Became more hot and urgent, Pamphilus
Began to waver in his mind, and felt
A conflict betwixt love and duty in him.
At length, by hammering on marriage still,
And daily instances, th' old man prevail'd,
And made a match with our next neighbor's daughter.
Pamphilus did not take it much to heart,
Till just upon the very brink of wedlock:
But when he saw the nuptial rites prepar'd,
And, without respite, he must marry; then
It came so home to him, that even Bacchis,
Had she been present, must have pitied him.
Whenever he could steal from company,
And talk to me alone,—“Oh Parmeno,
What have I done?” he'd cry.—“I'm lost forever.
Into what ruin have I plung'd myself!
I can not bear it, Parmeno. Ah wretch!
I am undone.”

PHI. Now all the powers of heav'n
Confound you, Laches, for thus teasing him?

PAR. In short, he marries, and brings home his wife.
The first night he ne'er touch'd her! nor the next.

PHI. How! he a youth, and she a maidenhead!
Tipsy, and never touch her! 'Tis not likely;
Nor do I think it can be true.

PAR. No wonder.
For they that come to you come all desire:
But he was bound to her against his will.

PHI. What followed upon this?

PAR. A few days after,
Pamphilus, taking me aside, informs me,
“That the maid still remain'd a maid for him;
That he had hop'd, before he brought her home,
He might have borne the marriage:—but resolving

Within myself not to retain her long,
I held it neither honesty in me,
Nor of advantage to the maid herself,
That I should throw her off to scorn:—but rather
Return her to her friends, as I receiv'd her,
Chaste and inviolate.”

PHI. A worthy youth,
And of great modesty!

PAR. “To make this public
Would not, I think, do well: and to return
her
Upon her father's hands, no crime alleg'd,
As arrogant: but she, I hope, as soon
As she perceives she can not live with me,
Will of her own accord depart.”

Is arrogant: but she, I hope, as soon

PHI. But tell me;
Went he meanwhile to Bacchis?

PAR. Every day.
But she, as is the way you know, perceiving
He was another's property, became
More cross and mercenary.

PHI. Troth, no wonder.

PAR. Aye, but 'twas that detach'd him chiefly from her.
For when he had examined well himself,
Bacchis, and her at home; and had compar'd
Their different manners; seeing that his bride,
After the fashion of a lib'ral mind,
Was decent, modest, patient of affronts,
And anxious to conceal the wrongs he did her;
Touch'd partly with compassion for his wife,
And partly tir'd with t'other's insolence,
He by degrees withdrew his heart from Bacchis,
Transferring it to her, whose disposition
Was so congenial to his own. Meanwhile

An old relation of the family
Dies in the isle of Imbrus. His estate
Comes by the law to them; and our old man
Dispatching thither, much against his will,
The now-fond Pamphilus, he leaves his wife
Here with his mother. The old gentleman
Retir'd into the country, and but seldom
Comes up to town.

PHI. But what is there in this
That can affect the marriage?

PAR. You shall hear
Immediately. At first, for some few days,
The women seem'd to live on friendly terms:
Till all at once the bride, forsooth, conceiv'd
A wonderful disgust to Sostrata:
And yet there was no open breach between them,
And no complaints on either side.

PHI. What then?

PAR. If Sostrata, for conversation' sake,
Went to the bride, she instantly withdrew,
Shunning her company. At length, not able Shunning her company. At length, unable
To bear it any longer, she pretends
Her mother had sent for her to assist
At some home-sacrifice. Away she went.
After a few days' absence, Sostrata
Sent for her back. They made some lame
excuse,
I know not what. She sends again. No lady.
Then after several messages, at last
They say the gentlewoman's sick. My
mistress
Goes on a visit to her: not let in.
Th' old gentleman, inform'd of all this,
came
On this occasion yesterday to town;

And waited on the father of the bride.
What pass'd between them, I as yet can't
tell;
And yet I long to know the end of this.
—There's the whole business. Now I'll on
my way.

PHI. And I: for there's a stranger here, with
whom
I have an assignation.

PAR. Speed the plow!

PHI. Parmeno, fare you well!

PAR. Farewell, Philotis!

(*Exeunt severally.*

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.

LACHES, SOSTRATA.

LACH. Oh heav'n and earth, what animals are women!
What a conspiracy between them all,
To do or not do, love or hate alike!
Not one but has the sex so strong in her,
She differs nothing from the rest. Step-mothers
All hate their Step-daughters: and every wife
Studies alike to contradict her husband,
The same perverseness running through them all.

Each seems train'd up in the same school of mischief:
And of that school, if any such there be,
My wife, I think, is schoolmistress.

SOSTRA. Ah me!
Who know not why I am accus'd.

LACH. Not know?

SOSTRA. No, as I hope for mercy! as I hope
We may live long together!

LACH. Heav'n forbid!

SOSTRA. Hereafter, Laches, you'll be sensible
How wrongfully you have accus'd me.

LACH. I?
Accuse you wrongfully?—Is't possible
To speak too hardly of your late behavior?
Disgracing me, yourself, and family;
Laying up sorrow for your absent son;
Converting into foes his new-made friends,
Who thought him worthy of their child in marriage.
You've been our bane, and by your shrewishness
Brew'd this disturbance.

SOSTRA. I?

LACH. You, woman, you!
Who take me for a stone, and not a man.
Think ye, because I'm mostly in the country,
I'm ignorant of your proceedings here?
No, no; I know much better what's done here,
Than where I'm chiefly resident. Because
Upon my family at home depends
My character abroad. I knew long since
Philumena's disgust to you;—no wonder!
Nay, 'twere a wonder, had it not been so.
Yet I imagin'd not her hate so strong,
'Twould vent itself upon the family:
Which had I dream'd of, she should have remain'd,

And you pack'd off.—Consider, Sostrata,
How little cause you had to vex me thus.
In complaisance to you, and husbanding
My fortune, I retir'd into the country:
Scraping, and laboring beyond the bounds
Of reason, or my age, that my estate
Might furnish means for your expense and pleasure.
—Was it not then your duty, in return,
To see that nothing happen'd here to vex me?

SOSTRA. 'Twas not my doing, nor my fault
indeed.

LACH. 'Twas your fault, Sostrata; your fault
alone.

You was sole mistress here; and in your
care

You were sole mistress here; and in your care

The house, though I had freed you of all
other cares.

A woman, an old woman too, and quarrel
With a green girl! oh shame upon't!—

You'll say
That 'twas her fault.

SOSTRA. Not I indeed, my Laches.

LACH. 'Fore Heav'n, I'm glad on't! on my
son's account.

For as for you, I'm well enough assur'd,
No fault can make you worse.

SOSTRA. But prithee, husband,
How can you tell that her aversion to me
Is not a mere pretense, that she may stay
The longer with her mother?

LACH. No such thing.
Was not your visit yesterday a proof,
From their denial to admit you to her?

SOSTRA. They said she was so sick she could not see me.

LACH. Sick of your humors; nothing else, I fancy.
And well she might: for there's not one of you
But want your sons to take a wife: and that's
No sooner over, but the very woman
Which, by your instigation, they have married,
They, by your instigation, put away.

SCENE II.

Enter PHIDIPPUS.

PHID. (*to PHILUMENA within*). Although, Philumena, I know
my pow'r
To force you to comply with my commands;
Yet yielding to paternal tenderness,
I e'en give way, nor cross your humor.

LACH. See,
Phidippus in good time! I'll learn from him
The cause of this.— (*Going up to him.*) Phidippus, though I own
Myself indulgent to my family,
Yet my complacency and easiness
Runs not to that extreme, that my good-nature
Corrupts their morals. Would you act like me,
'Twould be of service to both families.
But you, I see, are wholly in their power.

PHID. See there!

LACH. I waited on you yesterday
About your daughter: but I went away
No wiser than I came. It is not right,
If you would have the alliance last between us,
To smother your resentment. If we seem
In fault, declare it; that we may refute,
Or make amends for our offense: and you
Shall carve the satisfaction out yourself.
But if her sickness only is the cause

Of her remaining in your family,
Trust me, Phidippus, but you do me wrong,
To doubt her due attendance at my house.
For, by the pow'rs of heav'n, I'll not allow
That you, although her father, wish her better
Than I. I love her on my son's account;
To whom, I'm well convinc'd, she is as dear
As he is to himself: and I can tell
How deeply 'twill affect him, if he knows this.
Wherefore I wish she should come home again,
Before my son's return.

PHID. My good friend Laches,
I know your care, and your benevolence;
Nor doubt that all is as you say; and hope
That you'll believe I wish for her return,
So I could but effect it.

LACH. What prevents it?
Tell me, Phidippus! does she blame her husband?

PHID. Not in the least. For when I urg'd it home,
And threaten'd to oblige her to return,
She vow'd most solemnly she could not bear
Your house, so long as Pamphilus was absent.
—All have their failings: I am of so soft
A nature, I can't thwart my family.

LACH. Ha, Sostrata! (*To SOSTRATA, apart.*)

SOSTRA. Wretch that I am! Ah me! (*Aside.*)

LACH. And her return's impossible? (*To PHIDIPPUS.*)

PHID. At present.

—Would you aught else with me? for I have business
That calls me to the Forum.

LACH. I'll go with you.

(*Exeunt.*)

SCENE III.

Manet SOSTRATA.

SOSTRA. How unjustly
Do husbands stretch their censures to all
 wives
For the offenses of a few, whose vices
Reflect dishonor on the rest!—For, Heaven
So help me, as I'm wholly innocent
Of what my husband now accuses me!
But 'tis no easy task to clear myself;
So fix'd and rooted is the notion in them,
That Step-Mothers are all severe.—Not I;
For I have ever lov'd Philumena
As my own daughter; nor can I conceive
What accident has drawn her hatred on me.
My son's return, I hope, will settle all;
And, ah, I've too much cause to wish his
 coming.

Because of the offences of a few,
Whose faults reflect dishonour on the rest!
—For, heav'n so help me, as I'm innocent

(Exit.

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.

Enter PAMPHILUS *and* PARMENO.

PAM. Never did man experience greater ills,

More miseries in love than I.—Distraction!
Was it for this I held my life so dear?
For this was I so anxious to return?
Better, much better were it to have liv'd
In any place, than come to this again!
To feel and know myself a wretch!—For when
Mischance befalls us, all the interval
Between its happening, and our knowledge of it,
May be esteem'd clear gain.

PAR. But as it is,
You'll sooner be deliver'd from your troubles:
For had you not return'd, the breach between them
Had been made wider. But now, Pamphilus,
Both will, I doubt not, reverence your presence.
You'll know the whole, make up their difference,
And reconcile them to each other.—These
Are all mere trifles, which you think so grievous.

PAM. Ah, why will you attempt to comfort me?
Was ever such a wretch?—Before I married,
My heart, you know, was wedded to another.
—But I'll not dwell upon that misery,
Which may he easily conceiv'd: and yet
I had not courage to refuse the match
My father forc'd upon me.—Scarcely wean'd
From my old love, my lim'd soul scarcely freed
From Bacchis, and devoted to my wife,
Than, lo, a new calamity arises,
Threatening to tear me from Philumena.
For either I shall find my mother faulty,
Or else my wife: In either case unhappy.
For duty, Parmeno, obliges me
To bear with all the failings of a mother:
And then I am so bounden to my wife,
Who, calm as patience, bore the wrongs I did her,
Nor ever murmur'd a complaint.—But sure
'Twas somewhat very serious, Parmeno,

That could occasion such a lasting quarrel.

PAR. Rather some trifle, if you knew the truth.
The greatest quarrels do not always rise
From deepest injuries. We often see
That what would never move another's spleen
Renders the choleric your worst of foes.
Observe how lightly children squabble.—Why?
Because they're govern'd by a feeble mind.
Women, like children, too, are impotent,
And weak of soul. A single word, perhaps,
Has kindled all this enmity between them.

PAM. Go, Parmeno, and let them know I'm come.

(*Noise within.*)

PAR. Ha! what's all this?

PAM. Hush!

PAR. I perceive a bustle,
And running to and fro.—Come this way, Sir!
—To the door!—nearer still!—There, there, d'ye hear?

(*Noise continues.*)

PAM. Peace; hush! (*Shriek within.*) Oh Jupiter, I heard
a shriek!

PAR. You talk yourself, and bid me hold my tongue.

MYRRHINA (*within*). Hush, my dear child, for Heaven's sake!

PAM. It seem'd
The voice of my wife's mother. I am ruin'd!

PAR. How so?

PAM. Undone!

PAR. And why?

PAM. Ah, Parmeno,
They hide some terrible misfortune from me!

PAR. They said your wife Philumena was ill:
Whether 'tis that, I can not tell.

PAM. Death, Sirrah!
Why did you not inform me that before?

PAR. Because I could not tell you all at once.

PAM. What's her disorder?

PAR. I don't know.

PAM. But tell me,
Has she had no physician?

PAR. I don't know.

PAM. But why do I delay to enter straight,
That I may learn the truth, be what it will?
—Oh my Philumena, in what condition
Shall I now find thee?—If there's danger of thee,
My life's in danger too.

(Exit.

SCENE II.

PARMENO *alone.*

It were not good
That I should follow him into the house:
For all our family are odious to them.
That's plain from their denying Sostrata
Admittance yesterday.—And if by chance
Her illness should increase (which Heav'n forbid,
For my poor master's sake!), they'll cry directly,
“Sostrata's servant came into the house:”
Swear,—“that I brought the plague along with me,
Put all their lives in danger, and increas'd
Philumena's distemper.”—By which means
My mistress will be blam'd, and I be beaten.

SCENE III.

Enter SOSTRATA.

SOSTRA. Alas, I hear a dreadful noise within.
Philumena, I fear, grows worse and worse:
Which Æsculapius, and thou, Health, forbid!
But now I'll visit her. (*Goes toward the house.*)

PAR. Ho, Sostrata!

SOSTRA. Who's there?

PAR. You'll be shut out a second time.

SOSTRA. Ha, Parmeno, are you there?—Wretched woman!
What shall I do?—Not visit my son's wife,
When she lies sick at next door!

PAR. Do not go;
No, nor send any body else; for they
That love the folks, to whom themselves are odious,
I think are guilty of a double folly:
Their labor proves but idle to themselves,
And troublesome to those for whom 'tis meant.
Besides, your son, the moment he arriv'd,
Went in to visit her.

SOSTRA. How, Parmeno!
Is Pamphilus arriv'd?

PAR. He is.

SOSTRA. Thank Heav'n!
Oh, how my comfort is reviv'd by that!

PAR. And therefore I ne'er went into the house.
For if Philumena's complaints abate,
She'll tell him, face to face, the whole affair,
And what has pass'd between you to create
This difference.—But here he comes—how sad!

SCENE IV.

Enter PAMPHILUS.

SOSTRA. My dear boy, Pamphilus!

PAM. My mother, save you! (*Disordered.*)

SOSTRA. I'm glad to see you safe return'd—How does
Your wife!

PAM. A little better.

SOSTRA. Grant it, Heav'n!
—But why d'ye weep, and why are you so sad?

PAM. Nothing, good mother.

SOSTRA. What was all that bustle?
Tell me, did pain attack her suddenly?

PAM. It did.

SOSTRA. And what is her complaint?

PAM. A fever.

SOSTRA. What! a quotidian?

PAR. So they say.—But in,
Good mother, and I'll follow.

SOSTRA. Be it so.

(*Exit.*

PAM. Do you run, Parmeno, to meet the servants,
And give your help in bringing home the baggage.

PAR. As if they did not know the road!

PAM. Away!

(*Exit* PARMENO.

SCENE V.

PAMPHILUS *alone.*

Which way shall I begin the wretched tale
Of my misfortunes, which have fall'n upon me
Thus unexpectedly? which even now
These very eyes have seen, these ears have heard?
And which, discover'd, drove me out o'doors.
Cover'd with deep confusion?—For but now
As I rush'd in, all anxious for my wife,
And thinking to have found her visited,
Alas! with a far different complaint;
Soon as her women saw me, at first sight
Struck and o'erjoy'd, they all exclaim'd, “He's come!”
And then as soon each countenance was chang'd,
That chance had brought me so unseasonably.
Meanwhile one of them ran before, to speak
Of my arrival. I, who long'd to see her,
Directly follow'd; and no sooner enter'd,
Than her disorder was, alas! too plain:
For neither had they leisure to disguise it,
Nor could she silence the loud cries of travail.
Soon as I saw it, “Oh shame, shame!” I cried,
And rush'd away in tears and agony,
O'erwhelm'd with horror at a stroke so grievous.
The mother follows me, and at the threshold
Falls on her knees before me all in tears.
This touch'd me to the soul. And certainly
'Tis in the very nature of our minds,
To rise and fall according to our fortunes.
Thus she address'd me.— “Oh, my Pamphilus,
The cause of her removal from your house
You've now discover'd. To my virgin-daughter
Some unknown villain offer'd violence;
And she fled hither to conceal her labor

From you and from your family.”—Alas!
When I but call her earnest prayers to mind,
I can not choose but weep.—“Whatever chance,”
Continued she, “whatever accident,
Brought you to-day thus suddenly upon us,
By that we both conjure you—if in justice
And equity we may—to keep in silence,
And cover her distress.—Oh, Pamphilus,
If e’er you witness’d her affection for you,
By that affection she implores you now
Not to refuse us!—for recalling her,
Do as your own discretion shall direct.
That she’s in labor now, or has conceiv’d
By any other person, is a secret
Known but to you alone. For I’ve been told,
The two first months you had no commerce with her,
And it is now the seventh since your union.
Your sentiments on this are evident.
But now, my Pamphilus, if possible,
I’ll call it a miscarriage: no one else
But will believe, as probable, ’tis yours.
The child shall be immediately expos’d.
No inconvenience will arise to you;
While thus you shall conceal the injury
That my poor girl unworthily sustain’d.”
—I promis’d her; and I will keep my word.
But to recall her would be poor indeed:
Nor will I do it, though I love her still.
And former commerce binds me strongly to her.
—I can’t but weep, to think how sad and lonely
My future life will be.—Oh fickle fortune!
How transient are thy smiles!—But I’ve been school’d
To patience by my former hapless passion,
Which I subdued by reason: and I’ll try
By reason to subdue this too.—But yonder
Comes Parmeno, I see, with th’ other slaves!
He must by no means now be present, since

To him alone I formerly reveal'd
That I abstain'd from her when first we married:
And if he hears her frequent cries, I fear
That he'll discover her to be in labor.
I must dispatch him on some idle errand,
Until Philumena's deliver'd.

SCENE VI.

Enter at a distance PARMENO, SOSIA, and other slaves with baggage.

PAR. (to SOSIA). Aye?
And had you such a wretched voyage, say you?

SOSIA. Oh Parmeno, words can't express how wretched
A sea-life is.

PAR. Indeed?

SOSIA. Oh happy Parmeno!
You little know the dangers you've escap'd,
Who've never been at sea.—For not to dwell
On other hardships, only think of this!
I was on shipboard thirty days or more,
In constant fear of sinking all the while,
The winds so contrary, such stormy weather!

PAR. Dreadful!

SOSIA. I found it so, I promise you.
In short, were I assur'd I must return,
'Fore Heaven, Parmeno, I'd run away,
Rather than go on board a ship again.

PAR. You have been apt enough to think of that
On slighter reasons, Sosia, before now.
—But yonder's my young master Pamphilus
Standing before that door.—Go in! I'll to him,
And see if he has any business for me.

(Exeunt SOSIA, and the rest of the slaves with the baggage.

Master, are you here still? (To PAMPHILUS.)

PAM. Oh Parmeno!

I waited for you.

PAR. What's your pleasure, Sir?

PAM. Run to the Citadel.

PAR. Who?

PAM. You.

PAR. The Citadel!

For what?

PAM. Find out one Callidemides,
My landlord of Mycone, who came over
In the same ship with me.

PAR. A plague upon it!
Would not one swear that he had made a vow
To break my wind, if he came home in safety,
With running on his errands?

PAM. Away, Sirrah!

PAR. What message? must I only find him out?

PAM. Yes; tell him that it is not in my power
To meet him there to-day, as I appointed;
That he mayn't wait for me in vain.—Hence; fly!

PAR. But I don't know him, if I see him, Sir.

PAM. (*impatiently*). Well; I'll describe him, so you can not miss him.
—A large, red, frizzle-pated, gross, blear-eyed,
Ill-looking fellow.

PAR. Plague on him, say I!
—What if he should not come, Sir, must I wait
Till evening for him?

PAM. Wait.—Be quick!

PAR. Be quick?

I can't be quick,—I'm so much tir'd.

(Exit.

SCENE VII.

PAMPHILOS *alone*.

He's gone.

What shall I do? Alas! I scarcely know
How to conceal, as Myrrhina desir'd,
Her daughter's labor. Yet I pity her;
And what I can, I am resolv'd to do,
Consistent with my duty: for my parents
Must be obey'd before my love.—But see!
My father and Phidippus come this way.
How I shall act, Heav'n knows.

And what I can, consistent with my duty,
I am resolv'd to do: and yet my parents

SCENE VIII.

Enter at a distance LACHES *and* PHIDIPPUS.

LACH. Did not you say
She only waited my son's coming?

PHID. Aye.

LACH. They say that he's arriv'd. Let us return then!

PAM. (*behind*). What reason I shall frame to give my father,
For not recalling her, I can not tell.

LACH. (*overhearing*). Whose voice was that?

PAM. (*to himself*). And yet I am resolv'd
To stand to my first purpose.

LACH. (*seeing* PAMPHILUS). He himself,
Whom I was speaking of!

PAM. (*going up*). My father, save you!

LACH. Save you, my son!

PHID. Pamphilus, welcome home!
I'm glad to see you safe, and in good health.

PAM. I do believe it.

LACH. Are you just now come?

PAM. Just now, Sir.

LACH. Well; and tell me, Pamphilus,
What has our kinsman Phania left us?

PAM. Ah, Sir,
He, his whole lifetime, was a man of pleasure,
And such men seldom much enrich their heirs.
Yet he has left at least this praise behind him,
“While he liv'd, he liv'd well.”

LACH. And have you brought
Nothing home with you but this single sentence?

PAM. What he has left, though small, is of advantage.

LACH. Advantage? No, it is a disadvantage:
For I could wish he was alive and well.

PHID. That you may safely; for your wishing for't
Will never bring the man to life again:
Yet I know well enough which you'd like best. (*Aside.*)

LACH. (*to PAMPHILUS*). Phidippus order'd that Philumena
Should be sent over to him yesterday.
—Say that you order'd it. (*Aside to PHIDIPPUS, thrusting him.*)

PHID. (*aside to LACHES*). Don't thrust me so.—
I did. (*Aloud.*)

LACH. But now he'll send her home again.

PHID. I will.

PAM. Nay, nay, I know the whole affair.
Since my arrival, I have heard it all.

LACH. Now plague upon these envious tale-bearers,
Who are so glad to fetch and carry news!

PAM. (to PHIDIPPUS). That I've endeavor'd to deserve no blame
From any of the family, I'm conscious.
Were it my inclination to relate
How true I've been, how kind and gentle tow'rd her,
I well might do it: but I rather choose
You should collect it from herself. For when
She, although now there's enmity between us,
Bespeaks me fair, you will the sooner credit
My disposition tow'rd her. And I call
The Gods to witness that this separation
Has not arisen from my fault. But since
She thinks it is beneath her to comply
With Sostrata, and bear my mother's temper;
And since no other means are to be found
Of reconciliation, I, Phidippus,
Must leave my mother or Philumena.
Duty then calls me to regard my mother.

LACH. My Pamphilus, I can not be displeas'd
That you prefer to all the world a parent.
But take heed your resentment don't transport you
Beyond the bounds of reason, Pamphilus.

PAM. Ah, what resentment can I bear to her,
Who ne'er did any thing I'd wish undone,
But has so often deserv'd well of me?
I love her, own her worth, and languish for her;
For I have known her tenderness of soul:
And Heaven grant that with some other husband
She find that happiness she miss'd in me;
From whom the strong hand of necessity
Divorces her forever!

PHID. That event
'Tis in your pow'r to hinder.

LACH. If you're wise,

Take your wife home again!

PAM. I can not, father.

I must not slack my duty to my mother. (*Going.*)

LACH. Where are you going?

(*Exit PAMPHILUS.*)

SCENE IX.

Manent LACHES and PHIDIPPUS.

PHID. How perverse is this! (*Angrily.*)

LACH. Did not I say he'd take it ill, Phidippus,
And therefore begg'd you to send back your daughter?

PHID. 'Fore Heaven I did not think him such a churl.
What! does he fancy I'll go cringing to him?
No;—if he'll take his wife he may:—if not,
Let him refund her portion;—there's an end!

LACH. See there now! you're as fractious as himself.

PHID. You're come back obstinate and proud enough
In conscience, Pamphilus! (*Angrily.*)

LACH. This anger will subside,
Though he has had some cause to be disturb'd.

PHID. Because you've had a little money left you,
Your minds are so exalted!

LACH. What, d'ye quarrel
With me too?

PHID. Let him take to-day to think on't,
And send me word if he shall have her home
Or not: that if she don't remain his wife,
She may be given to another.

(*Exit hastily.*)

SCENE X.

LACHES *alone.*

Stay!

Hear me! one word, Phidippus! Stay!—He's gone.

—What is't to me? (*Angrily.*) E'en let them settle it

Among themselves; since nor my son, nor he

Take my advice, nor mind one word I say.

—This quarrel shall go round, I promise them:

I'll to my wife, the author of this mischief,

And vent my spleen and anger upon her.

(*Exit.*

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.

Enter MYRRHINA hastily.

MYRR. What shall I do?—Confusion!—which way turn?

Alas! what answer shall I make my husband?

For I dare say he heard the infant's cries,

He ran so hastily, without a word,

Into my daughter's chamber. If he finds

That she has been deliver'd, what excuse

To make, for having thus conceal'd her labor,

I can't devise.—But our door creaks!—'tis he.

I am undone.

SCENE II.

Enter PHIDIPPUS.

PHID. Soon as my wife perceiv'd
That I was going to my daughter's chamber,
She stole directly out o' doors.—But there
She stands.—Why, how now, Myrrhina?
Holo, I say! (*She affects not to see him.*)

MYRR. D'ye call me, husband?

PHID. Husband!
Am I your husband? am I ev'n a man?
For had you thought me to be either, woman,
You would not dare to play upon me thus.

MYRR. How!

PHID. How?—My daughter has been brought to bed.
—Ha! are you dumb?—By whom?

MYRR. Is that a question
For you, who are her father, to demand?
Alas! by whom d'ye think, unless her husband?

PHID. So I believe: nor is it for a father
To suppose otherwise. But yet I wonder
That you have thus conceal'd her labor from us,
Especially as she has been deliver'd
At her full time, and all is as it should be.
What! Is there such perverseness in your nature,
As rather to desire the infant's death,
Than that his birth should knit the bond of friendship
Closer betwixt us; rather than my daughter,
Against your liking, should remain the wife
Of Pamphilus?—I thought all this
Had been their fault, while you're alone to blame.

MYRR. How wretched am I!

PHID. Would to Heav'n you were!
—But now I recollect your conversation
When first we made this match, you then declar'd
You'd not endure she should remain the wife
Of Pamphilus, who follow'd mistresses,
And pass'd the nights abroad.

MYRR. I had much rather
He should think any reason than the true one. (*Aside.*)

PHID. I knew he kept a mistress; knew it long
Ere you did, Myrrhina; but I could never
Think that offense so grievous in a youth,
Seeing 'tis natural to them all: and soon
The time shall come when he'll stand self-reprov'd.
But you, perverse and willful as at first,
Could take no rest till you had brought away
Your daughter, and annul'd the match I made:
There's not a circumstance but loudly speaks
Your evil disposition to the marriage.

MYRR. D'ye think me then so obstinate, that I,
Who am her mother, should betray this spirit,
Granting the match were of advantage to us?

PHID. Is it for you then to foresee, or judge
What's of advantage to us? You perhaps
Have heard from some officious busy-body,
That they have seen him going to his mistress,
Or coming from her house: and what of that,
So it were done discreetly, and but seldom?
Were it not better that we should dissemble
Our knowledge of it, than pry into things
Which to appear to know would make him hate us?
For could he tear her from his heart at once,
To whom he'd been so many years attach'd,
I should not think he were a man, or likely
To prove a constant husband to my daughter.

MYRR. No more of Pamphilus or my offense;

Since you will have it so!—Go, find him out;
Confer with him alone, and fairly ask him,
Will he, or no, take back Philumena?
If he avows his inclination to't,
Restore her; but if he refuses it,
Allow, I've ta'en good counsel for my child.

PHID. Grant, he should prove repugnant to the match,
Grant, you perceiv'd this in him, Myrrhina;
Was not I present! had not I a right
To be consulted in't?—It makes me mad.
That you should dare to act without my order:
And I forbid you to remove the child
Out of this house.—But what a fool am I,
Enjoining her obedience to my orders!
I'll in, and charge the servants not to suffer
The infant to be carried forth.

(Exit.

SCENE III.

MYRRHINA *alone.*

No woman more unhappy than myself:
For how he'd bear it, did he know the whole,
When he has taken such offense at this,
Which is of much less consequence, is plain.
Nor by what means to reconcile him to it,
Can I devise. After so many ills,
This only misery there yet remain'd,
To be oblig'd to educate the child,
Ignorant of the father's quality.
For he, the cruel spoiler of her honor,
Taking advantage of the night and darkness,
My daughter was not able to discern
His person; nor to force a token from him,
Whereby he might be afterward discover'd:

But he, at his departure, pluck'd by force
A ring from off her finger.—I fear too,
That Pamphilus will not contain himself,
Nor longer keep our secret, when he finds
Another's child acknowledg'd for his own.

(Exit.

SCENE IV.

SOSTRATA, PAMPHILUS.

SOSTRA. Dear son, I'm not to learn that you
suppose,
Though you dissemble your suspicions to
me,
That my ill-humor caus'd your wife's
departure.
But by my trust in Heav'n, and hopes in
you,
I never knowingly did any thing
To draw her hatred and disgust upon me.
I always thought you lov'd me, and to-day
You have confirm'd my faith: for even now
Your father has been telling me within,
How much you held me dearer than your
love.

Now therefore, on my part, I am resolv'd
To equal you in all good offices;
That you may know your mother ne'er
withholds

The just rewards of filial piety;
Finding it then both meet for your repose,
My Pamphilus, as well as my good name,
I have determin'd to retire directly
From hence into the country with your
father;

Finding it then both meet, my Pamphilus,
For your repose, as well as my good name,

So shall my presence be no obstacle,
Nor any cause remain, but that your wife
Return immediately.

PAM. What thoughts are these?
Shall her perverseness drive you out of town?
It shall not be: Nor will I draw, good mother,
That censure on me, that my obstinacy,
Not your good-nature, was the cause.—Besides,
That you should quit relations, friends, diversions,
On my account, I can't allow.

SOSTRA. Alas!
Those things have no allurements for me now.
While I was young, and 'twas the season for them,
I had my share, and I am satisfied.
'Tis now my chief concern to make my age
Easy to all, that no one may regret
My lengthen'd life, nor languish for my death.
Here, although undeservedly, I see
My presence odious: I had best retire:
So shall I best cut off all discontent,
Absolve myself from this unjust suspicion,
And humor them. Permit me then to shun
The common scandal thrown upon the sex.

PAM. How fortunate in every thing but one,
Having so good a mother,—such a wife!

SOSTRA. Patience, my Pamphilus! Is't possible
You can't endure one inconvenience in her?
If in all else, as I believe, you like her,
Dear son, be rul'd by me, and take her home!

PAM. Wretch that I am!

SOSTRA. And I am wretched too:
For this grieves me, my son, no less than you.

SCENE V.

Enter LACHES.

LACH. I have been standing at a distance, wife,
And overheard your conversation with him.
You have done wisely to subdue your temper,
And freely to comply with what, perhaps,
Hereafter must be done.

SOSTRA. And let it be!

LACH. Now then retire with me into the country:
There I shall bear with you, and you with me.

SOSTRA. I hope we shall.

LACH. Go in then, and pack up
The necessaries you would carry with you.
Away!

SOSTRA. I shall obey your orders.

(Exit.

PAM. Father!

LACH. Well, Pamphilus?

PAM. My mother leave the town?
By no means.

LACH. Why?

PAM. Because I'm yet uncertain
What I shall do about my wife.

LACH. How's that?
What *would* you do but take her home
again?

PAM. 'Tis what I wish for, and can scarce
forbear it.

PAM. 'Tis what I wish for, and can scarce forbear
But I'll not alter what I first design'd.
What's best I'll follow: and I'm well convinc'

But I'll not alter what I first design'd.
What's best I'll follow: and I'm well
 convinc'd
That there's no other way to make them
 friends,
But that I should not take her home again.

No other means remain to make them friends,
But that I should not take her home again.

LACH. You don't know that: but 'tis of no
 importance
Whether they're friends or not, when
 Sostrata
Is gone into the country. We old folks
Are odious to the young. We'd best retire.
In short, we're grown a by-word,
 Pamphilus,
"The old man and old woman."—But I see
Phidippus coming in good time. Let's meet
 him!

SCENE VI.

Enter PHIDIPPUS.

PHID. (*to PHILUMENA within*). I'm angry with you—'fore Heaven, very angry,
Philumena!—You've acted shamefully.
Though you indeed have some excuse for't, seeing
Your mother urg'd you to't; but she has none.

LACH. You're come upon us in good time, Phidippus;
Just in the time we wanted you.

PHID. What now?

PAM. What answer shall I give them! how explain? (*Aside.*)

LACH. Inform your daughter, Sostrata will hence
Into the country; so Philumena
Need not dread coming home again.

PHID. Ah, friend!
Your wife has never been in fault at all:
All this has sprung from my wife Myrrhina.
The case is alter'd. She confounds us, Laches.

PAM. So that I may not take her home again,
Confound affairs who will! (*Aside.*)

PHID. I, Pamphilus,
Would fain, if possible, make this alliance
Perpetual between our families.
But if you can not like it, take the child.

PAM. He knows of her delivery. Confusion! (*Aside.*)

LACH. The child! what child?

PHID. We've got a grandson, Laches.
For when my daughter left your house, she was
With child, it seems, although I never knew it
Before this very day.

LACH. 'Fore Heav'n, good news!
And I rejoice to hear a child is born,
And that your daughter had a safe delivery.
But what a woman is your wife,
Phidippus?
Of what a disposition? to conceal
Such an event as this? I can't express
How much I think she was to blame.

How very much I think she was to blame.

PHID. This pleases me no more than you,
good Laches.

PAM. Although my mind was in suspense
before,
My doubts all vanish now. I'll ne'er recall
her,
Since she brings home with her another's
child. (*Aside.*)

LACH. There is no room for choice now,
Pamphilus.

PAM. Confusion! (*Aside.*)

LACH. We've oft wish'd to see the day
When you should have a child to call you father.
That day's now come. The Gods be thank'd!

PAM. Undone! (*Aside.*)

LACH. Recall your wife, and don't oppose my will.

PAM. If she had wish'd for children by me, father,
Or to remain my wife, I'm very sure
She never would have hid this matter from me:
But now I see her heart divorc'd from me,
And think we never can agree hereafter,
Wherefore should I recall her?

LACH. A young woman
Did as her mother had persuaded her.
Is that so wonderful? and do you think
To find a woman without any fault?
—Or is't because the *men* are ne'er to blame? (*Ironically.*)

PHID. Consider with yourselves then, gentlemen,
Whether you'll part with her, or call her home.
What my wife does, I can not help, you know.
Settle it as you please, you've my consent,
But for the child, what shall be done with him?

LACH. A pretty question truly! come what may,
Send his own bantling home to him of course,
That we may educate him.

PAM. When his own
Father abandons him, I educate him?

LACH. What said you? how! not educate him, say you?
Shall we expose him rather, Pamphilus?
What madness is all this?—My breath and blood!
I can contain no longer. You oblige me

To speak, against my will, before Phidippus:
Think you I'm ignorant whence flow those tears?
Or why you're thus disorder'd and distress'd?
First, when you gave as a pretense, *you could not*
Recall your wife from reverence to your mother,
She promis'd to retire into the country.
But now, since that excuse is taken from you,
You've made *her private lying-in* another.
You are mistaken if you think me blind
To your intentions—That you might at last
Bring home your stray affections to your wife,
How long a time to wean you from your mistress
Did I allow? your wild expense upon her
How patiently I bore? I press'd, entreated,
That you would take a wife. 'Twas time, I said.
At my repeated instances, you married,
And, as in duty bound to do, complied:
But now your heart is gone abroad again
After your mistress, whom to gratify,
You throw this wanton insult on your wife.
For I can plainly see you are relaps'd
Into your former life again.

PAM. Me?

LACH. You.
And 'tis base in you to invent false causes
Of quarrel with your wife, that you may live
In quiet with your mistress, having put
This witness from you. This your wife perceiv'd.
For was there any other living reason
Wherefore she should depart from you?

PHID. He's right,
That was the very thing.

PAM. I'll take my oath
'Twas none of those that you have mention'd.

LACH. Ah!

Recall your wife: or tell me why you will not.

PAM. 'Tis not convenient now.

LACH. Take home the child then;
For *he* at least is not in fault. I'll see
About the mother afterward.

PAM. (*to himself*). Ev'ry way
I am a wretch, nor know I what to do:
My father has me in the toils, and I,
By struggling to get loose, am more entangled.
I'll hence, since present I shall profit little.
For I believe they'll hardly educate
The child against my will; especially
Seeing my step-mother will second me.

(*Exit.*

SCENE VII.

Manent PHIDIPPUS, LACHES.

LACH. Going? how's that? and give me no plain answer!
—D'ye think he's in his senses?—Well—send home
The child to me, Phidippus. I'll take care on't.

PHID. I will.—I can not wonder that my wife
Took this so ill. Women are passionate,
And can't away with such affronts as these.
This was their quarrel: nay she told me so,
Though before him I did not care to speak on't:
Nor did I credit it at first; but now
'Tis evident, and I can plainly see
He has no stomach to a wife.

LACH. Phidippus,
How shall I act? What's your advice?

PHID. How act?
I think 'twere best to seek this wench, his mistress.

Let us expostulate the matter with her,
Speak to her roundly, nay, e'en threaten her,
If she has aught to do with him hereafter.

LACH. I'll follow your advice.—Ho, boy! (*Enter a boy*) run over
To Bacchis. Tell her to come forth to me.

(*Exit boy.*)

—I must beseech you also to continue
Your kind assistance to me in this business.

PHID. Ah, Laches! I have told you all along.
And I repeat it now, that 'tis my wish
To render our alliance firm and lasting,
If possible, as I have hopes it will be.
—But would you have me present at your conference
With Bacchis?

LACH. No; go, seek the child a nurse.

(*Exit PHIDIPPUS.*)

SCENE VIII.

Enter BACCHIS attended by her Women.

BACCH. (*to herself*). 'Tis not for nothing Laches wants to see me;
And, or I'm much deceiv'd, I guess the cause.

LACH. (*to himself*). I must take care my anger don't transport me
Beyond the bounds of prudence, which may hinder
My gaining my design on her, and urge me
To do what I may afterward repent.
I'll to her.— (*Going up.*) Save you, Bacchis!

BACCH. Save you, Laches!

LACH. Bacchis, I do not doubt but you're surpris'd
That I should send the boy to call you forth.

BACCH. Aye, and I'm fearful too, when I
reflect

Both who and what I am: lest my vocation
Should prejudice me in your good opinion.
My conduct I can fully justify.

LACH. If you speak truth, you're in no
danger, woman.

LACH. Speak but the truth, you're in no danger
woman.

For I'm arriv'd at that age when a trespass
Would not be easily forgiven in me.
Wherefore I study to proceed with caution,
And to do nothing rashly. If you act,
And will continue to act honestly,
It were ungenerous to do you wrong,
And seeing you deserve it not, unjust.

BACCH. Truly, this conduct asks my highest thanks;
For he who does the wrong, and then asks pardon,
Makes but a sorry reparation for it.
But what's your pleasure?

LACH. You receive the visits
Of my son Pamphilus——

BACCH. Ah!——

LACH. Let me speak.
Before he married I endur'd your love.
—Stay! I've not finish'd all I have to say.——
He is now married. You then, while 'tis time,
Seek out another and more constant friend.
For he will not be fond of you forever,
Nor you, good faith, forever in your bloom.

BACCH. Who tells you that I still receive the visits
Of Pamphilus?

LACH. His step-mother.

BACCH. I?

LACH. You.
And therefore has withdrawn her daughter: therefore
Meant secretly to kill the new-born child.

BACCH. Did I know any thing, to gain your credit,
More sacred than an oath, I'd use it, Laches,
In solemn protestation to assure you
That I have had no commerce with your son
Since he was married.

LACH. Good girl! but dy'e know
What I would farther have you do?

BACCH. Inform me.

LACH. Go to the women here, and offer them
The same oath. Satisfy their minds, and clear
Yourself from all reproach in this.

BACCH. I'll do't;
Although I'm sure no other of my calling
Would show herself before a married woman
Upon the same occasion.—But it hurts me
To see your son suspected on false grounds;
And that, to those who owe him better thoughts,
His conduct should seem light. For he deserves
All my best offices.

LACH. Your conversation has much wrought upon me,
Gain'd my good-will, and alter'd my opinion.
For not the women only thought thus of you,
But I believ'd it too. Now therefore, since
I've found you better than my expectation,
Prove still the same, and make my friendship sure.
If otherwise—But I'll contain myself. I'll not
Say any thing severe.—But I advise you,
Rather experience what a friend I am,
Than what an enemy.

BACCH. I'll do my best.

SCENE IX.

Enter PHIDIPPUS and a Nurse.

PHID. (*to the Nurse*). Nay, you shall want for nothing at my house;
I'll give you all that's needful in abundance;
But when you've eat and drank your fill yourself,
Take care to satisfy the infant too.

LACH. I see the father of Philumena
Coming this way. He brings the child a nurse.
—Phidippus, Bacchis swears most solemnly—

PHID. Is this she?

LACH. Aye.

PHID. They never mind the Gods,
Nor do I think the Gods mind them.

BACCH. Here are
My waiting-women: take them, and extort
By any kind of torment the truth from them.
—Our present business is, I take it, this:
That I should win the wife of Pamphilus
To return home; which so I but effect,
I sha'n't regret the same of having done
What others of my calling would avoid.

LACH. Phidippus, we've discover'd that in fact
We both suspected our wives wrongfully.
Let's now try her: for if your wife perceives
Her own suspicions also are unjust,
She'll drop her anger. If my son's offended
Because his wife conceal'd her labor from him,
That's but a trifle; he'll be soon pleas'd.
—And truly I see nothing in this matter
That need occasion a divorce.

PHID. 'Fore Heaven,
I wish that all may end well.

LACH. Here she is:
Examine her; she'll give you satisfaction.

PHID. What needs all this to Me! You know my mind

Already, Laches: do but make them easy.

LACH. Bacchis, be sure you keep your promise with me.

BACCH. Shall I go in then for that purpose?

LACH. Aye.

Go in; remove their doubts, and satisfy them.

BACCH. I will; although I'm very sure my presence
Will be unwelcome to them; for a wife,
When parted from her husband, to a mistress
Is a sure enemy.

LACH. They'll be your friends,
When once they know the reason of your coming.

PHID. Aye, aye, they'll be your friends, I promise you,
When they once learn your errand; for you'll free
Them from mistake, yourself from all suspicion.

BACCH. I'm cover'd with confusion. I'm asham'd
To see Philumena.— (*To her women.*) You two in after me.

(*Exeunt PHIDIPPUS, BACCHIS, etc.*)

(*LACHES alone.*)

What is there that could please me more than this,
That Bacchis, without any loss, should gain
Favor from them, and do me service too?
For if she really has withdrawn herself
From Pamphilus, it will increase, she knows,
Her reputation, interest, and honor:
Since by this generous act she will at once
Oblige my son, and make us all her friends.

(*Exit.*)

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.

PARMENO *alone.*

I' faith my master holds my labor cheap,
To send me to the Citadel for nothing,
Where I have waited the whole day in vain
For his Myconian, Callidemides.

There was I sitting, gaping like a fool,
And running up, if any one appear'd,
—"Are you, Sir, a Myconian?"—"No,
not I."——

—"But your name's Callidemides?"—"Not
it."——

"And have not you a guest here of the
name

"And have not you a guest here of the name
Of Pamphilus?"—No—no—All No.

Of Pamphilus?"—All answer'd, No.

In short, I don't believe there's such a man.
At last I grew asham'd, and so sneak'd off.

—But is't not Bacchis that I see come forth
From our new kinsman? What can she do
there?

SCENE II.

Enter BACCHIS.

BACCH. Oh Parmeno, I'm glad I've met with you.
Run quick to Pamphilus.

PAR. On what account?

BACCH. Tell him that I desire he'd come.

PAR. To you?

BACCH. No; to Philumena.

PAR. Why? what's the matter?

BACCH. Nothing to you; so ask no questions.

PAR. Must I
Say nothing else?

BACCH. Yes; tell him too,
That Myrrhina acknowledges the ring,
Which formerly he gave me, as her daughter's.

PAR. I understand you. But is that all?

BACCH. All.
He'll come the moment that you tell him that.
What! do you loiter?

PAR. No, i' faith, not I.
I have not had it in my pow'r, I've been
So bandied to and fro, sent here and there,
Trotting, and running up and down all day.

(Exit.

SCENE III.

BACCHIS *alone.*

What joy have I procur'd to Pamphilus
By coming here to-day! what blessings
brought him!
And from how many sorrows rescued him!
His son, by his and their means nearly lost,
I've sav'd; a wife he meant to put away,
I have restor'd; and from the strong
suspitions
Of Laches and Phidippus set him free.

I sav'd; a wife he meant to put away,

—Of all these things the ring has been the
cause.
For I remember, near ten months ago,
That he came running home to me one
evening,
Breathless, alone, and much inflam'd with
wine,
Bringing this ring. I was alarm'd at it.
“Prithee, my dearest Pamphilus, said I,
Whence comes all this confusion? whence this ring?
Tell me, my love.”—He put me off at first:
Perceiving this, it made me apprehend
Something of serious import, and I urg'd him
More earnestly to tell me.—He confess'd
That, as he came along, he had committed
A rape upon a virgin—whom he knew not——
And as she struggled, forc'd from her that ring:
Which Myrrhina now seeing on my finger,
Immediately acknowledg'd, and inquir'd
How I came by it. I told all this story:
Whence 'twas discover'd that Philumena
Was she who had been ravish'd, and the child
Conceiv'd from that encounter.—That I've been
The instrument of all these joys I'm glad,
Though other courtesans would not be so;
Nor is it for our profit and advantage
That lovers should be happy in their marriage.
But never will I, for my calling's sake,
Suffer ingratitude to taint my mind.
I found him, while occasion gave him leave,
Kind, pleasant, and good-humor'd: and this marriage
Happen'd unluckily, I must confess.
Yet I did nothing to estrange his love;
And since I have receiv'd much kindness from him,
'Tis fit I should endure this one affliction.

SCENE IV.

Enter at a distance PAMPHILUS and PARMENO.

PAM. Be sure you prove this to me, Parmeno;
Prithee, be sure on't. Do not bubble me
With false and short-liv'd joy.

PAR. 'Tis even so.

PAM. For certain?

PAR. Aye, for certain.

PAM. I'm in heaven,
If this be so.

PAR. You'll find it very true.

PAM. Hold, I beseech you.—I'm afraid I think
One thing, while you relate another.

PAR. Well?

PAM. You said, I think, “that Myrrhina discover'd
The ring on Bacchis' finger was her own.”

PAR. She did.

PAM. “The same I gave her formerly.
—And Bacchis bade you run and tell me this.”
Is it not so?

PAR. I tell you, Sir, it is.

PAM. Who is more fortunate, more bless'd than I?
—What shall I give you for this news? what? what?
I don't know.

PAR. But I know.

PAM. What?

PAR. Just nothing.

For I see nothing of advantage to you,
Or in the message, or myself.

PAM. Shall I
Permit you to go unrewarded; you,
Who have restor'd me ev'n from death to life?
Ah, Parmeno, d'ye think me so ungrateful?
—But yonder's Bacchis standing at the door.
She waits for me, I fancy. I'll go to her.

BACCH. (*seeing him*). Pamphilus, save you.

PAM. Bacchis! my dear Bacchis!
My guardian! my protectress!

BACCH. All is well:
And I'm o'erjoy'd at it.

PAM. Your actions speak it.
You're still the charming girl I ever found you.
Your presence, company, and conversation,
Come where you will, bring joy and pleasure with them.

BACCH. And you, in faith, are still the same as ever,
The sweetest, most engaging man on earth.

PAM. Ha! ha! ha! that speech from you, dear Bacchis?

BACCH. You lov'd your wife with reason, Pamphilus:
Never that I remember, did I see her
Before to-day; and she's a charming woman.

PAM. Speak truth.

BACCH. So Heaven help me, Pamphilus!

PAM. Say, have you told my father any part
Of this tale?

BACCH. Not a word.

PAM. Nor is there need.
Let all be hush! I would not have it here,
As in a comedy, where every thing

Is known to every body. Here those persons
Whom it concerns already know it; they,
Who 'twere not meet should know it, never shall.

BACCH. I promise you it may with ease be hid.
Myrrhina told Phidippus that my oath
Convinc'd her, and she held you clear.

PAM. Good! good!
All will be well, and all, I hope, end well.

PAR. May I know, Sir, what good I've done to-day?
And what's the meaning of your conversation?

PAM. No.

PAR. I suspect, however.—“I restore him
From death to life”—which way?——

PAM. Oh, Parmeno,
You can't conceive the good you've done to-day;
From what distress you have deliver'd me.

PAR. Ah, but I know, and did it with design.

PAM. Oh, I'm convinced of that. (*Ironically.*)

PAR. Did Parmeno
Ever let slip an opportunity
Of doing what he ought, Sir?

PAM. Parmeno,
In after me!

PAR. I follow.—By my troth,
I've done more good to-day, without design,
Than ever with design in all my life.——
Clap your hands!



PHORMIO.

PERSONS REPRESENTED.

PROLOGUE.	PHORMIO.
DEMIPHO.	DORIO.
CHREMES.	GETA.
ANTIPHO.	DAVUS, <i>and other Servants.</i>
PHÆDRIA.	
CRATINUS.	NAUSISTRATA.
CRITO.	SOPHRONA.
HEGIO.	

SCENE, ATHENS.

PROLOGUE.

THE Old Bard finding it impossible
To draw our Poet from the love of verse,
And bury him in indolence, attempts
By calumny to scare him from the stage;
Pretending that in all his former plays
The characters are low, and mean the style;
Because he ne'er describ'd a mad-brain'd youth,
Who in his fits of frenzy thought he saw
A hind, the dogs in full cry after her;
Her too imploring and beseeching him
To give her aid.—But did he understand
That, when the piece was first produc'd, it ow'd
More to the actor than himself its safety,

He would not be thus bold to give offense.
—But if there's any one who says, or thinks,
“That had not the Old Bard assail'd him first,
Our Poet could not have devis'd a Prologue,
Having no matter for abuse;”—let such
Receive for answer, “that although the prize
To all advent'urers is held out in common,
The Veteran Poet meant to drive our Bard
From study into want: *He* therefore chose
To answer, though he would not first offend.
And had his adversary but have prov'd
A generous rival, he had had due praise;
Let him then bear these censures, and reflect
Of his own slanders 'tis the due return.
But henceforth I shall cease to speak of him,
Although he ceases not himself to rail.”
But now what I'd request of you, attend:
To-day I bring a new play, which the Greeks
Call Epidicazomenos; the Latins,
From the chief character, name Phormio:
Phormio, whom you will find a parasite,
And the chief engine of the plot.—And now,
If to our Poet you are well inclin'd,
Give ear; be favorable; and be silent!
Let us not meet the same ill fortune now
That we before encounter'd, when our troop
Was by a tumult driven from their place;
To which the actor's merit, seconded
By your good-will and candor, has restor'd us.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.

DAVUS *alone.*

Geta, my worthy friend and countryman,
Came to me yesterday: for some time past
I've ow'd him some small balance of account:
This he desir'd I would make up: I have;
And brought it with me: for his master's son,
I am inform'd, has lately got a wife:
So I suppose this sum is scrap'd together
For a bride-gift. Alack, how hard it is
That he, who is already poor, should still
Throw in his mite to swell the rich man's heap!
What he scarce, ounce by ounce, from short allowance,
Sorely defrauding his own appetite,
Has spar'd, poor wretch! shall she sweep all at once,
Unheeding with what labor it was got?
Geta, moreover, shall be struck for more;
Another gift, when madam's brought to bed;
Another too, when master's birthday's kept,
And they initiate him.—All this mamma
Shall carry off, the bantling her excuse.
But is that Geta?

SCENE II.

Enter GETA.

GETA (*at entering.*) If a red-hair'd man
Inquire for me——

DAVUS. No more! he's here.

GETA. Oh, Davus!
The very man that I was going after.

DAVUS. Here, take this! (*Gives a purse.*) 'Tis all told: you'll find it right;
The sum I ow'd you.

GETA. Honest, worthy Davus!
I thank you for your punctuality.

DAVUS. And well you may, as men and times go now,
Things, by my troth, are come to such a pass,
If a man pays you what he owes, you're much
Beholden to him.—But, pray, why so sad?

GETA. I?—You can scarce imagine in what dread.
What danger I am in.

DAVUS. How so?

GETA. I'll tell you,
So you will keep it secret.

DAVUS. Away, fool!
The man whose faith in money you have tried,
D'ye fear to trust with words?—And to what end
Should I deceive you?

GETA. List, then!

DAVUS. I'm all ear.

GETA. D'ye know our old man's elder brother, Chremes?

DAVUS. Know him? aye, sure.

GETA. You do?—And his son Phædria?

DAVUS. As well as I know you.

GETA. It so fell out,
Both the old men were forc'd to journey forth
At the same season. He to Lemnos, ours
Into Cilicia, to an old acquaintance
Who had decoy'd the old curmudgeon thither
By wheedling letters, almost promising
Mountains of gold.

DAVUS. To one that had so much

More than enough already?

GETA. Prithee, peace!

Money's his passion.

DAVUS. Oh, would I had been

A man of fortune, I!

GETA. At their departure,

The two old gentlemen appointed me

A kind of governor to both their sons.

DAVUS. A hard task, Geta!

GETA. Troth, I found it so.

My angry Genius for my sins ordain'd it.

At first I took upon me to oppose:

In short, while I was trusty to th' old man,

The young one made my shoulders answer for it.

DAVUS. So I suppose: for what a foolish task

To kick against the pricks!

GETA. I then resolv'd

To give them their own way in every thing.

DAVUS. Aye, then you made your market.

GETA. Our young spark

Play'd no mad pranks at first: but Phædria

Got him immediately a music-girl:

Fond of her to distraction! she belong'd

To a most avaricious, sordid pimp;

Nor had we aught to give;—th' old gentleman

Had taken care of that. Naught else remain'd,

Except to feed his eyes, to follow her,

To lead her out to school, and hand her home.

We too, for lack of other business, gave

Our time to Phædria. Opposite the school,

Whither she went to take her lessons, stood

A barber's shop, wherein most commonly

We waited her return. Hither one day

Came a young man in tears: we were amaz'd,
And ask'd the cause. Never (said he, and wept)
Did I suppose the weight of poverty
A load so sad, so insupportable,
As it appear'd but now.—I saw but now,
Not far from hence, a miserable virgin
Lamenting her dead mother. Near the corpse
She sat; nor friend, nor kindred, nor acquaintance,
Except one poor old woman, was there near
To aid the funeral. I pitied her:
Her beauty, too, was exquisite.—In short,
He mov'd us all: and Antipho at once
Cried, "Shall we go and visit her?"—Why, aye,
"I think so," said the other; "let us go!"
"Conduct us, if you please."—We went, arriv'd.
And saw her.—Beautiful she was indeed!
More justly to be reckon'd so, for she
Had no additions to set off her beauty.
Her hair dishevel'd, barefoot, woe-begone,
In tears, and miserably clad: that if
The life and soul of beauty had not dwelt
Within her very form, all these together
Must have extinguish'd it.—The spark, possess'd
Already with the music-girl, just cried,
"She's well enough."—But our young gentleman——

DAVUS. Fell, I suppose, in love.

GETA. In love, indeed.

But mark the end! next day, away he goes
To the old woman straight, beseeching her
To let him have the girl.—"Not she, indeed!
Nor was it like a gentleman," she said,
"For him to think on't: She's a citizen,
An honest girl, and born of honest parents:——
If he would marry her indeed, by law
He might do *that*; on no account, aught else."
—Our spark, distracted, knew not what to do:

At once he long'd to marry her, at once
Dreaded his absent father.

DAVUS. Would not he,
Had he return'd, have giv'n consent?

GETA. To wed
A girl of neither family nor fortune?
Never.

DAVUS. What then?

GETA. What then! There is a parasite,
One Phormio, a bold, enterprising fellow,
Who—all the Gods confound him!——

DAVUS. What did he?

GETA. Gave us the following counsel.
—“There's a law
That orphan Girls should wed their next of
kin,
Which law obliges too their next of kin
To marry them.”—I'll say that you're her
kinsman,
And sue a writ against you. I'll pretend
To be her father's friend, and bring the
cause
Before the judges. Who her father was,
Her mother who, and how she's your
relation,
All this sham evidence I'll forge; by which
The cause will turn entirely in my favor.
You shall disprove no title of the charge;
So I succeed.—Your father will return;
Prosecute me;—what then?—The girl's our
own.”

You shall disprove no tittle of the charge;

DAVUS. A pleasant piece of impudence!

GETA. It pleas'd
Our spark at least: he put it into practice;

Came into court; and he was cast; and married.

DAVUS. How say you?

GETA. Just as you have heard.

DAVUS. Oh Geta,
What will become of you?

GETA. I don't know, faith.
But only this I know, what'er chance brings,
I'll patiently endure.

DAVUS. Why, that's well said,
And like a man.

GETA. All my dependence is
Upon myself.

DAVUS. And that's the best.

GETA. I might
Beg one indeed to intercede for me,
Who may plead thus—"Nay, pardon him this once!
But if he fails again, I've not a word
To say for him."—And well if he don't add,
"When I go hence e'en hang him!"

DAVUS. What of him,
Gentleman-usher to the music-girl?
How goes he on?

GETA. So, so!

DAVUS. He has not much
To give, perhaps.

GETA. Just nothing, but mere hope.

DAVUS. His father too, is he return'd?

GETA. Not yet.

DAVUS. Nor your old man, when do you look for him?

GETA. I don't know certainly: but I have heard

That there's a letter from him come to port,
Which I am going for.

DAVUS. Would you aught else
With me, good Geta?

GETA. Nothing, but farewell!

(*Exit* DAVUS.

Ho, boy! what, nobody at home! (*Enter boy.*) Take this
And give it Dorcium. (*Gives the Purse, and Exit.*)

SCENE III.

ANTIPHO, PHÆDRIA.

ANT. Is it come to this?
My father, Phædria!—my best friend!—That I
Should tremble, when I think of his return!
When, had I not been inconsiderate,
I, as 'tis meet, might have expected him.

PHÆD. What now?

ANT. Is that a question? and from you?
Who know the atrocious fault I have committed?
Oh, that it ne'er had enter'd Phormio's mind
To give such counsel! nor to urge me on,
In the extravagance of blind desire,
To this rash act, the source of my misfortunes!
I should not have possess'd her: that indeed
Had made me wretched some few days.—But then
This constant anguish had not torn my mind.—

PHÆD. I hear you.

ANT. —While each moment I expect
His coming to divorce me.

PHÆD. Other men,
For lack of what they love, are miserable;

Abundance is your grievance. You're too rich
A lover, Antipho! For your condition
Is to be wish'd and pray'd for. Now, by Heaven,
Might I, so long as you have done, enjoy
My love, it were bought cheaply with my life.
How hard my lot, unsatisfied, unblest'd!
How happy yours, in full possession!—One
Of lib'ral birth, ingenuous disposition,
And honest fame, without expense, you've got:
The wife, whom you desir'd!—in all things blest'd,
But want the disposition to believe so.
Had you, like me, a scoundrel pimp to deal with,
Then you'd perceive—But sure 'tis in our nature
Never to be contented.

ANT. Now to me,
Phædria, 'tis you appear the happy man.
Still quite at large, free to consider still,
To keep, pursue, or quit her: I, alas!
Have so entangled and perplex'd myself,
That I can neither keep nor let her go.
—What now? isn't that our Geta, whom I see
Running this way?—'Tis he himself— Ah me,
How do I fear what news he brings!

SCENE IV.

Enter at a distance GETA, running.

GETA. Confusion!
A quick thought, Geta, or you're quite undone,
So many evils take you unprepar'd;
Which I know neither how to shun nor how
To extricate myself: for this bold stroke
Of ours can't long be hid.

ANT. What's this confusion?

GETA. Then I have scarce a moment's time to think.
My master is arriv'd.

ANT. What mischief's that?

GETA. Who, when he shall have heard it, by what art
Shall I appease his anger?—Shall I speak?
'Twill irritate him.—Hold my peace?—enrage him.—
Defend myself?—impossible?—Oh, wretch!
Now for myself in pain, now Antipho
Distracts my mind.—But him I pity most;
For him I fear; 'tis he retains me here:
For, were it not for him, I'd soon provide
For my own safety—aye, and be reveng'd
On the old graybeard—carry something off,
And show my master a light pair of heels.

ANT. What scheme to rob and run away is this?

GETA. But where shall I find Antipho? where seek him?

PHÆD. He mentions you.

ANT. I know not what, but doubt
That he's the messenger of some ill news.

PHÆD. Have you your wits?

GETA. I'll home: he's chiefly there.

PHÆD. Let's call him back!

ANT. Holloa, you! stop!

GETA. Heyday!
Authority enough, be who you will.

ANT. Geta!

GETA (*turning*). The very man I wish'd to meet!

ANT. Tell us, what news?—in one word, if you can.

GETA. I'll do it.

ANT. Speak!

GETA. This moment at the port——

ANT. My father?

GETA. Even so.

ANT. Undone!

PHÆD. Heyday!

ANT. What shall I do?

PHÆD. What say you? (*To GETA.*)

GETA. That I've seen
His father, Sir,—your uncle.

ANT. How shall I,
Wretch that I am! oppose this sudden evil!
Should I be so unhappy to be torn
From thee, my Phanium, life's not worth my care.

GETA. Since that's the case then, Antipho, you ought
To be the more upon your guard.

ANT. Alas!
I'm not myself.

GETA. But now you should be most so, Antipho.
For if your father should discern your fear,
He'll think you conscious of a fault.

PHÆD. That's true.

ANT. I can not help it, nor seem otherwise.

GETA. How would you manage in worse difficulties?

ANT. Since I'm not equal to bear this, to those
I should be more unequal.

GETA. This is nothing.
Pooh, Phædria, let him go! why waste our time?
I will be gone. (*Going.*)

PHÆD. And I. (*Going.*)

ANT. Nay, prithee, stay!
What if I should dissemble?—Will that do?

(*Endeavoring to assume another air.*

GETA. Ridiculous!

ANT. Nay, look at me! will that
Suffice?

GETA. Not it.

ANT. Or this?

GETA. Almost.

ANT. Or this?

GETA. Aye! now you've hit it. Do but stick to that;
Answer him boldly; give him hit for dash,
Nor let him bear you down with angry words.

ANT. I understand you.

GETA. "Forc'd"—"against your will"—
"By law"—"by sentence of the court"—
d'ye take me?

—But what old gentleman is that I see
At t'other end o' th' street?

Turning the corner of the street?

ANT. 'Tis he himself.
I dare not face him. (*Going.*)

ANT. 'Tis he.
I dare not face him. (*Going.*)

GETA. Ah! what is't you do?
Where d'ye run, Antipho! stay, stay, I say.

ANT. I know myself and my offense too
well:
To you, then, I commend my life and love.

(*Exit.*

SCENE V.

Manent PHÆDRIA *and* GETA.

PHÆD. Geta, what now?

GETA. You shall be roundly chid;
I soundly drubb'd; or I am much deceiv'd.
—But what e'en now we counsel'd Antipho,
It now behooves ourselves to practice, Phædria.

PHÆD. Talk not of what behooves, but say at once
What you would have me do.

GETA. Do you remember
The plea whereon you both agreed to rest,
At your first vent'ring on this enterprise?
“That Phormio's suit was just, sure, equitable,
Not to be controverted.”——

PHÆD. I remember.

GETA. Now then that plea! or, if it's possible,
One better or more plausible.

PHÆD. I'll do't.

GETA. Do you attack him first! I'll lie in ambush,
To reinforce you, if you give ground.

PHÆD. Well. (*They retire.*)

SCENE VI.

Enter DEMIPHO at another part of the stage.

DEM. How's this? a wife! what, Antipho! and ne'er
Ask my consent?—nor my authority——
Or, grant we pass authority, not dread
My wrath at least?—To have no sense of shame?
—Oh, impudence!—Oh, Geta, rare adviser!

GETA. Geta at last.

DEM. What they will say to me,
Or what excuse they will devise, I wonder.

GETA. Oh, we have settled that already: think
Of something else.

DEM. Will he say this to me,
—“Against my will I did it”—“Forc’d by law”—
—I hear you: I confess it.

GETA. Very well.

DEM. But conscious of the fraud, without a word
In answer or defense, to yield the cause
Tamely to your opponents—did the law
Force you to *that* too?

PHÆD. That’s home.

GETA. Give me leave.
I’ll manage it.

DEM. I know not what to do:
This stroke has come so unawares upon me,
Beyond all expectation, past belief.
—I’m so enrag’d, I can’t compose my mind
To think upon it.—Wherefore ev’ry man,
When his affairs go on most swimmingly,
Ev’n then it most behooves to arm himself
Against the coming storm: loss, danger, exile,
Returning ever let him look to meet;
His son in fault, wife dead, or daughter sick——
All common accidents, and may have happen’d;
That nothing should seem new or strange. But if
Aught has fall’n out beyond his hopes, all that
Let him account clear gain.

GETA. Oh, Phædria,
’Tis wonderful how much a wiser man
I am than my old master. My misfortunes
I have consider’d well.—At his return
Doom’d to grind ever in the mill, beat, chain’d,
Or set to labor in the fields; of these
Nothing will happen new. If aught falls out

Beyond my hopes, all that I'll count clear gain.
—But why delay t'accost th' old gentleman,
And speak him fair at first? (PHÆDRIA *goes forward.*)

DEM. Methinks I see
My nephew Phædria.

PHÆD. My good Uncle, welcome!

DEM. Your servant!—But where's Antipho?

PHÆD. I'm glad
To see you safe——

DEM. Well, well!—But answer me.

PHÆD. He's well: hard by.—But have affairs turn'd out
According to your wishes?

DEM. Would they had!

PHÆD. Why, what's the matter?

DEM. What's the matter, Phædria?
You've clapp'd up a fine marriage in my absence.

PHÆD. What! are you angry with him about that?

GETA. Well counterfeited!

DEM. Should I not be angry?
Let me but set eyes on him, he shall know
That his offenses have converted me
From a mild father to a most severe one.

PHÆD. He has done nothing, Uncle, to offend you.

DEM. See, all alike! the whole gang hangs together:
Know one, and you know all.

PHÆD. Nay, 'tis not so.

DEM. One does a fault, the other's hard at hand
To bear him out: when t'other slips, *he's* ready:
Each in their turn!

GETA. I' faith th' old gentleman

Has blunder'd on their humors to a hair.

DEM. If 'twere not so, you'd not defend
him, Phædria.

DEM. For, were't not so, you'd not defend him
Phædria.

PHÆD. If, Uncle, Antipho has done a
wrong,
Or to his interest or reputation,
I am content he suffer as he may:
But if another, with malicious fraud,
Has laid a snare for unexperienced youth,
And triumph'd o'er it; can you lay the
blame
On us, or on the judges, who oft take
Through envy from the rich, or from
compassion
Add to the poor?

GETA. Unless I knew the cause,
I should imagine this was truth he spoke.

DEM. What judge can know the merits on your side,
When you put in no plea; as he has done?

PHÆD. He has behav'd like an ingenuous youth.
When he came into court, he wanted pow'r
To utter what he had prepar'd, so much
He was abash'd by fear and modesty.

GETA. Oh brave!—But why, without more loss of time,
Don't I accost th' old man! (*Going up.*) My master, welcome!
I am rejoic'd to see you safe return'd.

DEM. What! my good master Governor! your slave!
The prop! the pillar of our family!
To whom, at my departure hence, I gave
My son in charge.

GETA. I've heard you for some time
Accuse us all quite undeservedly,
And me, of all, most undeservedly.
For what could I have done in this affair?

A slave the laws will not allow to plead;
Nor can he be an evidence.

DEM. I grant it.
Nay more—the boy was bashful—I allow it.
—You but a slave.—But if she had been prov'd
Ever so plainly a relation, why
Needed he marry her? and why not rather
Give her, according to the law, a portion,
And let her seek some other for a husband?
Why did he rather bring a beggar home?

GETA. 'Twas not the thought, but money that was wanting.

DEM. He might have borrow'd it!

GETA. Have borrow'd it!
Easily said.

DEM. If not to be had else,
On interest.

GETA. Nay, now indeed you've hit it!
Who would advance him money in your life?

DEM. Well, well, it shall not, and it can not be,
That I should suffer her to live with him
As wife a single day. There is no cause.
—Would I might see that fellow, or could tell
Where he resides!

GETA. What, Phormio!

DEM. The girl's Patron.

GETA. He shall be with you straight.

DEM. Where's Antipho?

PHÆD. Abroad.

DEM. Go, Phædria; find him, bring him here.

PHÆD. I'll go directly.

(*Exit*

GETA (*aside*). Aye, to Pamphila.

(*Exit*

SCENE VII.

DEMIPHO *alone*.

I'll home, and thank the Gods for my return:
Thence to the Forum, and convene some friends,
Who may be present at this interview,
That Phormio may not take me unprepar'd.

(*Exit.*

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.

PHORMIO, GETA.

PHOR. And Antipho, you say, has slunk away,
Fearing his father's presence?

GETA. Very true.

PHOR. Poor Phanium left alone?

GETA. 'Tis even so.

PHOR. And the old gentleman enrag'd!

GETA. Indeed.

PHOR. The sum of all then, Phormio, rests on you:

On you, and you alone. You've bak'd this cake;
E'en eat it for your pains. About it then!

GETA. I do beseech you.

PHOR. (*to himself*.) What if he inquire?——

GETA. Our only hope's in you.

PHOR. (*to himself*.) I have it!—Then,
Suppose he offer to return the girl?——

GETA. You urg'd us to it.

PHOR. (*to himself*.) Aye! it shall be so.

GETA. Assist us!

PHOR. Let him come, old gentleman!
'Tis here: it is engender'd: I am arm'd
With all my counsels.

GETA. What d'ye mean to do?

PHOR. What would you have me do, unless contrive
That Phanium may remain, that Antipho
Be freed from blame, and all the old man's rage
Turn'd upon me?

GETA. Brave fellow! friend indeed!
And yet I often tremble for you, Phormio,
Lest all this noble confidence of yours
End in the stocks at last.

PHOR. Ah, 'tis not so.
I'm an old stager too, and know my road.
How many men d'ye think I've bastinadoed
Almost to death? Aliens and citizens?
The oft'ner, still the safer.—Tell me then,
Didst ever hear of actions for assault
And batt'ry brought against me?

GETA. How comes that?

PHOR. Because the net's not stretch'd to
catch the hawk,
Or kite, who do us wrong; but laid for
those
Who do us none at all: In them there's
profit,
In those mere labor lost. Thus other men
May be in danger who have aught to lose;
I, the world knows, have nothing.—You
will say,
They'll seize my person.—No, they won't
maintain
A fellow of my stomach.—And they're
wise,
In my opinion, if for injuries
They'll not return the highest benefit.

In these mere labor lost. Thus other men

GETA. It is impossible for Antipho
To give you thanks sufficient.

PHOR. Rather say,
No man sufficiently can thank his patron.
You at free cost to come! anointed, bath'd,
Easy and gay! while he's eat up with care
And charge, to cater for your entertainment!
He gnaws his heart, you laugh; eat first, sit first,
And see a doubtful banquet plac'd before you!

GETA. Doubtful! what phrase is that?

PHOR. Where you're in doubt,
What you shall rather choose. Delights like these
When you but think how sweet, how dear, they are;
Him that affords them must you not suppose
A very deity?

GETA. The old man's here.
Mind what you do! the first attack's the fiercest:
Sustain but that, the rest will be mere play. (*They retire.*)

SCENE II.

Enter at a distance DEMIPHO—HEGIO, CRATINUS, CRITO, *following.*

DEM. Was ever man so grossly treated, think ye?
—This way, Sirs, I beseech you.

GETA. He's enrag'd!

PHOR. Hist! mind your cue: I'll work him.—(*Coming forward, and speaking loud.*) Oh, ye Gods!

Does he deny that Phanium's his relation?
What, Demipho! does Demipho deny
That Phanium is his kinswoman?

GETA. He does.

PHOR. And who her father was, he does not know?

GETA. No.

DEM. (*to the Lawyers*). Here's the very fellow, I believe,
Of whom I have been speaking.—Follow me!

PHOR. (*aloud*). And that he does not know who Stilpho was?

GETA. No.

PHOR. Ah! because, poor thing, she's left in want,
Her father is unknown, and she despis'd.
What will not avarice do?

GETA. If you insinuate
My master's avaricious, woe be to you!

DEM. (*behind*). Oh impudence! he dares accuse me first.

PHOR. As to the youth, I can not take offense,
If he had not much knowledge of him; since,
Now in the vale of years, in want, his work
His livelihood, he nearly altogether
Liv'd in the country: where he held a farm
Under my father. I have often heard

The poor old man complain that this his kinsman
Neglected him.—But what a man! A man
Of most exceeding virtue.

GETA. Much at one:
Yourself and he you praise so much.

PHOR. Away!
Had I not thought him what I've spoken of him,
I would not for his daughter's sake have drawn
So many troubles on our family,
Whom this old cuff now treats so scandalously.

GETA. What, still abuse my absent master, rascal!

PHOR. It is no more than he deserves.

GETA. How, villain!

DEM. Geta! (*Calling.*)

GETA. Rogue, robber, pettifogger! (*To PHORMIO pretending not to hear*
DEMIPHO.)

DEM. Geta!

PHOR. Answer. (*Apart to GETA.*)

GETA (*turning*). Who's that?—Oh!

DEM. Peace!

GETA. Behind your back
All day without cessation has this knave
Thrown scurvy terms upon you, such as none
But men like him can merit.

DEM. Well! have done.

(*Putting GETA by, then addressing PHORMIO.*)

Young man! permit me first to ask one question.
And, if you please, vouchsafe to answer me.
—Who was this friend of yours? Explain! and how
Might he pretend that I was his relation?

PHOR. So! you fish for't, as if you did not know. (*Sneeringly.*)

DEM. Know! I!

PHOR. Aye; you.

DEM. Not I: You that maintain
I ought, instruct me how to recollect.

PHOR. What! not acquainted with your cousin?

DEM. Plague!
Tell me his name.

PHOR. His name? aye!

DEM. Well, why don't you?

PHOR. Confusion! I've forgot the name. (*Apart.*)

DEM. What say you?

PHOR. Geta, if you remember, prompt me. (*Apart to GETA.*)—Pshaw,
I will not tell.—As if you did not know,
You're come to try me. (*Loud to DEMIPHO.*)

DEM. How! try you?

GETA. Stilpho. (*Whispering PHORMIO.*)

PHOR. What is't to me?—Stilpho.

DEM. Whom say you?

PHOR. Stilpho:
Did you know Stilpho, Sir?

DEM. I neither know him,
Nor ever had I kinsman of that name.

PHOR. How! are you not ashamed?—But if, poor man,
Stilpho had left behind him an estate
Of some ten talents——

DEM. Out upon you!

PHOR. Then
You would have been the first to trace your line

Quite from your grandsire and great grandsire.

DEM. True.

Had I then come, I'd have explain'd at large
How she was my relation: so do you!
Say, how is she my kinswoman?

GETA. Well said!

Master, you're right.—Take heed! (*Apart to PHORMIO.*)

PHOR. I have explain'd
All that most clearly, where I ought, in court.
If it were false, why did not then your son
Refute it?

DEM. Do you tell me of my son?
Whose folly can't be spoke of as it ought.

PHOR. But you, who are so wise, go seek the judge:
Ask sentence in the self-same cause again:
Because you're lord alone, and have alone
Pow'r to obtain judgment of the court
Twice in one cause.

DEM. Although I have been wrong'd,
Yet, rather than engage in litigation,
And rather than hear you; as if she were
Indeed related to us, as the law
Ordains, I'll pay her dowry: take her hence,
And with her take five minæ.

PHOR. Ha! ha! ha!
A pleasant gentleman!

DEM. Why, what's the matter?
Have I demanded any thing unjust?
Sha'n't I obtain this neither, which is law?

PHOR. Is't even so, Sir?—Like a common harlot,
When you've abus'd her, does the law ordain
That you should pay her hire and whistle her off?
Or, lest a citizen through poverty

Bring shame upon her honor, does it order
That she be given to her next of kin
To pass her life with him? which you forbid.

DEM. Aye; to her next of kin: But why to us;
Or wherefore?

PHOR. Oh! that matter is all settled:
Think on't no more.

DEM. Not think on't! I shall think
Of nothing else till there's an end of this.

PHOR. Words, words!

DEM. I'll make them good.

PHOR. But, after all,
With you I have no business, Demipho!
Your son is cast, not you: for at your age
The coupling-time is over.

DEM. Be assur'd
That all I've said he says: or I'll forbid
Him and this wife of his my house.

GETA. He's angry. (*Apart.*)

PHOR. No; you'll think better on't.

DEM. Are you resolv'd,
Wretch that you are, to thwart me ev'ry way?

PHOR. He fears, though he dissembles. } (*Apart.*)

GETA. Well begun!

PHOR. Well; but what can't be cur'd must be endur'd:
'Twere well, and like yourself, that we were friends.

DEM. I! friend to you? or choose to see or hear you!

PHOR. Do but agree with her, you'll have a girl
To comfort your old age. Your years, consider!

DEM. Plague on your comfort! take her to yourself!

PHOR. Ah! don't be angry!

DEM. One word more, I've done.
See that you fetch away this wench, and soon,
Or I shall turn her headlong out o' doors.
So much for Phormio!

PHOR. Offer but to touch her
In any other manner than beseems
A gentlewoman and a citizen,
And I shall bring a swinging writ against you.
So much for Demipho!—If I am wanted,
I am at home, d'ye hear? (*Apart to GETA.*)

GETA. I understand. (*Apart.*)

(*Exit PHORMIO.*

SCENE III.

DEM. With how much care, and what solicitude,
My son affects me, with this wretched match
Having embroil'd himself and me! nor comes
Into my sight, that I might know at least
Or what he says, or thinks of this affair.
Go you, and see if he's come home or no.

GETA. I'm gone.

(*Exit.*

DEM. You see, Sirs, how this matter stands.
What shall I do? Say, Hegio!

HEGIO. Meaning me?
Cratinus, please you, should speak first.

DEM. Say then,
Cratinus!

CRA. Me d'ye question?

DEM. You.

CRA. Then I,
Whatever steps are best I'd have you take.
Thus it appears to me. Whate'er your son
Has in your absence done is null and void,
In law and equity.—And so you'll find.
That's my opinion.

DEM. Say now, Hegio!

HEGIO. He has, I think, pronounc'd most learnedly.
But so 'tis: many men, and many minds!
Each has his fancy: Now, in my opinion,
Whate'er is done by law can't be undone.
'Tis shameful to attempt it.

DEM. Say you, Crito!

CRITO. The case, I think, asks more deliberation.
'Tis a nice point.

HEGIO. Would you aught else with us?

DEM. You've utter'd oracles. (*Exeunt Lawyers.*) I'm more uncertain
Now than I was before.

(*Re-enter* GETA.)

GETA. He's not return'd.

DEM. My brother, as I hope, will soon arrive:
Whate'er advice he gives me, that I'll follow.
I'll to the Port, and ask when they expect him. (*Exit.*

GETA. And I'll go find out Antipho, and tell him
All that has pass'd.—But here he comes in time.

SCENE IV.

Enter at a distance ANTIPHO.

ANT. (*to himself*). Indeed, indeed, my Antipho,
You're much to blame, to be so poor in spirit.
What! steal away so guilty-like! and trust

Your life and safety to the care of others!
Would they be touch'd more nearly than yourself?
Come what come might of ev'ry thing beside,
Could you abandon the dear maid at home?
Could you so far deceive her easy faith,
And leave her to misfortune and distress?
Her, who plac'd all her hopes in you alone?

GETA (*coming forward*). I' faith, Sir, we have thought you much to blame
For your long absence.——

ANT. You're the very man
That I was looking for.

GETA. —But ne'ertheless
We've miss'd no opportunity.

ANT. Oh, speak!
How go my fortunes, Geta? has my father
Any suspicion that I was in league
With Phormio?

GETA. Not a jot.

ANT. And may I hope?

GETA. I don't know.

ANT. Ah!

GETA. Unless that Phædria
Did all he could do for you.——

ANT. Nothing new.

GETA. —And Phormio has on all occasions else.
Prov'd himself a brave fellow.

ANT. What did he?

GETA. Out-swagger'd your hot father.

ANT. Well said, Phormio!

GETA. —I did the best I could too.

ANT. Honest Geta,
I am much bounden to you all.

GETA. Thus, Sir,
Stand things at present. As yet all is calm.
Your father means to wait your uncle's coming.

ANT. For what?

GETA. For his advice, as he propos'd;
By which he will be rul'd in this affair.

ANT. How do I dread my uncle's coming, Geta.
Since by his sentence I must live or die!

GETA. But here comes Phædria.

ANT. Where?

GETA. From his old school. (*They retire.*)

SCENE V.

Enter, from Dorio's, DORIO, PHÆDRIA following.

PHÆD. Nay, hear me, Dorio!

DORIO. Not I.

PHÆD. But a word!

DORIO. Let me alone.

PHÆD. Pray hear me!

DORIO. I am tir'd
With hearing the same thing a thousand times.

PHÆD. But what I'd say you would be glad to hear.

DORIO. Speak then! I hear.

PHÆD. Can't I prevail on you
To stay but these three days?— Nay, where d'ye go?

DORIO. I should have wonder'd had you said aught new.

ANT. (*behind*). This pimp, I fear, will work himself no good.

GETA. I fear so too.

PHÆD. Won't you believe me?

DORIO. Guess.

PHÆD. Upon my honor.

DORIO. Nonsense.

PHÆD. 'Tis a kindness
Shall be repaid with interest.

DORIO. Words, words!

PHÆD. You'll be glad on't; you will, believe me.

DORIO. Pshaw!

PHÆD. Try; 'tis not long.

DORIO. You're in the same tune still.

PHÆD. My kinsman, parent, friend!——

DORIO. Aye, talk away.

PHÆD. Can you be so inflexible, so cruel.
That neither pity nor entreaties touch you?

DORIO. And can you be so inconsiderate,
And so unconscionable, Phædria,
To think that you can talk me to your purpose,
And wheedle me to give the girl for nothing?

ANT. (*behind*). Poor Phædria!

PHÆD. (*to himself*). Alas! he speaks the truth.

GETA (*to ANTIPHO*). How well they each support their characters!

PHÆD. (*to himself*). Then that this evil should have come
upon me,
When Antipho was in the like distress!

ANT. (*going up*). Ha! what now, Phædria?

PHÆD. Happy, happy Antipho!——

ANT. I?

PHÆD. Who have her you love in your possession,
Nor e'er had plagues like these to struggle with!

ANT. In my possession? yes, I have, indeed,
As the old saying goes, a wolf by th' ears:
For I can neither part with her nor keep her.

DORIO. 'Tis just my case with him.

ANT. (to DORIO). Thou thorough bawd!
—(To PHÆDRIA.) What has he done?

PHÆD. Done?—The inhuman wretch
Has sold my Pamphila.

GETA. What! sold her?

ANT. Sold her?

PHÆD. Yes; sold her.

DORIO (*laughing*). Sold her.—What a monstrous crime!
A wench he paid his ready money for.

PHÆD. I can't prevail upon him to wait for me,
And to stave off his bargain but three days;
Till I obtain the money from my friends,
According to their promise.—If I do not
Pay it you then, don't wait a moment longer.

DORIO. You stun me.

ANT. 'Tis a very little time
For which he asks your patience, Dorio.
Let him prevail on you; your complaisance
Shall be requited doubly.

DORIO. Words; mere words!

ANT. Can you then bear to see your Pamphila
Torn from this city, Phædria?—Can you, Dorio,
Divide their loves

DORIO. Nor I, nor you.

GETA. Plague on you!

DORIO (*to PHÆDRIA*). I have, against my natural disposition,
Borne with you several months, still promising,
Whimpering, and ne'er performing any thing:
Now, on the contrary, I've found a spark,
Who'll prove a ready-paymaster, no sniveler:
Give place then to your betters!

ANT. Surely, Phædria,
There was, if I remember, a day settled
That you should pay the money down.

PHÆD. There was.

DORIO. Do I deny it?

ANT. Is the day past?

DORIO. No.
But this has come before it.

ANT. Infamous!
Ar'n't you ashamed of such base treachery?

DORIO. Not I, while I can get by't.

GETA. Scavenger!

PHÆD. Is this just dealing, Dorio?

DORIO. 'Tis my way:
So, if you like me, use me.

ANT. Can you deceive him thus?

DORIO. Nay, Antipho,
'Tis he deceives me: he was well aware
What kind of man I was, but I believ'd
Him different. He has disappointed me,
But I am still the same to him as ever.
However, thus much I can do for him;
The Captain promis'd to pay down the money

To-morrow morning. But now, Phædria,
If you come first, I'll follow my old rule,
"The first to pay shall be first serv'd." Farewell.

(Exit.

SCENE VI.

PHÆDRIA, ANTIPHO, GETA.

PHÆD. What shall I do? Unhappy that I am,
How shall I, who am almost worse than nothing,
Raise such a sum so suddenly?—Alas!
Had I prevail'd on him to wait three days,
I had a promise of it.

ANT. Shall we, Geta,
Suffer my Phædria to be miserable?
My best friend Phædria, who but now, you said,
Assisted me so heartily?—No—Rather
Let us, since there is need, return his kindness!

GETA. It is but just, I must confess.

ANT. Come then;
'Tis you alone can save him.

GETA. By what means?

ANT. Procure the money.

GETA. Willingly: but whence?

ANT. My father is arriv'd.

GETA. He is: what then?

ANT. A word to the wise, Geta!

GETA. Say you so?

ANT. Ev'n so.

GETA. By Hercules, 'tis rare advice.

Are you there with me? will it not be triumph,
So I but 'scape a scouring for your match,
That you must urge me to run risks for him?

ANT. He speaks the truth, I must confess.

PHÆD. How's that?
Am I a stranger to you, Geta?

GETA. No:

Nor do I hold you such. But is it nothing
That the old man now rages at us all,
Unless we irritate him so much further
As to preclude all hopes to pacify him?

That Demipho now rages at us all,

PHÆD. Shall then another bear her hence?

Ah me!

Now then, while I remain, speak to me,
Antipho.

Behold me!

ANT. Wherefore? what is it you mean?

PHÆD. Wherever she's convey'd, I'll follow her;
Or perish.

GETA. Heaven prosper your designs!—
Gently, Sir, gently!

ANT. See if you can help him.

GETA. Help him! but how?

ANT. Nay, think, invent, devise;
Lest he do something we repent of, Geta!

GETA. I'm thinking. (*Pausing.*)—Well then I believe, he's safe.
But I'm afraid of mischief.

ANT. Never fear:
We'll bear all good and evil fortune with you.

GETA. Tell me the sum you have occasion for.

PHÆD. But thirty minæ.

GETA. Thirty! monstrous, Phædria!
She's very dear.

PHÆD. Dog-cheap.

GETA. Well, say no more.
I'll get them for you.

PHÆD. O brave fellow!

GETA. Hence!

PHÆD. But I shall want it now.

GETA. You'll have it now.
But Phormio must assist me in this business.

ANT. He's ready: lay what load you will upon him,
He'll bear it all; for he's a friend indeed.

GETA. Let's to him quickly then!

ANT. D'ye want my help?

GETA. We've no occasion for you. Get you home
To the poor girl, who's almost dead with fear;
And see you comfort her.—Away! d'ye loiter?

ANT. There's nothing I would do so willingly.

(Exit.

PHÆD. But how will you effect this?

GETA. I'll explain
That matter as we go along.—Away!

(Exeunt.

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.

Enter DEMIPHO and CHREMES.

DEM. Well, Chremes, have you brought
your daughter with you,
On whose account you went to Lemnos?

CHREM. No.

DEM. Why not?

CHREM. It seems the mother, grown
impatient,
Perceiving that I tarried here so long,
And that the girl's age brook'd not my
delays,
Had journeyed here, they said, in search of
me,
With her whole family.

CHREM. Her mother grown, it seems, impatient

DEM. Appris'd of this,
What kept you there so long then?

CHREM. A disease.

DEM. How came it? what disease?

CHREM. Is that a question?
Old age itself is a disease.—However,
The master of the ship, who brought them over,
Inform'd me of their safe arrival hither.

DEM. Have you heard, Chremes, of my son's misfortune
During my absence?

CHREM. Aye; and it confounds me.
For to another should I tender her,
I must relate the girl's whole history,
And whence arises my connection with her.
You I can trust as safely as myself:

But if a stranger courts alliance with me,
While we're new friends, he'll hold his peace perhaps,
But if he cools, he'll know too much of me.
Then I'm afraid my wife should know of this;
Which if she does, I've nothing else to do
But shake myself, and leave my house directly:
For I've no friend at home except myself.

DEM. I know it; and 'tis that which touches me.
Nor are there any means I'll leave untried,
Till I have made my promise to you good.

SCENE II.

Enter, at another part of the stage, GETA.

GETA (*to himself*). I never saw a more
shrewd rogue than Phormio.
I came to let him know we wanted money,
With my advice for getting it; and scarce With my device for getting it; and scarce
Had I related half, but he conceiv'd me.
He was o'erjoy'd; commended me;
demanded
To meet with Demipho; and thank'd the
god;
That it was now the time to show himself
As truly Phædria's friend as Antipho's.
I bade him wait us at the Forum; whither
I'd bring th' old gentleman.—And there he
is!
—But who's the furthestmost? Ha!
Phædria's father.
—Yet what was I afraid of, simpleton?
That I have got two dupes instead of one?
Is it not better that my hopes are doubled?
—I'll attack him, I first propos'd. If he
Answers my expectation, well: if not,

Why then have at you, uncle!

SCENE III.

Enter behind, ANTIPHO.

ANT. (*to himself*). I expect
Geta's arrival presently.—But see!
Yonder's my uncle with my father.—Ah!
How do I dread his influence!

GETA. I'll to them.
Oh, good Sir Chremes! (*Going up.*)

CHREM. Save you, save you, Geta!

GETA. I'm glad to see you safe arriv'd.

CHREM. I thank you.

GETA. How go affairs?

CHREM. A world of changes here,
As usual at first coming home again.

GETA. True. Have you heard of Antipho's affair?

CHREM. The whole.

GETA (*to DEMIPHO*). Did you inform him, Sir?—'Tis monstrous, Chremes,
To be so shamefully impos'd upon!

DEM. 'Twas on that point I was just talking with him.

GETA. And I too, having turn'd it in my thoughts,
Have found, I think, a remedy.

DEM. How, Geta?
What remedy?

GETA. On leaving you, by chance
I met with Phormio.

CHREM. Who is Phormio?

GETA. The girl's solicitor.

CHREM. I understand.

GETA. I thought within myself, "suppose I found him!"

And taking him aside, "Now prithee, Phormio,

Why don't you try to settle this affair

By fair means rather than by foul?" said I.

"My master is a generous gentleman,

And hates to go to law. For I assure you

His other friends advis'd him, to a man,

To turn this girl directly out o' doors."

ANT. (*behind*). What does he mean? or where will all this end?

GETA. "The law, you think, will give you damages

If he attempts to turn her out.—Alas!

He has good counsel upon that.—I' faith,

You'll have hot work if you engage with him;

He's such an orator!—But ev'n suppose

That you should gain your lawsuit, after all

The trial is not for his life, but money."

Perceiving him a little wrought upon,

And soften'd by this style of talking with him,

"Come now," continued I, "we're all alone.

Tell me, what money would you take in hand

To drop your lawsuit, take away the girl,

And trouble us no farther!"

ANT. (*behind*). Is he mad?

GETA. —"For I am well convinc'd, that if your terms

Are not extravagant and wild indeed,

My master's such a worthy gentleman,

You will not change three words between you."

DEM. Who

Commission'd you to say all this?

CHREM. Nay, nay,

Nothing could be more happy to effect

The point we labor at.

ANT. (*behind*). Undone!

CHREM. (*to GETA*). Go on.

GETA. At first he rav'd.

DEM. Why, what did he demand?

GETA. Too much: as much as came into his head.

CHREM. Well, but the sum?

GETA. He talk'd of a great talent.

DEM. Plague on the rascal! what! has he no shame?

GETA. The very thing I said to him.—“Suppose
He was to portion out an only daughter,
What could he give her more?—He profits little,
Having no daughter of his own; since one
Is found to carry off a fortune from him.”
—But to be brief, and not to dwell upon
All his impertinences, he at last
Gave me this final answer.—“From the first,
I wish'd,” said he, “as was indeed most fit,
To wed the daughter of my friend myself.
For I was well aware of her misfortune;
That, being poor, she would be rather given
In slavery, than wedlock, to the rich.
But I was forc'd, to tell you the plain truth,
To take a woman with some little fortune,
To pay my debts: and still, if Demipho
Is willing to advance as large a sum
As I'm to have with one I'm now engag'd to.
There is no wife I'd rather take than her.”

ANT. (*behind*). Whether through malice or stupidity,
He is rank knave or fool, I can not tell.

DEM. (*to GETA*). What, if he owes his soul?

GETA. “I have a farm,”
Continued he, “that's mortgag'd for ten minæ.”

DEM. Well, let him take her then: I'll pay the money.

GETA. "A house for ten more."

DEM. Huy! huy! that's too much.

CHREM. No noise! demand those ten of me.

GETA. "My wife
Must buy a maid; some little furniture
Is also requisite; and some expense
To keep our wedding: all these articles,"
Continues he, "we'll reckon at ten minæ."

DEM. No; let him bring a thousand writs
against me.

DEM. No; let him bring ten thousand writs against
me.

I'll give him nothing. What! afford the
villain

An opportunity to laugh at me?

Colman's note on this passage says in part: "I have ... rendered the *sexcentas* of Terence by *Ten Thousand*, as being most agreeable to the English idiom, as well as the Greek."

CHREM. Nay, but be pacified! I'll pay the money.
Only do you prevail upon your son
To marry her whom we desire.

ANT. (*behind*). Ah me!
Geta, your treachery has ruin'd me.

CHREM. She's put away on my account: 'tis just
That I should pay the money.

GETA. "Let me know,"
Continues he, "as soon as possible,
Whether they mean to have me marry her;
That I may part with t'other, and be certain.
For t'other girl's relations have agreed
To pay the portion down immediately."

CHREM. He shall be paid this too immediately.

Let him break off with her, and take this girl!

DEM. Aye, and the plague go with him!

CHREM. Luckily

It happens I've some money here; the rents

Of my wife's farms at Lemnos. I'll take that; (to DEMIPHO)

And tell my wife that you had need of it.

(Exeunt.)

SCENE IV.

Manent ANTIPHO, GETA.

ANT. *(coming forward)*. Geta!

GETA. Ha, Antipho!

ANT. What have you done!

GETA. Trick'd the old bubbles of their money.

ANT. Well,

Is that sufficient, think ye?

GETA. I can't tell.

'Twas all my orders.

ANT. Knave, d'ye shuffle with me? *(Kicks him.)*

GETA. Plague! what d'ye mean?

ANT. What do I mean, Sirrah!

You've driven me to absolute perdition.

All pow'rs of heav'n and hell confound you for't,

And make you an example to all villains!

—Here! would you have your business duly manag'd,

Commit it to this fellow!—What could be

More tender than to touch upon this sore,

Or even name my wife? my father's fill'd

With hopes that she may be dismiss'd.—And then,

If Phormio gets the money for the portion,

He, to be sure, must marry her.—And what
Becomes of me then?

GETA. He'll not marry her.

ANT. Oh, no: but when they redemand the money,
On my account he'll rather go to jail! (*Ironically.*)

GETA. Many a tale is spoiled in telling, Antipho.
You take out all the good, and leave the bad.
—Now hear the other side—If he receives
The money, he must wed the girl: I grant it.
But then some little time must be allow'd
For wedding-preparation, invitation,
And sacrifices.—Meanwhile, Phædria's friends
Advance the money they have promis'd him:
Which Phormio shall make use of for repayment.

ANT. How so? what reason can he give?

GETA. What reason?
A thousand.—“Since I made this fatal bargain,
Omens and prodigies have happen'd to me.
There came a strange black dog into my house!
A snake fell through the tiling! a hen crow'd!
The Soothsayer forbade it! The Diviner
Charg'd me to enter on no new affair
Before the winter.”—All sufficient reasons.
Thus it shall be.

ANT. Pray Heav'n it may be!

GETA. It shall.
Depend on me:—But here's your father.—Go;
Tell Phædria that the money's safe.

(*Exit* ANTIPHO.

SCENE V.

Re-enter DEMIPHO *and* CHREMES.

DEM. Nay, peace!
I'll warrant he shall play no tricks upon us:
I'll not part rashly with it, I assure you;
But pay it before witnesses, reciting
To whom 'tis paid, and why 'tis paid.

GETA. How cautious,
Where there is no occasion! (*Aside.*)

CHREM. You had need.
But haste, dispatch it while the fit's upon him:
For if the other party should be pressing,
Perhaps he'll break with us.

GETA. You've hit it, Sir.

DEM. Carry me to him then.

GETA. I wait your pleasure.

CHREM. (*to DEMIPHO*). When this is done, step over to my wife,
That she may see the girl before she goes;
And tell her, to prevent her being angry,
"That we've agreed to marry her to Phormio,
Her old acquaintance, and a fitter match;
That we have not been wanting in our duty,
But giv'n as large a portion as he ask'd."

DEM. Pshaw! what's all this to you?

CHREM. A great deal, brother.

DEM. Is't not sufficient to have done your
duty,
Unless the world approves it?

CHREM. I would choose
To have the whole thing done by her
consent,

Lest she pretend she was turn'd out o'
doors.

Lest she pretend we turn'd her out o' doors.

DEM. Well, I can say all this to her myself.

CHREM. A woman deals much better with a
woman.

DEM. I'll ask your wife to do it then.

(*Exeunt* DEMIPHO and GETA.

CHREM. I'm thinking
Where I shall find these women now.

SCENE VI.

Enter SOPHRONA at a distance.

SOPH. (*to herself*). Alas!
What shall I do, unhappy as I am?
Where find a friend? to whom disclose this story?
Of whom beseech assistance?—For I fear
My mistress will sustain some injury
From following my counsel: the youth's father,
I hear, is so offended at this marriage.

CHREM. Who's this old woman, coming from my brother's,
That seems so terrified?

SOPH. (*to herself*). 'Twas poverty
Compell'd me to this action: though I knew
This match would hardly hold together long,
Yet I advis'd her to it, that meanwhile
She might not want subsistence.

CHREM. Surely, surely,
Either my mind deceives me, or my eyes fail me,
Or that's my daughter's nurse.

SOPH. Nor can we find——

CHREM. What shall I do?

SOPH. —Her father out.

CHREM. Were't best
I should go up to her, or wait a little,

To gather something more from her discourse?

SOPH. Could he be found, my fears were at an end.

CHREM. 'Tis she. I'll speak with her.

SOPH. (*overhearing*). Whose voice is that?

CHREM. Sophrona!

SOPH. Ha! my name too?

CHREM. Look this way.

SOPH. (*turning*). Good Heav'n have mercy on us! Stilpho!

CHREM. No.

SOPH. Deny your own name?

CHREM. (*in a low voice*). This way, Sophrona!——

——A little further from that door!—this way!——

And never call me by that name, I charge you.

SOPH. What, ar'n't you then the man you said you was? (*Aloud.*)

CHREM. Hist! hist!

SOPH. What makes you fear those doors so much?

CHREM. I have a fury of a wife within:

And formerly I went by that false name,

Lest she should indiscreetly blab it out,

And so my wife might come to hear of this.

SOPH. Ah! thus it was, that we, alas! poor souls,

Could never find you out here.

CHREM. Well, but tell me,

What business have you with that family? (*Pointing.*)

—Where is your mistress and her daughter?

SOPH. Ah!

CHREM. What now? are they alive?

SOPH. The daughter is:

The mother broke her heart with grief.

CHREM. Alas!

SOPH. And I a poor, unknown, distress'd old woman,
Endeavoring to manage for the best,
Contriv'd to match the virgin to a youth,
Son to the master of this house.

CHREM. To Antipho?

SOPH. The very same.

CHREM. What! has he two wives then?

SOPH. No, mercy on us! he has none but her.

CHREM. What is the other then, who, they pretend,
Is a relation to him?

SOPH. This is she.

CHREM. How say you?

SOPH. It was all a mere contrivance:
That he, who was in love, might marry her
Without a portion.

CHREM. O ye powers of heav'n,
How often fortune blindly brings about
More than we dare to hope for! Coming home,
I've found my daughter, even to my wish,
Match'd to the very person I desir'd.
What we have both been laboring to effect,
Has this poor woman all alone accomplish'd.

SOPH. But now consider what is to be done!
The bridegroom's father is return'd; and he,
They say, is much offended at this marriage.

CHREM. Be of good comfort: there's no danger there.
But, in the name of heav'n and earth, I charge you,
Let nobody discover she's my daughter.

SOPH. None shall discover it from me.

CHREM. Come then!

Follow me in, and you shall hear the rest.

(Exeunt.

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.

DEMIPHO, GETA.

DEM. 'Tis our own fault that we encourage rogues,
By overstraining the due character
Of honesty and generosity.
"Shoot not beyond the mark," the proverb goes.
Was't not enough that he had done us wrong,
But we must also throw him money too,
To live till he devises some new mischief?

GETA. Very right!

DEM. Knavery's now its own reward.

GETA. Very true!

DEM. How like fools have we behav'd!

GETA. So as he keeps his word, and takes the girl,
'Tis well enough.

DEM. Is that a doubt at present?

GETA. A man, you know, may change his mind.

DEM. How! change?

GETA. That I can't tell: but, if perhaps, I say.

DEM. I'll now perform my promise to my brother,
And bring his wife to talk to the young woman.
You, Geta, go before, and let her know
Nausistrata will come and speak with her.

(*Exit* DEMIPHO.

SCENE II.

GETA *alone.*

The money's got for Phædria: all is hush'd:
And Phanium is not to depart as yet.
What more then? where will all this end at last?
—Alas! you're sticking in the same mire still:
You've only chang'd hands, Geta. The disaster
That hung but now directly over you,
Delay perhaps will bring more heavy on you.
You're quite beset, unless you look about.
—Now then I'll home; to lesson Phanium,
That she mayn't stand in fear of Phormio,
Nor dread this conf'rence with Nausistrata.

(*Exit.*

SCENE III.

Enter DEMIPHO *and* NAUSISTRATA.

DEM. Come then, Nausistrata, afford us now
A little of your usual art, and try
To put this woman in good humor with us;
That what is done she may do willingly.

NAUS. I will.

DEM. And now assist us with your counsel,
As with your cash a little while ago.

NAUS. With all my heart: and I am only sorry
That 'tis my husband's fault I can't do more.

DEM. How so?

NAUS. Because he takes such little care
Of the estate my father nurs'd so well:
For from these very farms he never fail'd
To draw two talents by the year. But ah!
What difference between man and man!

DEM. Two talents?

NAUS. Aye—in worse times than these—and yet two talents?

DEM. Huy!

NAUS. What, are you surpris'd?

DEM. Prodigiously.

NAUS. Would I had been a man! I'd show——

DEM. No doubt.

NAUS. —By what means——

DEM. Nay, but spare yourself a little
For the encounter with the girl: lest she,
Flippant and young, may weary you too much.

NAUS. —Well, I'll obey your orders: but I see
My husband coming forth.

SCENE IV.

Enter CHREMES, hastily.

CHREM. Ha!
Has Phormio had the money yet?

CHREM. Ha! Demipho!

DEM. I paid him
Immediately.

CHREM. I'm sorry for't.— (*Seeing*
NAUSISTRATA.)—My wife!
I'd almost said too much. (*Aside.*)

DEM. Why sorry, Chremes?

CHREM. Nothing.—No matter.

DEM. Well, but hark ye, Chremes!
Have you been talking with the girl, and told her
Wherefore we bring your wife?

CHREM. I've settled it.

DEM. Well, and what says she?

CHREM. 'Tis impossible
To send her hence.

DEM. And why impossible?

CHREM. Because they are both so fond of one another.

DEM. What's that to us?

CHREM. A great deal. And besides,
I have discover'd she's related to us.

DEM. Have you your wits?

CHREM. 'Tis so. I'm very serious.
—Nay, recollect a little!

DEM. Are you mad?

NAUS. Good now, beware of wronging a relation!

DEM. She's no relation to us.

CHREM. Don't deny it.
Her father had assum'd another name,
And that deceiv'd you.

DEM. What! not know her father?

CHREM. Perfectly.

DEM. Why did she misname him then?

CHREM. Won't you be rul'd, nor understand me then?

DEM. What can I understand from nothing?

CHREM. Still? (*Impatiently.*)

NAUS. I can't imagine what this means.

DEM. Nor I.

CHREM. Would you know all?—Why then, so help me Heaven,
She has no nearer kindred in the world
Than you and I.

DEM. Oh, all ye powers of heaven!
—Let us go to her then immediately:
I would fain know, or not know, all at once. (*Going.*)

CHREM. Ah! (*Stopping him.*)

DEM. What's the matter?

CHREM. Can't you trust me then?

DEM. Must I believe it? take it upon trust?
—Well, be it so!—But what is to be done
With our friend's daughter?

CHREM. Nothing.

DEM. Drop her?

CHREM. Aye.

DEM. And keep this?

CHREM. Aye.

DEM. Why then, Nausistrata,
You may return. We need not trouble you.

NAUS. Indeed, I think, 'tis better on all sides,
That you should keep her here, than send her hence.
For she appear'd to me, when first I saw her,
Much of a gentlewoman.

(*Exit* NAUSISTRATA.

SCENE V.

Manent DEMIPHO *and* CHREMES.

DEM. What means this?

CHREM. (*looking after* NAUSISTRATA). Is the door shut?

DEM. It is.

CHREM. O Jupiter!

The Gods take care of us. I've found my daughter
Married to your son.

DEM. Ha! how could it be?

CHREM. It is not safe to tell you here.

DEM. Step in then.

CHREM. But hark ye, Demipho!—I would not have
Even our very sons inform'd of this.

(*Exeunt.*

SCENE VI.

ANTIPHO alone.

I'm glad, however my affairs proceed,
That Phædria's have succeeded to his mind.
How wise to foster such desires alone,
As, although cross'd, are easily supplied!
Money, once found, sets Phædria at his ease;
But my distress admits no remedy.
For, if the secret's kept, I live in fear;
And if reveal'd, I am expos'd to shame.
Nor would I now return, but in the hope
Of still possessing her.—But where is Geta?
That I may learn of him the fittest time

To meet my father.

SCENE VII.

Enter, at a distance, PHORMIO.

PHOR. (*to himself*). I've receiv'd the money;
Paid the procurer; carried off the wench;
Who's free, and now in Phædria's possession.
One thing alone remains to be dispatch'd;
To get a respite from th' old gentlemen
To tipple some few days, which I must spend
In mirth and jollity.

ANT. But yonder's Phormio.— (*Goes up.*)
What now?

PHOR. Of what?

ANT. What's Phædria about?
How does he mean to take his fill of love?

PHOR. By acting your part in his turn.

ANT. What part?

PHOR. Flying his father's presence.—And he begs
That you'd act his, and make excuses for him;
For he intends a drinking-bout with me.
I shall pretend to the old gentlemen
That I am going to the fair at Sunium,
To buy the servant-maid that Geta mention'd:
Lest, finding I am absent, they suspect
That I am squandering the sum they paid me.
—But your door opens.

ANT. Who comes here?

PHOR. 'Tis Geta.

SCENE VIII.

Enter hastily, at another part of the stage, GETA.

GETA. O fortune, O best fortune, what high blessings,
What sudden, great, and unexpected joys
Hast thou shower'd down on Antipho to-day!——

ANT. What can this be he's so rejoic'd about?

GETA. —And from what fears deliver'd us, his friends?
—But wherefore do I loiter thus? and why
Do I not throw my cloak upon my shoulder,
And haste to find him out, that he may know
All that has happen'd?

ANT. (to PHORMIO). Do you comprehend
What he is talking of?

PHOR. Do you?

ANT. Not I.

PHOR. I'm just as wise as you.

GETA. I'll hurry hence
To the procurer's.—I shall find them there. (*Going.*)

ANT. Ho, Geta!

GETA. Look ye there!—Is't new or strange,
To be recall'd when one's in haste? (*Going.*)

ANT. Here, Geta!

GETA. Again? bawl on! I'll ne'er stop. (*Going on.*)

ANT. Stay, I say!

GETA. Go, and be drubb'd!

ANT. You shall, I promise you,
Unless you stop, you rascal!

GETA (*stopping*). Hold, hold, Geta!
Some intimate acquaintance this, be sure,
Being so free with you.—But is it he
That I am looking for, or not?—’Tis he.

PHOR. Go up immediately. (*They go up to GETA.*)

ANT. (*to GETA*). What means all this?

GETA. O happy man! the happiest man on earth!
So very happy, that, beyond all doubt,
You are the God’s chief fav’rite, Antipho.

ANT. Would I were! but your reason.

GETA. Is’t enough
To plunge you over head and ears in joy?

ANT. You torture me.

PHOR. No promises! but tell us
What is your news?

GETA. Oh, Phormio! are you here?

PHOR. I am: but why d’ye trifle?

GETA. Mind me then! (*To PHORMIO.*)
No sooner had we paid you at the Forum,
But we return’d directly home again.
—Arriv’d, my master sends me to your wife. (*To ANTIPHO.*)

ANT. For what?

GETA. No matter now, good Antipho.
I was just entering the women’s lodging,
When up runs little Mida; catches me
Hold by the cloak behind, and pulls me back.
I turn about, and ask why he detains me.
He told me, “Nobody must see his mistress:
For Sophrona,” says he, “has just now brought
Demipho’s brother, Chremes, here; and he
Is talking with the women now within.”
—When I heard this, I stole immediately

On tip-toe tow'rd the door; came close; stood hush;
Drew in my breath; applied my ear; and thus,
Deep in attention, catch'd their whole discourse.

ANT. Excellent, Geta!

GETA. Here I overheard
The pleasantest adventure! On my life,
I scarce refrain'd from crying out for joy.

ANT. What?

GETA. What d'ye think? (*Laughing.*)

ANT. I can't tell,

GETA. Oh! it was (*laughing.*)
Most wonderful!—most exquisite!—your uncle
Is found to be the father of your wife.

ANT. How! what?

GETA. He had a sly intrigue, it seems,
With Phanium's mother formerly at Lemnos. (*Laughing.*)

PHOR. Nonsense! as if she did not know her father!

GETA. Nay, there's some reason for it, Phormio,
You may be sure.—But was it possible
For me, who stood without, to comprehend
Each minute circumstance that pass'd within?

ANT. I have heard something of this story too.

GETA. Then, Sir, to settle your belief the more,
At last out comes your uncle; and soon after
Returns again, and carries in your father.
Then they both said, they gave their full consent
That you should keep your Phanium.—In a word,
I'm sent to find you out, and bring you to them.

ANT. Away with me then instantly! D'ye linger?

GETA. Not I. Away!

ANT. My Phormio, fare you well!

PHOR. Fare you well, Antipho!

(Exeunt.

SCENE IX.

PHORMIO *alone.*

Well done, 'fore Heaven!
I'm overjoy'd to see so much good fortune
Fallen thus unexpectedly upon them:
I've now an admirable opportunity
To bubble the old gentlemen, and ease
Phædria of all his cares about the money;
So that he need not be oblig'd to friends.
For this same money, though it will be given,
Will yet come from them much against the grain;
But I have found a way to force them to't.
—Now then I must assume a grander air,
And put another face upon this business.
—I'll hence a while into the next by-alley,
And pop upon them as they're coming forth.
—As for the trip I talk'd of to the fair,
I sha'n't pretend to take that journey now.

(Exit.

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.

Enter DEMIPHO and CHREMES—and soon after, on t'other side,
PHORMIO.

DEM. Well may we thank the gracious Gods, good brother,
That all things have succeeded to our wish.
—But now let's find out Phormio with all speed,
Before he throws away our thirty minæ.

PHOR. (*pretending not to see him*).
I'll go and see if Demipho's at home,
That I may——

DEM. (*meeting him*).—We were coming to you, Phormio.

PHOR. On the old score, I warrant.

DEM. Aye.

PHOR. I thought so.
—Why should you go to me?—ridiculous!
Was you afraid I'd break my contract with you?
No, no! how great soe'er my poverty,
I've always shown myself a man of honor.

CHREM. Has not she, as I said, a liberal air? } *Apart.*

DEM. She has.

PHOR. —And therefore I was coming, Demipho,
To let you know I'm ready to receive
My wife whene'er you please. For I postpon'd
All other business, as indeed I ought,
Soon as I found ye were so bent on this.

DEM. Aye, but my brother has dissuaded me
From going any further in this business.
“For how will people talk of it?” says he:
“At first you might have done it handsomely;
But then you'd not consent to it; and now,
After cohabitation with your son,
To think of a divorce is infamous.”
—In short, he urg'd almost the very things
That you so lately charg'd me with yourself.

PHOR. You trifle with me, gentlemen.

DEM. How so?

PHOR. How so? Because I can not marry t'other,
With whom I told you I was first in treaty.
For with what face can I return to her
Whom I have held in such contempt?

CHREM. Tell him

Antipho does not care to part with her. (*Prompting DEMIPHO.*)

DEM. And my son too don't care to part with her:
—Step to the Forum then, and give an order
For the repayment of our money, Phormio.

PHOR. What! when I've paid it to my creditors?

DEM. What's to be done then?

PHOR. Give me but the wife
To whom you have betroth'd me, and I'll wed her.
But if you'd rather she should stay with you,
The portion stays with me, good Demipho,
For 'tis not just I should be bubbled by you;
When, to retrieve your honor, I've refus'd
Another woman with an equal fortune.

DEM. A plague upon your idle vapping,
You vagabond!—D'ye fancy we don't know you?
You, and your fine proceedings?

PHOR. You provoke me.

DEM. Why, would you marry her, if proffer'd?

PHOR. Try me.

DEM. What! that my son may keep her privately
At your house?—That was your intention.

PHOR. Ha!

What say you, Sir?

DEM. Give me my money, Sirrah!

PHOR. Give me my wife, I say.

DEM. To justice with him!

PHOR. To justice? Now, by Heaven, gentlemen,
If you continue to be troublesome——

DEM. What will you do?

PHOR. What will I do? Perhaps
You think that I can only patronize
Girls without portion; but be sure of this,
I've some with portions too.

CHREM. What's that to us?

PHOR. Nothing.—I know a lady here whose husband——

CHREM. Ha! (*Carelessly.*)

DEM. What's the matter?

PHOR. —Had another wife
At Lemnos.

CHREM. (*aside*). I'm a dead man.

PHOR. —By which other
He had a daughter; whom he now brings up
In private.

CHREM. (*aside*). Dead and buried.

PHOR. This I'll tell her. (*Going toward the house.*)

CHREM. Don't, I beseech you!

PHOR. Oh! are you the man?

DEM. Death! how insulting!

CHREM. (*to PHORMIO*). We discharge you.

PHOR. Nonsense!

CHREM. What would you more? The money you have got
We will forgive you.

PHOR. Well; I hear you now.

—But what a plague d’ye mean by fooling thus,
Acting and talking like mere children with me?

—I won’t; I will: I will; I won’t again:—

Give, take; say, unsay; do, and then undo.

CHREM. (to DEMIPHO). Which way could he have learn’d this?

DEM. I don’t know;

But I am sure I never mention’d it.

CHREM. Good now! amazing!

PHOR. I have ruffled them. (*Aside.*)

DEM. What! shall he carry off so large a sum,
And laugh at us so openly?—By Heaven,
I’d rather die.—Be of good courage, brother!
Pluck up the spirit of a man! You see
This slip of yours is got abroad; nor can you
Keep it a secret from your wife. Now, therefore,
’Tis more conducive to your peace, good Chremes,
That we should fairly tell it her ourselves,
Than she should hear the story from another.
And then we shall be quite at liberty
To take our own revenge upon this rascal.

PHOR. Ha!—If I don’t take care I’m ruin’d still.
They’re growing desperate, and making tow’rd me
With a determin’d gladiatorial air.

CHREM. (to DEMIPHO). I fear she’ll ne’er forgive me.

DEM. Courage, Chremes!

I’ll reconcile her to’t; especially
The mother being dead and gone.

PHOR. Is this

Your dealing, gentlemen? You come upon me
Extremely cunningly.—But, Demipho,
You have but ill consulted for your brother,
To urge me to extremities.—And you, Sir (to CHREMES),
When you have play’d the whoremaster abroad;

Having no reverence for your lady here,
A woman of condition; wronging her
After the grossest manner; come you now
To wash away your crimes with mean submission?
No.—I will kindle such a flame in her,
As, though you melt in tears, you sha'n't extinguish.

DEM. A plague upon him! was there ever man
So very impudent?—A knave! he ought
To be transported at the public charge
Into some desert.

CHREM. I am so confounded,
I know not what to do with him.

DEM. I know.
Bring him before a judge!

PHOR. Before a judge?
A lady-judge; in here, Sirs, if you please.

DEM. Run you and hold him, while I call her servants.

CHREM. I can not by myself; come up and help me.

PHOR. I have an action of assault against you. (*To DEMIPHO.*)

CHREM. Bring it!

PHOR. Another against you too, Chremes!

DEM. Drag him away! (*Both lay hold of him.*)

PHOR. (*struggling*). Is that your way with me!
Then I must raise my voice.—Nausistrata!
Come hither.

CHREM. Stop his mouth!

DEM. (*struggling*). A sturdy rogue!
How strong he is!

PHOR. (*struggling*). Nausistrata, I say.
Nausistrata!

CHREM. (*struggling*). Peace, Sirrah!

PHOR. Peace, indeed!

DEM. Unless he follows, strike him in the stomach!

PHOR. Aye, or put out an eye!—But here comes one
Will give me full revenge upon you both.

SCENE II.

To them NAUSISTRATA.

NAUS. Who calls for me?

CHREM. Confusion!

NAUS. (*to CHREMES*). Pray, my dear,
What's this disturbance?

PHOR. Dumb, old Truepenny!

NAUS. Who is this man?—Why don't you answer me? (*To CHREMES.*)

PHOR. He answer you! he's hardly in his senses.

CHREM. Never believe him!

PHOR. Do but go and touch him;
He's in a shivering fit, I'll lay my life.

CHREM. Nay——

NAUS. But what means he then?

PHOR. I'll tell you, madam;
Do but attend!

CHREM. Will you believe him then?

NAUS. What is there to believe, when he says nothing?

PHOR. Poor man! his fear deprives him of his wits.

NAUS. (*to CHREMES*). I'm sure you're not so much afraid
for nothing.

CHREM. What! I afraid? (*Endeavoring to take heart.*)

PHOR. Oh, not at all!—And since
You're in no fright, and what I say means nothing,
Tell it yourself.

DEM. At your desire, you rascal?

PHOR. Oh, you've done rarely for your brother, Sir!

NAUS. What! Won't you tell me, husband?

CHREM. But——

NAUS. But what?

CHREM. There's no occasion for it.

PHOR. Not for you:
But for the Lady there is much occasion.
In Lemnos——

CHREM. Ha! what say you?

DEM. (*to PHORMIO*). Hold your peace!

PHOR. Without your knowledge——

CHREM. Oh dear!

PHOR. He has had
Another wife.

NAUS. My husband? Heav'n forbid!

PHOR. 'Tis even so.

NAUS. Ah me! I am undone.

PHOR. —And had a daughter by her there; while you
Was left to sleep in ignorance alone.

NAUS. Oh Heavens!—Baseness!—Treachery!

PHOR. 'Tis fact.

NAUS. Was ever any thing more infamous?
When they're with us, their wives forsooth, they're old.
—Demipho, I appeal to you: for him
I can not bear to speak to.—And were these

His frequent journeys and long stay at Lemnos?
Was this the cheapness that reduc'd our rents?

DEM. That he has been to blame, Nausistrata,
I don't deny; but not beyond all pardon.

PHOR. You're talking to the dead.

DEM. It was not done
Out of aversion or contempt to you.
In liquor, almost fifteen years ago,
He met this woman, whence he had this daughter;
Nor e'er had commerce with her from that hour.
She's dead: your only grievance is remov'd.
Wherefore I beg you'd show your wonted goodness,
And bear it patiently.

NAUS. How! bear it patiently?
Alas! I wish his vices might end here.
But have I the least hope? can I suppose
That years will cure these rank offenses in him?
Ev'n at that time he was already old,
If age could make him modest.—Are my years
And beauty, think ye, like to please him more
At present, Demipho, than formerly?
—In short, what ground, what reason to expect
That he should not commit the same hereafter?

PHOR. (*aloud*). Whoever would attend the funeral
Of Chremes, now's the time!—See! that's my way.
Come on then! provoke Phormio now, who dares!
Like Chremes, he shall fall a victim to me.
—Let him get into favor when he will!
I've had revenge sufficient. She has something
To ring into his ears his whole life long.

NAUS. Have I deserv'd this?—Need I, Demipho,
Number up each particular, and say
How good a wife I've been?

DEM. I know it all.

NAUS. Am I then justly treated?

DEM. Not at all.

But since reproaches can't undo what's done,
Forgive him! he begs pardon; owns his fault;
And promises to mend.—What would you more?

PHOR. But hold; before she ratifies his pardon,
I must secure myself and Phædria. (*Aside.*)
—Nausistrata, a word!—Before you give
Your answer rashly, hear me!

NAUS. What's your pleasure?

PHOR. I trick'd your husband there of thirty minæ,
Which I have giv'n your son; and he has paid them
To a procurer for a mistress.

CHREM. How!
What say you?

NAUS. Is it such a heinous crime
For your young son, d'ye think, to have *one* mistress,
While *you* have *two* wives?—Are you not ashamed?
Have you the face to chide him? answer me!

DEM. He shall do ev'ry thing you please.

NAUS. Nay, nay,
To tell you plainly my whole mind at once,
I'll not forgive, nor promise any thing,
Nor give an answer, till I see my son.

PHOR. Wisely resolv'd, Nausistrata.

NAUS. Is that
Sufficient satisfaction for you?

PHOR. Quite.
I rest contented, well pleas'd, past my hopes.

NAUS. What is your name, pray?

PHOR. My name? Phormio:

A faithful friend to all your family,
Especially to Phædria.

NAUS. Trust me, Phormio,
I'll do you all the service in my power.

PHOR. I'm much oblig'd to you.

NAUS. You're worthy on't.

PHOR. Will you then even now, Nausistrata,
Grant me one favor that will pleasure me,
And grieve your husband's sight?

NAUS. With all my soul.

PHOR. Ask me to supper!

NAUS. I invite you.

DEM. In then!

NAUS. We will. But where is Phædria, our judge?

PHOR. He shall be with you.— (*To the AUDIENCE.*)
Farewell; Clap your hands!

THE END.

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